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BY PHYSICS WALLAH

UPSC WALLAH

INDIAN ART & CULTURE

COMPREHENSIVE LEARNING SERIES FOR
PRELIMS AND MAINS



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EDITION: First

Published By: Physicswallah Private Limited



Physics Wallah Publication

ISBN: 978-93-6034-300-2

Mobile App: Physics Wallah (Available on Play Store)



Website: www.pw.live

Youtube Channel: Physics Wallah - Alakh Pandey
UPSC Wallah
UPSC Wallah - Hindi Medium
PSC Wallah - UP Bihar
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PREFACE

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A plethora of UPSC Study Material is available in the market but PW ONLY IAS professionals are continuously working to provide the supreme quality study material for our UPSC students.

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- Holistic coverage of topics, strictly as per exam syllabus
- One-stop solution for subject wise coverage
- Intensive use of Maps, Diagrams, Flowcharts and Timelines for quick understanding and revision
- Thinking Points in and as 'Ignite Your Mind'
- Updated with latest current affairs and data



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Indian Architecture, Sculpture and Inscriptions

1

INTRODUCTION

Architecture basically means the **art and science of designing structures**. Indian architecture is rooted in India's history, culture, and religion. The story of Indian architecture is also a story of evolution from the ancient Indus Valley civilization to the Post Independence period in India. **Sculpture** is different from architecture in the sense that sculpture is a visual art form in which materials are shaped or **combined to create three-dimensional works of art** and is more related to aesthetics than engineering and measurements.

In this chapter, we will discuss the architectural contributions and art of sculpture and pottery making from different time periods viz. Indus Valley Civilization, Vedic Period, Mauryan & Post Mauryan Period, Gupta Period, Sultanate and Mughal Period, Colonial Period and Post-Independence Period.

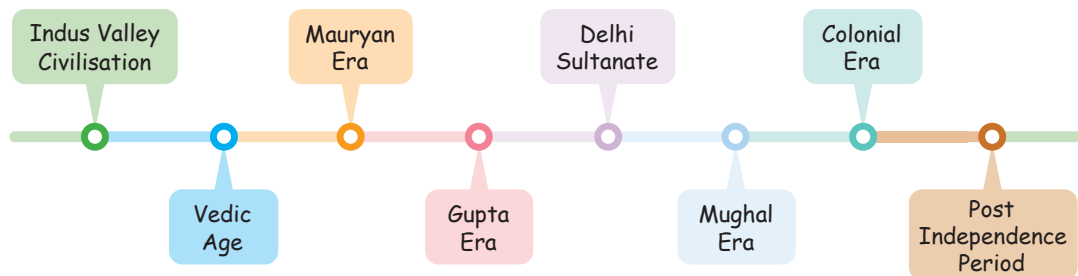


Fig. 1.1: Timeline of History

INDUS VALLEY CIVILIZATION

Indus Valley Civilization emerged in the **second half of the third millennium BC** on the banks of the river Indus. The **first site** to be excavated was **Harappa** therefore, this civilization is also known by the name of **Harappan Civilisation**. The earliest remains of Indian architecture are found in Harappa, Mohenjo-daro, Ropar, Kalibangan, Lothal and Rangpur. Some of the important sites of the IVC and their respective features have been tabled below. Further, in this section **Town Planning, Sculptures** (Stone, Bronze, Terracotta), **Seals, Pottery, Beads** and **Ornaments** of IVC have been discussed.

Sites	Sculptures and Architectural Remains
Harappa State - Punjab (Pakistan) River- Ravi	Two rows of six Granaries , Male torso (Red sandstone), Stone symbols of Lingam and Yoni, Mother Goddess and Dice.
Mohenjo-daro State - Sindh (Pakistan) River - Indus	❑ Post cremation burial, Great Granary, Great Bath (largest building), Pashupati seal, terracotta statue of Mother goddess, Bronze statue of a Dancing girl, Bronze buffalo, Bearded man. ❑ It had a planned town built on a platform, having two distinct areas. One is identified as a citadel, and the other as the lower town.
Chanhudaro State - Sindh (Pakistan) River - Indus	Exclusively devoted to craft production , including Bead-making, Shell-cutting, Metal works, Seal-making and Weights, dog's paw imprint on brick, Terracotta model of bullock cart, and Bronze toy cart.
Lothal State - Gujarat River - On Bhogava river which is a tributary of Sabarmati	❑ Important naval trade site, port and dockyard, Granaries, Double burial (male and female together). ❑ The Citadel was not walled off but was built at a height. The entire settlement was fortified, and sections within the town were also separated by walls.

Dholavira State - Gujarat River - Luni	❑ UNESCO World Heritage Site in 2021. ❑ Unique water harvesting system, stormwater drainage system, Megalithic stone circle, specialised drill, and giant water reservoirs. ❑ Stone was used in construction. ❑ An ancient signboard had been found with letters engraved on it. ❑ This site was divided into three parts (Citadel, Middle Town and Lower Town). ❑ The entire settlement was fortified, and sections within the town were also separated by walls.
Kalibangan State - Rajasthan River - Ghaggar	Bronze figure of a bull .
Banawali State - Haryana River - Sarasvati (Dried up)	❑ Centre of Pre-Harappan, Mature and Late Harappan civilization. ❑ Oval-shaped settlement. ❑ Lack of systematic drainage and the only city with Radial streets.
Rangpur State - Gujarat River - Madar	Remains of both pre-Harappan and mature Harappan culture: Yellow and Grey colour pots of pre-Harappan people.
Daimabad State - Maharashtra River - Pravara	Bronze images (charioteer with chariot, ox, elephant and rhinoceros).
Kot-Diji State - Sindh (Pakistan) River - Sindh	❑ The fortification was made of mud bricks and stone. ❑ 'Wellfired red and buff wares' pottery is found with common motifs like horned deities, pipal leaves and fish scales executed in black.

Town Planning



Fig. 1.2: Harappan Town

Excavation of the Indus Valley Civilization reveals the modern urban nature of this civilisation with expert town planning and engineering skills. The town planning of this civilisation is so advanced that inputs for planning present-day urban spaces can be taken from here. The town was usually divided into two parts.

- ❑ The **upper part** was known as the **Citadel**, located in the **western part**. It was smaller than the lower town and hosted large buildings like **granaries, administrative buildings, pillared halls, residences of the rulers and aristocrats, courtyards etc.**
- ❑ The **lower part** was known as **Lower Town**, which was located in the **eastern part**. It contained small **one-roomed houses, probably for working-class people.**

Architecture of the Lower Town

- ❑ **City planning:** It followed a **grid pattern**, with streets cutting at **right angles**. Planning also involved **laying streets first**, then building houses along them. The streets were broad, dividing the town into rectangular and square blocks.
- ❑ **Construction material:** For construction, they used **bricks and stones**. The houses were built of **mud bricks** and drainages of **burnt bricks**.
 - The bricks were of identical **1:2:4 ratio** in terms of thickness, width, and length across all Harappan structures. The houses had **bathrooms** paved with **burnt bricks** and proper **drains**.

Contemporary buildings in **Egypt** mainly use **dried bricks** for construction. We find the use of **baked bricks** in contemporary **Mesopotamia**, but they were used to a much larger extent in the Harappan cities.

❑ Other Features

- **Houses** varied in size, with **two or more stories** and **multiple rooms**, but were quite **monotonous**.
- Many of the houses had a **central courtyard** with rooms all around. The **courtyard** was the centre of the **residential building**, with rooms on all sides. It was the centre of activities such as cooking and weaving.
- In **Kalibangan**, many houses had **wells**, often in a room that could be reached from the outside and perhaps used by passers-by.

❑ Drainage System

- Every house was connected to the **street drains**.
- The main channels were made of bricks set in mortar and were **covered with loose bricks** or limestone that could be removed for cleaning.
- House drains were first emptied into a **sump or cesspit** into which solid matter settled while wastewater flowed out into the street drains.
- Very long drainage channels were provided at intervals with sumps for cleaning.



Fig. 1.3: Drainage System

Architecture of Upper Town

- ❑ **Planning:** It was constructed on a **mud-brick platform** and was **physically separated** from **Lower Town** through a wall.



Fig. 1.4: The Great Bath

- ❑ **Purpose:** It had important **residential structures**, possibly occupied by **ruling class** members. It contained structures that were used for particular public purposes. These include the **Great Bath** and the **Warehouse (Granary)**.
- ❑ **Other important structures in the Upper Town**
 - **The Great Bath (Mohenjo-daro):** It was meant for some kind of special **ritual bath**.
 - ❑ It was a large rectangular tank in a courtyard surrounded by a corridor on all four sides.
 - ❑ The floor of the bath was made of burnt bricks.
 - ❑ There were **side rooms** for changing clothes.
 - ❑ The bricks were laid watertight with gypsum mortar.
 - **Granaries:** They constituted an important part of the Harappan sites.
 - ❑ **The Great Granary** was the **largest** building in **Mohenjo-daro**.
 - ❑ There were **six granaries** in the citadel of **Harappa**. Circular brick platforms were evidently meant for threshing grains, as **wheat** and **barley** have been found in the crevices of the floors.
 - ❑ At **Kalibangan**, the southern part of the brick platform may have been used for granaries.



Fig. 1.5: The Great Granary



IGNITE YOUR MIND

“To what extent did the emphasis on public infrastructure, such as the Great Bath and granaries, reflect a communal approach to urban living, and what lessons can contemporary cities draw from this cooperative model?”

Sculpture

The **first** known sculptures of the Indian subcontinent were from the Indus Valley civilization made up of **stone, bronze** and **clay**.

Stone Statues

- ❑ **Bust of a Bearded Man (Mohenjo-daro):** The statue is made up of **steatite** and is interpreted as a **priest**. It bears a close resemblance to a similar figure discovered in the **Sumerian sites** of **Ur** and **Susa**.



Fig. 1.6: Bearded Man

- **Features:** The figure of the bearded man is draped in a shawl coming under the right arm and covering the left shoulder. This shawl is decorated with trefoil patterns. The eyes are a little elongated and half-closed, as in meditative concentration. The hair is parted in the middle, and a plain woven fillet is passed around the head. An armlet is worn on the right hand, and holes around the neck suggest a necklace.

- ❑ **Male torso in Red Sandstone (Harappa):** There are **socket holes** in the neck and shoulders for the attachment of the head and arms. The frontal posture of the torso has been consciously adopted. The shoulders are well-baked, and the abdomen is slightly prominent.



Fig. 1.7: Torso in Red Sandstone

- ❑ **Male Dancer:** It was discovered at **Harappa**, showing the importance of music and dance.

Bronze Figures

Bronze is an alloy of copper and tin. The Harappans had knowledge of bronze casting. Bronze statues of **human** as well as **animal figures** were found, which were made using the “**lost wax technique**” or “**Cire Perdue**”.

- ❑ Examples include animal figures of a **buffalo**, **copper dog** and **bird of Lothal** and a **bronze figure of a Bull** from **Kalibangan**. **Bronze sculptures** from **Daimabad (Maharashtra)** showcase unique representations, such as the **Chariot** driven by a **human figure** with **sturdy bulls** in the forefront.

Lost Wax Technique

Wax figures were first covered with a coating of clay and allowed to dry. Then the wax was heated, and the molten wax was drained out through a tiny hole made in the clay cover. The hollow mould thus created was filled with molten metal, which took the original shape of the object. Once the metal cooled, the clay cover was completely removed.

- ❑ **Bull (Mohenjo-daro):** The massiveness of the bull and the fury of the charge are eloquently expressed. The animal is shown standing with his head turned to the right and with a cord around the neck.

Dancing Girl

This is an approximately **four-inch-high** copper figure found in **Mohenjo-daro**. This exquisite casting depicts a girl whose long hair is tied in a bun. **Bangles** cover her left arm, a **bracelet** and an amulet or bangle adorn her right arm, and a **cowry shell necklace** is seen around her neck. Her right hand is on her hip, and her left hand is clasped in a traditional **Indian dance gesture (Tribhanga posture)**. She has large eyes and a flat nose. This figure is full of expression and bodily vigour and conveys a lot of information.



Fig. 1.8: Dancing Girl

Terracotta

It refers to the **use of fire-baked clay** for making sculptures. They were made using the **pinching method** and had been found mainly in the sites of **Gujarat** and **Rajasthan**.

- ❑ **Mother Goddess Figure (Mohenjo-daro):** Mother Goddess was worshipped for fertility and prosperity. The mother goddess figures are usually crude standing female figures adorned with necklaces hanging over prominent breasts and wearing a loin cloth and a girdle. The fan-shaped head-dress with a cup-like projection on each side is a distinct decorative feature of the mother goddess figures of the Indus Valley. The pellet eyes and beaked nose of the figures are very crude, and the mouth is indicated by a slit.
- ❑ Other figures like that of a pair of squirrels, a toy animal (Mohenjo-daro), a bearded male with coiled hair, and toy carts with wheels were also found.



Fig. 1.9: Mother Goddess

Seals

The standard Harappan seal was a **square plaque**, usually made of **steatite** and engraved with a **pictographic script** (which is yet to be deciphered). While most of the seals are **square**, it was found that **triangular, rectangular, circular** and **cylindrical seals** were also being used. Other materials used in making seals were **agate, chert, faience, terracotta, gold, ivory** and **copper**.



Fig. 1.10: Harappan Seal

- ❑ **Figures on seals:** Generally, they had an **animal** or **human figure** on **one side** and an **inscription** on the **opposite side** or inscriptions on both sides. Animal figures include the **Unicorn, Bull, Rhinoceros, Tiger, Elephant, Bison, Goat, Buffalo** etc. However, there was **no evidence of cows** on the seals.
- ❑ **Use of Seals**
 - They were used by different **guilds or merchants** and traders for stamping purposes.
 - It appears that the seals were also used as **amulets**, carried by their owners, perhaps as **modern-day identity cards**.

Pashupati Seal

- ❑ It is a **steatite seal** discovered at **Mohenjo-daro**. It depicts a human figure or a deity sitting cross-legged (seated figure of a Yogi).
- ❑ An **elephant** and a **tiger** are depicted on the right side of the seated figure, while on the left, a **rhinoceros** and a **buffalo** can be seen. Below the seat, **two antelopes** are shown.
- ❑ This seal may shed light on the religion of the Harappan age.



Fig. 1.11: Pashupati Seal

Pottery

The Indus Valley pottery consists chiefly of very fine **wheel-made wares**, very few of which were **hand-made**.

- ❑ Plain pottery is generally made of **red clay**, with or without a fine red or grey slip.
- ❑ The **black-painted ware** has a fine coating of red slip, on which **geometric** and **animal designs** are executed in glossy black paint.



Fig. 1.12: Pottery of Harappa

- ❑ **Polychrome pottery** was rare and mainly comprised of small vases decorated with **geometric patterns in red, black, green, rarely white and yellow**.
- ❑ **Incised Ware** was also rare, with incised decoration confined to the bases of pots.

Uses of Pottery

- ❑ **Perforated pottery** with large holes at the bottom and small holes all over the wall was probably used for **straining the liquor**.
- ❑ **Miniature vessels**, generally less than half an inch in size, were used for **decorative purposes**.
- ❑ Pottery for **household purposes** was found in all shapes and sizes. Graceful curves were used, while straight and angular shapes were an exception.

Beads and Ornaments

Bead industry was well developed, as evident from **factories** discovered at **Chanhu-daro** and **Lothal**.

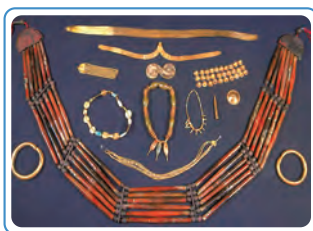


Fig. 1.13: Harappan Ornaments

- ❑ **Precious metals, gemstones, bone and baked clay** were used to make beads. Some of the materials used were carnelian, amethyst, jasper, crystal, quartz, steatite, turquoise, lapis lazuli, copper, bronze, gold, shell, faience, terracotta, etc.
- ❑ **Necklaces, fillets, armlets and finger rings** were commonly worn by both men and women, but **girdles, earrings and anklets** were worn by only women.
- ❑ The people of the time were **conscious of fashion**.
 - **Cinnabar**, an ore of mercury, was used to make face paints, sindoor and lipstick, among other things. **Face paint, lipstick and collyrium** (eyeliner) were also known to them.
- ❑ A cemetery has been found at **Farmana** (Haryana), where dead bodies were buried with ornaments.

Overall, the art and architecture of the Indus Valley Civilization reflect a highly organized society with advanced engineering skills and a rich cultural and religious life.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

“How did the detailed craftsmanship of Harappan seals contribute to the recording of economic transactions, and what can these seals reveal about the complexity of their trade networks and commercial activities?”

VEDIC AND LATER VEDIC PERIOD

The time period of the **Early Vedic** phase spans from **1500 BC to 1000 BC**. During the early Vedic period, Aryans were mainly confined to the **Indus region**, referred to as **Sapta Sindhu** or the land of seven rivers in the Rigveda. Their region covered present-day parts of Afghanistan, Punjab, and Haryana. The early Vedic inhabitants were **pastoralists**. Cattle rearing was their primary occupation.

Later Vedic phase spans between **1000 BC to 600 BC**. In this phase, **Aryans moved to eastern areas (up to Bengal)**, the core area being the **Kuru-Panchala region** (Indo-Gangetic divide and the upper Ganga Valley). Tribal kingdoms in the East were **Magadha, Anga, and Vanga**. Later Vedic texts refer to the three divisions of India: **Aryavarta** (Northern India), **Madhyadesa** (Central India), and **Dakshinapatha** (Southern India). The Western Ganga-Valley was called ‘Aryavarta’. During this phase, **agriculture** became the mainstay of the Vedic people.

Art and Architecture of the Vedic Period

The contributions of the Vedic Aryans to architectural history is the **use of wood along with bricks and stones** for building their houses. They hardly knew the use of burnt bricks. Art forms of the time include:

- ❑ Weaving, leatherwork, pottery, and carpentry.
- ❑ Potters were referred to as **Kulala**, and wool was referred to as **Urna sutra**.
- ❑ **Painted Grey ware** was the prominent pottery during this time period.
- ❑ Black Slipped Ware, Plain Grey Ware, and Black-and-Red Ware were some other associated potteries of this period.

Painted Grey Ware Culture

- ❑ The **Iron Age of north India** is broadly associated with PGW culture. The pottery tradition in this culture is grey and decorated with black designs.



- ❑ The major archaeological sites of this culture are Ahichhatra, Hastinapura, Kaushambi, Shravasti, Sringaverpura and Mathura in Uttar Pradesh; Vaishali in Bihar; Manda in Jammu; Ujjain in Madhya Pradesh; Ropar in Punjab; Noh in Rajasthan and Bhagwanpura in Haryana.

- ❑ PGW carries various geometric designs such as lines, criss-crosses, circles, dots, sigma and semi-circles etc. The swastika is also depicted on some pottery.

Fig. 1.14: Painted Grey Ware

Knowledge of Metals

The use of iron was started around 1200 BC, and it was termed **Krishna Ayas/Shyama Ayas**. Around 1000 BC, it was used in the **Gandhara** area, eastern Punjab, western UP, MP, and Rajasthan.

- ❑ Excavations reveal the use of iron weapons by the Aryans, like **arrowheads and spearheads**, in **western UP** from about 800 BC onwards.
- ❑ The **iron axe** was used to clear the forests in the **upper Gangetic basin**. Towards the end of the Vedic period, knowledge of iron spread in **eastern UP** and **Videha (Mithila region)**.
- ❑ Metals such as **copper, tin, gold, bronze and lead** are mentioned. The **copper objects** were used for making weapons for war and hunting.
- ❑ **Glass manufacturing** was also known to them.

While the Vedic period is not as well-documented in terms of art and architecture compared to later periods, archaeological findings, textual references, and later developments suggest a rich cultural and religious landscape that laid the foundation for subsequent artistic and architectural traditions in India.

MAURYAN ART AND ARCHITECTURE

Magdha, evolving into a formidable kingdom, extended its dominion over neighbouring regions. By the **fourth century BC**, the Mauryas established their dominance, and by the third century BC, a substantial part of India fell under Mauryan rule. Despite the existence of various forms of worship, Buddhism emerged as the most widely embraced social and religious movement, which influenced the art and architecture of the time. The art form of the Mauryan empire can be divided into **Court art** and **Popular art** based on the presence or absence of state patronage.

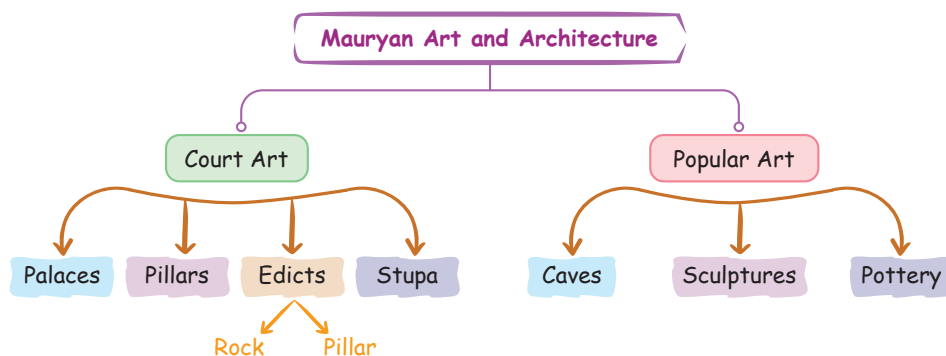


Fig. 1.15: Mauryan Art and Architecture

Court Art

It includes the architectural works commissioned by rulers. It was used for **political as well as religious purposes**. Some of these architectural works include Palaces, Pillars, Rock edicts and Stupas.

Palaces

- ❑ Mauryan palaces were examples of the splendour of Mauryan art and architecture.
- ❑ The Palace of **Chandragupta Maurya** was inspired by the **Achaemenid palaces** at Persepolis in **Iran**. As per Megasthenes, it was one of the greatest creations of mankind. Wood was the principal building material.
- ❑ **Ashoka's Palace** at **Kumrahar** had a grand 80-pillared Assembly hall. All the pillars were rock cut. Wooden structures with decorative carvings covered the remaining portion of the palace.

Pillars

The tradition of constructing pillars is very old, and it may be observed that the erection of pillars was prevalent in the Achaemenian empire as well. However, the Mauryan pillars are different from the Achaemenian pillars. **The Mauryan pillars are rock-cut pillars**, thus displaying the carver's skills, whereas the **Armenian pillars are constructed in pieces**

by a mason. Stone pillars were erected by Ashoka, which have been found in the north Indian part of the Mauryan Empire with **inscriptions engraved on them**. Ashoka's pillar inscriptions were built as a **symbol of the state** and to **commemorate battle victories**.

- ❑ The pillars were usually made of **Chunar sandstone**.

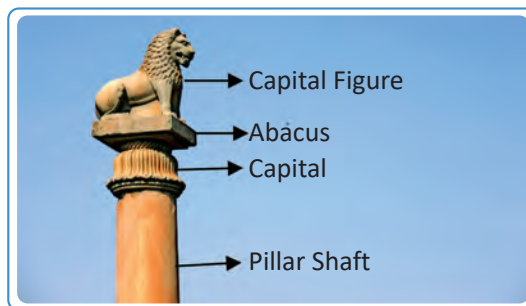


Fig. 1.16: Lion Pillar in Vaishali

- ❑ The pillar is made up of **four parts**:
 - **Capital Figure**: They are usually figures of animals like **bull, lion, elephant** etc. All the capital figures are vigorous and carved standing on a square or circular abacus.
 - **Abacus**: On the top of the capital, there was a circular or rectangular base known as the Abacus on which animal figures were placed.

- **Capital:** It lays above the shaft and could be either lotus-shaped or bell-shaped. The bell-shaped pillars, influenced by Iranian pillars, are known for their lustrous and polished finish.
- **Shaft:** The shaft formed the base and was made up of a single piece of stone or monolith.

- ❑ Some of the existing pillars with capital figures were found at **Basarah-Bakhira (Lion)**, **Lauriya Nandangarh (Lion)** and **Rampurva (Bull)** in Bihar; **Sankisa (Elephant)** and **Sarnath (Lion)** in Uttar Pradesh.

Lion Capital of Ashoka (Sarnath)

- ❑ The Lion Capital is part of a column erected by the Mauryan Emperor Ashoka in the 3rd century BC.
- ❑ The sculpture is made of **sandstone** and is **highly polished**, giving it a smooth and lustrous appearance.
- ❑ This **pillar capital** was built by Ashoka commemorating **Dharmachakrapravartana** (the first sermon by the Buddha).
- ❑ It is renowned for its depiction of **four lions** standing back to back, symbolizing power, courage, and the spread of Buddhism.
- ❑ The **abacus** features the **Dharmachakra**, a Buddhist wheel of law, which is a symbol of the teachings of Buddha. The wheel is surrounded by a frieze of four animals that represent four directions - a **horse** (West), an **elephant** (East), a **bull** (South) and a **lion** (North). The abacus has the depiction of a **chakra** (wheel) having **twenty-four** spokes in all four directions.
- ❑ The **Elephant** depicts the **dream of Queen Maya**, the **Bull** depicts the **zodiac sign** of the month in which Buddha was born (Taurus), the **Horse** represents the **Buddha's horse 'Kanthaka'** which he used to go away from princely life, and the **lion** shows the **attainment of enlightenment**.
- ❑ The **four lion symbols** symbolise Buddha spreading Dhamma in all directions.
- ❑ The Lion Capital of Sarnath has been adopted as the **National Emblem of India**. In the National Emblem, the words '**Satyameva Jayate**' from **Mundaka Upanishad**, meaning "Truth alone triumphs", are inscribed below the abacus in Devanagari script.



Fig. 1.17: Sarnath Lion Capital (National Emblem of India)



Fig. 1.18: Lauriya Nandangarh Pillar

Lauriya Nandangarh Pillar

- ❑ The **Ashoka pillar** in Lauriya-Nandangarh is exceptionally polished in the distinctive Mauryan style, much like the others.

- ❑ The capital of this pillar comprises a **single seated lion**, the abacus consists of **a row of geese flying clockwise**.
- ❑ This abacus is attached to the pillar with metal dowel rods and set on an **inverted bell-shaped lotus** with fluted petals.
- ❑ It includes the six proclamations, or edicts, of Ashoka written in both Prakrit and Brahmi.

Rampurva Bull Capital

- ❑ The Rampurva Bull Capital is an archaeological artefact associated with the Mauryan Empire, specifically dating back to the **3rd century BC**.
- ❑ The capital is made of highly **polished sandstone**.
- ❑ It is a mixture of **Indian and Persian elements**. The motifs on the base, atop the inverted lotus, the rosette, the palmette and the acanthus ornaments are not Indian features.
- ❑ The **bull** is often considered a **symbol of strength and vitality** in Indian art and mythology. In the context of Ashoka's pillars, it might have represented the **power and prosperity** associated with the Mauryan Empire.



Fig. 1.19: Rampurva Bull Capital

Difference between Ashokan and Achaemenian pillars

Aspect	Ashokan Pillar	Achaemenian Pillar
Period	3rd century BC.	6th - 4th century BC.
Purpose	Independently erected.	Part of the palace.
Material	Sandstone or other local stones.	Limestone, sandstone or other local stones.
Structure	Single monolithic shaft with a capital.	Tall, fluted shaft with elaborate capital and made up of several stones cemented together.
Religious influence	Associated with Buddhism.	Associated with Zoroastrianism and Persian culture.
Capitals	Sculptures of lions, elephants and bulls.	No capitals, only images of humans are engraved on shafts.

Edicts of Ashoka

There are 33 edicts (inscriptions) on rocks and pillars that are found in the Indian subcontinent and Kandahar in Afghanistan. Ashoka was the first Indian king to **speak directly to the people** through inscriptions to spread the message of Dhamma in order to solve the problems of society. These edicts are the first concrete proof of Buddhism. They were generally placed on **ancient highways** and provided details about the empire's policies and extent.

James Prinsep deciphered the edicts of Ashoka in **1837**. He deciphered the **Brahmi** and **Kharosthi** scripts used in the earliest inscriptions and coins.

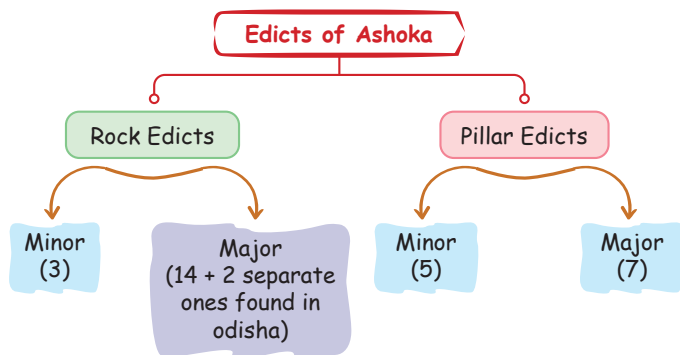


Fig. 1.20: Classification of Ashoka's Edicts

Rock Edicts

Minor Rock Edicts

The Minor Rock Edicts of Ashoka are found at 17 locations, and they consist of three main edicts, with some variations in content depending on the location. Majority of these were written in Prakrit and are present at the following known locations:

New Delhi: Bahapur;

Rajasthan: Bairat;

Andhra Pradesh: Yerragudi, Rajula Mandagiri;

Bihar: Sasaram;

Uttar Pradesh: Ahraura.

Madhya Pradesh: Gujjara, Rupnath, Panguraria;

Karnataka: Maski, Gavimath, Palkigundu, Nittur, Udegolam, Brahmagiri, Siddhagiri and Jatinga Rameshwara.

❑ **Gujjara Minor Rock Edict I:** In this edict, Ashoka is referred as **Devanampiya Piyadasi Asokaraja**.

❑ **Maski Minor Rock Edict:** Ashoka is referred as Ashoka himself instead of Devanampiya Piyadasi.

Minor Rock Edict	Description
Edict 1	In this Edict, Ashoka describes himself as a Buddhist layman (Upasaka).
Edict 2	Ashoka emphasizes virtues of Dhamma should be followed.
Edict 3	Only appears at Bairat. Ashoka claims, "Great is my reverence and faith in the Buddha, the Dharma (and) the Samgha", and makes a list of recommended Buddhist scriptures that Buddhist monks, as well as the laity, should repeatedly study.

Major Rock Edicts

- There are **14 Major Rock Edicts** and two separate ones found in Odisha.
- These are found in 10 locations, viz. **Kandahar** (Afghanistan), **Dhauli** and **Jaugada** (Odisha), **Yerragudi** (Andhra Pradesh), **Sannati** (Karnataka), **Bombay-Sopara** (Maharashtra), **Girnar** (Gujarat), **Kalsi** (Uttarakhand), **Mansehra** and **Shahbaz Garhi** (Pakistan).
- Most of the edicts were written in **Prakrit language** and **Brahmi Script**. The edicts present in present-day Pakistan were in Prakrit language and Kharosthi script. **Kandahar bilingual rock inscriptions** were written in **Greek and Aramic**.

Major Rock Edict	Theme
Edict 1	Prohibition of animal sacrifice and holidays on festive gatherings.
Edict 2	One of the functions of the state was to provide medical care . He ordered hospitals to be set up to treat human beings and animals .
Edict 3	Officials, like the Yuktas (subordinate officials) and Pradesikas (heads of the districts), were to go on tours every five years to instruct people about dhamma (a code of conduct and morals such as charity, kindness, benevolence and tolerance, to be followed).
Edict 6	It expresses King's desire to be constantly informed about the people's conditions.
Edict 7	It is a request for tolerance among all religious groups.
Edict 8	❑ The emperor renounced his previous habit of travelling on hunting expeditions. ❑ The account details Ashoka's maiden trip to Bodh Gaya. ❑ Declares that the emperor will go on Dhamma yatras, or journeys.
Edict 9	❑ He disapproved of the rituals held following childbirth, during sickness, prior to marriage, and before embarking on a voyage. ❑ He focused on the Dhamma rituals, which entail moral behaviour.

Edict 10	He rejected fame and glory and reiterated the benefits of adhering to the Dhamma's teachings.
Edict 11	The importance of treating friends liberally, refraining from killing animals, and showing respect for elders is emphasized.
Edict 12	A call for religious tolerance .
Edict 13	- It mentions the war with Kalinga. - It is important to understand the Asokan policy of Dhamma, which pleads for conquest by Dhamma instead of War.
Edict 14	This Dhamma-related record has been expanded or simplified to enable individuals to act in the right way.
Separate Major Rock Edict I and II	These rock edicts contain instructions related to the administration for the officials of Dhauili and Jaugada .



Fig. 1.21: Dhauili Rock Edict

Pillar Edicts

Minor Pillar Edicts

- These have been found at Sanchi, Sarnath, Prayagraj, Rummindei and Nigali Sagar.
- These inscriptions are written in Prakrit language and Brahmi script.
- Rumendei Pillar Inscription of Ashoka (Lumbini, Nepal):** Ashoka visited and worshipped the place, as Shakyamuni was born there.
- Sanchi, Sarnath and Prayagraj Pillar Inscription:** It is mentioned that dissidents in the sangha could face punishment. In the Prayagraj inscription there is mention of Ashoka's queen, Karuvaki.

Major Pillar Edicts

- These are a total of **seven** in number.
- These were found at the following locations: **Allahabad** (Uttar Pradesh), **Rampurva** (Bihar), **Kandahar** (Afghanistan), **Lauriya-Nandangarh** (Bihar), **Lauriya Araraj** (Bihar), **Delhi-Topra** (has all seven major pillar edicts present) and **Delhi-Meerut**.
- Except for the Kandahar inscription, all other inscriptions are written in Prakrit language and Brahmi script.
- There are **two Ashokan pillars** in **Rampurva** i.e. **Bull capital pillar** (no inscription is inscribed) and **Lion capital pillar** (Edict I to VI is inscribed).



Fig. 1.22: Rampurva Lion Capital

Major Pillar Edict	Description
Edict I	Outlined his ideals for the security of people.
Edict II	Describes the Dhamma in terms of kindness, veracity, righteousness, etc.
Edict III	Asks people to restrain from cruelty, enmity, violence, and rage.
Edict IV	Rajukas's responsibilities and duties.
Edict V	List of birds and animals that should be slaughtered on specific days and those that should not be slaughtered at all.
Edict VI	The Dhamma policy.
Edict VII	Ashoka outlines the aspiration of every group for mental purity and restraint.



Fig. 1.23: Edict of Ashoka

Inscriptions on the Allahabad Pillar (An Ashokan Stambh)

- ❑ **Ashokan Inscription** is in the Prakrit language and Brahmi script.
- ❑ **Inscription of Samudragupta** is written by **Harisena** in Sanskrit language. This inscription is also known as **Prayag Prashasti**.
- ❑ **Birbal Magh Mela Inscription** of the 16th century AD.
- ❑ **Jahangir's Inscription** was written in the Persian Language and in fine Nastaliq script.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

"How did the strategic placement of Ashokan pillars at key sites, such as major trade routes and urban centers, influence cultural integration and communication within the diverse Mauryan society?"

Stupa

Stupas are hemispherical structures in Buddhist architecture, often containing relics or sacred objects. They serve as focal points for devotion and meditation, embodying key Buddhist principles of impermanence, enlightenment, and the path to liberation.

Patrons of Stupa

- ❑ Patrons range from lay devotees to **Gahapatis** (a wealthy property-owner) and **Kings**.
- ❑ Donations by the guilds are also mentioned at several sites. However, there are very few inscriptions mentioning the names of artisans, such as **Kanha at Pitalkhora** (Satmala range in western ghats) and his disciple **Balaka at Kondane** caves (near Lonavala) in Maharashtra.
- ❑ From the second century BC onwards, the pattern of patronage has been a very collective one, and there are very few examples of royal patronage. One of the examples of the structure of a stupa in the third century BC is at **Bairat in Rajasthan**.

Features of the Stupa

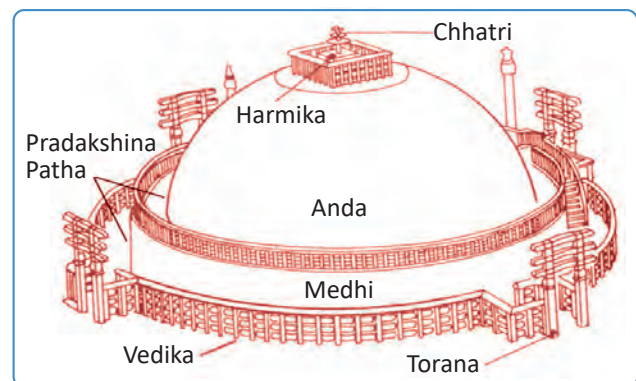


Fig. 1.24: Parts of Stupa

The Buddhist stupa is a **hemispherical dome with a solid structure**.

- ❑ The **core** of the Stupa was made of **unburnt brick**, while the **outer surface** was made of **burnt bricks**.
- ❑ It consists of a **circular cylindrical drum** with a **Harmika** and **Chhatra** on the top.
- ❑ It is surrounded by a **circumambulatory passage** or **Pradakshinapatha**, where devotees walk around.
- ❑ The whole structure was also surrounded by **wooden railings** and gateways called **Toranas**.
- ❑ Buddha's life events like **birth, renunciation, enlightenment, dhammachakrapravartana**, and **mahaparinibbana** were depicted through symbols like **lotus, elephant, Jataka stories etc.**

Symbolism in the Stupa

The stupa represents the teachings and enlightenment of the Buddha.

- ❑ The '**Harmika**' symbolizes achieving **Nirvana**.
- ❑ '**Toranas**' are the principal teaching areas which are covered in carvings depicting stories about the Buddha and religious topics. They are arranged in **all four directions** and contain the **Jatakas**.
- ❑ The deeper significance of '**Anda**' is that it is a symbol of latent creative power. The Anda was also meant to serve as a **visual representation of the cycle of rebirth and death**, much like the limitless dome of heaven.
- ❑ The parasol, which suggested nobility and grandeur, stood for enlightenment or the sacred tree of life.
- ❑ The **Dharma** (the Law), the **Sangha** (the society of monks), and the **Buddha** were the **three Jewels** of Buddhism, and they were represented by the three components of the '**Chattra**' at Sanchi.
- ❑ '**Vedikas**' served to demarcate the boundary of the sacred precinct with the secular world.

Location of Stupas

Tradition has it that after the great demise of Lord Buddha, Emperor Ashoka decided to construct a large number of stupas throughout his dominion in memory of the master and enshrine in them relics such as pieces of bones, teeth, hair etc., over which the Stupas were constructed.

- ❑ Stupa constructed over the **relics of Buddha**:
 - **Rajagraha, Vaishali, Vethadipa** in Bihar.
 - **Kapilavastu, Allakappa and Ramagrama** in Nepal.
 - **Kushinagar, Pava and Pippalvina** in Uttar Pradesh.
- ❑ The textual tradition also mentions the construction of various other stupas on the relics of the Buddha at several places, including **Avanti** and **Gandhara**, which are outside the Gangetic valley.
- ❑ **Bharhut, Bodh Gaya, Amravati** and **Nagarjunakonda** were other important sites.

Sanchi Stupa



Fig. 1.25: Sanchi Stupa

Sanchi stupa, a **world heritage site**, lies to the west of the **Betwa River** in Raisen district near **Bhopal**. The great stupa was built by Ashoka in the third century BC. It enshrines religious relics or the remains of the Buddha and his most revered disciples.

- ❑ Along with other relatively small stupas, there are **three main stupas at Sanchi**.
 - **Stupa-1** is presumed to have the **relics of the Buddha**.
 - **Stupa-2** contains the **relics** of ten less famous **arhats** (who have attained enlightenment) belonging to three different generations. Their names are found on the relic casket.
 - **Stupa-3** has the relics of **Sariputta** and **Mahamougalayana** (the two chief disciples of the Buddha).
- ❑ The **Ashokan lion-capital pillar** with an inscription is found on the **southern side of the stupa**.
- ❑ There is also the **upper Pradakshina path** which is unique to this site.
- ❑ There are guardian images on pillars, and the **Shalbhanjika** (lady holding the branch of a tree) sculptures are remarkable in their treatment of volume.
- ❑ The **mound** of the stupa was built during the time of **Ashoka**. Over the course of the next thirteen centuries, expansion to the stupa kept taking place.

Popular Art

In addition to royal support, a variety of artistic mediums, including sculpture, ceramics, and cave construction, arose via local support. These were categorised as forms of popular art.

Cave Architecture

Rock-cut architecture refers to a method of creating architectural elements, structures, or entire buildings by carving directly into natural rock formations or cliffs.

- ❑ Rock-cut cave architecture emerged during the Mauryan period were characterised by **highly polished interiors** and **decorative gateways**. These were generally used as **viharas** (living quarters) by the **Jain** and **Buddhist monks**. The early Mauryan caves were used by **Ajivika sects** and later, they became popular as **Buddhist monasteries**.

❑ **Barabar** and **Nagarjuni caves** in **Bihar** were formed during the Mauryan period.

- The Barabar Hills embrace a cluster of four caves, together called Barabar caves. These are known as 'Lomas Rishi', 'Sudama', 'Vishwakarma' and 'Karan Chaupar' caves.
- **Nagarjuni caves** include Vadathi-ka-kubha, Vape-ka-kubha and Gopi-ka-Kumbha.

Lomas Rishi Caves

These are rock-cut caves carved in the **Barabar hills** near **Gaya in Bihar**. The facade of the cave is decorated with the **semicircular chaitya arch** as the entrance. The elephant frieze carved in high relief on the chaitya arch shows considerable movement. The interior hall of this cave is rectangular, with a circular chamber at the back. The entrance is located on the side wall of the hall. These caves were donated by **Ashoka** to the **Ajivika sect**.



Fig. 1.26: Lomas Rishi Cave

Sculptures

Indian sculpture considerably progressed during the Mauryan period and was largely **influenced** by **Buddhism**. However, sculptures from the Mauryan period are related to all three religions - **Jainism, Hinduism and Buddhism**.

❑ **Mauryan pillars** like the **Lion Capital (Sarnath)** and the **Bull Capital (Rampurva)** were built by Ashoka.

❑ In **Dhauili (Orissa)**, there is an **image of an elephant** carved out from a rock. It shows modelling in a round with a linear rhythm. It was created during Ashoka's reign. This was the first time a massive animal figure had been carved out of a boulder or rock and contains edicts of Ashoka (268-232 BC).

❑ The **Torso of a male figure** found at **Lohanipur (Bihar)** probably represents a **Jain Tirthankara**.

❑ Large statues of **Yakshas and Yakshinis** were found in places like **Patna, Vidisha and Mathura**. These monumental images are mostly in the standing position. One of the distinguishing elements in all these images is their polished surface. The depiction of faces is in full round with pronounced cheeks and physiognomic detail.



Fig. 1.27: Didarganj Yakshini

Yakshas and Yakshinis

They were **related to all three religions: Jainism, Hinduism and Buddhism**. The earliest mention of yakshi can be found in Silappadikaram. These images are mostly in **standing position** with **well-polished surfaces**.

❑ Didarganj Yakshini

- It is a tall, well-proportioned, free-standing sculpture in round made in sandstone with a polished surface. The chauri is held in the right hand, whereas the left hand is broken.
- The face has round, fleshy cheeks, while the neck is relatively small in proportion; the eyes, nose and lips are sharp. Folds of muscles are properly rendered.
- The necklace beads are in full round, hanging to the belly.
- The hair is tied in a knot at the back.
- The back is bare. Drapery at the back covers both legs.
- The flywhisk in the right hand is shown with incised lines continued on the back of the image.

Pottery

❑ Pottery of the Mauryan period is known as **Northern Black Polished Ware (NBPW)**.

❑ They were characterized by black paint and a **highly lustrous finish** and were considered the **highest level of pottery**.

❑ This pottery has been found at more than 1500 sites and extends from **Taxila** and **Charsada** in the northwest to **Amaravati** in Andhra Pradesh; and from **Prabhas Patan** in Gujarat to **Tamluk** in Bengal.

❑ The main excavated sites are Ropar in Punjab, Raja Karna Ka Tila and Daulatpur in Haryana; Hastinapura, Atranjikheda, Kaushambi, Shravasti in UP; Vaishali, Patna and Sonpur in Bihar.

❑ At sites in Punjab, Haryana, Rajasthan and UP, it is preceded by the PGW phase with an overlap between them.

❑ In eastern UP and Bihar, NBPW follows the Black-and-Red ware phase.

Overall, Mauryan art and architecture reflect the empire's cultural richness, religious diversity, and the patronage of rulers like Ashoka towards Buddhism and other faiths. These artistic and architectural achievements laid the foundation for subsequent developments in Indian art and culture.



Fig. 1.28: Northern Black Polished Ware



IGNITE YOUR MIND

“How did the establishment of cave complexes, such as those at Barabar and Nagarjuni, serve strategic or symbolic purposes for the Mauryan administration, and what insights can these structures provide into the political landscape of the time?”

POST-MAURYAN ART AND ARCHITECTURE

The art of a period reflects the changing socio-political scenario. In Mauryan times, due to the state patronage of Buddhism, Buddhist influence on art and architecture of that period was quite evident. In post-Mauryan times, the influence of Hinduism on art and architecture became prominent.

Art and architecture of Post Mauryan Period contain **Rock cut cave** architecture, **Stupas, Sculptures** (Gandhara, Mathura and Amaravati School) and **Inscriptions**.

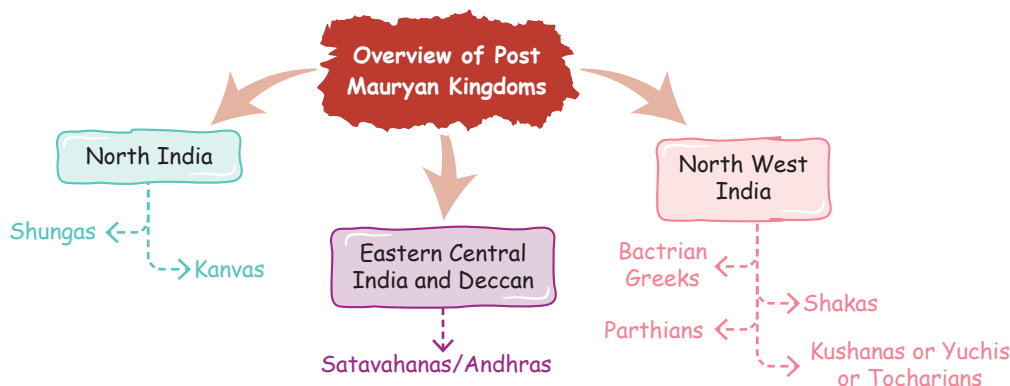


Fig. 1.29: Polity during the Post Mauryan times

Rock-Cut Caves

This period saw the development of two types of caves i.e. Chaityas and Viharas. The caves were generally decorated with human and animal figures, they also had **courtyards** and **stone screen** walls.

Chaityas	Viharas
- Used as prayer halls. - Chaityas were with Stupas. - These have a small rectangular doorway that opens to a vaulted Hall with an apsidal end. At the end, there is a stupa.	Residential places for Buddhist and Jain monks. - Viharas did not have stupas. - They consist of a main hall, assembly hall and dining chambers. - From the halls deep into the rocks, cells are provided for meditation.
Fig. 1.30: Plan of Chaitya	Fig. 1.31: Plan of Vihara

Cave Tradition in Western India

In western India, many Buddhist caves dating back to the **second century BC** have been found.

- Mainly three architectural types were executed
 - Apsidal vault-roof chaitya halls** (found at Ajanta, Pitalkhora, Bhaja).
 - Apsidal vault roof pillarless Hall** (found at **Thana-Nadsur** in Maharashtra).

- **Flat roofed quadrangular hall** with a circular chamber at the back (found at **Kondivite** in Maharashtra).
- Subsequently, the **quadrangular flat-roofed** variety became the most preferred design and is extensively found in many places.



Fig. 1.32: Karla Chaitya

- ❑ Many chaityas i.e. Buddhist prayer halls have been excavated. Karla Chaitya is the **biggest rock-cut Chaitya Hall**.
- ❑ In the fourth and fifth century AD, the stupas situated at one end of Chaitya have Buddha images attached.
- ❑ The viharas are excavated in all the cave sites. The plan of the viharas consists of a veranda, a hall and a cell around the walls of the hall. Later, a stupa was added at the back of the hall of the vihara, and it became a chaitya-vihara.
- ❑ Some of the important **vihara caves** are at **Ajanta**, **Bedsa** and **Nashik** Caves.
- ❑ The **vihara caves** at **Nashik** were excavated with front pillars carved with **ghata-base** and **ghata-capital** with **human figures**.
- ❑ **Other Cave Sites: Bhaja Caves** near Pune have Buddhist caves, **Kanheri** in Mumbai, etc.
- ❑ **Junnar** has the **largest cave excavations**. Vihara cave was also excavated at **Junnar** in Maharashtra, which is popularly known as **Ganeshleni** because an image of Ganesha belonging to a later period was installed in it.

Nasik Caves (Maharashtra)

These caves are also known as **Pandav Leni Caves** and are a collection of **24 Buddhist caves** dedicated to the **Hinayana faith**.

- ❑ The inscriptions in the Nasik Caves talk about the King of Western Maharashtra, Kshatrapa dynasty, Satavahana dynasty.
- ❑ Beautiful sculptures, chambers, unusual water features, and stone ladders constructed inside the cave are features of the Pandav Leni cavern.

The tradition of rock-cut caves continued in the Deccan, and they are found not only in **Maharashtra** but also in **Karnataka**, mainly at **Badami** and **Aihole**, executed under the patronage of the **Chalukyas**; in Andhra Pradesh in the area of **Vijayawada**; and in Tamil Nadu, mainly at

Mahabalipuram, under the patronage of the **Pallavas**. The post-sixth-century development of art history in the country depended more on political patronage than the collective public patronage of the early historic periods.

Cave Tradition in Eastern India

Buddhist caves have been excavated mainly in the coastal regions of Andhra Pradesh and Odisha.

Guntapalle Cave (Andhra Pradesh)

- ❑ The caves were excavated in the **second century BC**.
- ❑ The cave is **relatively small** compared to the caves of western India.
- ❑ It is among the unique sites where **structured stupas**, **viharas** and **caves** are excavated in one place.
- ❑ It has a **circular chaitya cave** and **rectangular vihara caves**.

Other Cave Sites in Andhra

- ❑ Cave site **Rampaerrampallam** has very moderate small excavations, but there are rock-cut stupas on the hillock.
- ❑ **Anakapalli in Vishakhapatnam**: A huge rock-cut stupa was carved out of the hillock during the fourth-fifth century AD. It is a unique site as it has **the biggest rock-cut stupas** in the country.
- ❑ **Dhanyakataka (Andhra Pradesh)**: Prominent Buddhist centre under the Mahasanghikas.

Udayagiri-Khandagiri Caves (Odisha)

- ❑ They have inscriptions of **Kharavela Jain kings**. According to the inscriptions, the caves were meant for **Jain monks**.
- ❑ The figures in this cave are **voluminous** and **move freely** in the picture space. Some caves in this complex were excavated later, sometime in the eighth-ninth centuries AD.
- ❑ There are numerous **single-cell excavations**.



Fig. 1.33: Varaha Avatar (Udayagiri caves)

Stupas

- ❑ Stupas became **larger and more decorative** in the post-Mauryan period.
- ❑ **Stone** was increasingly used in place of wood and brick.
- ❑ The **Shunga** dynasty introduced the idea of **Torans**. The Torans were carved with figures and patterns and were evidence of Hellenistic influence.
- ❑ Examples: **Bharhut Stupa** and **Sanchi Stupa** in Madhya Pradesh.

Sanchi Stupa (Madhya Pradesh)

The **mound** of the stupa was built during the time of **Ashoka**. Over the course of the next thirteen centuries, expansion to the stupa kept taking place.

- ❑ In the middle of the **second century BC**, during the **Shunga** period, the original brick structure was enlarged to twice its size and the mound was covered in sandstone slabs.
- ❑ A **circumambulatory walkway** was constructed around the stupa which was bounded by a stone railing also known as '**Vedika**'. Moreover, a '**Harmika**' was also added to the stupa.
- ❑ The most elaborate additions to the stupa were made during the **Satavahana** period from the first century BC to the second century AD. Four stone gateways/ **Toranas** were added to the stupa in the four cardinal directions. These toranas were richly carved with episodes from the life of Buddha and the jatakas.
- ❑ The victory inscription of Chandragupta II is carved on the railing of the Great Stupa dating to the fourth century AD.

The site is said to have been a thriving religious centre from the third century BC to the thirteenth century AD. Its decline as a prominent religious site coincided with the decline of Buddhism in the Indian subcontinent.

Amaravati Stupa (Andhra Pradesh)

- ❑ Like the Sanchi Stupa, the Amaravati Stupa also has pradakshina patha enclosed within a vedika on which many narrative sculptures are depicted.
- ❑ The mound of the stupa is elaborately carved with niches and sculptures.
- ❑ The torana of the Amaravati Stupa has disappeared over a period of time. Like Sanchi, the early phase is devoid of Buddha images but during the later phase, in the second and third centuries AD, the Buddha images are carved on the drum slabs and at many other places.
- ❑ Figures are slender, have a lot of movement, bodies are shown with three bents (i.e. tribhanga), and the sculptural composition is more complex than at Sanchi.
- ❑ Narratives are profusely depicted, which include events from the life of the Buddha and the Jataka stories.

Bharhut Stupa (Madhya Pradesh)

- ❑ Asoka constructed the Bharhut stupa at first, but the Sungas later made modifications.
- ❑ Stupas at Sanchi and Bharhut were plain except for the stone railings.
- ❑ The layout of the four Torana gates and the stone railing encircling the centre stupa were similar to that of Sanchi.



Fig. 1.34: Part of railing of Stupa from Bharhut

- ❑ The inscriptions on the railings of the Bharhut stupa reveal that laypeople, monks, and nuns provided reliefs and figures, in contrast to the Mauryan imperial art. Hence, it is among the first instances of popular art in Maurya.
- ❑ There are several pictures of the yakshas and yakshis on the railings of the Bharhut stupa.
- ❑ Buddha has been portrayed through symbols.
- ❑ One of the prominent motifs on the railing of the Bharhut "stupa" is Queen Maya's dream.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

In what ways did the decorative motifs on stupas symbolize the cosmological and symbolic aspects of Buddhism, and how did these visual representations contribute to the transmission of Buddhist ideology to a diverse audience?

Post Mauryan Sculpture

Evolution of Sculpture Tradition

First century AD onwards, **Gandhara** (now in Pakistan), **Mathura** in northern India and **Vengi** in Andhra Pradesh emerged as important centres of art production. Buddha in the symbolic form got a **human form** in Mathura and Gandhara.

Gandhara School of Art

Gandhara art is known for its unique **blend of Indian, Central Asian, and Greco-Bactrian elements**. This syncretic art form emerged as a result of cultural interactions during the conquests of Alexander the Great, the Greco-Bactrian Kingdom, and the Kushan Empire.

- ❑ Influenced by the idealist style of the Greeks, Buddha is depicted as having a muscular body showing strength and beauty.
- ❑ Gandhara art incorporates Greek mythological figures.
- ❑ Gandhara art utilized **materials like grey schist and stucco**, reflecting the influence of Greco-Bactrian cultures.
- ❑ Gandhara art features Roman elements such as realism i.e. depiction of real people unlike the presentation of Buddha with ideal features.
- ❑ The main theme of this art was **Lord Buddha** and **Bodhisattvas (Mahayana Buddhism)**.



Fig. 1.35: Sculpture from Gandhara School

Mathura School of Art

- ❑ Images of **Vaishnava** (mainly Vishnu and his various forms) and **Shaiva** (mainly the Lingas and Mukhalingas) faiths were found at Mathura, but **Buddhist images** were also found in large numbers.
 - One notable feature of images of Vishnu and Shiva is that they are **represented by their Ayudhas** (weapons).
- ❑ Early **Jain Teerthankar** images and portraits of kings, especially the **headless Kanishka**, are also found in Mathura.
- ❑ The local sculptural tradition at Mathura spread to northern India, like the stupa sculptures found at **Sanghol** in the Punjab.



Fig. 1.36: Mathura School

Amaravati School of Art

- ❑ During the **Satavahana period**, an aesthetic movement of greater magnitude developed in **Andhra Pradesh**.
- ❑ The sculptures belonging to the Amaravati school are found in the valley of Krishna on the sites and museums of **Jaggayyapetta, Amaravati** and **Nagarjunakonda**.
- ❑ The Amaravati style is more elegant and sophisticated. The sculptured panels of Amaravati are characterised by delicacy of forms, and linear grace.



Fig. 1.37: Amaravati School

Comparison Between Different Schools of Art

Dimensions	Gandhara School	Mathura School	Amaravati School
External Influences	Greco-Roman influence.	Purely indigenous . Modelled on the lines of earlier Yaksha images found during the Mauryan period.	Purely indigenous .
Religious influence	Buddhism and Hellenistic realism.	Hinduism, Buddhism and Jainism . Images from the Vaishnava and Shaiva faiths are also found.	Religious and secular images, but the main theme includes the life stories of Buddha and the jatakas .
Material used	Bluish-grey sandstone and Grey sandstone	Spotted red sandstone	White Marble
Patronage	Kushana	Kushana	Satavahanas
Area of Development	North West frontier including locations like Taxila, Peshawar, Begram and Bamiyan	Flourished on the banks of river Yamuna	Developed in the Krishna- Godavari Valley. Notable sites: Amravati, Goli, Vengi, Nagarjunikonda, and Ghantasala
Features of Buddha sculpture	❑ Spiritual Buddha ❑ Wavy hair ❑ Less ornamentation ❑ Long ears and long forehead ❑ Buddha in Yogi posture with eyes half closed. ❑ Protuberance on the head signifying the omniscience of Buddha. ❑ Halo around the head of Lord Buddha	❑ Delighted Buddha ❑ Face muscular and energetic. ❑ Buddha seated in Padmasana surrounded by two Bodhisattvas- Padmapani and Vajrapani. ❑ Protuberance similar to that of Gandhara image. ❑ Halo around the head of Buddha is decorated with geometrical patterns.	❑ Less emphasis on individual features of Buddha. ❑ The sculptures generally depict the life stories of Buddha and the Jataka tales. ❑ Other sculptures: taming of Nalagiri (mad elephant) and the presentation of Prince Rahul to his father, the Buddha.

Bharhut Sculpture (Madhya Pradesh)

- ❑ **Green Schist** was used for carving the sculptures.
- ❑ They are **tall**, like the images of **Yaksha** and **Yakshi** in the Mauryan period. Here, the sculptural volume is in low relief, maintaining linearity. Images stick to the picture plane.
- ❑ There is a **general stiffness** in the **body** and **arms**. Due to the shallow carving of the picture surface, projection of hands and feet was not possible, hence, the **folded hands** and **awkward position of the feet**.
- ❑ One main characteristic in all the male images of the 1st and 2nd century BC is the **knotted headgear**.



Fig. 1.38: Dream of Maya

- ❑ **Narrative reliefs** at Bharhut were used as pictorial language to effectively communicate stories like **Queen Mayadevi's dream, depiction of Ruru Jataka** (where the Bodhisattva deer is rescuing a man on his back), etc.

In terms of stylistic development, the subsequent stage of sculpture development at **Sanchi Stupa-1, Mathura**, and **Vengi** in Andhra Pradesh (Guntur District) is notable.

Sanchi Sculptures (Madhya Pradesh)

The current stupa at Sanchi was first built during the reign of Ashoka, but it was expanded, and in the first century BC, the outer railing and circumambulatory enclosure were added.

- ❑ Stupa-1 at Sanchi has an upper as well as lower pradakshina patha or circumambulatory path. It has **four** beautifully decorated **toranas** depicting various events from the life of the Buddha and the Jatakas. Some of the stories include the **Siege of Kushinara, Buddha's visit to Kapilavastu, and the visit of Ashoka to the Ramagrama Stupa (Nepal)**.
 - ❑ Carving techniques appear more advanced than **Bharhut**.
 - ❑ Heads have a considerable projection in the picture space.
 - ❑ In the Eastern Gate of the Stupa, there is a scene depicting a bracket figure of a **Vrikshika (tree Goddess) or wood nymph** in **Tribhanga** posture.
 - ❑ Figure compositions are in high relief. Depiction of posture gets naturalistic and there is no stiffness in the body; images are given movement. Heads have a considerable projection in the picture space.
 - ❑ At Sanchi Stupa-1, narratives get more elaborated; however, the depiction of the dream episode remains very simple.
- Some of the prominent examples of the finest sculpture are found at **Vidisha, Bharhut** (Madhya Pradesh), **Bodhgaya** (Bihar), **Jaggayyapeta** (Andhra Pradesh), **Mathura** (Uttar Pradesh), **Khandagiri-Udaigiri** (Odisha), **Bhaja** near Pune and **Pavani** near Nagpur (Maharashtra).



Fig. 1.39: Mahakapi - Jataka at Bharhut Stupa

Other Post-Mauryan Sculptures Include

- ❑ The **dwarfish Yaksha** from the **Pithalkhora caves** (Satmala range of the Western Ghats) in Maharashtra.
- ❑ The **stupa** was built by the **Ikshvakus** at **Nagarjunikonda**.
- ❑ The **Vessantara Jataka from Goli** (1st century AD) depicts Buddha in his previous birth as **Prince Vessantara**, who was never tired of giving away everything he had in charity.
- ❑ The carvings from **Karle** date to the first century AD with figures of **Dampati** and **Mithuna**.

Post Mauryan Inscriptions

Junagadh/Girnar Rock Inscription (Gujarat)

- ❑ These rocks bear the inscriptions of **Ashoka** (3rd century BC), **Rudradaman I** (a saka ruler, 2nd century BC) and **Skandagupta** (Gupta ruler, 5th century BC).
- ❑ The Ashokan edict is written in Prakrit language and Brahmi script.
- ❑ There is mention of restoration of a reservoir by Rudradaman I in the inscription of Rudradaman.

Hathigumpha Inscription (Odisha)

- ❑ This inscription is found in the **Udayagiri caves** of Odisha.
- ❑ **King Kharavela** inscribed this inscription.
- ❑ It is written in Prakrit language and Brahmi script.
- ❑ It is the main source of information about Kalinga ruler Kharavela who was a **patron of Jainism**.

Besnagar Pillar Inscription (Madhya Pradesh)

- ❑ The Garuda Pillar was set up in the 2nd century BC by Heliodorus, an ambassador of the Greek king in the court of a Shunga Prince.
- ❑ This inscription is written in Prakrit language and Brahmi script.
- ❑ This pillar was set up in honour of God Vasudeva by Heliodorus who describes himself as Bhagvata (worshipper of Krishna).

Naneghat Inscription (Maharashtra)

- ❑ This inscription is attributed to the **Satavahana dynasty**.
- ❑ Inscription dates around the 2nd -1st century BC.
- ❑ These inscriptions refer to **tax exemptions** given to the lands granted to Buddhist monks.
- ❑ The inscriptions present the world's oldest numeration symbols for "2, 4, 6, 7, and 9" which resemble modern-era numerals, more closely than those found in modern Nagari and Hindu-Arabic script.

Hathibada Ghosundi Inscription (Rajasthan)

This is a Sanskrit Inscription in Brahmi script related to Vaishnavism.

Rabatak Inscription (Afghanistan)

- ❑ This inscription dates back to around the 2nd century AD.
- ❑ It is written in the Bactrian Language and Greek script.
- ❑ It gives information about the Kushan dynasty and particularly about the Kushan ruler Kanishka.

Kanaganahalli Inscription (Karnataka)

It contains various sculptural slabs among which there is a portrait slab of King Ashoka which contains a single line label 'Ranyo Ashoka' written in Brahmi script.

Vakataka Inscriptions

Vakatakas (250 AD-500 AD) were contemporaries of Gupta rulers and successors of the Satavahana dynasty. **Ramtek Kevala Narasimha temple inscription** (Maharashtra), **Tirodi Copper Plates** (Madhya Pradesh) and **Chamak Copper Plates** (Maharashtra) provide details of this dynasty.

Nagarjunakonda Inscriptions (Andhra Pradesh)

- ❑ These inscriptions are related to the **Ikshvaku dynasty** and written in Brahmi script.
- ❑ These have a connection to Shaivism and Buddhism.

Nashik Prashasti

- ❑ This inscription belongs to the mother of Satavahana king **Gautamiputra Satkarni**.
- ❑ It describes Gautamiputra Satkarni as '**Ekabrahmana**' (An extraordinary Brahmana) and **Khatiya-dapamanamada** (one who destroyed the pride of Kshatriyas).

Bandhogarh Inscriptions (Madhya Pradesh)

The contributions made by merchants are mentioned. It is a rare example of a secular gift.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

Considering the influence of foreign invasions and cultural exchanges during the post-Mauryan times, how did inscriptions facilitate the integration of new rulers and their ideologies, and what role did these epigraphs play in cultural assimilation and adaptation?

GUPTA ART AND ARCHITECTURE

The Gupta Empire rose in the middle of the **3rd century AD** after the decline of the Satavahanas, Kushans and Murundas. Guptas were possibly the feudatories of Kushans in Uttar Pradesh, with the centre of power in Prayaga. The Gupta Empire is often called the "**Golden age of ancient India**". Early Gupta rulers encouraged Buddhist Architecture, but later, temple architecture was encouraged. Gupta art was mostly inspired by religion, and there were very few non-religious art forms.

In this section along with Rock Cut Cave, Stupa, and Temple architecture, art of Sculpture (Sarnath School), Pottery and Inscriptions (Gupta and Post Gupta period) have been discussed.

Rock Cut Caves

Ajanta Caves



Fig. 1.40: Ajanta Caves

- ❑ Ajanta is a series of **rock-cut caves**, all arranged in a **horse-shoe shape** located in the **Sahyadri hills** by the gorge of the **Waghora River** in the **Aurangabad** district of **Maharashtra**.
- ❑ Ajanta has **29 caves**. It has **4 chaitya caves** datable to the earlier phase, i.e., **the second and the first century BC** (Cave Nos. 10 and 9) and the later phase, i.e., the **fifth century AD** (Cave Nos. 19 and 26).
- ❑ **Satvahana Kings** gave patronage to these caves in the **first phase**. This phase is also known as the **Hinayana Phase**, as a symbolic representation of Buddha was done. The focus was given to stupas.



Fig. 1.41: Cave 26: Mahaparinirvana of Buddha

- ❑ The construction under the **second phase** was done during the Gupta and Post Gupta periods under the patronage of the **Vakataka rulers**. This phase is known as the **Mahayana phase**.
- ❑ In **Ajanta caves**, the **sculpture of Buddha in the garbagriha** is in the classical model. Heaviness is the general character of the sculptures. Sculptures of **Yakshis** and **Hariti** with children are significant. The popular Bodhisattva **Avalokitesvara** is depicted in paintings and sculptures.

Ellora Caves

- ❑ These caves are located in **Aurangabad** District, Maharashtra.
- ❑ It has an overall total of **34 Buddhist, Brahmanical and Jain caves**.
- ❑ These caves were developed between the **5th and 11th centuries AD** (newer as compared to the Ajanta caves).
- ❑ At Ellora, the **triple storey** is a unique achievement.



Fig. 1.42: Cave no. 12 (Teen Tal), Ellora

Buddhist Caves Ellora

- ❑ Buddha images are bigger in size and they are generally guarded by the images of **Padmapani** and **Vajrapani**.
- ❑ The Buddhist caves have many images belonging to Vajrayana Buddhism, like **Tara, Mahamayuri, Akshobya, Avalokiteshwara, Maitreya, Amitabha etc.**
- ❑ The central figure is Buddha, found in three sagacious postures: meditating (**Dhyana mudra**), preaching (**Vyakhyana mudra**) and touching the earth by the index finger of the right hand (**Bhumi-sparsha mudra**).
- ❑ Buddhist caves represented **goddesses** by way of the **carved images of Tara, Khadiravani-tara, Chunda, Vajradhat-vishvari, Maha-mayuri, Sujata, Pandara and Bhrikuti.**

Caves of Vedic Religion

The earliest caves in these groups are modest and simple. Mostly, of them are square-shaped except for the Kailasanatha cave (**cave-16**).

Kailasanatha Temple (Cave-16)

- ❑ It is a **monolithic** structure carved from a **single solid rock**. This temple is said to represent Kailash, the abode of Lord Shiva.
- ❑ The temple was built by **Krishna I (756-773 AD)** of the **Rashtrakuta Dynasty**.
- ❑ The temple is **two-storied**, and the **Kailasa temple is on the first one**.
- ❑ The **lower storey** has carved **life-size elephants**, which look like they are holding up the temple on their backs.
- ❑ The temple exterior has images of **Saivite and Vaishnavite** deities.
- ❑ The courtyard has two huge pillars with the **flagstaff** and a **Nandi mandapa**.
- ❑ The **wedding ceremony of Siva-Parvati**, the attempted **lifting of the Kailasa mountain by Ravana**, and the **destruction of Mahisasura by the goddess Durga** are beautiful sculptures.
- ❑ An interesting sculpture is that of the **river goddess Ganga mounted on a crocodile** and the **river goddess Yamuna mounted on a tortoise**.
- ❑ Among the Shaivite themes, **Ravana shaking Mount Kailash, Andhakasurvadha**, and **Kalyanasundara** are profusely depicted, whereas among the Vaishnavite themes, the different avatars of Vishnu are depicted.



Fig. 1.43: Kailasanatha Temple



Fig. 1.44: Cave 16: Ravana Shaking Mount Kailash

Jaina Caves

The Cave nos. 30-34 belongs to the Jaina tradition. They are generally dated between 9th and the 11th – 12th centuries A.D.

- ❑ Out of the five caves, **Caves 32 and 33** are the most important ones. They are known as **Indra Sabha** and **Jagannath Sabha** respectively.
- ❑ Cave 32 is actually a series of shrines dedicated to Mahavira and other Jaina divinities aesthetically arranged in double storeys.
- ❑ There is a **monolithic elephant** that reminds one of the elephants sculpted in the court of Kailasa, but here it is more elegant and well preserved.
- ❑ Cave 30 is an unfinished excavation resembling the Great Kailasa; hence, it is known as **Chhota Kailasa** (Small Kailasa).
- ❑ Figures of Yaksha-matanga, Mahavira, Parsvanatha, and Gomatesvara can be found in these caves.

Some of the Prominent Caves of Ellora

Cave 10

- ❑ Vishwakarma Cave or **Carpenter's Cave**.
- ❑ Buddha seated in **Dharmachakra Mudra** with a Bodhi tree carved at his back.

Cave 12

- ❑ A stout female figure is depicted wearing a waistband and headgear of a cobra.
- ❑ Khadrivani-tara also holds a cobra in one of her hands in the same cave.

Cave 14 - Ravan ki Khai.

Cave 15 - Dashavatar temple: It has cells and a layout plan that is similar to Buddhist Caves 11 and 12, which suggests this cave was intended to be a Buddhist cave. However, the presence of non-Buddhist features, such as a **Nrtya Mandapa** (an Indian classical dance pavilion) at its entrance, indicated otherwise.

Cave 29 - Dhumar Lena: Early Hindu temple building in the cave is centred around the "Vale Ganga", a natural waterfall that was integrated into the monument. It is dedicated to Lord Shiva.

Bagh Caves: They are located on the banks of the **Baghni River** in Dhar district of **Madhya Pradesh** and is a group of **nine Buddhist caves**. It was developed around 5th-6th century AD, mostly during the **Satavahana period**. The most significant cave is **the Rang Mahal**.

Junagadh Caves (Gujarat)

- ❑ Its unique feature is the presence of a 30-50 ft high citadel known as **'Upar kot'** in front of the prayer hall. Upar Kot has many interesting Buddhist caves.

- ❑ Its entrance is in the form of an archway which is a fine specimen of Hindu torana.
- ❑ There are halls connected by winding staircases.
- ❑ Apparently, some of the caves were two to three storeys high.

Mandapeshwar Caves (Near Mumbai)

- ❑ These are also known as **Montperir Caves**.
- ❑ These were developed in the later Gupta period as a **Brahmanical cave** and was later converted into a **Christian cave**.

Udayagiri Caves (Different from Udayagiri - Kandagiri Caves of Odisha)

These are located in Vidisha, Madhya Pradesh and were created in the early 5th century AD under the patronage of **Chandragupta II**.

Elephanta Caves (Mid-5th to 6th Centuries AD)



Fig. 1.45: Maheshmurti, Elephanta Caves

- ❑ It is located on Elephanta Island (otherwise known as the Island of Gharapuri) near **Mumbai** and was **originally a Buddhist site**, later dominated by the **Shaivite faith**. It is contemporary with Ellora, and it is famous for its **sculptures**. It is a **UNESCO World Heritage site**.
- ❑ It has **Five Hindu caves** and **a pair of Buddhist caves**.
- ❑ The most important cave is the **Maheshmurti cave**.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

To what extent did the surge in temple construction during the Gupta period corresponds to a renaissance in Hinduism, and how did these temples serve as centres for religious practices, rituals, and cultural expression?

Stupas

There was a decline in the development of stupas during the Gupta age. Though, following prominent stupas were constructed during this period. During the reign of Gupta rulers, Sarnath developed as a great school of art, introducing some new features and spiritual aspects in sculptures.



Fig. 1.46: Dhamek Stupa

- ❑ **Dhamek stupa** is the largest stupa in Sarnath. It marks the spot where Buddha proclaimed his faith.
- ❑ **Chaukhandi stupa** is a three-tiered (Trimedhi) stupa of Gupta period. It is surmounted by an octagonal superstructure constructed during the Mughal period to commemorate Humayun's one-night stay at this spot.
- ❑ The final form of the **Sarnath stupa** dates from the Gupta period. Its inner core is the only part that has remained.

Devnimori in Gujarat is an important stupa site **outside the Gangetic Valley**. The site is vaguely dated to the 3rd century or 4th century AD.

Note: Temple architecture has been separately discussed in the 2nd chapter.

Sculpture

In India, the **classical era of sculpture** began during the Gupta era.

- ❑ Gupta sculpture is the logical outcome of the early classical sculpture of **Amaravati** and **Mathura**.
 - Gupta sculptures derived their **plasticity from Mathura** and **elegance from Amaravati**.
 - The art of Bharhut, Amravati, Sanchi and Mathura grew ever more integrated.
- ❑ The traditional centre, **Mathura**, remained the main art production site, whereas **Sarnath** and **Kosambi** also emerged as important centres of art production in the 5th and 6th century AD.

Examples of Gupta Sculptures

- A **Red sandstone** image of the **Buddha** from **Mathura** with his right hand in **Abhaya mudra**.
- In another image, Buddha was shown seated in **Vijraparyanka** in **Dharmachakrapravartana Mudra** (the gesture of Preaching).
- **Metal Sculpture** includes seven-and-a-half feet high **Sultanganj Buddha (Bihar)**.
- The large panel of **Sheshashayi Vishnu** from the **temples at Deogarh (Uttar Pradesh)** and the **Great Boar (Varaha)** at the entrance of temples in **Udayagiri (Madhya Pradesh)** and **Ajanta** are excellent specimens of figure sculptures.
- At a **Shiva temple** in **Ahichhatra** (Uttar Pradesh), there are life-sized **terracotta images of Ganga** and **Yamuna** standing on a **Crocodile** and a **Tortoise**, respectively, are the attendants of Lord Shiva.



Fig. 1.47: Red Sandstone Buddha



Fig. 1.48: Ganga and Yamuna at Ahichhatra Temple

Sarnath School of Sculpture

- ❑ The **human figurine** was the pivot of Gupta sculpture.
- ❑ It used **cream-coloured sandstone** and **metal** in its sculptures.
- ❑ Buddha images in **Sarnath** have **plain transparent drapery**, whereas the Mathura Buddha images continue to depict folds of the drapery.
- ❑ The **halo** around the head of Buddha has very little ornamentation.

Terracotta and Pottery

- ❑ Clay figurines were used both for **religious** and **secular** purposes.
- ❑ Gupta pottery remains were found at Ahichhatra, Rajgarh, Hastinapur and Bashar. The most distinctive class of pottery of this period is "**red ware**".

Inscriptions

❑ Sanchi Inscription (Madhya Pradesh)

- It belongs to the period of the Gupta Emperor Chandragupta II.
- He is described as Maharajadhiraja or "Lord of Great Kings".
- It is written in Sanskrit.
- It is a Buddhist inscription and records the grant made to the Buddhist establishment.

❑ Mehrauli Inscription (Delhi)

- The **Iron Pillar** now seen at the **Qutb Complex**, New Delhi, India, was originally erected during the time of **King Chandragupta II** of the Gupta dynasty.
- It is also thought to have been created in honour of the Hindu god Lord Vishnu.
- This inscription lauds the accomplishments of the Gupta emperor Chandragupta Vikramaditya.

❑ Bhitari Pillar Inscription (Uttar Pradesh)

- It dates to the reign of Gupta Empire ruler **Skandagupta**.
- Inscription suggests that Skandagupta restored the Gupta power by defeating his enemies, who may have been rebels or foreign invaders. He repulsed an invasion by the Hunas.
- It also mentions the conflict between Skandagupta and Pushyamitras

❑ Mandsaur Pillar Inscription (Madhya Pradesh)

- It was written in Sanskrit and mentions the rule of **Yashodharman**.
 - ❑ Yashodharman was a ruler of Malwa, in Central India, during the early part of the 6th century. He probably belonged to the Second Aulikara dynasty.

❑ Aihole Inscription (Karnataka)

- It was composed by the Jain poet **Ravikirti** in honour of his patron king **Pulakeshin II** of the Badami **Chalukya dynasty**.
- The inscription is in Sanskrit language and Kannada script.
- There is a mention of the defeat of Harshavardhana and Pallavas by Chalukyas. Harshavardhan was defeated by Pulakesin II.

❑ Eran Boar Inscription (Madhya Pradesh)



Fig. 1.49: Eran Boar inscription

- The Eran boar inscription of **Toramana**, is a stone inscription found in Eran in the Malwa region of Madhya Pradesh.
- It has 8 lines of Sanskrit and the first evidence of Sati is found on this inscription.

❑ Halmidi Inscription (Karnataka)

- This is the oldest known Kannada-language inscription in the Kadamba script.

❑ Tumen Inscription (Madhya Pradesh)

- **Kumaragupta I**, the Gupta king, had a temple built during his reign, according to the epigraphic record found in the Tumen inscription of Kumāragupta.

❑ Shankarpur Copper Plate (Madhya Pradesh)

- The inscription is the final known document pertaining to the later Gupta monarch **Budhagupta**, which makes it an extremely significant record of the history of the Gupta Empire.
- The plate is a record documenting a donation in the reign of King Budhagupta.

❑ Inscriptions of Harshavardhan

- **Sonepat** Plate Inscription (Haryana)
- **Banskhara** Copper Plate Inscription (Uttar Pradesh): It has a signature of Harshavardhan.
- **Madhuban** Plate Inscription (Uttar Pradesh)

❑ Mangulam Inscriptions (Tamil Nadu)

- The inscription, written in Tamil Brahmi script mentions that workers of a Pandyan king of the Sangam period made stone beds for Jain monks.

❑ Pugalur and Arachchalur Inscriptions (Tamil Nadu)

- The inscriptions are in Tamil Brahmi script.
- There is a mention of donations by Chera rulers.

Overall, Gupta art and architecture represent a **pinnacle of artistic achievement in ancient India**, characterized by its elegance, refinement, and spiritual profundity. The period witnessed a synthesis of diverse cultural influences, resulting in a rich and vibrant artistic tradition that continues to inspire awe and admiration today.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

Characterized by intricate ornamentation, innovative structural techniques, and a harmonious blend of religious and secular motifs, Gupta architecture epitomizes the cultural and intellectual flourishing of the Gupta Empire. Discuss.

INDO-ISLAMIC ARCHITECTURE

Indo-Islamic architecture started with the **Ghurid occupation** of India at the end of the **12th century AD**. The Muslims have combined varied designs from the **Sassanian** and **Byzantine empires**, which they inherited, with the local culture, giving rise to **Indo-Saracenic** or **Indo-Islamic architecture**.

Important Features of Indo-Islamic Architecture

- ❑ **Materials used for construction:** The walls in all buildings were extremely thick and were largely constructed of **rubble masonry**. These walls were then cased over with limestone plaster or dressed stone.
- ❑ The **Arcuate style** of architecture replaced the traditional **Trabeate style** of architecture.
- ❑ Introduced the **use of Minars** around mosques, **ornamentation** (using inlay work), **brackets**, **domes** etc.
- ❑ The buildings had intricate **jaali works** to provide ventilation and natural light.
- ❑ Muslims, **forbidden to replicate living forms** on any surface, developed their religious art and architecture, consisting of the arts of **Arabesque**, **geometrical patterns** and **calligraphy** on plaster and stone.

Arabesque: An ornamental design consisting of intertwined flowing lines, leaves and flowers.

- ❑ Courtyard pools and fountains became important features as they served the purpose of decoration, cooling of premises and ablution before the prayer.
- ❑ They introduced the '**Charbagh style**' of garden, in which a square block was divided into four identical gardens.

❑ Other techniques include:

- **Pietra-dura:** It is a technique which refers to a **pictorial mosaic work** using **semi-precious stones**.
- **Tessellation (or Tiling):** A technique for the decoration of walls and floors with mosaic.
- **Foreshortening technique:** It is a technique to give the illusion of depth. It visually compresses long objects to appear shorter.

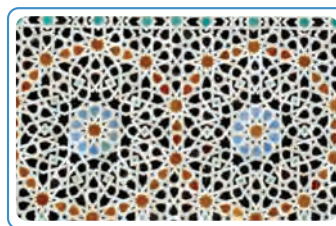


Fig. 1.50: Tessellation (Tiling)



Fig. 1.51: Jaali Work

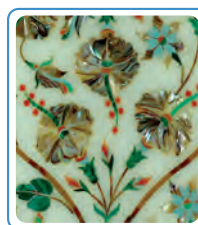


Fig. 1.52: Pietra Dura



Fig. 1.53: Arabesque Pattern

Difference between Arcuate style and Trabeate style

Arcuate Style	Trabeate Style
❑ Arches were constructed with voussoirs (series of interlocking blocks) fitted with keystones. ❑ Arches made the construction of domes possible in this style. ❑ Primary materials used: Brick, Lime plaster, and Mortar.	❑ Uses brackets, pillars and lintels for construction. ❑ Use of conical or curvilinear shikhara on the top of the temples. ❑ Mostly used stones for construction.
Fig. 1.54: Arcuate Style	Fig. 1.55: Trabeate Style

Categories of Styles

Indo-Islamic architecture can be categorised into the **Imperial Style** (Delhi Sultanate), the **Provincial Style** (Bengal, Jaunpur, Malwa, Bijapur), the **Mughal Style**, the **Sikh style** and the **Rajput Style**.



Fig. 1.56: Classification of Indo-Islamic Architecture

Imperial Style

It flourished under various dynasties that ruled during the **Sultanate period**, and each ruler imparted certain characteristics of his own.

Slave/Ilburi Dynasty (1206-1290 A.D.)

The style of architecture during this period is known as the **Mamluk style of architecture**.

- ❑ They started constructing a number of buildings but most of the constructions were **remodelling of the existing religious structures**.
- ❑ The **tomb of Balban** was adorned with the **first true arch**.
- ❑ **Qutub Minar, Quwwat-ul-Islam mosque in Delhi, Arhai-din-ka-jhopra** in Ajmer etc., were prominent structures of this period.

Qutub Minar

It is divided into **five-storey** buildings initiated by **Qutb-ud-din Aibak** and later completed by **Iltutmish** and **Firuz Shah Tughlaq**. It came to be associated with the **Saint Khwaja Qutbuddin Bhaktiyar Kaki**.



Fig. 1.57: Qutub Minar

- ❑ It is the highest stone tower in India with a height of **72.5 m**.
- ❑ It was **damaged by lightning** in 1326 and again in 1368 and was repaired by the rulers of the day, Muhammad-bin-Tughluq (1325-51) and Firuz Shah Tughluq (1351-88).

- ❑ According to the inscriptions on its surface it was repaired by Sikandar Lodi (1489-1517) as well.
- ❑ The minar is a mix of **polygonal** and **circular** shapes.
- ❑ It is largely built of **red and buff sandstone** with some use of **marble** in the upper stories.
- ❑ It is characterized by highly **decorated balconies** and **bands of inscriptions** intertwined with foliated designs.
- ❑ The everyday use of the Minars was for the 'Azaan' or call to prayer. Its phenomenal height, however, symbolised the might and power of the ruler.
- ❑ **Quwwat-ul-Islam mosque: Qutub-ud-din Aibak** built the Mosque around 1197 AD. The tower of Victory (Qutub Minar), which celebrates the Muslim conquest of India, is its most well-known feature.

Khilji Dynasty (1290- 1320 A.D.)

The Seljuk style of architecture was introduced during this dynasty. Characteristic features include:

- ❑ Employment of **true arch**, pointed horse-shoe in shape.
- ❑ Emergence of **true domes** with recessed arches under the squinch.
- ❑ Use of **red sandstone** and decorative **marble** reliefs as new building materials
- ❑ **Mortar** became a prominent building material.
- ❑ Appearance of '**lotus-bud**' **fringe** on the underside of the arch.
- ❑ Examples: **Alai Darwaza by Ala-ud-din Khilji, Siri Fort etc.**



Fig. 1.58: Alai Darwaza (First true dome)

Chanderi Inscription of Alauddin Khilji: This is the oldest known Islamic inscription, written in the Naskh script and Persian language.

Tughlaq Dynasty (1320-1414 A.D.)

The architecture of this period can be divided into **two main groups**. The first group belongs to the construction of **Ghiyasuddin and Muhammad Tughluq**, and the other to those of **Firuz Taghluq**. General features of architecture during this time:

- ❑ **Stone rubble** was the principal building material and the walls were in most cases plastered.
- ❑ The walls are invariably battered i.e. **sloping walls** to give them more strength, as seen in the tomb of Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq.
- ❑ A hesitant and possibly experimental use of a new shape of arch- the **four centered arch**-necessitated its reinforcement with a supporting beam. This **arch-beam combination** is a hall-mark of the Tughluq style.

- ❑ The pointed horse-shoe arch of the preceding style was abandoned because of its narrow compass and therefore the inability to span wider spaces.
- ❑ **Encaustic tiles** as an **element of decoration** in the panels of the buildings were introduced.
- ❑ A **pointed dome** with a clearly visible neck, in contrast with the rather stifled dome of the preceding style emerged.
- ❑ In the tombs of this period, an **octagonal plan** which came to be copied and perfected by the Mughals in the 16th-17th century emerged.
- ❑ The cities of **Tughlaqabad**, **Jahapanah** and **Ferozabad** are examples of Tughlaq construction.

Lodi Dynasty (1414-1451A.D.)

A large number of tombs were built in and around Delhi **without** any **lavish decorations**. These mausoleums were designed on an **octagonal plan**.

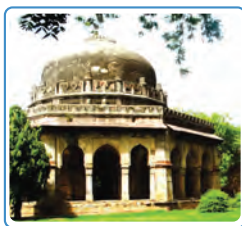


Fig. 1.59: Tomb of Sikander Lodi

- ❑ **Double domes** were introduced, which consisted of a **hollow dome inside the top dome**.
- ❑ **Sikander Lodi's tomb (Delhi)** was the **first garden tomb** built in India.

Public Buildings of the Sultanate Period comprised of Sarai, Bridges, Baolis, Dams, Kachehri (Administrative Buildings), Kotwali (Police stations), Dak-Chauki (Post-Stations), Hammam (Public Baths), and Katra (Market Places).

Sarai: It was **introduced** in India by the **Turks** in the 13th century. The earliest mention of the existence of Sarai is from **Balban's time** (1266).

- ❑ Muhammad Tughlaq and Firuz Tughlaq are known to have built a large number of Sarais in Delhi as well as along the major land routes of the Sultanate.

Wells and Step-Wells were a part of the Delhi Sultanate architecture. Example: **Gandhak ki Baoli**, built by **Iltutmish** at Mehrauli (Delhi), is one of the step-wells.

Provincial Style

Indo-Islamic architecture incorporated the local architectural styles of the provisional kingdoms of Bengal, Gujarat, Jaunpur, Golconda, Malwa and the Deccan, giving rise to the Provincial style. Some of these provincial features were:

Bengal (1203-1573 AD)

The **Bengal roof** with sloping cornices, which originated from **bamboo construction**, was adopted by the Muslims.

- ❑ **Brick** was the **chief building material**, and the use of **stone** was limited largely to **pillars**.
- ❑ **Covered brick** and **Glazed tiles** were usually pressed into service for **decoration**.
- ❑ Examples include the **Qadam Rasul mosque** and **Dakhil Darwaja** in Gour, **Adina mosque** in Pandua, **Darsbari Masjid** in Bengal, and the **Sidi Said Mosque** in Ahmedabad.



Fig. 1.60: Bengal Roof

Jaunpur(1394- 1479 AD)

- ❑ It was patronized by the **Sharqi rulers** who ruled the Jaunpur sultanate from 1394 to 1479.
- ❑ It avoided the use of Minars.
- ❑ Examples include **the Atala Mosque** and **the Lal Darwaza mosque** at Jaunpur.
- ❑ A unique feature of the buildings is the utilization of strong, compelling imagery painted on large screens in the prayer hall's side bays and center.



Fig. 1.61: Atala Mosque

Malwa (1405-1569 AD)

- ❑ It involves **environmental adaptations**, as seen in the large windows, arches, artificial reservoirs (Baolis) etc.
- ❑ A prominent feature was the use of different **coloured stones** and **marbles**.
- ❑ **Minars** were **absent** in this school of architecture.
- ❑ **Building material** used to be **locally sourced**.
- ❑ **Batter system** continued to be used in this school as well.
- ❑ The cities of **Dhar** and **Mandu** rose to prominence as architectural hotspots.
- ❑ Examples: **Hindola Mahal**, **Rani Roopmati Pavilion**, **Jahaz Mahal**, **Ashrafi Mahal** etc.



Fig. 1.62: Hindola Mahal, Mandu

Bijapur Style (1490-1656 AD)

It was developed under the **patronage** of **Adil Shah**.

- ❑ The constructions of this style were characterised by a **3-arched facade**, **bulbous dome** and the **use of cornices**.
- ❑ **Iron clamps** and strong **plaster of mortar** were used to strengthen the buildings.
- ❑ The ceilings were without any support.
- ❑ The walls were also decorated with rich carvings.
- ❑ **Gol Gumbaz** in **Bijapur (Karnataka)** was built in this style.

Gol Gumbaz

It was built as the **burial place** of **Muhammad Adil Shah** (1626–1656), the seventh Sultan of the Adil Shahi Dynasty.



Fig. 1.63: Gol Gumbaz

- ❑ **Gumbad Complex** has a **Naqqar Khana** (a ceremonial drum house), a mosque, and a Sarai.
- ❑ It was built using **dark grey basalt** combined with ornate plasterwork.
- ❑ **Timurid** and **Persian influences** are evident in its domes, arches, and geometric emphasis.
- ❑ It has the **second-largest dome in the world**.
- ❑ The **whispering gallery**, an acoustic marvel along the dome's drum, can magnify and echo sounds repeatedly. (**Victoria Memorial** (Kolkata) also has a whispering gallery.)



IGNITE YOUR MIND

Considering the regional diversity of the Sultanate period, how did architectural styles vary across different regions, and what role did local craftsmanship and materials play in shaping the distinctive features of buildings from this era?

Mughal Style

The Mughals were **great patrons of art and architecture**. A distinctive fusion of Persian, Indian, and Central Asian elements could be seen in Mughal art and architecture. Huge constructions adorned with pietra dura, magnificent minarets, and bulbous domes were characteristic of Mughal architecture.

Babar

Babur had a short reign of five years, most of which was spent fighting battles for the consolidation of the newly born Mughal state. He is, however, known to have taken considerable interest in **building secular works**. The only standing structures of Babur's reign are **two mosques**, built in 1526, at **Panipat and Sambhal**.

Humayun

The surviving buildings of Humayun's reign have the same inconsequential character as those of Babur. The Mughal domination over India was too unsettled for the production of any great work of architecture.

- ❑ **Persian style** became prominent in the architecture of this period.
- ❑ He laid the foundation of a city named **Dinpanah**.

Humayun Tomb (Delhi)

It is the **first** distinct example of Mughal architecture built by his widow, **Begha Begum**.



Fig. 1.64: Humayun Tomb

- ❑ It is a **synthesis** of **Persian architecture** and **Indian traditions**. It has a high **double dome** as well as the kiosks (chhatris), which give it a pyramidal shape from a distance.
- ❑ It has a **Charbagh-style** garden.
- ❑ The **octagonal form** of the central chamber contains the cenotaph.
- ❑ The red sandstone, double-storeyed structure of the mausoleum has been raised over a series of cells which are like a **musical composition**. It is for the **first time** that **red sandstone** and **white marble** were used.

Sher Shah

Surs embarked on profound architectural projects. Their buildings, in fact, laid the groundwork on which the Mughals built. This period is a phase of **transition** from the **Lodi style to the Mughal style** of architecture.



Fig. 1.65: Tomb of Sher Shah Suri, Sasaram

- ❑ He built the **Purana Qila** and the **Quila Kohna Masjid** in Delhi.
- ❑ He also built the **Shershah Sufi masjid** in Patna, and **Rohtas Fort** in Pakistan and his **own tomb at Sasaram**.
- ❑ He extended and reconstructed an old Mauryan route and renamed it '**Sadak-e-Azam**'. It was later called the **Grand Trunk Road**.

Akbar

The architecture in the reign of Akbar represents encouragement of the indigenous techniques and a selective use of the experiences of other countries. The chief elements of the style of architecture that evolved under Akbar's patronage are:

- ❑ Use of **red sandstone** as the primary building material.
- ❑ There was a **widespread use** of **trabeated construction**.
- ❑ The **arches** were used mainly in **decorative form** rather than in structural form.
- ❑ The dome was of the 'Lodi' type, sometimes built hollow but never technically of the true double order.
- ❑ The shafts of the pillars were multifaceted and the capitals of these pillars invariably took the form of bracket supports.
- ❑ The decoration consisted of boldly carved or inlaid patterns complemented by brightly coloured patterns on the interiors.
- ❑ Akbar's building projects can be divided into **two main groups**, each representing a different phase.
 - The **first group** comprised buildings of a fort and a few palaces at **Agra, Allahabad and Lahore**.
 - The **second group** related basically to the construction of his **new capital** at **Fatehpur Sikri**.

Agra Fort

- ❑ Its construction started during the reign of Akbar, but most of the buildings inside were constructed during Shah Jahan's time.
- ❑ It is conceived as a robust building in **red sandstone**.
- ❑ Gardens are built in **Charbagh style**.
- ❑ Prominent buildings inside the fort are Moti Masjid, Sheesh Mahal, Diwan-i-aam (Hall of Public audience), and Diwan-i-khas (Hall of Private audience) which were built by Shah Jahan.
- ❑ Today, the **Delhi Gate** of the fort and **Jahangiri Mahal** are the only representative buildings of Akbar's reign.



Fig. 1.66: Agra Fort

Fatehpur Sikri

It was founded as a token of gratitude to **Sheikh Salim Chisti**. (Emperor Akbar named his first son Salim, later named Emperor Jahangir, in honour of Chishti.)

- ❑ It has been described as a **"frozen moment in history"** as the buildings here represent a **blend** of **Hindu** and **Persian styles**. It was the new capital city of Akbar.
- ❑ All the buildings are in characteristic rich **red sandstone**, using traditional **trabeate construction**.
- ❑ The structures were built from local rocks and assembled without the use of mortar.



Fig. 1.67: Buland Darwaza

❑ Important buildings inside the City of Fatehpur Sikri:

- ❑ **Buland Darwaza** - It was built in 1576 to commemorate Akbar's victory over Gujarat. It is the highest gateway in the world. **Red sandstone** is used for its construction.



Fig. 1.68: Tomb of Salim

- ❑ **Salim Chisti's tomb** - It is the only building at Fatehpur Sikri built of **white marble**.
- ❑ **Ibadat Khana** - Akbar used to have discussions with leaders of different religions.
- ❑ Other buildings include **Panch Mahal, Pachisi Court** (to play chess), **Jama Masjid, Hiran Minar, Jodha Bai's Palace** etc.

- ❑ **Govind Dev temple** in **Vrindavan** was built in **Red stone** by **Raja Man Singh**. The stone for the construction of the temple was donated by Akbar.

Jahangir and Shahjahan

In the sphere of the building art, Jahangir and Shah Jahan's reigns were an **age of marble**.

The place of red sandstones was soon taken over by marble in its most refined form. This dictated significant stylistic changes which have been listed below:

- ❑ The arch adopted a distinctive form with **foliated curves**, usually with nine cusps.
- ❑ Marble arcades of engrailed arches became a common feature.
- ❑ The dome developed a bulbous form with a stifled neck. **Double domes** became very common.
- ❑ Inlaid patterns in **coloured stones** became the dominant decorative form.
- ❑ In the buildings, from the latter half of Jahangir's reign, a new device of inlay decoration called **pietra dura** was adopted.

Some of the **constructions under Jahangir's reign** were:

- ❑ **Akbar's tomb (Sikandara), Moti Mahal (Lahore)** and **Shalimar Bagh** and **Nishat Bagh** in Kashmir. **Akbar's Tomb** was **designed** by **Akbar** himself, and its construction began in his own lifetime. It was later **completed** by **Jahangir**.
- ❑ **Nur Jahan**, wife of Jahangir, commissioned the construction of the **tomb of Itmad-ud-Daulah** (Agra) in **white marble**.

Shahjahan's notable constructions include - **City of Shahjahanabad** (present-day old Delhi), the **Moti Masjid** (made exclusive of marble) in the **Agra Fort**, the **Jama Masjid** and **Lal Qila** at **Delhi**, and the **Taj Mahal**.

Red Fort (Lal Qila)



Fig. 1.69: Red Fort

- It is near the old course of the Yamuna River.
- There are two gateways – **Delhi Gate** and **Lahore Gate**.
- Notable buildings inside the fort are **Diwan-i Aam**, **Diwan-i Khas**, **Moti Mahal**, **Hira Mahal** and **Rang Mahal**.
 - Diwan-i-Khas**: It was the Hall for Private Audiences. Here, the Mughal Emperor Shah Jahan **received courtiers and state guests**. It is also said that its marble dais once supported the famous **Peacock Throne**. The well-known statement, “**If there be a paradise on earth, it is this, it is this, it is this,**” is emblazoned on the walls of this marble castle.
 - The **Diwan-i-Am**, or Hall of Audience, is a room in the Red Fort of Delhi where the Mughal emperor Shah Jahan and his successors received members of the general public and heard their grievances.

Taj Mahal

- Taj Mahal is an immense mausoleum of **white marble**, built in Agra between 1631 and 1648 by order of the Mughal emperor Shah Jahan in memory of his favourite wife, Mumtaz Mahal.
- It is on the **south bank of the Yamuna River** in the Indian city of Agra.
- The chief architect was **Ustad Ahmad Lahawri**, an Indian of Persian descent.
- The Taj Mahal was listed as a **UNESCO World Heritage Site** and one of the 7 Wonders of the World in 2007.
- It has all the features of Mughal architecture, like calligraphy, Pietra Dura, and char bagh style garden.



Fig. 1.70: Taj Mahal

Aurangzeb

The architectural works during the reign of Aurangzeb were less numerous and of a lower standard than those executed under any previous Mughal ruler. The major buildings of his reign include the **mausoleum of his wife Rabia ud Daurani (Bibi-ka-Makbara)** in Aurangabad.

It was an attempt to mimic the Taj Mahal. Other significant structures include the **Badshahi Masjid** in Lahore and the **Moti Masjid** at Lal Qila, Delhi.



Fig. 1.71: Bibi ka Maqbara, Aurangabad

Sikh Style

This style developed in the region of present-day Punjab and was heavily influenced by the Mughal Style of architecture.

Its features include:

- Shallow cornices and **fluted domes** which were generally covered with **brass** and **copper** guilds for decoration and support.
- Use **multiple chhatris** on the top of the structure.
- Arches were decorated with numerous foliations.
- Examples: Harmandir Sahib Gurudwara** (Golden Temple).



Fig. 1.72: Golden Temple

Rajput Style

- This style was also influenced by Mughal Architecture.
- Hanging Balconies** were introduced which were constructed in all shapes and sizes.
- Cornices were built in the shape of an arch.
- Construction and maintenance of **Fort**s became a prime feature in their architectural style.
 - Besides serving the defence purpose, the forts played wider functions such as maintaining linkage with big landholdings and the existing composition of population.
- Examples:** Jaisalmer Fort, Kumbhalgarh Fort, Chittorgarh Fort, Jantar Mantar etc.

Awadh Architecture

- Bada Imambara**, located in Lucknow, was built by **Asaf-ud-Daula** in 1784. This structure has been made by interlocking bricks without the use of mortar in its construction.
- Rumi Darwaza** is also located in Lucknow. It was built by the Nawab of Awadh, Asaf-ud-Daula. It was built using bricks, coated with lime.

Islamic architecture in India is a testament to the cultural exchange and synthesis that occurred over centuries, resulting in a unique and vibrant architectural heritage.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

How can the Mughal approach to blending traditional craftsmanship with innovative techniques influence contemporary architects striving to bridge the gap between heritage preservation and modern functionality and sustainability?

KASHMIRI ARCHITECTURE

Kashmiri architecture is a distinctive style of architecture that has evolved over the centuries in the region of Kashmir, located in the northern part of the Indian subcontinent. The architecture of Kashmir reflects a unique blend of various cultural and artistic influences.

Main Features of Kashmiri Architecture

Gandhara influence was seen in **Trefoil arches**, elements of Greek architecture could also be seen in column walls and **triangular pediments**. Other features include a cellular layout and enclosed courtyard, a **straight-edged pyramidal roof** and a relatively larger number of steps.

Kashmiri architecture was constructed in **two phases**. The first phase was the **early medieval Hindu phase**, in which temple construction reached a pinnacle during the reign of the Utpala and Karkota dynasties.



Fig. 1.73: Martanda Sun Temple

❑ **Martand Sun Temple (Anantnag, Kashmir)**

- It was built in the 8th century AD under the aegis of **Karkota Dynasty** ruler **Lalitaditya Muktapida**.
- The monuments exhibit influences from Gandhara, China, and the Gupta dynasty.

Other examples include the Temples at Awantipora (Utpala Dynasty), Mamleshwara Shiva Temple and Pandrethan Temple.

- ❑ The **second phase** began 14th century onward when the **blending of the Kashmiri style with the Islamic style** was seen after the establishment of Islamic rule. During this phase wood, brick and stones were used as material for the construction of mosques. Multi leveled sloping roofs and tall spires replaced domes and cloisters.

• **Jamia Masjid, Srinagar**

- ❑ It was built in 1400 A.D. during the reign of Sultan Sikandar in Kashmir.
- ❑ This Indo-Saracen architecture is designed with 370 wooden pillars and a splendid courtyard.
- ❑ Architecturally unique, this monument has spires instead of domes and minarets.

• **Gardens in Kashmir**

The celebrated Mughal gardens of Kashmir owe their grandeur primarily to Emperor Jahangir who had an undaunted love for Kashmir, and his son Shah Jahan. The design of these gardens is inspired by the Persian designs. They have been constructed in Char Bagh style.

- ❑ **Shalimar Bagh** was built in 1619 by Emperor Jahangir for his wife Noor Jahan.
- ❑ **Achabal Bagh** is located in the town of Achabal in Anantnag district. It was built in 1620 by Emperor Jahangir. The garden is most famous for its beautiful chinar trees.
- ❑ **Chashma Shahi** is located in Srinagar, and is one of the smallest Mughal gardens in the valley. The garden is most famous for its natural spring which, as per the locals, is believed to have medicinal properties.
- ❑ **Verinag Garden** was built by Emperor Jahangir in 1620, and the place where the garden is located, is actually the source of the Jhelum River. There's a popular octagonal-shaped spring in the garden.
- ❑ **Nishat Garden**, also known as Nishat Bagh, is located on the eastern side of Dal Lake.

Other examples include Aali Masjid, Srinagar, Pari Mahal etc.

MODERN ARCHITECTURE

The introduction of modern building construction and planning occurred after the arrival of the British in India. The main aim of this architecture was to house their organisations, their people, and whatever was necessary to control a big empire like India.

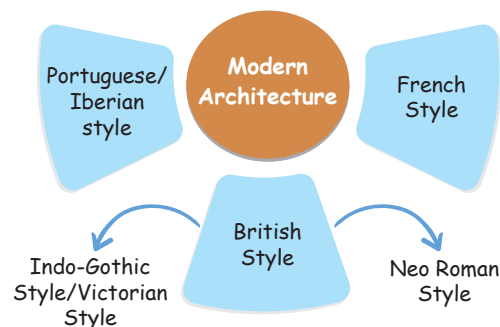


Fig. 1.74: Classification of Modern Architecture

Portuguese Influence

They introduced the **Iberian style** of architecture in India. They also introduced the concept of **Patio houses** and the **Baroque style** involving the use of contrasting colours.

- Examples of Portuguese constructions are **Se Cathedral and Basilica of Bom Jesus in Goa, Diu Fort etc.**

French Influence

They developed the towns of **Puducherry, Chandannagar, Mahe** (Kerala), **Karaikal** (Tamil Nadu), and **Yanam** (Andhra Pradesh) and brought the concept of **Urban city planning**.

- Other examples of French constructions are: **The Church of Sacred Heart of Jesus in Puducherry and, the Sacred Heart Church of Chandannagar (West Bengal).**

British Influence

They brought with them the **Gothic style** and merged it with Indian architecture resulting in the **Indo-Gothic style** of architecture. **Neo-Roman** architecture emerged post-1911.

Indo-Gothic Style

It is a unique blend of Indian, Persian and Gothic styles of architecture and is also known as the **Victorian style**.

- The buildings are large and elaborate, with **thinner walls** compared to the Indo-Islamic era.
- The **arches were pointed**, unlike the curving arches of the Indo-Islamic era.
- **Large windows** are the unique features of the Victorian style.
- The churches had a crucified ground plan.
- **Examples: Victoria Memorial in Kolkata, Gateway of India in Mumbai etc.**



Fig. 1.75: Gateway of India

Neo-Roman Style

The works of **Edwin Lutyens** and **Herbert Baker** were the finest examples of this style.

- It was a confluence of all styles of architecture, which made the style congested and cramped.
- As a result of the **hybrid nature** of the construction, **simplicity, modernity and utility were highly compromised**.
- The focus was more on **circular buildings** (Example: Old Parliament Building), and there was an overuse of oriental motifs to realise western architectural designs.

Iberia Architecture (Portuguese)	Gothic Architecture
Main material was brick. Wood was used for roofs and stairs.	Red sandstone and coarse limestone were the main materials.
Continued with the Western style. No adoption of Indian architectural elements.	Adopted Indian motifs and styles, giving rise to the Indo-Gothic style of architecture.

POST-INDEPENDENCE ARCHITECTURE

The architecture of this era defies easy categorization into specific styles. Most of these architectural forms were in line with widely acknowledged science and contemporary building practices.

- **Le Corbusier** conducted a unique experiment in this sense with the construction of Chandigarh. Outside Chandigarh, Le Corbusier's most influential structures include Sarabhai House (Ahmadabad), Millowner's Association Building (Ahmedabad) etc.
- **Laurie Baker**, dubbed the "**Architect of the Poor**," is credited with revolutionizing the mass housing model in Kerala.

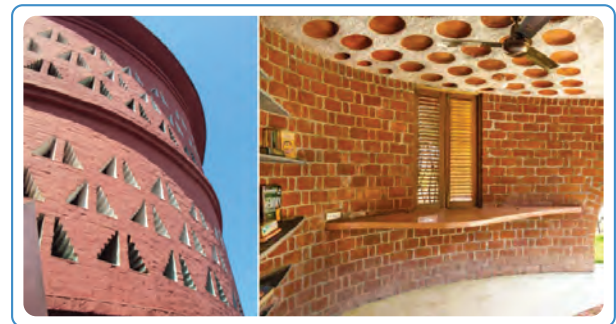


Fig. 1.76: A Design by Laurie Baker

His style of architecture includes:

- Introduction of the idea of building with **filler slabs to use less cement and steel**.
- He also emphasized on the importance of thermal comfort and ventilation.
- His architectural style includes, among other things, creating environmentally sustainable structures with materials that are readily available locally.

Charles Correa

Charles Correa was one of India's greatest architects and urban planners. Correa was one of the major advocates of what he called the **open-to-sky space concept**, which was reflected in his work across the world.

- His famous works are the **Mahatma Gandhi Memorial Museum at the Sabarmati Ashram** in Ahmedabad and the Jawahar Kala Kendra in Jaipur.

CONCLUSION

Indian architecture, sculpture, and inscriptions exhibit a remarkable journey of artistic and cultural evolution from ancient to modern times. These diverse styles and influences have shaped India's architectural, sculptural, and inscriptional heritage into a rich tapestry of artistic expression and cultural identity.

Temple Architecture and Sculptures

2

INTRODUCTION

Temples in various parts of the nation have unique architectural styles as a result of differences in geography, ethnicity and history. Indian Temple architecture is a vibrant reflection of the nation's artistic, religious and cultural heritage. Through excavation, it has been found that the earliest known structural temples belong to the Mauryas. Nonetheless, the Guptas are accredited for bringing effective knowledge as well as architects in terms of making efficient and effective structures and temples. Thus, Indian temple architecture began during the Gupta era.

THE BASIC FORM OF A HINDU TEMPLE

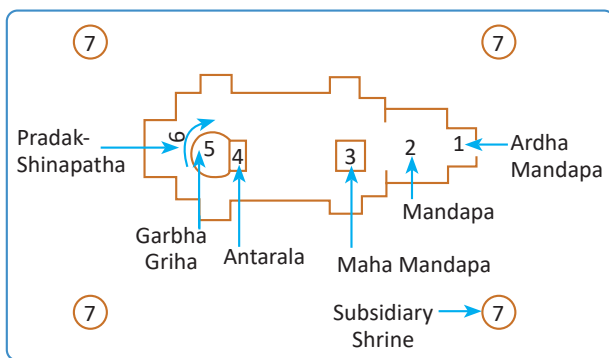


Fig. 2.1: Basic form of a Hindu Temple

- ❑ **Sanctum (Garbhagriha):** The sanctum, initially a small cubicle with a single entrance, evolved into a larger chamber over time. It is designed to house the main icon, which becomes the focal point of significant ritual attention.
- ❑ **Entrance (Mandapa):** The entrance to the temple, whether a portico or collonaded hall, serves as a space for accommodating a large number of devotees.
 - The mandapa was also converted into a larger area to accommodate greater number of devotees and was then called **Maha-mandapa**.
 - Entering the maha mandapa directly was not considered good, so **Ardha-mandapa** was added to it, which was smaller than the maha-mandapa with a small porch to it known as **Mukha-mandapa**.
- ❑ **Architectural Elements:** In freestanding temples, a mountain-like spire is featured, taking the form of a curving **Shikhar** in North India and a pyramidal tower known as a **Vimana** in South India.

- ❑ **Vahan and Dhvaj:** Positioned axially before the sanctum, the vahan represents the mount or vehicle of the main deity, accompanied by a standard pillar or Dhvaj.
- ❑ Each temple featured a principal deity image. The temple shrines came in three types:
 - **Sandhara** (without pradikshinapatha)
 - **Nirandhara** (with pradikshinapatha)
 - **Sarvatobhadra** (accessible from all sides).

TEMPLE ARCHITECTURE

Construction of the Gupta temples was done by using **dry stone masonry** in the desired shape and form. There was no use of mortar. **Burnt bricks** were also used in the construction of temples. During the Gupta era, **square sanctums** and **pillared porticos** were prominent features in temple construction. The monolithic, flat-roofed temples of the early periods gradually gave way to the sculptured "**shikhara**" of the later periods. There are five distinct stages to the progression:

First Stage

- ❑ The structure was built on a **low platform**.
- ❑ Shape of the temples was **square**, and the **roof was flat**.
- ❑ **Shallow pillars** were used for the development of Portico.



Fig. 2.2: Temple no. 17 at Sanchi

Example: Temple 17 at Sanchi (built around 400 A.D.).

Second Stage

- ❑ Structure was built on a **higher platform**. All other features were the continuation of the earlier phases.
- ❑ A few two storied temples have also been found.
- ❑ A covered ambulatory passageway around the garbhagriha was a new addition that was used as a Pradakshina patha.



Fig. 2.3: Parvati Temple, Nachna Kuthara

Example: Parvati Temple, Nachna Kuthara, Madhya Pradesh.

Third Stage

- ❑ **Low shikhara** replaced the flat roof of the temple.
- ❑ **Panchayatana style** was adopted.

Example: **Durga Temple** at Aihole (Karnataka) and **Dashavatara Temple** at Deogarh (Uttar Pradesh).

Panchayatana Style

- ❑ There were **four subsidiary shrines** along with the temple of the principal deity.
- ❑ The main temple is **square** in shape with an elongated mandapa.
- ❑ The subsidiary shrines were placed opposite to each other on either side of the mandap, giving the ground plan a crucified shape.

Deogarh Temple

- ❑ Deogarh temple follows the **panchayatana style**.
- ❑ The **curvilinear shikhara** (**curving latina** or **Rekha-prasada** type of shikhara) indicates an early example of the classic **Nagara style**.
- ❑ This **west-facing temple** has a grand doorway featuring **sculptures of Ganga and Yamuna**.



Fig. 2.4: Deogarh Temple

- ❑ The temple's depictions of Vishnu in various forms led to the misconception that it was a **Dasavatara temple** with subsidiary shrines housing Vishnu's avatars.
- ❑ However, it remains unknown who this temple was originally dedicated to. But the main reliefs of Vishnu, such as **Sheshashayana, Nara-Narayan, and Gajendramoksha**, adorn the west-facing temple walls.

Fourth Stage

- ❑ The Main shrine became **rectangular**.
- ❑ All other features remained almost similar.

Example: Trivikrama Temple, Maharashtra (also known as Ter temple).

Fifth Stage



Fig. 2.5: Maniyar Math, Rajgir.

- ❑ **Circular temples** with shallow rectangular projections were introduced.
 - ❑ All other features remained almost similar.
- Example:** Maniyar Math, Rajgir.

STYLES OF TEMPLE ARCHITECTURE

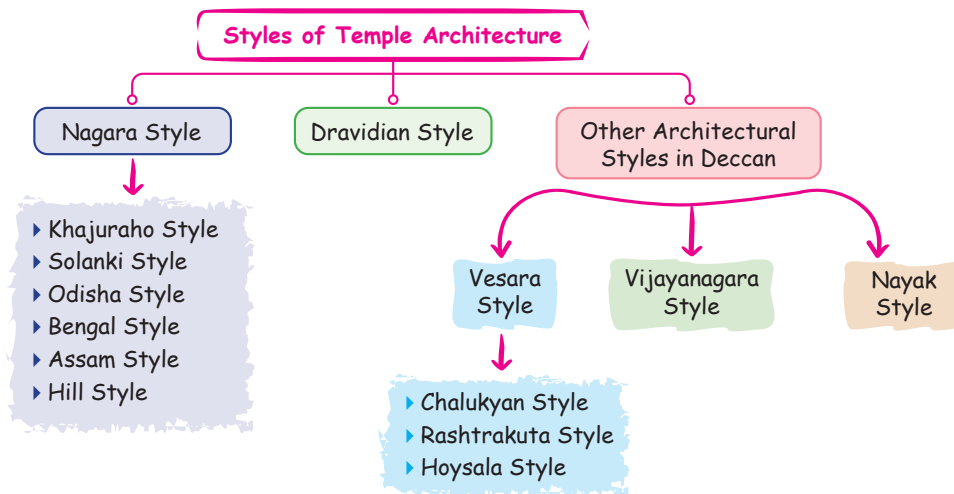


Fig. 2.6: Styles of Temple Architecture

The Nagara or North Indian Temple Style

The prevalent style of temple architecture in **Northern India** is known as nagara, which developed in the 5th century AD.

Features

- ❑ Northern temples are often constructed on a **stone platform** with **steps leading** up to it.
- ❑ Unlike South India, there is typically an **absence of elaborate boundary walls** or **gateways**.

- ❑ The temple architecture's form is influenced by **ancient building forms** existing before the 5th century AD. The Valabhi type of Shikhara, for instance, finds **similarities with the ground plan of Buddhist rock-cut chaitya caves**.
- ❑ The temples generally followed the **Panchayatana style** of temple-making.
- ❑ Outside the garbhagriha, there were **images of Ganga and Yamuna**.
- ❑ There were pillars supporting the portico.
- ❑ There were **no water tanks** or reservoirs in the temple premises.
- ❑ **Pradakshina patha** around the garbhagriha is covered.
- ❑ The vertical end of the shikhara ended in a horizontal fluted disc known as **Amalak**.
- ❑ On the top of that is a spherical-shaped structure called **Kalash** or Kalasa.

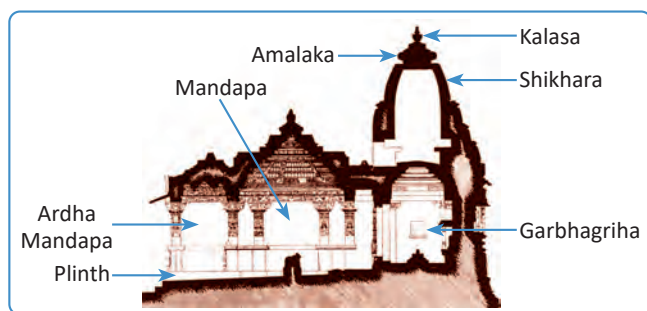


Fig. 2.7: Nagara Style of Temple

Evolution of Temple Towers (Shikhara)

Early temples had a single tower (shikhara), but later ones featured multiple towers. The garbhagriha (sanctum) is always situated directly under the tallest tower or shikhara.

Multiple types of shikhara evolved over time

❑ Latina Type Shikhara

This is a simple shikhara, famously known as the '**latina**' or '**rekha-prasada**' type.

- It has a **square base** and **walls that curve or slope inward**, culminating in a point at the top.
- It is often considered a basic form of shikhara.
- Latina buildings evolved to support many smaller towers, clustered together like rising mountain peaks.

❑ Phamsana Type Shikhara

These are **broader** and **shorter** than Latina ones.

- Their roofs consist of several slabs gently rising to a single point, presenting a different profile compared to the sharply rising towers of the Latina type.
- In many North Indian temples, phamsana design is applied to mandapas (halls), while the main garbhagriha is housed in a Latina building.

❑ Valabhi Type Shikhara

It is characterized by **rectangular buildings with a roof rising into a vaulted chamber**.

- The edge of the vaulted chamber is rounded, resembling **ancient bamboo or wooden wagons**.
- Often referred to as '**wagon-vaulted buildings**'.



Fig. 2.8: Latina Type Shikhara, Phamsana Type Shikhara, Valabhi Type Shikhara

Subdivisions of Nagara Temples

Variations in the shape of the shikhara lead to different **subdivisions** of Nagara temples.

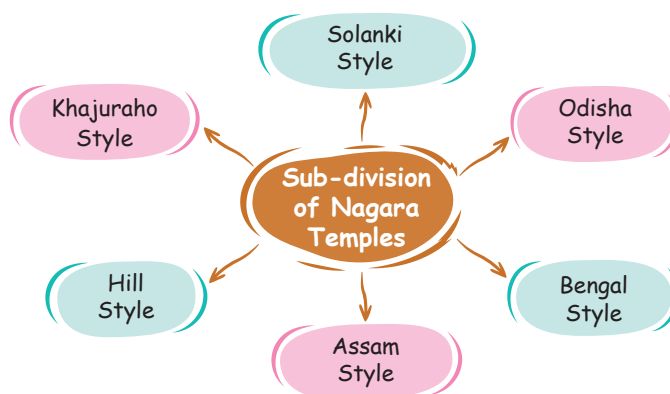


Fig. 2.9: Sub-division of Nagara Temples

Khajuraho School

It was constructed by **Chandela Kings** in the tenth century, showing significant evolution.

Features of Khajuraho School of Temple Architecture

- ❑ They were built on raised platforms in the Nagara style of Architecture.
- ❑ It is also a **UNESCO World Heritage site**.
- ❑ These temples are mostly north or east-facing.
- ❑ All Nagara temples from this period feature the standard crowning elements of **Amalak** and **Kalash**, and distinctively, this temple exhibits projecting **balconies** and **verandahs**, setting it apart from Deogarh.
- ❑ These marvels were built of high-quality sandstone ranging from buff to pink or pale yellow and granite.
- ❑ Temples are stated to be of two types in Khajuraho, one is temples of nirandhara types (with pradakshinapatha), and the second is sandhara types (without pradikshinapatha).

- ❑ There are three chambers in the temple, viz. **Garbhagriha**, **Mandapa** and **Ardha Mandapa**. Some temples have **Antarala** (Vestibular entrance to the garbhagriha).
- ❑ Khajuraho has numerous Hindu temples, Jain temples, and a **Chausath Yogini temple**; most of them devoted to Hindu gods.
 - **Chausath Yogini** temple predates the tenth century and is dedicated to goddesses associated with **Tantric worship**. It was built entirely of granite.

Built between the **seventh** and **tenth centuries**, a number of temples dedicated to the cult of yoginis are scattered across Madhya Pradesh, Odisha, and extending as far south as Tamil Nadu.



Fig. 2.10: Kandariya Mahadev Temple

Example: **Kandariya Mahadev** temple in Khajuraho epitomizes Central Indian temple architecture during the medieval period.

Lakshmana Temple

- ❑ The **Lakshmana temple** represents the full-fledged, developed style of temple architecture during the time of the Chandellas. Its construction was completed by 954, the year as per the inscription found at the base of the temple, by **Yashovarman**, the seventh ruler of the Chandella dynasty.
- ❑ The temple plan is of a **Panchayatana type**.
- ❑ The temple is constructed on a heavy plinth.
- ❑ It consists of an ardha mandapa (porch), mandapa (porch), the maha mandapa (greater hall) and the garbhagriha with vimana.
- ❑ Each part has a separate roof rising backwards.
- ❑ The outer walls of the garbhagriha and the outer and inner walls around the circumambulatory path are decorated with sculptures.
- ❑ An image of Chaturmukha Vishnu is in the garbhagriha.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

How does the architectural grandeur of temples, marked by intricate carvings and ornate decorations, contribute to the preservation and promotion of cultural heritage, and what role do these structures play in shaping the identity of a community or region?

- ❑ There are four shrines in each corner of the temple. There are images of Vishnu in three shrines and Surya in one.

Sculptures During Chandelas

The temples at Khajuraho were sculpted with human representations with slender taller figures and a considerable accentuation of linear details.

- ❑ Sculptures at Khajuraho are highly stylized, often in full relief, with sharp features like noses, chins, and slanting eyes. **Erotic sculptures**, including **Mithun** (embracing couple) sculptures, are considered auspicious and are integral to the temples. These sculptures are placed on the exterior walls.
- ❑ The **artwork** on the temples of Khajuraho **symbolically highlights** the **four goals** and necessary pursuits and goals of human life as per Hinduism: **Dharma (righteousness)** - represented by the duties of a human in their daily life. **Kama (desire)** - represented by erotic sculptures and sensual fulfilment in human life.



Fig. 2.11: Sculptures on Temple Walls

Solanki School

These temples in **North-western India**, spanning Gujarat, Rajasthan and western Madhya Pradesh were developed under the patronage of **Solanki rulers**.

Features of Solanki School of temple architecture

- ❑ **Variety of stones have been used.**
 - **Sandstone** is common, while grey to black basalt appears in tenth to twelfth-century temple sculptures.
 - Soft **white marble**, manipulatable and exuberant, is seen in **Jain temples** in **Mount Abu** (tenth to twelfth century) and the fifteenth-century temple at Ranakpur.
- ❑ Temples are mostly **east facing**. Sun rays fall directly into the central shrine during the equinox.
- ❑ There were **no carved walls** but the portico had **decorative arched gateways (torans)**.
- ❑ Garbhagriha and Mandapa were connected internally and externally.
- ❑ In the proximity of the temple, a rectangular stepped tank known as the 'Surya Kund' can be found. This is a noticeable feature from earlier times – proximity of a sacred water body. Numerous small temples with wooden carvings can be found on each step.

Example: Sun Temple, Modhera, Gujarat.



Fig. 2.12: Sun Temple, Modhera, Gujarat.

Odisha Style

Odisha's temples, classified into **Rekhapida**, **Pidhadeul**, and **Khakra** orders, form a distinct sub-style within the nagara order.

Features of Odisha School of temple architecture

- ❑ Shikharas (called **deul**) in Odisha temples are **vertical** until the **top**, sharply curving inwards, with **square ground plans**.
- ❑ Mandapas are called **Jagamohana** in Odisha.
- ❑ The Odishan temples have two or more halls used for different purposes and each one is constructed separately, namely "**Natya Mandapa**" the hall of dance and "**Bhoga-Mandapa**" the hall of offerings.
- ❑ It may be noted that Rekha- deul, pidha-deul, natya-mandapa and bhoga-mandapa are placed in one axial alignment and facing the garbhagriha.
- ❑ The temples have an addition of **torana-dvara**, an independently standing arched gateway in front of the temple.
- ❑ One can find carvings on exterior walls but interior walls are devoid of such decoration.
- ❑ Odisha temples often include **boundary walls**, distinguishing them from other styles.

Examples: Most of the main temple sites are located in ancient **Kalinga**, modern **Puri** District including **Bhubaneswar** or ancient Tribhuvaneshvara, Puri and Konark.

- ❑ The **Lingaraj Temple** is dedicated to **Lord Shiva** and is considered to be the most ancient temple in Bhubaneswar. It finds mention in the Brahma Purana. It was built by the **Somavanshi king Jajati Keshari** in **11th century AD**.

❑ Sun temple (Konark)

- It was built by **King Narasimhadeva I** around 1240, with a colossal shikhara that reached 70m before collapsing in the nineteenth century.
- The vast complex is within a quadrilateral precinct of which the **Jagamohana** or the **dance-pavilion (mandapa)** has survived.
- The temple, **resembling a chariot**, has walls covered in detailed ornamental carvings, including twelve pairs of enormous wheels representing the **Sun god's chariot wheels**.



Fig. 2.13: Jagannath Temple, Puri



Fig. 2.14: Sun Temple, Konark

- A massive sculpture of Surya carved out of green stone and strategically placed images captured the sun's rays in the garbhagriha.

Rekha-deul: Its shikhara or spire is linear or straight. Here Rekha means straight and deul means temple.

Pidha-deul: Its shikhara has tiers of diminishing pidhas or platforms. Here pidha means a low flat wooden tablet to sit on. It is also called Jagamohana, which is in fact a mandapa raised in front of the sanctum.

Khakhara-deul: The top of the shikhara looks like a gourd or barrel-shaped roof. Here khakhara has been derived from the term khakharu, i.e., a pumpkin and gourd.

Bengal Style

Bengal's temple styles vary from the **Pala style** (ninth to eleventh centuries) to the **Sena style** (eleventh to thirteenth centuries).

- ❑ Pala rulers, patrons of Buddhist monastic sites, influenced the local **Vanga style** in temples, such as the **Siddheshvara Mahadeva temple** in **Barakar**, evolving into loftier forms in subsequent centuries.
 - It is characterized by a tall curving shikhara crowned by a large amalaka. It shares similarities with contemporary temples in Odisha.
- ❑ **Terracotta brick temples** in Bengal, influenced by local traditions and Islamic architecture, proliferated in the seventeenth century.
- ❑ Temples submerged in **Telkupi**, Purulia District, showcased architectural styles aware of prevalent nagara sub-types in North India.
- ❑ The **black-to-grey basalt** and **chlorite stone pillars**, along with **arched niches** in these temples, significantly influenced the earliest Bengal sultanate buildings at **Gaur** and **Pandua**.
- ❑ Local building traditions played a key role, especially the shape of the curving or sloping side of the bamboo roof seen in **Bengali huts**. This distinctive feature, known as the **Bangla roof**, later found **adoption in Mughal buildings**, becoming a recognizable architectural element across North India.
- ❑ During the Mughal period and beyond, scores of terracotta brick temples were constructed across Bengal and Bangladesh.
- ❑ The architectural influence also extends to incorporating forms of arches and domes taken from Islamic architecture.
- ❑ Prominent locations for these temples include **Bishnupur**, **Bankura**, **Burdwan**, and **Birbhum**, with most dating to the seventeenth century.

Assam Style

In Assam, a sixth-century sculpted door frame from **Dah Parbatiya** near Tezpur reflects Gupta influences.

- ❑ A post-Gupta style persisted until the tenth century, followed by the emergence of a distinct Assamese style by the twelfth to fourteenth centuries.
- ❑ The **Ahom style**, influenced by **Tais** from Upper Burma and **Pala style** from Bengal, is evident in the seventeenth-century **Kamakhya temple** (a Shakti Peeth dedicated to Goddess Kamakhya) in Guwahati.



Fig. 2.15: Kamakhya Devi Temple, Guwahati

Sculptures during Pala, Sena and Eastern Ganga Dynasty

- ❑ The Pala rulers in Bihar and Bengal were Buddhists by faith and greatly encouraged centres of learning like **Nalanda** and **Vikramasila**, where the stupas and monasteries gave ample scope for development of sculptures.
 - Among the bronze sculpture is a four armed **Avalokiteswara** in graceful **tribhanga posture**.
 - Figure of **river goddess Ganga** from **Mahanad** in **West Bengal**.
- ❑ The Pala tradition continued under the **Sena rulers** in the 12th century until the Islamic rulers overran the country.
- ❑ Eastern Gangas ruled Odisha from the 7th to the 13th century. Their sculptures maintained the traditional lines of grace and vigour.
 - The Orissan temples have many **beautiful female figures called Nayikas**.
 - Sculptures can be found on the walls of temples at **Bhubaneswar, Puri** and **Konark**.

Hill Temples

- ❑ The hills of Kumaon, Garhwal, Himachal, and Kashmir gave rise to a distinctive form of architecture.
- ❑ Proximity to **Gandhara sites like Taxila and Peshawar** influenced Kashmiri architecture which also had elements of **Gupta** and **post-Gupta** traditions from Sarnath, Mathura, Gujarat, and Bengal.
- ❑ Frequent travels of Brahmin pundits and Buddhist monks contributed to the intermingling of **Buddhist** and **Hindu traditions in the hills**.
- ❑ Hills maintained their own tradition of **wooden buildings with pitched roofs**.
 - Temples often showcase a **blend of styles**, with the main garbhagriha and shikhara in rekha-prasada or latina style, while the **mandapa** reflects an older form of wooden architecture.
 - Some temples adopt a **pagoda shape**, highlighting the uniqueness of hill architecture.

The Karkota Period in Kashmir

The Karkota period in Kashmir, especially during the eighth and ninth centuries, is significant for temple architecture.

- ❑ **Pandrethan temple**, possibly dedicated to Shiva, exemplifies Kashmir's wooden building tradition, featuring a peaked roof slanting outward. Moderately ornamented, it deviates from post-Gupta aesthetics, emphasizing simplicity with a row of elephants and a **decorated doorway**.

Nagara Architecture in Kumaon

- ❑ Temples at **Jageshwar** near Almora and Champawat near **Pithoragarh** in Kumaon represent classic examples of nagara architecture in the region.
- ❑ These temples showcase the regional adaptation of architectural styles, contributing to the rich heritage of hill architecture.

Temple Style in Himachal Pradesh

Various architectural styles of hill temples are scattered throughout Himachal Pradesh, each representing distinct periods of religious faith. These styles can be classified based on the type of roofing they feature.

- ❑ **The pent roof style:** The slanted roof, comprised of rows of slates, is crafted to suit the climatic conditions of the region, particularly the heavy snowfall.
Example: Bijli Mahadev Temple (Kullu), Lakshana Devi Temple (Bharmour, Chamba)
- ❑ **Pagoda Style:** The temple's tower consists of multiple tiers with leaf-like structures. These buildings, constructed from wood and stone, feature a series of stacked roofs.
Example: Manu Temple (Kullu), Prashar Temple (Mandi), Hadimba Temple (Kullu).
- ❑ **Sutlej Valley Style:** It combines elements of a pent roof with the pagoda style typically found in the upper Satluj Valley.
Example: Bhimakali temple (Shimla).
- ❑ **Shikhar Style:** Constructed of stone, it features a tower-like conical formation, with an **amalaka** placed atop the Shikhara.
Example: Lord Vaidyanath's temple (Bajjnath, Kangra)
- ❑ **Dome Type Temple:** The influence of the Mughals and Sikhs is discernible in this design, characterized by a structure with a hollow upper half resembling a sphere.
Example: Jwalamukhi Temple (Kangra), Naina Devi Temple (Bilaspur).
- ❑ **Chamba Sculptures and Fusion of tradition:** Chamba exhibits an amalgamation of local traditions with a post-Gupta style, seen in sculptures like **Mahishasuramardini** and **Narasimha** at the **Lakshana-Devi Mandir**.
 - Influenced by the metal sculpture tradition of Kashmir, these sculptures in yellow color possibly feature an alloy of zinc and copper.
 - An inscription at the temple, built during the reign of **Meruvarman** in the seventh century, indicates its historical significance.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

Considering the influence of local geography and climate, how do the shapes of temples adapt to environmental conditions, and to what extent does this architectural responsiveness contribute to the sustainability and resilience of these structures?

The Dravida or South Indian Temple Style

The Pallavas, one of the ancient South Indian dynasties that were active in the Andhra region from the second century CE onwards, moved south to settle in Tamil Nadu. They left behind a significant architectural legacy through inscriptions in stone and several monuments including temples. **Mamallapuram**, also known as Mahabalipuram, served as a hub for structural endeavours. Initially, hard igneous rocks were used, followed by the introduction of soft sandstone in later periods.

The temple architecture in South India began under the **Pallava rulers** and can be classified into four stages:

Mahendra Group

- ❑ The first stage of Pallava architecture was basically **rock-cut temples**.
- ❑ **Mahendravarman** claims in his **Mandagappattu inscription** that his shrine to Brahma, Isvara and Vishnu was made without using traditional materials such as brick, timber, metal and mortar.
- ❑ Temples were known as Mandapas (in Nagara style mandapa meant assembly hall).
- ❑ Temples are usually the **mandapa** type with a pillared hall or the mandapa in front and a small shrine at the rear or sides.

Narasimha Group

- ❑ sculptures were used to decorate the rock-cut temples.
- ❑ Under Narasimhavarman 1 (630-668 AD), the mandapas were divided into Rathas, the biggest one being the **Dharmaraja Ratha**.
- ❑ Most of the building works at Mahabalipuram/Mamallapuram were inaugurated by him.
- ❑ **The Dravidian style** of Temple architecture is a **successor of Dharmaraja Ratha**.



Fig. 2.16: Dharmaraja Ratha

Rajasimha Group

- ❑ Under him, the development of real **structural temples** took place instead of rock-cut temples.

- ❑ **Example: Shore temple** at **Mahabalipuram** was built in the reign of **Narasimhavarman II**, also known as **Rajasimha**, who reigned from 700 to 728 AD, **Kailasanatha temple** at Kanchipuram etc.



Fig. 2.17: Shore Temple, Mahabalipuram

Nandivarman Group

- ❑ The temples were smaller in size.
- ❑ The features were almost similar to the Dravidian style of Temple architecture.

Mahabalipuram

This 7th-century Pallava site was declared as a **UNESCO World Heritage Site**.

Important monuments at Mahabalipuram:

- ❑ **Rock cut cave temples:** Varaha cave temple, Krishna cave temple, Pancha Pandava cave temple and Mahishasuramardini Mandapa.
- ❑ **Pancha Pandava Rathas:** The Five Rathas, named after the renowned five Pandava brothers from the Mahabharata, are monuments sculpted from a single rock. While the Dharmaraja, Arjuna, and Draupadi Rathas are square in shape, the Bhima and Ganesa Rathas are rectangular, and the Sahadeva Ratha is apsidal.
- ❑ Descent of Ganges, also known as **Arjuna's penance** or Bhagiratha's penance, is an open-air rock relief.
- ❑ **Shore temple complex:** It has one large temple and two smaller ones. One of the three temples has a sculpture of **Anantashayana**, or **Vishnu**, although the main focus of the shrine is **Lord Shiva**. The compound includes evidence of a water tank, early gopuram, and **sculptures of Nandi**, though erosion has affected some carvings.



Fig. 2.18: Varaha cave temple, Mahabalipuram

Varahamandapa Cave

It is behind the monument of Arjuna's penance and has the following features:

- ❑ The front hall has **two-lion pillars** and two pilasters.
- ❑ The center cell is guarded by **two Dwarpalas**.
- ❑ One of the panels represents **Varaha** raising the Earth from the ocean, wherein she was submerged.
- ❑ A remarkable feature is the **snout of the boar**.

Sculptures During Pallavas

An artistic movement of great importance flourished under the aegis of the Pallava rulers of **Kanchi**.

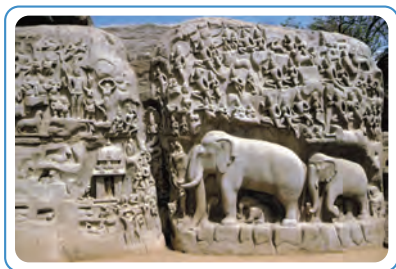


Fig. 2.19: Arjuna's Penance

- Some of the sculptures include **Seven monolithic Rathas** in **Mahabalipuram**, **Mahishasuramardini** in relief, **Girigovardhana** panel, **Arjuna's penance** or the Descent of the Ganga, **Trivikrama Vishnu**, **Gajalakshmi**, **Anatasayanam** and great **goddess Durga** engaged in a fierce battle with the Buffalo headed demon.
- The Pallava period also holds a rich **Bronze sculpture** tradition, like the bronze sculpture of **Shiva in Ardhaparyanka asana** (one leg kept dangling).

Chola Architecture

During the rule of the Chola kings, numerous temples were erected. These temples followed a style that was an extension of Pallava architecture with slight modifications. This architectural style promoted by the Cholas eventually became known as the Dravidian style.

Features of Chola Architecture/Dravidian Architecture

- Dravida temples are categorized into **five shapes**: **Square** (kuta or caturasra), **Rectangular** (shala or ayatasra), **Elliptical** (gaja-prishta or vrittayata), **Circular** (vritta), and **Octagonal** (ashtasra).
- The Dravidian temples have **towering boundary walls** surrounding them, in contrast to the Nagara temples.
- The **gopuram**, a **tall entrance gateway**, was located on the front wall.
- Temple complexes often include **large water reservoirs** or temple tanks.
- There was a main temple and four smaller shrines on the **panchayatana-style** temple grounds.
- The spire in the Dravidian architecture is **shaped like a stepped pyramid** and rises straight up rather than curled. It is referred to as **Vimana**.
- Shikhar**, which is in **octagonal shape**, resembles the kalash of the Nagara shrine.
- There is a **single vimana on top of the main temple**. The secondary shrines lack vimanas, in contrast to Nagara-style buildings.
- A **vestibular tunnel** connects the assembly hall to the garbhagriha.
- The entrance to Garbhagriha has sculptures typically depicting **fierce dvarapalas** or Dvarapalakas (door guardians) guarding the temple.

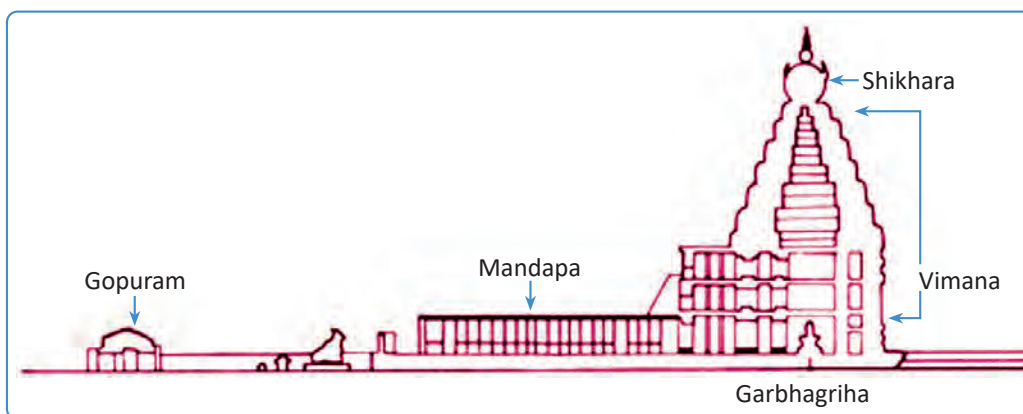


Fig. 2.20: Dravida Style Temple



IGNITE YOUR MIND

One of the common features in the Nagara and Dravida style of temple architecture is the use of the Panchayatana style. Discuss its significance in Hindu mythology.

Early Chola Temples

- These temples were much smaller in comparison to the huge monumental structures of the later Cholas.
- Many small figures called '**ganas**' are depicted on the temple walls.
- The temples are seen with intricate carvings.



Fig. 2.21: Brihadeeswara Temple, Thanjavur

Examples: **Vijayalaya Cholisvara temple** in Narthamalai, **Brahmapurisvara temple** in Pullamangai, **Mooverkovil** at Kodambalur etc.

Later Chola Temples

These were large temples built with Royal patronage.

- ❑ **Rajaraja Chola**, in the year 1010 AD, completed the construction of **Brihadeeswara temple**, which is known for its grandeur and might.
- ❑ Other examples include the **Airavateshwara temple** at Darasuram, built by **Rajaraja Chola II**, and **Gangaikondacholapuram** by **Rajendra I**.

Brihadeeswara Temple

- ❑ The temple is a part of the **UNESCO World Heritage Site**.
- ❑ This temple's pyramidal vimana rises to a height of 200 ft and is topped by a monolithic shikhara which is an octagonal dome-shaped stupika.
- ❑ Huge **Nandi figures** dot the corners of the shikhara, and the Kalasha on top itself is about 3mts high.
- ❑ The main deity of the temple is **Siva**, who is shown as a huge **lingam** set in a **two-storeyed sanctum**.

Sculptures During Cholas

The Chola dynasty was renowned for its patronage of the arts, particularly temple architecture and sculpture. Chola sculptures were characterized by their intricate detail, lifelike portrayal, and spiritual significance.

- ❑ Chola sculptures were present at **Brihadeeswara temple** in **Thanjavur**.
- ❑ Other sculptures: an 11th-century relief carving of Siva as **Gajurasamahamurti** and a 13th-century sculpture showing **Bhudevi, or the earth goddess**, as the younger consort of Vishnu.
- ❑ Although bronze images were modelled and cast during the Pallava Period in the eighth and ninth centuries,



Fig. 2.22: A Chola Kalyanasundara Bronze

some of the most beautiful and exquisite statues were produced during the Chola Period in Tamil Nadu from the tenth to the twelfth century. Chola Queen Sembiyan Mahadevi was a distinguished patron.

- The ninth-century **Kalyanasundara murti** is highly remarkable for the manner in which **Panigrahana** (ceremony of marriage) is represented by two separate statuettes. Shiva, with his extended right hand, accepts Parvati's (the bride's) right hand, who is depicted with a bashful expression and taking a step forward.

Nataraja Sculpture

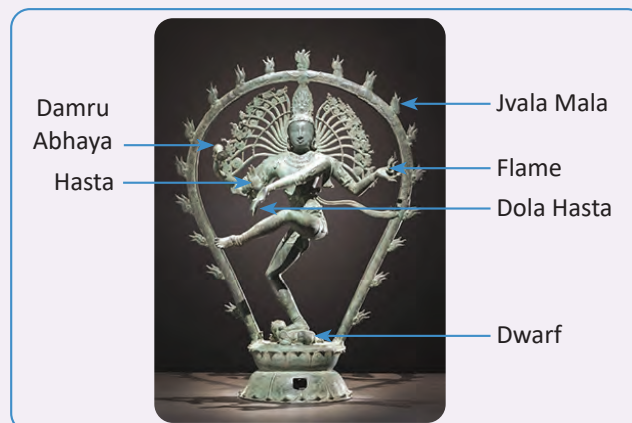


Fig. 2.23: Nataraja Sculpture

- ❑ It is a **bronze sculpture** of the Chola period showing **Lord Shiva** balancing himself on his right leg and suppressing the **Apasmara**, the demon of ignorance, with the foot of the same leg.
- ❑ He raises his left leg in **Bhujangatrasita's stance**, which represents **Tirobhava**, which is kicking away the **veil of Maya** or **illusion** from the devotee's mind.
- ❑ His four arms are outstretched, and the main right hand is posed in **Abhaya hasta** while the upper right hand holds **Damaru**, which signifies the sound of creation.
- ❑ The upper left hand carries a **flame** which represents destruction. The main left hand is held in **Dola hasta** (shows the path of salvation) and connects with the **Abhaya hasta** (conveys a sense of reassurance, peace, and protection to the devotee.) of the right hand.
- ❑ His hair locks (representing the flow of river Ganga) fly on both sides, touching the circular **Jwala mala** or the **garland of flames**.
- ❑ **The snake around the arm symbolizes Kundalini power.**
- ❑ Shiva is shown in **the Ardhanarishvara avatar** (fusion of male and female).
- ❑ A nimbus of bright lights surrounds the Nataraja, symbolizing the endless cycle of time.

OTHER ARCHITECTURAL STYLES IN DECCAN

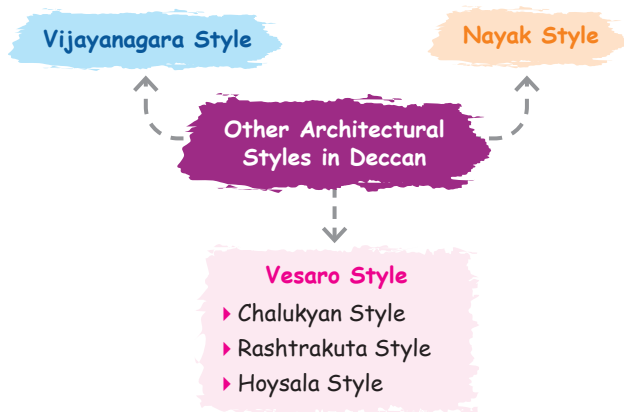


Fig. 2.24: Other Architectural Styles in Deccan

Vesara Style

The temple architecture in the Deccan region, particularly in **Karnataka**, is known as the **Vesara style**.

Features

- ❑ It exhibits a blend of North and South Indian influences.
- ❑ Open ambulatory passageway with pillars, doorways and ceilings decorated with intricate carvings.
- ❑ **Dravidian influence** is seen in **intricate carvings and sculptures**.
- ❑ **Nagara style influence** is seen in the curvilinear shikhara and the square base of temples.
- ❑ Emphasis was laid on Vimana and Mandapas.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

Diffusion has helped in the synthesis of various architectural styles, giving rise to distinct styles all over India. Examine.

Architectural Style of Chalukyas

Pulakesin I found the western Chalukya kingdom around Badami in 543 AD.

- ❑ In Karnataka, the western Chalukyas blended various styles, leading to experimental hybrid **vesara architecture**.
- ❑ Chalukyas introduced the technique of building temples using **soft sandstones** as a medium.
- ❑ Early Chalukyan architectural activity included rock-cut caves, which evolved into structural temples.

Aihole

- ❑ The **Ravana Phadi cave** showcases a distinctive sculptural style, featuring a significant depiction of Nataraja surrounded by larger-than-life saptamatrikas, characterized by graceful, slim bodies and unique attire details.

- ❑ The **Lad Khan temple** in Karnataka is inspired by wooden-roofed hill temples but constructed entirely in stone.
- ❑ The **Durga temple at Aihole** is unique with an early apsidal shrine reminiscent of Buddhist chaitya halls, surrounded by a later veranda with a stylistically nagara shikhara.
- ❑ Another temple, called **Huccmalligudi**, is rectangular in shape.
- ❑ Moreover, Chalukyas constructed Jain temples. The evolution of temple architecture during the Chalukyas can be seen in the **Megudi Jain Temple**. At Aihole, the mandapa-style cave has been preserved.



Fig. 2.25: Durga Temple, Aihole

Badami (Vatapi)

There are four cave temples in Badami. Two temples are dedicated to Vishnu and one each to Siva and to the Jaina Tirthankaras.

- ❑ The largest cave temple built by **Mangalesa** is dedicated to **Vishnu**. The reclining posture of Vishnu on the snake bed and Narasimha are exquisite examples of Chalukya art.

Pattadakal

Pattadakal was a centre for performing royal rituals.

- ❑ The **Virupaksha temple** was built at the order of queen **Lohamahadevi** to commemorate the **conquest of Kanchipuram** by her husband **Vikramaditya II**.



Fig. 2.26: Papanath temple at Pattadakal

- The Chalukyas here adopted the distinctive characteristic of the structure temple constructed by Rajasimha at Mamallapuram.
- The east porch of the Virupaksha temple has a Kannada inscription eulogizing the architect who designed the temple who was given the title **Tribhuavacharya** (maker of the three worlds).

- ❑ The **Papanath temple** at Pattadakal is dedicated to **Lord Shiva** and exemplifies the Dravida tradition.
- ❑ Eastern Chalukyan temples, like Mahakuta and Swarga Brahma temples, show the assimilation of northern styles from Odisha and Rajasthan.

Architectural Style of Rashtrakutas

- ❑ In the late seventh or early eighth century, the Rashtrakutas took control of the Deccan, showcasing grand architecture at Ellora.

- ❑ The **Kailashnath temple at Ellora** dedicated to Shiva (with a Nandi shrine and a gopuram-like gateway, surrounding cloisters, subsidiary shrines, staircases and an imposing tower or vimana rising to thirty metres), is a complete dravida building carved entirely from living rock.
 - The temple was made out of a single rock during the time of **Krishna I** in the 8th century.
 - It is **similar** to the **Lokesvara temple** at Pattadakal, in Karnataka, built by **Chalukya** king **Vikramaditya II** to commemorate his victory over the Pallavas
- ❑ Rashtrakuta sculptures at Ellora display dynamism, grandeur, and overwhelming energy.

Sculptures During Rashtrakutas

In the middle of the 8th century, the Rashtrakutas wrested power from the Chalukyas.

- ❑ Their sculptures include images of **Shiva marrying Parvati**, **Ravana shaking Mount Kailasa**, **Dasavatara Bhairava**, **dancing Shiva** and **Vishnu** at the **Kailasa temple in Ellora**. (The temple was built by King **Krishna I**).
- ❑ **Elephanta Caves:** Sculptures include **Nataraja**, **Sadashiva**, **Ardhanarishvara** and **Maheshamurti**
 - **Maheshamurti** has **three heads** emanating from one - The central head is the main **Shiva** figure, and the other two are **Bhairava** & **Uma**, representing three different aspects of **Lord Shiva**.

Architectural Style of Hoysalas

Hoysala rulers constructed temples in the region of Karnataka between 1050-1300 AD. The prominent seats of Hoysala art being **Belur, Halebidu, Sringeri**.

Characteristics of Hoysala style of temple architecture

- ❑ The shrines were designed in the form of Star and are known as the **stellate plan**.
- ❑ **Soft soapstone** was used as the main building material, which enabled the intricate craftsmanship.
- ❑ **Multiple shrines** were built around a central pillared hall.
- ❑ Both the interior and exterior walls were **intricately carved**.
- ❑ The temples were built on an upraised platform known as **Jagati**.
- ❑ All chambers of the temple have shikharas.
- ❑ **Examples:** **Hoysaleswara temple** at Halebidu, **Chennakesava temple** at Belur, and **Chennakesava temple** at Somanathapura.



Fig. 2.27: Hoysaleswara Temple



Fig. 2.28: Sculpture of Hariharaswami, Hoysaleswara Temple

- Constructed in 1150 AD by the Hoysala king using **dark schist stone**, the Hoysaleswara temple is one of the three most frequently discussed temples, alongside those at **Belur** and **Somnathpuram**.
- The **Halebid temple**, dedicated to **Shiva** as **Nataraja**, is a dual structure with a mandapa for music and dance, featuring intricate carvings of animals and deities.

Sculptures during Hoysalas

- ❑ The decoration was elaborate. The emphasis was more on ornamentation than movement or the grace of the human body.
- ❑ Sculptures were squat, short and highly embellished.
- ❑ Examples can be seen in the temples at **Halebid** and **Belur** where sculpture looks like **lacework in stone**. The carving of **Lord Krishna** holding aloft the mountain **Goverdhan** is another example.

Vijayanagara Style

They ruled from 1336 to 1565 AD and continued the Chola and Chalukyan art traditions. The Vijayanagara architecture **combined the features of the Cholas, Hoysalas, Pandyas, and Chalukyas architectural styles**. Under them the architectural style started to get influenced by the **Indo-Islamic style of Bijapur**. Though often characterized as Dravida style, it had its own distinct features. This new style of architecture is called the **Provida style**. The kings of this dynasty built great marvels in hard stones like granite and they also made additions to the already existing temples.

Features of the Temples



Fig. 2.29: Virupaksha Temple, Hampi

- ❑ Their temple complexes consisted of paralleled series of rectangular prakaras or side walls with gopurams at the centre of each side.
- ❑ The walls of these temples were highly decorated with carvings and geometrical patterns.
- ❑ **Gopurams** were built on all sides and were in several storied pyramidal structures. Larger and taller Gopurams are known as **Raya Gopurams**. They were generally seven to eleven storeys tall.
- ❑ The temples were equipped with **monolithic Rock pillars**.
- ❑ A new structure known as **the Amman Shrine** appeared. Here, the spouse of the chief deity was kept. E.g., Amman shrine of **Hazara temple**.

- ❑ Numerous mandapas were constructed, and the central mandap came to be known as **Kalyana mandapa**.
- ❑ The concept of **secular buildings** inside the temple premises became a common feature.
- ❑ **Examples:** **Vittalaswami temple complex** (Its pillars emit musical notes on tapping), **Lotus Mahal**, **Virupaksha temple** and **Raghunatha temple** at Hampi.



Fig. 2.30: Portrait of Krishnadevaraya at Chidambaram Temple

Sculptures During the Vijayanagar Empire

- ❑ They built temples at places like **Tadpatri**, **Hampi**, **Kanchipuram** etc and carving in these temples indicates their sculptural skills.
- ❑ Narrative forms of the **Ramayana** and **Krishna Bal Lila** were their favourite themes.
- ❑ Vijayanagara rulers also made the sculptors carve excellent **portraits** of themselves, like the **Portrait of Krishnadevaraya at Chidambaram temple** and **life-size bronze statues of Krishnadevaraya and his Queens** at **Tirupati**.
- ❑ Many **sculptures** were carved in the Gopura and courts of **Meenakshi temple** at **Madurai** during **Krishnadevaraya's** reign.

Nayaka Style



Fig. 2.31: Meenakshi Temple

It flourished under Nayaka rulers of Madurai and Tanjavur between the **16th** and **18th centuries AD**.

- ❑ Along with having architectural **similarity to the Dravidian style** it also had **Islamic influence**.
- ❑ Huge corridors (Prakarams) can be found around the garbhagriha.
- ❑ **Intricate carvings were done to decorate the temple.**
- ❑ The Nayaka dynasty, who have some of the largest gopurams, is credited with bringing the art of gopurams to its pinnacle.

Example: **Meenakshi temple** at Madurai.

Sculptures During Nayakas

Animal motifs attained importance, and they were carved with details. Examples include the **sculptures** at **Srirangam temple** in **Trichinapally**.

Though traditions of stone sculptures continued, **no major sculpture movement survived** under the **Mughals**. During the **British regime**, **no proper patronage** was provided to sculptors, and the whole tradition of Indian art almost came to a standstill.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

Indian history is a testimony to the fact that strong and stable polity is an important factor in the blooming of art and architecture. Comment.

JAIN AND BUDDHIST ARCHITECTURAL LEGACY

Jain Architectural Development

- ❑ Jains, like Hindus, were prolific temple builders, with sacred sites found across India.
- ❑ Bihar hosts some of the oldest Jain pilgrimage sites, often associated with early Buddhist shrines.
- ❑ **Ellora** and **Aihole** in the Deccan feature architecturally significant Jain sites.
- ❑ Central Indian towns like **Deogarh**, **Khajuraho**, **Chanderi**, and **Gwalior** showcase exemplary Jain temples.
- ❑ **Jain temples** at **Mount Abu**, constructed by **Vimal Shah**, exhibit a simplistic exterior with rich sculptural decoration.



Fig. 2.32: Dilwara Jain Temple

• Dilwara Jain Temples

The Jaina temple complex of Dilwara at Mount Abu had some **Solanki architecture influence** and it is considered to be in the category of **Vesara style of temple architecture**.

- ❑ These temples were mostly made of **white marble**.
- ❑ They have phenomenal torans, carved ceilings with lotus motifs, female bracket figures, and also open backyards with deva-kulikas i.e., images of gods and goddesses. The Brahmanical and Jaina temples have almost the same plan.
- ❑ The **Vimal-Vasahi temple** is dedicated to Adinatha.
- ❑ **Shatrunjay hills** near Palitana in Gujarat house an imposing cluster of Jain temples.

Jain Sculptures

□ **Gujarat and Rajasthan** have been strongholds of Jainism since early times.

- The **hoard of bronzes discovered in Akota near Vadodara** established that bronze casting was practiced in Gujarat or western India between the sixth and ninth centuries.
- Most of the images represent the **Jain Tirthankaras** like **Mahavira, Parshvanath or Adinath**.
- A new format was invented in which **Tirthankaras are seated on a throne**; they can be single or combined in a group of three or in a group of twenty-four Tirthankaras.
- **Female images** were also cast representing **yakshinis or Shasanadevis** of some prominent Tirthankaras. Stylistically, they were influenced by the features of both the Gupta and the Vakataka period bronzes.

□ Karnataka boasts a rich Jain heritage, with **Sravana Belagola** hosting the world's tallest monolithic free-standing structure—the statue of **Gomateshwara**. The Gommateshwara statue is dedicated to the Jain figure **Bahubali** and symbolises the Jain precepts of peace, non-violence, sacrifice of worldly affairs, and simple living. It was built around 983 AD during the Western Ganga dynasty.



Fig. 2.33: Statue of Bahubali

Buddhist Architectural Development

□ **Mahabodhi Temple**

- The first shrine here, located at the base of the Bodhi tree, is said to have been constructed by King Ashoka: the vedika around it is said to be post-Mauryan, of about 100 BC.
- Many of the sculptures in the niches in the temple are dated to the eighth-century Pala Period, while the actual Mahabodhi temple itself, as it stands now is largely a Colonial Period reconstruction of the old seventh-century design.
- The design of the temple is unusual. It is, strictly speaking, neither Dravida nor Nagara. It is narrow, like a Nagara temple, but it rises without curving, like a Dravida one.



Fig. 2.34: Mahabodhi Temple, Bodhi Gaya

□ **Nalanda Mahavihara**

- Nalanda Mahavihara, regarded as one of the greatest universities of the ancient world, was found by **Kumaragupta I** (413-455 A.D.) of the great Gupta dynasty.



Fig. 2.35: Nalanda Mahavihara

- King **Harshavardhana** of Kannauj (606-647 A.D.) and the **Pala kings** of east India (8th-12th Century A.D.) continued to extend patronage to this centre.
- The decline of this great institution started in the later Pala period, but the final blow came in around 1200 A.D. by the invasion of **Bakhtiyar Khalji**, who destroyed it by fire and the glory of Nalanda and thus got buried under the soil.
- Excavations conducted by the Archaeological Survey of India have exposed the extensive remains of **six major brick temples** and **eleven monasteries** arranged on a systematic layout and spread over an area of more than a square kilometre.
- Basically a hundred feet wide passage runs north-south with the row of temples on the west and that of the monasteries on the east of it.

□ **Sirpur in Chhattisgarh** is an early Odisha style site which belongs to the period between 550 AD and 800 AD, with both Hindu and Buddhist shrines.

□ The **port town of Nagapattinam** was also a major Buddhist center right until the **Chola Period**.

Buddhist Sculptures

- Many standing Buddha images with the right hand in **Abhaya mudra** were cast in North India, particularly Uttar Pradesh and Bihar, during the Gupta and Post-Gupta periods, i.e., between the **fifth to seventh centuries**.
- **Vakataka bronze images** of the Buddha from Phopnar, Maharashtra, are contemporary with the Gupta period bronzes. They show the **influence of the Amaravati style** of Andhra Pradesh in the third century AD.
- **Himachal Pradesh and Kashmir** regions also produced bronze images of Buddhist deities as well as Hindu gods and goddesses.
- In Buddhist centres like **Nalanda**, a school of bronze casting emerged around the ninth century during the rule of the Pala Dynasty in the Bihar and Bengal regions.
 - A remarkable bronze is of a **four-armed Avalokitesvara**, which is a good example of a male figure in graceful **tribhanga posture**.
 - **Images of Tara** became very popular. Seated on a throne, she is accompanied by a growing curvilinear lotus stalk and her right hand is in the abhaya mudra.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

To what extent does the symbolism embedded in every element of Buddhist temple architecture contribute to the spiritual experience of worshippers, and how does it serve as a visual representation of Buddhist principles such as non-violence and truth?

OTHER IMPORTANT TEMPLES

State	Name of the Temple	Description
Andhra Pradesh	Venkateswara Temple (Also known as Temple of Seven Hills)	This temple of Lord Sri Venkateswara (incarnation of Vishnu) was built by King Thondaiman , Tamil ruler. Later developed by Chola Dynasty Kings.
	Varaha Lakshmi Narasimha Temple (also known as Simahachalam Temple)	This temple is dedicated to Lord Varaha Narsimha (a lion-man incarnation of Lord Vishnu).
	Sri Bhramaramba Mallikarjuna Temple	This is a temple of Lord Shiva and Parvati . Inscriptional evidence from the Satvahana Dynasty suggests additions were done during the time of King Harihara of Vijayanagar Empire.
	Suryanarayana Temple (also known as Arasavalli Sun Temple)	This temple of the Sun God was Built by the ruler Devendra Sarma in the 7th century AD.
	Sri Ranganathswami Temple	Built in the 12th century, this temple is dedicated to Lord Ranganatha (a resting form of Lord Vishnu).
	Veerabhadra Temple	The temple of Lord Shiva was built in 1530 AD by Virupanna Nayaka and Viranna , both were Governors under the Vijayanagar Empire .
Arunachal Pradesh	Malinithan	This is a temple of Deity Durga in her Shakti form, which was built in the 14-15th Centuries.
Assam	Kamakhya Temple (also known as Kamrup Kamakhya)	Built in the 8th-17th Century, this temple is dedicated to Mother Kamakhya .
	Umananda Devaloi	This temple of Umananda (Shiva) was built by Ahom King Gadadhar Singha (1681–1696)
	Navagraha Temple	Built by Ahom King Rajeswar Singha in the late 18th century, this temple is dedicated to Navagraha.
	Negheriting Shiva Doul	Built by the Kacharis during the 8th –9th century AD and reconstructed in 1687 by the Ahom king , the chief deity of this temple is Lord Shiva .
	Hayagriva Madhava Temple	This is a temple of Narasimha . The present temple structure was constructed by the King Raghudeva Narayan in 1583 . According to some historians, the King of Pala dynasty constructed it.
Bihar	Mundeshwari Devi Temple	Built in 105 AD, this temple is dedicated to Lord Shiva and Shakti .
Gujarat	Dwarkadheesh Temple	This temple of Lord Krishna is around 2200 years old.
	Bahuchara Mata	Built in 1783 AD, this temple is dedicated to the Goddess Bahuchara .
	Modhera Sun Temple	This temple of Sun God was built in 1026-27 AD during the reign of Bhima I of the Chalukya .
	Somnath Temple	
	❑ The first temple is said to have existed 2000 years ago. In 649 AD, King Maitre of Vallabhini built and renovated a second temple. ❑ It is one of the twelve Jyotirlingas. ❑ A description of the temple was done by Al-Biruni, an Arab traveller, and it prompted a visit in 1024 AD by Mahmud of Ghazni. ❑ The contemporary Somnath temple's reconstruction was started under the orders of the first Home Minister of India Vallabhbhai Patel. Then President of India, Dr. Rajendra Prasad, did the Pran-Pratistha of the temple.	

Chattisgarh	Bhoramdeo Temple	Built in 1089 AD , this temple is dedicated to Lord Shiva .
	Danteshwari Temple	This temple of Goddess Danteshwari was built in the 14th century .
	Mahamaya Temple	Built in the 12– 13th century , during the reign of Ratnadeva , Kalachuri king of Ratnapura, presiding deities of this temple are Goddess Lakshmi & Saraswati.
Himachal Pradesh	Jwalamukhi Devi Temple	This temple is dedicated to Goddess Jwalamukhi. An eternal flame of fire is worshipped in this temple.
	Baba Balak Nath Temple	This temple is dedicated to Baba Balak Nath who was supposed to be an incarnation of Lord Shiva in Kalyuga.
Jharkhand	Baidyanath Temple	This temple is dedicated to Lord Shiva.
Karnataka	Durga Temple	This temple of Goddess Durga was built in the 7th-8th century by the Chalukya Dynasty .
	Virupaksha Temple	Built by the rulers of the Vijaynagar empire , this temple is dedicated to Lord Virupaksha, a form of Lord Shiva.
	Hoysaleswara	This temple of Lord Shiva was built by the rulers of the Hoysala empire in the 12th century.
	Chennakesava Temple [Belur]	Built by the rulers of the Hoysala empire in the 12th century, Lord Vishnu is the presiding deity.
	Chennakesava Temple [Somanathapura]	This temple of Lord Vishnu was built by the rulers of the Hoysala empire in 12th century.
Kerala	Padmanabhaswamy Temple	This is a temple of Lord Vishnu.
	Sabarimala Temple	Built before the 12th century AD, this temple is dedicated to Ayyappan , an incarnation of Vishnu and Shiva
Madhya Pradesh	Kandariya Mahadeva Temple	This temple of Lord Shiva was built in the 11th century by a Chandela ruler.
	Sas-Bahu Temple (also called Sahastrabahu temple)	Built in the 11th century by King Mahipala of the Kachchhapaghata dynasty , this temple houses Lord Vishnu and Lord Shiva in two separate temples.
	Omkareshwar Temple	This is a Lord Shiva temple.
	Mahakaleshwar Temple	Built before the 13th Century, this temple is dedicated to Lord Shiva.
Maharashtra	Vitthal Temple or Vithoba Temple	Built by the rulers of the Hoysala empire in the 13th century AD to house Lord Vitthal, who is believed to be a form of Vishnu and his consort Rakhumai.
	Trimbakeshwar Temple	Built by Balaji Baji Rao , this temple is dedicated to Lord Shiva .
Odisha	Konark Sun Temple	This temple of the Sun God was built by the Eastern Ganga dynasty in the 13th century .
	Lingaraja Temple	Built by the rulers of the Somavamsi dynasty in the 11th century, this temple has Harihara, a form of Shiva and Vishnu as the chief deity.
Rajasthan	Karni Mata Temple	This temple of Goddess Durga was built by Maharaja Ganga Singh.
Telangana	Thousand Pillar or Rudreswara Swamy Temple	Built by the rulers of the Kakatiya Dynasty in the 12-14th centuries , this temple houses Lord Vishnu, Shiva and Surya.
	Ramappa Temple	Built by the rulers of the Kakatiya Dynasty in the 11th century , this temple has Ramalingeswara as the chief deity.
Tamil Nadu	Shore Temple	Built in the 8th Century AD by the Pallavas , this temple is dedicated to Lord Shiva.
	Meenakshi Temple	Goddess Parvati is the presiding deity, and this temple was built in the 16th Century .
	Murugan Temple	This temple is dedicated to Lord Murugan (Lord Kartikeya)
	Brihadeeswara Temple	Built by Raja Raja I in 1010 AD , this temple houses Lord Shiva as the chief deity.
	Ranganathaswamy Temple	It is dedicated to Lord Vishnu.

Tripura	Unakoti Cave Temple	It is dedicated to Lord Shiva and was built in 600-700 AD.
Uttar Pradesh	Vishwanath Temple	It is dedicated to Lord Shiva and was built in 1780 AD.
West Bengal	Dakshineswar Temple	It is dedicated to Goddess Kali and was built in 1855 AD.

CONCLUSION

Indian temple architecture is a testament to the rich cultural heritage, artistic ingenuity, and spiritual devotion of the Indian subcontinent. From the towering spires of North Indian temples to the intricate carvings of South Indian shrines, each architectural style reflects a deep reverence for divinity and a profound understanding of geometry, symbolism, and aesthetics.

Furthermore, Indian temple architecture exemplifies a harmonious synthesis of artistic expression, tradition and religious philosophy. Hinduism, Buddhism, and Jainism have contributed to the architectural landscape, such as the Ajanta and Ellora caves. The artistic expressions in the form of intricate carvings, frescoes etc., convey deeper meanings and stories, as seen in various temples depicting scenes from Indian mythology and daily life.

INTRODUCTION

Painting is one of the principal artistic forms utilized to portray India's long legacy of artistic brilliance. In India, paintings have a long history, dating back to prehistoric times. A number of caves belonging to ancient times have been found with huge murals on their walls and ceilings. Various temples of that time also feature murals on their walls. Subsequently, the Mughal and Rajput courts were dominated by miniature style, and then the Westernization of painting began with the arrival of the Europeans.

Literary Mention of Paintings

- ❑ The third Khanda of the **Vishnudharmottara Purana**, a fifth-century text, includes the chapter **Chitrasutra**, a significant source of Indian art, especially painting.
 - This text introduces the art of image-making known as **"Pratima Lakshana"**, which outlines the canons of painting.
 - It also discusses techniques, tools, materials, surfaces (like walls), perception, perspective, and the three-dimensionality of human figures.
- ❑ The drama **"Mudrarakshasa"** by **Vishakhadutta** discusses painting styles and their distinguishing features. Among the styles were:
 - **Cauka Pitaka**: Notable for individual framed drawings.
 - **Dighala Pitaka**: Known for its extended scroll-style paintings.
 - **Yama Pitaka**: Emphasizes standalone, isolated artworks.

Essential Components of Paintings

'Shadang' or the six limbs of Indian Art find their first mention in **Vatsyayana's** celebrated text **Kama Sutra**. Shadang weaves the language and defines the principles of the creation of an artwork. It mirrors the limbs of art, without which an artwork is deficient. It has been mentioned in the form of verses as:

**"Roopabhedah pramanani bhava-lavanya-yojanam |
Sadrishyam varnakabhangam iti chitram shadakam ||"**

- ❑ **Rupabhedha**: It emphasizes the **significance of form** (Rupa) and the nuanced distinctions among various forms. One should possess the ability to differentiate between a sleeping individual and a deceased individual.
- ❑ **Pramanam**: It discusses the **proportion** between object and subject. The focus lies on perception, measurement, and structure.

- ❑ **Bhava**: It addresses **emotions or intentions**, where Bhava can manifest overtly or covertly. Ravi Varma gained renown for portraying veiled emotions in his artwork.
- ❑ **Lavanya Yojanam**: "Lavanya embodies **grace**. An artist cannot truly capture a character without attaining grace, which empowers them to reveal the beauty inherent not just in outward appearance, but in essence."
- ❑ **Sadrishyam**: It refers to attaining a **resemblance to the subject**. At times, this resemblance stems from forms, occasionally from attributes, and sometimes from virtues.
- ❑ **Varnika Bhanga**: This aspect relates to **colours**, whose beauty is found in their application.

WALL PAINTINGS

India has a rich tradition of wall paintings that span centuries and reflect the diverse cultural heritage of the country. **Vinaya Pitaka**, a Buddhist text, mentions pleasure houses with picture halls adorned with painted figures and decorative patterns. It also mentioned the Ajanta paintings of Maharashtra. Under the section on Wall paintings, we have also discussed Rock paintings and Mural paintings.

Prehistoric Rock Paintings



Fig. 3.1: Prehistoric Rock Paintings

Rock paintings in India offer fascinating glimpses into prehistoric cultures and their artistic expressions. Spread across various regions, these paintings provide insights into the lives, beliefs, and activities of ancient people.

- ❑ Primitive paintings have been found in cave walls in the **Kaimur Range** of Central India, the **Vindhya Hills**, with locations like **Bhimbetka**, **Mirzapur**, **Pachmarhi**, and **Indus Valley pottery** (Painted Earthen Jar discovered in Mohenjodaro was painted in black and adorned with motifs of plants and geometric patterns).
- ❑ Even before the discovery of Bhimbetka caves, archaeologist **Archibald Carlleyle** discovered rock paintings in **Sohagighat**, Mirzapur, in 1867-68.

Three primary phases of Prehistoric rock paintings:

Upper Paleolithic Period	- Walls are of Quartzite in rock shelter caves utilized for prehistoric paintings. - Primary pigments Ochre or geru (got that from haematite), mixed with lime and water. Green (from the chalcedony stone). White (from Lime). - The paintings of the Upper Palaeolithic phase are linear representations of huge animal figures, such as bison, elephants, tigers, rhinos and boars besides stick-like human figures in green and dark red. - Human figures are represented with red (hunters) and green (dancers).
Mesolithic Period	- The largest number of paintings belong to this period. Red pigment has been used predominantly during this era. - There are generally smaller size paintings compared to the Upper Paleolithic Period. - Frequent themes include group hunting, grazing scenes, and depictions of riding activities. Community dances also provide a common theme. Animals were painted in a naturalistic style and humans were depicted only in a stylistic manner. Women are painted both nude and clothed.
Chalcolithic Period	- Notable rise in the number of paintings using green and yellow pigments. - Prominent subject: Battle scenes. - Numerous depictions of men on horseback and elephants, some armed with bows and arrows, suggest readiness for conflicts.

Bhimbetka Caves

- The earliest prehistoric paintings belong to the **Bhimbetka caves** of **Madhya Pradesh**.
 - The caves were discovered in 1957–58 by eminent archaeologist **V.S. Wakankar**.
 - These caves were declared a **UNESCO World Heritage Site** in 2003.
- The rock paintings have numerous layers belonging to various epochs of time, ranging from the **Upper Palaeolithic and Mesolithic age to the protohistoric, early historic and medieval periods**. The most ancient scenes here are believed to be commonly belonging to the Mesolithic Age.
- The artists of Bhimbetka used many colours, including various shades of **white, yellow, orange, red ochre, purple, brown, green and black**. But white and red were their favourite colours.
- The **men** shown in them appear **adventurous and rejoicing** in their lives. The **animals** are shown more **youthful and majestic** than perhaps they actually were. Primitive artists seem to possess an intrinsic passion for **storytelling**.
- At Bhimbetka, in some places, there are as many as 20 layers of paintings, one on top of another.



Fig. 3.2: Boar rock Bhimbetka

- Lakhudiyar** translates to “one lakh caves.”
- Paintings in these shelters fall into **three categories: Human figures, animals, and geometric patterns**.
- Colors used include **white, black, and red ochre**.
- Predominant Scenes include **hand-linked dancing human figures**.
- Superimposition** of paintings is observed, with the earliest in **black**, followed by **red ochre**, and finally, **white** paintings.



Fig. 3.3: Human figures holding hands, Lakhudiyar Caves

Narsinghgarh Prehistoric Paintings

These are found in **Rajgarh district, Madhya Pradesh**.

- Depicts spotted deer skins left out for drying, supporting the idea that early humans **mastered the art of skin tanning** for clothing and shelter.
- Some paintings portrayed **musical instruments** such as harps.
- Complex geometric **shapes like spirals, rhomboids, and circles** can be found.

Lakhudiyar Rock Shelters

It is located along the **River Suyal** in the Kumaon Hills of **Uttarakhand**.

Jogimara Caves

These are located in the **Ramgarh hills, Chhattisgarh**, and contain paintings dated 1000 BC.

- Depiction of human figures, animals, palm prints, bullock carts, and other elements are indicative of a more settled and advanced way of life.

Ghodsar and Kohabaur Rock Art Sites

These are located in the **Koriya district, Chhattisgarh**.

- Site of **Chitwa Dongri (Durg district)** features a **Chinese figure** riding a donkey, images of dragons, and scenes of agriculture.
- Other Sites in Chhattisgarh are **Limdariha, Oogdi** and **Sitalekhni**.

In Odisha, **Gudahandi Rock Shelter** and **Yogimatha Rock Shelter** are significant examples of early cave paintings.

Ancient rock art, typically executed on rocks, is called **petroglyphs**. Petroglyphs are rock carvings (rock paintings are called **pictographs**) made by pecking directly on the rock surface using a stone chisel and a hammerstone.

These prehistoric paintings help us understand the early human beings, their lifestyle, their food habits, their daily activities and, above all, they help us understand their mind—the way they thought. More than anything else, the rock paintings are the greatest source of information the primitive human beings of this period left behind.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

According to your observation, how did the people of prehistoric times select themes for their paintings? What could have been the reasons for depicting more animal figures than human figures in cave paintings?

MURAL PAINTINGS

Mural painting is the class of **painting done on the walls and ceilings** in rock-cut architecture and structural temples by using special techniques. The **earliest historical paintings** in India were created in the Buddhist caves of the Satavahana period during the **2nd century AD**. Even in Central Asian caves Kushana period Buddhist mural paintings are found. All these are pre-Gupta mural paintings. By 4th century AD mural paintings reached their zenith.

Prominent Locations of Mural Paintings

- **Ajanta, Armamalai Cave, Ravan Chhaya Rock Shelter, Bagh Caves, Sittanavasal Caves, and Kailasa Temple (Ellora)**.
- Other locations include Anantha at Anantha Padmanabha Temple in Kasargod, **Shiva's pursuit of a boar in a scene** from Kiratarjuniya at Lepakshi Temple, **Chola king Rajaraja** and court poet **Karuvur Dever** in

Thanjavur (eleventh century), **Shiva killing Tripuraasura** in Thanjavur, **Rama's defeat of Ravana** in a scene from the Ramayana panel at Mattancheri Palace and Shasta at Padmanabhapuram Palace in Thakkala.

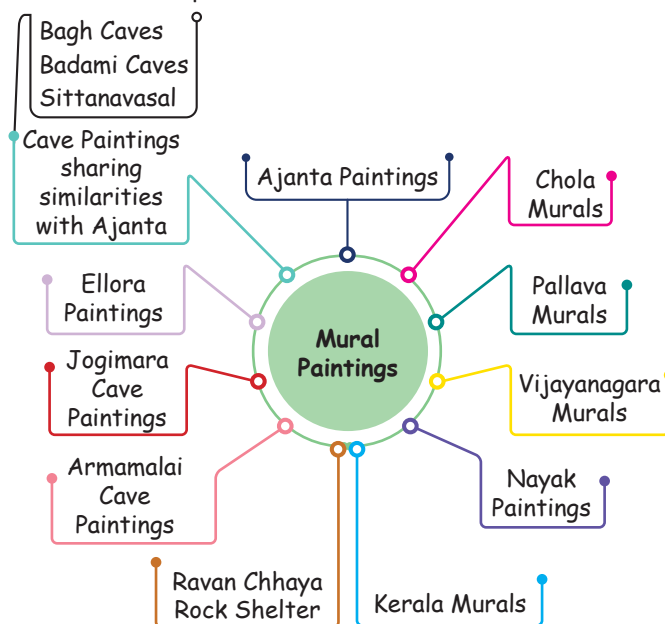


Fig. 3.4: Mural Paintings

Ajanta Paintings

The Ajanta caves have been constructed by cutting **volcanic rocks**. This place was developed from the **2nd century BC to the 7th century AD** patronised by **Satavahanas, Vakatakas** and **Guptas** and later abandoned. Ajanta is the only surviving example of painting from the first century BC and the fifth century AD. There are 29 caves, all arranged in a **horse-shoe shape**.

Key Features

- The **celestial figures** of **Kinnaras, Vidyadharas** and **Gandharvas** are depicted in paintings and sculptures.
- **Common themes: Jataka stories**, the life of Buddha, the **Avadanas** (a genre of Buddhist literature), and intricate **decorative designs** inspired by flora and fauna.
 - Some paintings, such as **Simhala Avadana, Mahajanaka Jataka** and **Vidhurpundita Jataka**, cover the entire wall of the cave.
- **Common Style:** The cave walls showcase a **blend of murals and fresco paintings**. These artworks employ the **tempera style**.

□ **Tempera painting** is a technique that involves using **pigments mixed with a water-soluble binder, typically egg yolk**.

□ Both **murals** and **frescoes** are forms of wall art, the main difference lies in the technique and materials used. Murals encompass a broader range of methods and materials, while frescoes specifically refer to paintings created using pigments applied onto wet plaster.

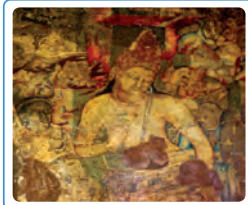
❑ **Colors:** **Vegetable** and **mineral dyes** served as the painting medium, with **red ochre** for figure outlines and **brown, black**, or **deep red** for contours.

❑ **Compositions of paintings**

- Lines are clearly defined and are very rhythmic.
- **Red ochre** has been used for the **outline of the figures**.
- Body colour gets merged with the outer line creating the effect of volume. A diverse range of skin colours, including brown, yellowish brown, greenish, and yellow ochre, symbolize a multicoloured populace.

- The figures are heavy, like the sculptures of western India.
- Figures are smaller than life-sized images, and **emotions** are **conveyed** through **hand gestures**.
- There is **a centrality to the most significant person** in each scene.
- Paintings depict human values, societal structures, clothing, and ornaments of the era.
- **Each female figure** in the paintings features a **distinctive hairstyle**.

Important Caves and their Paintings

Cave No. 1	❑ The scenes of Mahajanaka Jataka and Umag Jataka belong to the time period of mid 6th and 7th century AD. ❑ Painting of Vajrapani (protector and guide, a symbol of Buddha's power). He holds a vajra in his right hand and wears a crown. ❑ Painting of Padmapani (Avalokitesvara) (symbol of Buddha's compassion). It is dated late 5th Century AD. The Bodhisattva is holding a padma (lotus) in his right hand and the left hand is extended in the space.   Fig. 3.5: Mahajanaka Jataka Fig. 3.6: Bodhisattva Padmapani
Cave No. 4	Patron of Cave: Mathuradasa ❑ The rear wall of the verandah displays the litany panel of Avalokitesvara. ❑ The cave hosts a massive Buddha image depicted in dharmachakra pravartana mudra.
Cave No. 9 & 10	❑ The Murals of these caves belong to the Shunga period. ❑ Earliest surviving paintings of Shaddanta Jataka. • This shows a king and his entourage in front of a tree decked with flags. The monarch has arrived at the holy Bodhi tree in order to fulfill a vow involving the prince who is present with the king. ❑ Cave No. 10: Chaddanta Jataka of Pali language has also been painted.
Cave No. 16	Patron of the cave: Varahadeva (patron of Cave No. 16) who was the prime minister of the Vakataka king, Harishena. This cave contains the following paintings: ❑ "The Dying Princess" painting of the early 5th century A.D. The painting depicts the story of Nanda, who was passionately in love with this girl and was tricked away from her by the Buddha and carried up to heaven.
Cave No. 17	Patron of Cave Nos. 17 to 20: Upendragupta, the local king of the region and feudatory of the Vakataka king, Harishena. It contains following paintings: ❑ Portrayal of Buddha's life after enlightenment. • Buddha's visit to Yashodhara's home in Kapilavastu, where she and her son Rahula come out to meet him. ❑ Maya Devi, the mother of Buddha. ❑ Pink elephant

	❑ Flying apsaras belonging to the late 6th century A.D. The rich ornamentation in her turban is decked with pearls and flowers. ❑ Chaddanta Jataka story depicted where Chaddanta, is shown removing his own tusk and giving it to the hunter, Sonuttar. ❑ A few Brahmanical figures were also painted. Among which one is about Indra, a Hindu divinity, flying amid clouds with celestial nymphs.
Cave No. 19 & 26	❑ Chaitya caves feature apsidal-vaulted roofs (architectural features characterized by a vaulted or domed shape, typically found at the end of a building, forming a semicircular or polygonal termination). ❑ Cave 22: Painted figures of Manushi-Buddhas with Maitreya can be noticed here.

Cave Painting Sharing Similarities with Ajanta

Bagh Caves

It consists of **Buddhist mural paintings** and is located 97 km from the Dhar district of **Madhya Pradesh**. They closely resemble the actual Ajanta caves in terms of design, execution, and decoration.



Fig. 3.7: Bagh Cave Painting

- ❑ Unlike Ajanta, paintings in Bagh have more tightly modeled figures with stronger outlines.
- ❑ Figures are more earthly and human.
- ❑ **Cave No. 4**, known as **Rang Mahal** contains murals depicting Buddhist Jataka tales. Here paintings have acquired a secular tone as the contemporary lifestyle of the people is depicted with religious undertone.
- ❑ Remnants of **tempera mural paintings** on the walls and ceilings can also be observed in Cave Nos. 2, 3, 4, 5, and 7.

Badami Caves

These are located in **Karnataka**. These murals date to the **6th-7th century AD** and encompass various subjects, following the traditions of **Ajanta** and **Bagh**. Almost all of the original paint has been lost to history and natural elements, except for certain sections. These caves contain following paintings:

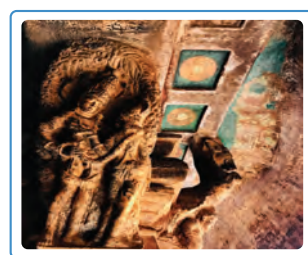


Fig. 3.8: Mural work in Badami

- ❑ There are depictions of scenes of **Chalukyan kings**, **Jain saints** renouncing worldly life, **Shiva-Parvati**, **Puranic events** and **various deities**.
- ❑ In **Cave No. 3**, there is a mural featuring a **four-armed Brahma on his swan**.
- ❑ In **Cave No. 4**, one scene of the painting shows **Kirtivarman, son of Pulakesi I** and elder brother of Mangalesha, seated in the palace with his wife and feudatories, observing a dance performance.

Sittannavalal

It is located in Pudukkottai district of **Tamil Nadu**. These murals dated from the **1st Century BC to the 10th Century AD**.

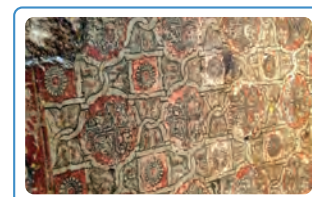


Fig. 3.9: Sittannavalal Mural

- ❑ These rock-cut cave temples are **renowned** for their **Jainism-themed** paintings.
- ❑ Certain scholars attribute these caves to the **Pallava period**, suggesting that **King Mahendravarman I** oversaw the excavation of the temple, while others argue that they were renovated during the 7th century under the **Pandya ruler's** patronage.
- ❑ These murals bear a striking **resemblance** to the paintings in **Bagh** and **Ajanta**.
- ❑ The paintings span **across the walls, ceilings, and pillars**.
- ❑ **Vegetable** and **mineral dyes** were used for painting, applied to the surface of thin, wet lime plaster. Common colours included **yellow, green, orange, blue, black, and white**.
- ❑ **Dominant theme: Jain Samavasarana** or Samosharana ("Refuge to All").
 - **Central motif** of the paintings is a pond with lotuses, with monks collecting flowers, and the presence of ducks, swans, fishes, and animals. This scene represents the Samavasarana.

Samavasarana: This is the divine preaching hall of the Tirthankara where they deliver sermons after achieving enlightenment (**kevala-jnana**). The audience in this grand hall includes bulls, elephants, apsaras, and deities.

Ellora Paintings

Ellora caves were excavated between the **6th to 11th century A.D**. These caves **have paintings with themes from Hinduism, Buddhism and Jainism**.

- ❑ Mural paintings are present in five caves, primarily in **Cave No. 16**, i.e. the **Kailasha Temple**.

- ❑ **Murals** are **created in two phases**:
 - 1st phase coincided with the cave carving.
 - The 2nd phase occurred centuries later.
- ❑ All the caves were plastered and painted but nothing visible is left.
- ❑ There are 12 Buddhist caves with numerous images associated with **Vajrayana Buddhism**, including figures like **Tara, Mahamayuri, Akshobhya, Avalokiteshwara, Maitrya, Amitabha**, etc.
- ❑ **Other prominent murals in Ellora**: Painting of lord shiva with his followers, Paintings of Goddess Lakshmi and Lord Vishnu etc.



Fig. 3.10: Painting in Jain Ellora Cave

Key Features

- ❑ **Compositions**: Organized within **rectangular panels** with **thick borders**, framing the artwork and **limiting spatial freedom** in contrast to the **more open style of Ajanta**.
 - While elements of the classical tradition, such as **mass modeling** and **soft outlines**, are still present in Ellora paintings, one can notice a clear departure from the traditional practices.
 - Sharp head twists, angular arm bends, concave limb curves, pronounced noses, and long, open eyes are medieval features in these paintings.
- ❑ **Cave Temple No. 32**: The **flying figures** (mid-9th century) show a **blend of Ajanta's classical style and medieval elements**.
- ❑ **Cave No. 14**: Only double-storey cave of the Brahmanical faith.
- ❑ Other paintings include Depictions of Goddess Lakshmi and Lord Vishnu, Scenes featuring Lord Shiva and his retinue and Elegant and graceful representations of Apsaras.

Jogimara Cave Paintings

- ❑ It is located in **Chhattisgarh** and dates back to 1000-300 BC.
- ❑ They are **artificially** carved out caves featuring **both paintings and inscriptions** (Brahmi script).
- ❑ The cave is believed to be an **extension** of an **amphitheater**, with the paintings serving as decorative elements.
- ❑ The artworks **depict dancing couples** and **various animals**, including **elephants** and **fish**.

- ❑ The paintings are distinguished by a **prominent red outline**, and other colours like white, yellow, and black were also employed.

Armamalai Cave Paintings

It is a **natural cave** situated in the district of **Vellore** in **Tamil Nadu**.

- ❑ These caves were **transformed** into a **Jain temple** during the 8th century AD.
 - The walls and roof are adorned with vibrant and captivating **paintings** that **narrate stories** related to **Astathik Palakas** (deities guarding the eight corners) and **Jainism**.

Ravan Chhaya Rock Shelter

It is located near **Sitabinji, Orissa**. It is thought to have functioned as a **royal hunting lodge**.



Fig. 3.11: Mural in Ravana Chhaya cave

- ❑ The **fresco paintings** on this rock shelter resemble a **half-opened umbrella** in shape.
- ❑ **Important painting**: Depiction of a royal procession from the 7th century AD.

Chola Murals

The Imperial Chola dynasty ruled the Tamil Country from the **10th century to the 12th century**. They built great temples in Tanjore, Darasuram and Gangaikonda Cholapuram.

Features of Chola Murals

- ❑ Images have wide-open eyes and unique vitality and sensitivity.
- ❑ The colours are soft and subdued.
- ❑ The lines are strong and very expressive with emotions.

Examples of Chola Paintings

- ❑ There are fragments of **early Chola paintings** in **Narthamalai, Malayadipatti** and other places.
- ❑ Incidents from the **Periyapuram**, in the form of miniatures, are depicted on the base of the **garbhagriha** (sanctum sanctorum) wall of the **Darasuram temple**.
- ❑ **Brihadisvara temple** at Tanjore is the real treasure-house of the art of Chola painter.

- The passage which runs around the shikhara contains the paintings.
- Paintings relate to **Lord Shiva** including Shiva in Kailash, Shiva as Tripurantaka, Shiva as Nataraja and **Shiva as Yoga- Dakshinamurthy**.

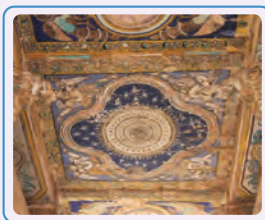


Fig. 3.12: Murals in Brihadeswara temple

- Depictions of the **patron Rajaraja** and his **mentor Kuruvar**, as well as dancing figures.
- The master pieces are the **dancing apsaras** (celestials) and **bejewelled celestials**.
- The **dancing figures** from **Rajarajeswara temples** of Tanjore (early 11th century AD).

These paintings exhibit a superb style of south Indian tradition of painting and remains as a link for Pallava (earlier to Chola) and Vijayanagar (later to Chola) times.

Pallava Murals

Successors of the Chalukya Kings, the **Pallava kings** were notable art patrons.

- **Mahendravarman I** built temples in **Panamalai**, **Mandagapattu**, and **Kanchipuram**, showcasing a keen interest in art. The inscription at **Mandagapattu** mentions Mahendravarman I with numerous titles such as Vichitrachitta (curious-minded), Chitrakarapuli (tiger among artists), Chaityakari (temple builder), which shows his interest in art activities.

□ Features of Pallava Murals

- Faces are round and large.
- Lines are rhythmic with increased ornamentation when compared with the paintings of an earlier period.
- Depiction of the torso still remains like the earlier sculptural tradition but is elongated.

□ Examples include:

- The **Panamalai figure** of a female divinity is drawn gracefully.
- Paintings at the **Kanchipuram temple** were patronised by the Pallava king, **Rajsimha**. Only traces of the paintings remain that depict **Somaskanda**.

Vijayanagara Murals

The Vijayanagar painting was a **continuation** of the earlier **Chola and Pandyan traditions**.

- Vijayanagara painters evolved a distinct pictorial language characterized by **profiled faces**, **two-dimensional depictions of figures** and **objects**, still but **fluid lines**, and **compositions in rectilinear compartments**.
- **Early phase** of this style is represented by paintings at **Tiruparakunram**, near Trichy dated 14th-century.

- The **Virupaksha temple** in **Hampi** has **paintings** on the ceiling of its mandap depicting dynastic history and stories from the Ramayana and Mahabharata.



Fig. 3.13: Dakshinamurthy Mural, Lepakshi

- The murals depict the procession of the sage **Vidyaranya**, the spiritual master who motivated Harihara and Bukka to establish the Vijayanagar empire.
- The paintings of **Tripurantaka**, **Narasimha** and the scene of **Girija Kalyana** are other remarkable panels.
- The **Veerabhadra Temple** in **Lepakshi, Andhra Pradesh**, is another example. These paintings are called **Lepakshi Paintings**.
 - The **theme** of these paintings revolves around religious narratives from the **Ramayana**, **Mahabharata**, and **Vishnu's incarnations** and other secular themes.
 - They exhibit the **absence of primary colours**, particularly **blue**.
 - They also reflect a **decline in painting quality**, with forms, figures, and costume details outlined predominantly in black and unusual treatment of faces, including horizontally projecting second eyes.
 - **The Boar Hunt** is a two-dimensional painting characteristic of late medieval works.

Nayaka Murals

The Nayaka dynasty, in the 17th and 18th centuries, continued the artistic tradition in **Thiruparakunram**, **Sreerangam**, and **Tiruvarur** in **Tamil Nadu**.

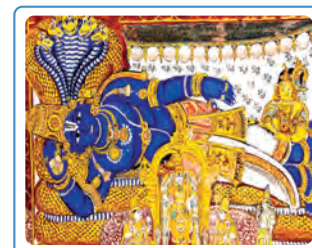


Fig. 3.14: Nayaka Mural, Srirangam

Themes

- It depicts episodes from the **Mahabharata** and the **Ramayana**, along with scenes from **Krishna-Leela**.
- Various temples showcase panels narrating stories related to Shiva, Vishnu, and the Ramayana.
 - **Tiruvarur temple** has panels narrating the **Muchukunda story**.
 - **Thiruparankundram temple** features paintings (dated 14th and 17th centuries) depicting scenes from the **life of Vardhamana Mahavira**.
 - In **Chidambaram temple**, there are panels of paintings narrating stories related to **Shiva** and **Vishnu**— **Shiva** as **Bhikshatana Murti**, **Vishnu** as **Mohini**, etc.
 - **Sri Krishna temple** in **Chengam** has panels narrating the **Ramayana story**.

Continuity and Modifications in Nayaka Style

- ❑ Nayaka paintings considered an **extension** of the **Vijayanagara style**, exhibit minor regional modifications and incorporations.
- ❑ Figures, mostly in profile, are set against **flat backgrounds**. **Male figures are depicted slim-waisted**, with **less heavy abdomens** compared to Vijayanagara paintings.
- ❑ The artists maintain a tradition of infusing movement and dynamism into the depicted space, as seen in the **painting of Nataraja** at Tiruvalanjuli.

Kerala Murals

During the 16th to 18th century, Kerala painters developed a distinctive pictorial language and technique, **incorporating elements** from **Nayaka** and **Vijayanagara** schools.

- ❑ They drew inspiration from local traditions like **Kathakali** and **Kalam Ezhuthu** (ritual floor painting of Kerala), utilizing vibrant colours and achieving **three-dimensional representations of human figures**.

Features of Kerala Murals

- ❑ Kerala mural paintings, found on **shrine** and **temple walls**, as well as **the interiors of palaces**, exhibit unique thematic elements.
- ❑ Narrations predominantly focus on episodes from **Hindu mythology popular in Kerala**.
- ❑ Artists drew from oral traditions and local versions of the **Ramayana** and the **Mahabharata** for their painted narratives.

Prominent Sites of Kerala Mural Painting

- ❑ Over sixty sites showcase mural paintings in Kerala, including notable locations like **Pundareekapuram** Krishna temple, Panayanarkavu, Thirukodithanam, Triprayar Sri Rama temple, and Trissur Vadakkunathan temple.
- ❑ These sites capture the mature phase of Kerala's mural painting tradition.

In conclusion, mural paintings in India stand as a testament to the country's rich artistic heritage, spanning millennia and reflecting the diverse cultural, religious, and regional influences that have shaped its history. These murals offer a window into India's past, showcasing exquisite craftsmanship, intricate detailing, and a kaleidoscope of themes and subjects.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

What role do patronage and commissioning practices play in shaping the thematic content of Indian mural paintings, particularly regarding the preference for religious subjects as a means of spiritual devotion and cultural preservation?

MINIATURE PAINTING

The miniature schools of painting flourished during the medieval period. Compared to the mural painting, the miniature painting is small in size and scale.

Features of Miniature Paintings

- ❑ The painting's size must **not** exceed 25 square inches.
- ❑ Traditional **tempera technique** is used for these paintings.
- ❑ **Human figures** are typically **depicted** in a **side profile**, exhibiting prominent features such as **bulging eyes**, **pointed noses**, and **slender waists**.
- ❑ **Background, sky, buildings, trees**, and **figures** painted in a specific order with the final outline drawn.
- ❑ **Materials Used:** Palm leaf, paper, wood, and cloth.

Colouring Technique in Miniature Painting

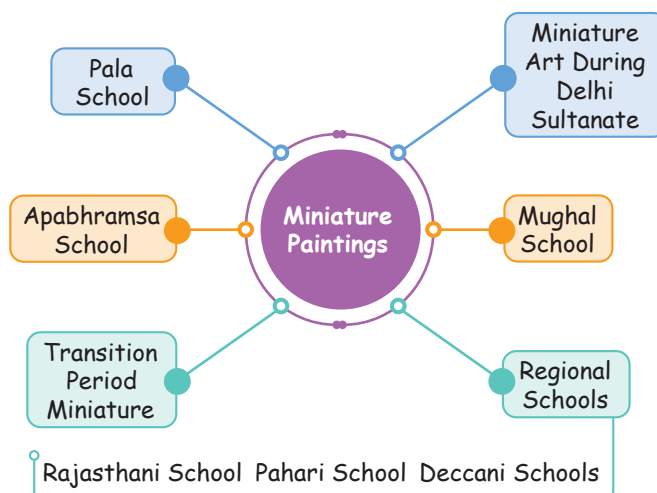


Fig. 3.15: Miniature Paintings

- ❑ Colors are mixed with a binding medium and applied to the drawing.
- ❑ Initial sketch is drawn freely in red or black. A white priming is applied over it.
- ❑ **Skin Tones**
 - In **Rajasthani miniatures**, characters are portrayed with **brown skin tones**, whereas **Mughal paintings** tend to depict **fairer complexions**.
 - Divine beings, like **Lord Krishna**, are often depicted with a **blue skin tone**.
- ❑ **Binding Media** in colours: Gum Arabic and neem gum.
- ❑ **Brushes** are made from animal hair, with fine brushes often from the hair of squirrels.

The Pala School

The Pala School of Painting originates from the illustrated manuscripts of the **Palas** of **eastern India** during the 11th and 12th centuries.

- ❑ These are the earliest Miniature Paintings in India found in illustrations of religious texts, particularly of Buddhism and Jainism.
- ❑ From 750 AD to 1150 AD, the Palas illustrated Buddhist texts mostly on materials like palm leaves or vellum paper.
 - Buddhist monks, promoting non-violence, led to restrictions on materials like banana or coconut tree leaves.
- ❑ Notable painters were Dhimman and Vitapala.

Features

- ❑ These paintings reflect a naturalistic style reminiscent of contemporary bronze and stone sculpture, with elements of classical art from Ajanta.
- ❑ An example of a Pala Buddhist palm leaf manuscript is the “Astasahasrika Prajnaparamita” (found in Bodleian Library, Oxford), also known as the ‘Perfection of Wisdom’.
 - This was created at the Nalanda monastery during King Ramapala’s reign in the eleventh century, boasts six illustrated pages and wooden covers adorned with paintings on both sides.
- ❑ These paintings often feature solitary figures, and it is rare to encounter group compositions.
- ❑ The background of the images has a subdued tone and sinuous lines have been used to draw the figures.

End of Pala Art: Abrupt end due to the destruction of Buddhist monasteries by Muslim invaders in the first half of the 13th century.

- ❑ **Gitagovinda:** In this manuscript, the poetic verses authored by Jayadev, who served as the court poet to Laksmana Sen of Bengal in the 12th century, depict the ethereal love shared between Radha and Krishna.
- ❑ **Laurchanda Paintings:** This piece is attributed to the Sufi poet Maulana Daud from the 14th century and narrates the romantic tale of Laur and Chanda.

Apabhramsa School

It is also known as the western Indian style of painting which prevailed in the region comprising Gujarat, Rajasthan and Malwa.

- ❑ The artistic activity in Western India was influenced by Jainism as it was patronized by the Kings of the Chalukya Dynasty who ruled Gujarat and parts of Rajasthan and Malwa.



Fig. 3.16: Tishala’s fourteen dreams, Kalpasutra

- ❑ **Jain paintings** grew due to the concept of “shaastradaan” (donation of books). Donating illustrated paintings to monastery libraries or “bhandars” was seen as a noble act of charity.
- ❑ Other than the theme of Jainism, Vaishnava themes like Gita Govinda and secular love have also been displayed.

Features

- ❑ This is an art of primitive vitality, vigorous line and forceful colours.
- ❑ **Palm leaf** was used for the manuscripts, and later on, paper was introduced.
- ❑ **Colours** have symbolic significance.
- ❑ **Exaggeration** of certain physical traits like eyes, breasts and hips are enlarged.
- ❑ Figures are flat and stiff with angularity of features.
- ❑ Eyes are drawn, protruding into space.

Examples

Kalpasutra, Uttaradhyayana Sutra, Sangrahani Sutra and the Kalakacharya Katha from the 15th century.

- ❑ **Kalakacharyakatha** narrates the story of Acharya Kalaka, who is on a mission to rescue his abducted sister (a Jain nun) from an evil king.
- ❑ **Uttaradhyayana Sutra** contains the teachings of Mahavir that prescribe the code of conduct that monks should follow
- ❑ **Sangrahani Sutra** is a cosmological text composed in the twelfth century that comprises concepts about the structure of the universe and mapping of space.

Persian Influence on Western Indian Painting

The Persian style of painting started influencing the Western Indian style of painting during the 15th century as is evident from the Persian facial types and hunting scenes appearing on the borders of some of the illustrated manuscripts of the Kalpasutra.

- ❑ It has a section, reciting events from the lives of the 24 Tirthankaras—from their births to salvation—that provides a biographical narrative for artists to paint.
- ❑ It was characterized by the introduction of the use of ultramarine blue and gold colour.

Miniature Art during Transition Period

Coming of the Muslim rulers brought a cultural renaissance in the 14th century. Traditional style of painting survived in western Indian courts, and a cultural synthesis took place. There was an emergence of a new style in Vijayanagara, which was closer to the Deccan painting style.

Features

- ❑ Outlines were drawn in black colour.
- ❑ Face was drawn in such a way that it gave a detached appearance.
- ❑ The landscape was filled with trees, rocks and designs.

Miniature Art During Delhi Sultanate

- ❑ There was an attempt to bring **Persian and Indian elements together**.
- ❑ Preference was given to illustrated manuscripts. Eg, Nimat Nama.
 - **The Nimat Nama Manuscript (Cookery Book)** reflects a new trend of painting in Malwa. It was started during the **reign of Ghiyasud-Din Shah of Malwa** (1469-1500 A.D.)
 - ❑ In this manuscript one can notice the **first attempt** towards the evolution of new styles of painting by the fusion of the Persian style of Shiraz with the indigenous Indian style.
 - ❑ Persian influence is visible in scroll-like clouds, flowering trees, and female figures, while Indian elements are notable in female types, costumes, ornaments, and colours.
- ❑ Another style, i.e. **Kulhadar group** was also developed.
 - **“Kulhadar Group” (Early 16th Century):** This group includes illustrations of various texts like the ‘Chaurapanchasika,’ ‘Gita Govinda,’ ‘Bhagavata Purana,’ and ‘Ragamala.’
 - ❑ The style of these miniatures is marked by the use of brilliant contrasting colours, vigorous and angular drawing, transparent drapery and the appearance of conical caps ‘Kulha’ on which turbans are worn by the male figures.
 - ❑ ‘Chaurapanchasika’ shows **indigenous styles** without evident Persian or Mughal influences. An example of the Chaurapanchasika miniature shows Champavati standing near a lotus pond. ‘Mrigavati’ and ‘Mahapurana’ manuscripts are in a similar style to Chaurapanchasika.

Miniature Art During the Mughals

This style is a **fusion of Indian and Safavid Persian painting traditions**.

Common Themes: It depicts the **glorification of rulers** and showcasing their lives, including hunting scenes, historical events, and court-related paintings **excluding religious subjects**. **Naturalism** was prominent with detailed observation of nature.

Technique: Introduced the **technique of foreshortening**, which made objects appear closer and smaller than they actually were. It was also influenced by **European art techniques** like **shading** and **perspective**.

Babur’s era

Continuous wars hindered Babar from patronizing painting development. However, he supported the Persian artist **Bihzad** in creating Mughal family tree illustrations.

Humayun’s era

- ❑ He was amazed by the Safavid artist traditions, so he invited master artists like **Mir Sayyid Ali** and **Abd Us Samad**, who **brought Persian elements into Mughal paintings**.

- ❑ He laid the groundwork for a painting workshop called **Nigaa Khana** and initiated the project ‘**Hamza Nama**’, an illustrious narrative of Hamza’s adventures. Humayun initially commissioned this illustrated manuscript, which was later completed by Akbar. It depicts Mihrdukht shooting arrows at a bird.

Akbar’s era

He established a department for paintings & document scribing, known as **Tasvir Khana** and the artists were employed on a salary basis.

- ❑ **Court painters:** Daswant Miskina, Nanha, Kanha Basawan, Manohar, Doulat, Mansur, Kesu, Bhim Gujarati, Dharam Das, Madhu, Surdas, Lal, Shankar Goverdhan and Inayat.
- ❑ He recognized Indian artists who initiated the ‘**Indian influence**’ in **Mughal paintings**.

Key Characteristics of Paintings

- ❑ Use of **3D figures**, and application of **foreshortening techniques** and incorporation of **calligraphy** into their paintings.
- ❑ **Shift from popular art to court art**, with artists focusing more on depicting scenes from court life rather than the lives of common people. Also, Hunting activities and portraits were created during Akbar’s reign.

Manuscripts Produced Under the Patronage of Akbar

- ❑ Akbar produced an illustrated rendition of **Baburnama**, originally written by Babur in the 16th century. This autobiography vividly portrays Babur’s affection and attachment to the Indian landscape.
- ❑ **Akbarnama:** This work, which is written in **the Persian language**, is credited to **Abul Fazl** from the 16th century. It includes vivid and detailed descriptions of his life and times. Its **third volume, Ain-i-Akbari**, delineates the administrative structure of Akbar’s empire and notably includes a renowned narrative on Hindu science.
- ❑ **Razmnama:** These illustrated paintings are attributed to **Faizi** under the supervision of painter Daswant. It is a Persian **translation of Mahabharata**.
- ❑ **Manuscript Tutinama**, or **Tales of a Parrot:** Abdus Samad Khan and Mir Sayyid Ali contributed to its creation, which represents the nascent stage of the Mughal style.

Jahangir’s Era

He transitioned **from illustrated manuscripts to albums**, emphasizing **naturalism in individual portraits**.

- ❑ A distinctive trend in this period was the **use of elaborately decorated margins** around the paintings.
- ❑ Artworks include **darbar scenes, portraits, and studies of birds, animals, and flowers**.



Fig. 3.17: Miniature work of Ustad Mansur

- ❑ Jahangir was considered a skilled artist himself, and his atelier produced famous naturalistic paintings of animals like the Zebra, turkey, and cock.

Prominent painters: Aqa Riza, Abul Hasan, **Ustad Mansur**, **Bishan Das**, Manohar, Goverdhan, Balchand, Daulat, Mukhlis, Bhim, and Inayat.

Some important manuscripts illustrated during his period are an animal fable book called **Ayar-i-Danish** and the **Anwar-i-Sunavli** both executed between 1603-10, some miniatures in the Gulistan and a Diwan of Hafiz. A miniature depicts **Jahangir with the Virgin Mary**, dated 1615-20.

Other popular Mughal paintings include a series of the **Razm-nama** from (1616 A.D.), a series of the **Rasikapriya (1610-1615)**, and a series of the **Ramayana** (1610 A.D.)

Shah Jahan's Era

There was a change in the style of painting in Shah Jahan's era from that of his predecessors.

Features

- ❑ Incorporated **artificial** elements and introduced **unnatural stillness** inspired by **European influence**.
- ❑ Significant **attention to portraits** and depiction of groups of ascetics, mystics, and various illustrated manuscripts.
- ❑ Discouraged the use of charcoal for drawing and **promoted pencil sketching**.
- ❑ Increase in the **use of gold and silver** in paintings, along with a preference for brighter colour palettes compared to his predecessors.
- ❑ **Artists:** Bichiter, Chaitaraman, Anup Chattar, Mohammed Nadir of Samarquand, Inayat, and Makr.
- ❑ **Manuscripts**
 - Copy of **Gulistan** (Persian Literature) and **Bustan of Sadi**.
 - **Padshahnama**, penned by Abdul Hamid Lahori during the 17th century, chronicles the reign of Shahjahan. (**Shahjahannama** refers to the non-illustrated text, while Padshahnama denotes the illustrated version).

Aurangzeb's Era

He **did not support** or encourage the art of painting due to religious reasons, which led to a decline in Mughal painting. Reduction in artistic quality, and **migration of court painters to provincial courts** in regions like Rajasthan.

There was a revival of the Mughal painting during the reign of Bahadur Shah's reign after the neglect shown by Aurangzeb. Post-1712 AD, Mughal painting once again began to deteriorate under the later Mughals. Art became lifeless and lost the inherent quality of earlier Mughal art.

Other Important Manuscripts

- ❑ Two manuscripts of the '**Laur Chanda**,' an Avadhi romance by **Mulla Daud**, created between 1530 to 1540 A.D., show a blend of Persian and Indian styles.

- ❑ Manuscripts include the **Gulistan of Sadi (1567)**, the **Anwari-Suhavli** (a book of fables, 1570) and another **Gulistan of Sadi (1581)** copied at Fatehpur Sikri by **Muhammad Hussain al-Kashmiri**.
- ❑ **Other notable Manuscripts** include **Baharistan of Jami** (dated 1595), the **Darab-nama**, the **Tarikh-i-Alfi** (by Mulla Daud, dated 1596 A.D.), the **Twarikh-e-Khandane Taimuria**, and the **Jog Vashisht** (dated 1602).
- ❑ **Rasikapriya:** This composition is credited to Keshav Das, who served as the court poet to **Raja Madhukar Shah of Orchha**, dating back to 1591. It delves into a range of emotional states, including love, jealousy etc.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

How did the Mughal emperors use manuscript paintings to celebrate personal achievements, victories, and imperial grandeur, and what role did the commissioning of illustrated manuscripts play in fostering a sense of imperial identity?

The Regional Schools (17th-19th Centuries)

The sub-imperial Schools, including the **Rajasthani** and the **Pahari Schools of Painting**, retained their Indian roots and a preference for colourful paintings contrasting with the more naturalistic Mughal style.

Common Themes

Inspiration from Indian epics like **Ramayana**, and **Mahabharata**; Puranas like **Bhagavata**, and **Siva Purana**; Sanskrit love poems like **Gita Govinda** of **Jayadeva**, **Rasamanjari** of **Bhanudatta**, **AmaruSataka**, and **Ragamala**; folklore and musical themes.

Rajasthani School

It refers to the painting styles that flourished in the princely states and regions, primarily in modern-day Rajasthan and parts of Madhya Pradesh.

Ragamala Paintings

They are a series of illustrations from medieval India by **Madho Das** based on the "**Garland of Ragas**" (Ragamala), portraying various Indian musical Ragas. They represent the **fusion of art, poetry**, and **classical music** in medieval India.

- ❑ Many artists later painted Ragamala paintings which came to be known as **Pahari Ragamala**, **Rajasthan or Rajput Ragamala**, **Deccan Ragamala**, and **Mughal Ragamala**.

Features

- ❑ The six principal ragas featured in Ragamala are **Bhairava, Deepak, Sri, Malkaush, Megha, and Hindola**. They convey the associated season and the time of day or night for singing specific raga.
- ❑ Many paintings in the series associate specific Hindu deities with the ragas, such as **Bhairava or Bhairavi with Shiva**, and **Sri with Devi**.
- ❑ Each painting personifies a Raga through colour and depicts a hero and heroine (**nayaka** and **nayika**) in a particular mood.

Development of the Rajasthani Art

- ❑ It is synonymous with the **Rajput school of paintings**.
- ❑ The '**ganga-jamni**' cultural confluence in Sultanate courts influenced Rajasthani painting's evolution.
- ❑ In the 16th century, '**Western Indian**' and '**Chaurapanchasika**' styles set the stage for 17th-century painting schools.
- ❑ Mughal artists migrated to places like Rajasthan and found employment at local courts.
- ❑ Notable schools of painting that emerged include **Malwa, Mewar, Bundi-Kotah, Amber-Jaipur, Bikaner, Marwar**, and **Kishengarh**.

Features of Rajasthani Style

- ❑ Paintings were crafted on "**waslis**", which are layered, thin sheets of handmade papers glued together for desired thickness.
- ❑ Brushes were made using **camel** and **squirrel hair**.
- ❑ **Bold drawings** and strong and contrasting colours were used.
- ❑ Division of the surface into compartments of different colours was introduced to separate scenes.
- ❑ **Flat Figures** were introduced without an attempt to create a naturalistic perspective.
- ❑ **Mughal influence** was evident in improved drawing techniques and the introduction of **naturalistic** elements in figures and trees.
- ❑ Each school of painting has its **unique facial types, costumes, landscapes, and colour schemes**, distinguishing it from others.

Malwa

It presents a unique blend, bridging the styles of **Jain manuscripts** and **Chaurpanchashika** (by Bilhana, 11th century) manuscript paintings.

- ❑ Themes are taken from the **Ramayana, the Bhagavata Purana, the AmaruShataka, the Rasikapriya, the Ragamala, and the Baramasa**.
- ❑ **Key characteristics:** Use of contrasting colours, the influence of Mughal painting and distinctive ornaments and costumes with black tassels and striped skirts.

- ❑ **Madhau Das** created a series of the Ragamala in 1680 AD.

- **Ragamala paintings** portray the **Megha Raga**.
- The text is inscribed in Nagari at the top of the painting.

Mewar

The earliest example of Mewar painting is a series of the **Ragamala** painted in 1605 A.D. at Chawand, a small place near Udaipur, by **Misardi**.

- ❑ Notable artists during this period included **Sahibdin** and **Manohar Jagannath**, another distinguished artist, painted the **Bihari Satsai** in 1719.

- **Sahibdin**, a 17th-century painter was renowned for his depiction of **literary texts** like the **Ragamala, Bhagavata Purana, Rasikapriya** and a part of the **Ramayana** titled **Yuddha Kanda**.
- **Manohar's** prominent contribution was the **Bal Kanda** of the Ramayana from 1649.

- ❑ **After Sahibdin's death**, the style of Mewari paintings underwent changes, with a **focus on depicting life at the Mewar court**.

- ❑ Notably, this period featured "**tamasha**" paintings that provided extraordinary **detail in showcasing court ceremonies and city views**.

- ❑ Other Mewar Paintings

- 3rd book (Aranya Kanda) of the Ramayana, dated 1651 AD.
- 7th book (Uttara Kanda) of the Ramayana from 1653 AD.



Fig. 3.18: Krishna lifting mount Govardhana

Nathdwara Paintings

- ❑ Nathdwara paintings are a **substyle of the Mewar school** of paintings. The **main theme** of these paintings is **Krishna and his leela**. The amalgamation of the cultural traditions of the Braj and Mewar are reflected in these paintings

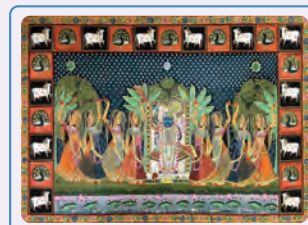


Fig. 3.19: Pichhwai Painting

- ❑ Nathdwara style also has a subtype called **Pichhwai Paintings**, themes of which include the life of Krishna, seasons etc.

Amber-Jaipur

It is believed that a school of painting originated in **Amber**, the old capital of the Amber State. Later on in the 18th century, the centre of artistic activity shifted to **Jaipur**, the new capital.

Evolution under Prominent Rulers

❑ Sawai Jai Singh (1699–1743)

- He established the city of Jaipur in 1727, shifting from Amber. During his reign, the Jaipur School thrived and became a distinct entity.
- He brought Mughal painters from Delhi to be part of his atelier. He reorganised the **Suratkhana (Painting department)**, the place for creating and storing paintings.
- He commissioned many paintings on **Radha** and **Krishna themes**. His sets based on **Rasikapriya, Gita Govinda, Baramasa, and Ragamala** were popular, often depicting the king as the hero.
- Portrait painting flourished with notable painters like **Sahibram** and **Muhammad Shah**.

❑ **Sawai Ishwari Singh (1743–1750)** continued the patronage of the arts. He commissioned paintings capturing leisure activities such as hunts and elephant rides. His successor **Sawai Madho Singh (1750–1767)** focused on documenting court life incidents in paintings. **Sawai Pratap Singh (1779–1803)** marked a turning point where the dominant Mughal influence began to wane. He introduced a unique Jaipur style, blending Mughal and indigenous aesthetics.

Marwar

This school encompasses regions like **Jodhpur, Bikaner** (Rathods), and **Jaisalmer** (Bhatis).

- ❑ **Jodhpur**, like Bikaner, prospered through its close ties with the Mughals.
- ❑ In the 15th-16th century paintings showcased vibrant clothing, **influenced by Mughal styles**.
- ❑ From the 17th to the 19th centuries, these artworks encompass themes including **portraits, court scenes, the Ragamala series**, and the **Baramasa**.
- ❑ The **Ragamala series** was created by artist **Virji** in 1623 AD at **Pali**.
- ❑ Notably, these miniatures show **no influence from the Mughal painting style**.
- ❑ By the 18th century, **Rajput influence prevailed**, marked by linear rhythms and vibrant colours.
- ❑ **Important paintings** during **Man Singh's reign (1803-1843)** include the **Shiva Purana, Natacharitra, Durgacharitra**, and **Panchtantra**.
- ❑ The prominent schools under the Marwar School umbrella are the **Kishangarh School** and the **Bundi School**.

Kishangarh School of Painting

Kishangarh paintings are among the most stylised Rajasthani miniatures.

Historical Origins and Evolution

- ❑ **Kishan Singh** established **Kishangarh** in 1609 after branching off from the **Jodhpur** monarchy.
- By the mid-seventeenth century, under **Man Singh's** patronage (1658–1706), a distinctive artistic style began to emerge in the Kishangarh court.
- This style was characterised by an inclination to **elongate human forms**, a fondness for the **colour green**, and a preference for **panoramic landscapes**.

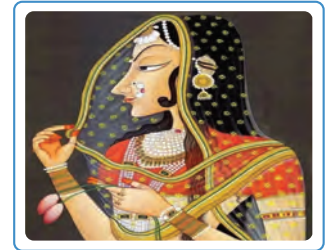


Fig. 3.20: Bani Thani

Themes

- ❑ Romantic legends of Sawant Singh and **Bani Thani**.
- ❑ **Religious Influence**
 - **Raj Singh's (1706–1748)** initiation into the **Pushtimargiya** cult of **Vallabhacharya** paved the way for **Krishna Lila** themes to become the primary focus of **Kishangarh art**.
 - These themes, especially those centered on the divine lovers **Radha** and **Krishna**, became deeply personal for Kishangarh's rulers.

Notable Artists and Their Contributions

- ❑ **Nihal Chand** stands out as the most celebrated artist, working primarily for **Sawant Singh between 1735 and 1757**.
- ❑ **Raja Sawant Singh (1748-1757 AD)**, wrote devotional poetry in praise of Krishna under the pen name **Nagari Das**.
 - **Bani Thani** by **Nihal Chand** is similar to Radha with features like elongated **lotus-like eyes**, **thin lips**, and a **pointed chin**. Her headgear **defines her side profile**.
 - **Other Paintings**: A pastoral scene depicting Krishna's return to Gokula in the evening.

Bundi School of Painting

It is associated with the **twin kingdoms of Bundi** and **Kota**, collectively known as **Hadoti**.

- ❑ Bundi School of Painting witnessed its zenith in the **17th century**, known for its impeccable colour perception and design.
- ❑ The early phase of Bundi painting is epitomized by the **"Bundi Ragamala"** from 1591, painted during the reign of **Bhoj Singh**.



Fig. 3.21: Krishna dance to the music of gopis

- ❑ The school thrived, notably under rulers **Rao Chattar Sal** and **Rao Bhao Singh**, with significant contributions from artists like Sahibdin and Manohar.
- ❑ Later, despite facing political turbulence, **Budh Singh** continued to champion the art form. His son, **Umed Singh**, brought meticulous detailing to the paintings.
- ❑ The paintings of the 18th century adopted Deccani aesthetics with a preference for vivid colours.
- ❑ Rulers such as Bishen Singh and Ram Singh showcased an inclination towards hunting, resulting in numerous hunting-themed artworks.
- ❑ Mural paintings depicting royal processions and Krishna's tales adorned the chitrashala of the Bundi palace during Ram Singh's reign.
- ❑ Bundi kings revered Krishna and used to act as regents for the god. It influenced painting, and painting, in turn, played a role in their Krishna bhakti.

Characteristics

It included detailed depictions of local vegetation.

- ❑ There is an element of **naturalism** in the treatment of the trees.
- ❑ **Human faces** were depicted as **round** with **pointed noses**.
- ❑ The sky was painted in various colours, with a prominent red ribbon often visible.
- ❑ **Mughal influence** is visible in the refined drawing of the faces.
- ❑ The text is inscribed in black against a yellow background at the top.

Examples: Portrayal of Bhairavi Ragini, Manuscript of the Bhagavata Purana and Series of the Rasikapriya.

Bikaner

Bikaner's painting style imbibed **Mughal grace** and a **subdued colour palette** due to prolonged ties with the Mughals.

- ❑ A unique Bikaner practice was to include portraits of artists, often with inscriptions detailing their lineage. Such artists were titled "**Ustas**" or "**Ustad**".
- ❑ **Ustad Ali Raza**, a master from Delhi, was employed by **Karan Singh**. His works mark the inception of the **Bikaner School**, dating back to 1650.
- ❑ In Anup Singh's era, master artist **Ruknuddin's** works blended indigenous, **Deccani**, and **Mughal styles**. He illustrated significant texts, including the **Ramayana**, **Rasikapriya**, and **Durga Satpsati**.
- ❑ Other Artists who worked at the Bikaner court included **Ruknuddin**, and his son **Shahadin**, **Ibrahim**, **Nathu**, **Sahibdin**, and **Isa**.
 - **Ibrahim's** creations carried a dreamy aura, with delicate figures and well-defined faces.

Kota Paintings (late 18th and 19th century)

- ❑ **Popular Themes:** Tiger and bear hunts were particularly popular.
- ❑ **Characteristic:** Prominent depiction of the hilly jungle. This element is rendered with a unique and charming quality, occupying a significant portion of the painting.

Difference between Rajput style and Mughal Style

Rajput Style (17th-18th century)	Mughal Style (16th-18th century)
It was initially derived from mural and fresco techniques, miniature painting eventually emerged as the predominant form in later periods.	It draws inspiration from the Persian miniature painting tradition.
Typically, it tends to have a devotional or religious theme.	Often portray the Mughal emperor and his court. Scenes of royal grandeur, battles, and hunting are commonly depicted as well.
Hindu symbols such as the lotus, peacock, and swan are recurrent motifs.	The focus is either on the central figure or on elements like trees, camels, and falcons.

The Pahari Schools

Introduction

During the 17th-18th century, a fine painting style emerged in **Kashmir** and the adjoining hill areas of Punjab and Uttar Pradesh. The paintings from these states are collectively called **Pahari paintings**, representing hill areas.

- ❑ Here, the artists and paintings travelled from one state to another frequently.
- ❑ It was also **influenced** by the **Mughal** school of painting, though they were **different** from **Mughal** painting in treatment, subjects, colour sense, and directly linked with folk base.
- ❑ **Themes:** Mythology, literature, the introduction of innovative techniques like multiple figures all in dynamic motion, with distinct compositions, colours, and pigmentation.
- ❑ **Important painters:** Nainsukh, Manaku, and Sansar Chand.

Basohli

In the 17th century, miniature paintings from Basohli (Jammu and Kashmir) representing the early phase of the Pahari school came into existence. **Raja Kirpal Singh** was the **first patron**, and **Devi Das** was the most famous **painter** of this school.



Fig. 3.22: Basohli Painting

Features

- ❑ It was characterized by vigorous and **bold lines** and strong **glowing colours**. They prominently used primary colours, such as **red, yellow, and green**.
- ❑ There was a change in the **facial type**, which became a little **heavier** and also in the **tree forms** which assume a somewhat **naturalistic** character, possibly due to the **influence** of the **Mughal painting**.
- ❑ **Expressive faces** featuring receding hairlines and large, lotus-petal-shaped eyes.
- ❑ Depiction of **monochrome background, bold lines**, use of **beetle wings** to depict diamonds in ornaments, a narrow sky, and the presence of a red border was noticed.
- ❑ **Elegance and vibrant palette** are reminiscent of the **Chaurpanchashika** paintings of Western India.

Popular Themes and Artists

- ❑ The most cherished theme was Bhanudatta's "**Rasamanjari**". Other themes included **Bhagavata Purana** and **Ragamala**. Portraits of kings, their consorts, courtiers, and other significant figures were also popular.
- ❑ Series of **Gita Govinda**, painted by **artist Manaku** in **1730 AD** depicts Krishna with gopis in a grove by a river.
- ❑ The style expanded to other hill states like **Chamba** and **Kullu**, leading to local variations.

Influence of the Ramayana

- ❑ The Sanskrit epic, Ramayana, was a favourite text for hill artists in Basohli and Kullu.
- ❑ A specific set of paintings, named after '**Shangri**', a place associated with the Kullu royal family, showcased the influence of Basohli and Bilaspur styles.
- ❑ Paintings depict scenes like Rama's exile, his acts of charity, and the emotional turmoil of the characters.
- ❑ Another painting illustrates the journey of Rama and Lakshmana with **Sage Vishvamitra**, where the depiction of animals adds depth and intrigue to the narrative.

From the 1690s to the 1730s, a new style emerged known as the **Guler-Kangra phase**. This phase was marked by experimentation, which eventually led to the formation of the Kangra style. Originating in Basohli, the art form spread to Mankot, Nurpur, Kullu, Mandi, Bilaspur, Chamba, Guler, and Kangra.

Guler style of Paintings

It represents a significant shift from the Basohli style, marking the beginning of the **Guler-Kangra phase** in Pahari painting.

Historical Context

- ❑ The transformation began in the early 18th century in Guler, under the patronage of **Raja Govardhan Chand** (1744–1773).

- ❑ Guler had a longstanding painting tradition, with evidence suggesting artists worked there during the reigns of **Dalip Singh (1695–1743)** and his son **Bishan Singh**, predating the Guler-Kangra phase.

Features

- ❑ These paintings exhibit a new **naturalistic, lyrical and delicate style**.
- ❑ The colours used are soft and cool, and the style appears to be **influenced by** the naturalistic Mughal painting of the **Muhammad Shah period**.
- ❑ The female figures are delicate with well-modeled faces, small slightly upturned noses, and intricately detailed hair.

Themes

- ❑ Focus was on **portraits**: Portraits of **Raja Balwant Singh of Jasrota** by artist **Nainsukh** who worked in both Jasrota and Guler, and portraits of **Raja Govardhan Chand of Guler** were produced around 1750 AD.
- ❑ **Bhagavata, Gita Govinda, Bihari Satasai, Baramasa**, and **Ragamala** were painted between 1760-1770 AD.

Prominent Artists and their Contributions

- ❑ The artist **Pandit Seu** and his sons, **Manak** (or Manaku) and **Nainsukh**, played pivotal roles in this transformation around 1730–40.
- ❑ **Manak's Notable Work**: A set of **Gita Govinda** painted in 1730, that retained certain Basohli-style elements.
- ❑ **Nainsukh's Distinction**: Renowned for his unique portraiture, especially of his patron, **Balwant Singh of Jasrota**.

Patrons and their Influence

- ❑ Manaku painted numerous portraits of his enthusiastic patron, **Raja Govardhan Chand**, and his family.
- ❑ **Raja Prakash Chand**, Govardhan Chand's successor, was also an art enthusiast, he had the sons of Manak and Nainsukh, namely **Khushala, Fattu**, and **Gaudhu**, as artists in his court.

Kangra School

It emerged during the last quarter of the 18th century, representing the third phase of Pahari painting.

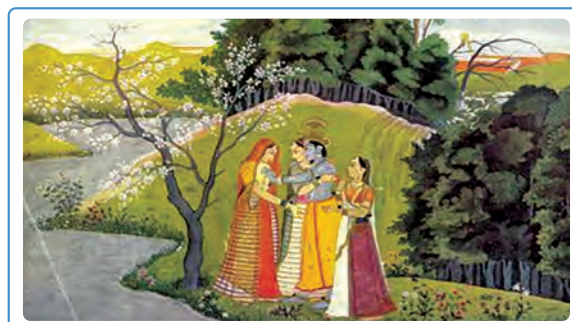


Fig. 3.23: Kangra Painting

- ❑ It evolved from the Guler style and retained its main characteristics, such as delicate drawing and naturalism.
- ❑ The school **reached its zenith** under the patronage of **Raja Sansar Chand** who commissioned paintings having sensuality and intelligence.
- ❑ The Kangra style thrived in various places, including **Kangra, Guler, Basohli, Chamba, the Union Territory of Jammu, Nurpur, Kullu, Mandi regions** and **Garhwal**.
- ❑ Paintings in the Kangra style are mainly attributed to the **Nainsukh family**.
- ❑ It got Patronage of **Maharaja Ranjit Singh** and the **Sikh nobility** in the early 19th century.

Features

- ❑ The faces of women in profile have the nose almost in line with the forehead.
- ❑ The eyes are long and narrow and the chin is sharp.
- ❑ There is no modelling of figures and hair is treated as a flat mass.

Themes

- ❑ It included the **Gita Govinda, Bhagwata Purana, Satsai of Biharilal**, and **Nal Damayanti**.
 - Love scenes of Krishna were a prominent theme, giving the paintings a mystical quality, especially the depiction from **Rasa Panchdhyayi**, which vividly illustrates the gopis' profound love for Krishna.
- ❑ Another famous series depicted the **"Twelve Months,"** illustrating the impact of each month on human emotions. This emotive style remained popular into the 19th century.

Kullu-Mandi School

Along with the naturalistic Kangra style in the Pahari region, there also flourished a folk style of painting in the Kulu-Mandi area, mainly inspired by the local tradition.

Features

- ❑ Bold and expressive drawing techniques.
- ❑ Use of dark and muted colours.
- ❑ Influence of the Kangra style is observed in certain cases yet this style maintains its distinct folkish character.

Example: Portraits of the rulers of Kullu and Mandi.

Famous Paintings

- ❑ Miniature from **Bhagavata series** painted by **Shri Bhagwan** in 1794 A.D.
- ❑ Another Kulu painting portrays **two girls flying kites**.

The Deccani Schools

It developed as a distinctive school of painting in the 16th and 17th centuries in the southern plateau region of India, beyond the Vindhya mountain range.

- ❑ The Ahmednagar School and other Deccani kingdoms owe a significant artistic debt to Persia, especially in their representation of landscapes.

- ❑ Early Deccan painting centers included **Ahmednagar, Bijapur, and Golconda**.
- ❑ In the Deccan, painting continued to develop independently of the Mughal style in the beginning. However, later in the 17th and 18th centuries, it was increasingly influenced by the Mughal style.

Ahmednagar

The Ahmednagar School of Painting traces its earliest origins to a volume of poems celebrating the reign of **Hussain Nizam Shah I** of **Ahmadnagar (1553–1565)**. This manuscript is known as the **'Tarif-in-Hussain Shahi'**.

- ❑ Other examples of Ahmednagar painting are the **"Hindola Raga"** of about 1590 A.D. and **portraits** of **Burhan Nizam Shah II** of Ahmednagar (1591-96 A.D.) and of **Malik Amber** of about 1605 A.D.

Features

- ❑ The women are depicted in modified northern attire comprising a **choli** (bodice), sport long **braided pigtails** adorned with tassels, and wrap a **long scarf** around their bodies, a distinctly southern style also observed in the Lepakshi frescoes.
- ❑ The colours employed in these paintings diverge from the northern manuscripts, predominantly drawn from the Mughal atelier, as they exhibit richer and more vivid hues.
- ❑ The **Persian influence** can be seen in the high horizon, gold sky and the landscape. Landscapes devoid of horizons are replaced by **neutral grounds** adorned with **stylized plants** or symmetrically patterned architectural domes.

Bijapur

It was patronized by **Ali Adil Shah I** (1558-80 AD) and his successor, **Ibrahim II** (1580-1627 AD).

- ❑ The encyclopedia known as **"Najum-al-Ulum"** (Stars of Sciences) was illustrated in 1570 A.D. in the reign of Ali Adil Shah I. This manuscript contains 876 miniatures having the following **features**:
 - It features **tall** and **slender women** dressed in South Indian attire.
 - Influences from **Lepakshi mural paintings** are evident in the depiction of female figures.
 - **Persian influences** are seen in the use of gold colour, flowering plants, and arabesques on the throne.
 - One of the miniatures illustrated here shows the **"Throne of Prosperity"**.
 - Other features include a rich colour scheme, palm trees, animals, and men and women.
- ❑ **Ibrahim II (1580-1627 AD)** - a musician and author of the book **"Naurasnama"** commissioned **Ragamala paintings**.

Golconda

The earliest paintings identified as Golconda works is a **Group of five charming artworks** (dated 1590 AD) during the reign of **Muhammad Quli Qutb Shah (1580-1612)** of Golconda.

- Paintings depict dancing girls entertaining a gathering, including a miniature illustrating the king watching a dance performance.
 - Gold colour is used in these paintings for architecture, costumes, jewellery, and vessels.
- Another painting: **"Lady with the Myna bird"** is a Manuscript of a Sufi poem (1605-15 AD) by the artist **Muhammad Ali**.

Hyderabad

It originated with the foundation of the **Asaf Jahi dynasty** by **Mir Qamruddin Khan** (Chin Qulick Khan) **Nizam-ul-Mulk** in 1724 AD.

Features:

- **Mughal influence** can be seen as painters migrated from there.
- The style of the painting is decorative and it is rich in colours.
- Deccani facial types and costumes can be observed in the miniature.
- **Example:** A miniature depicting a princess surrounded by maids. The princess is reclining on a richly furnished terrace covered with a canopy.

Tanjore Paintings

It emerged after the defeat of the **Thanjavur Nayakas** by **Marathas** and the **decline of the Vijayanagara empire** during the late 18th and 19th centuries. It is recognized as a Geographical Indication (GI) by the Government of India.

- During the 18th century, **Maratha rulers** greatly **supported and patronized** this school and reached its zenith under the patronage of **Maharaja Serfoji II** of the **Maratha dynasty**.

Features:

- Subjects include **birds, animals, buildings**, and **smiling Krishna** in various poses.
- It includes bold drawing, shading techniques, and the use of vibrant and pure colours.
- It lavishly uses **gold leaf** and presence of **conical crowns**.
- Created on **Palagai padam** (glass and wood), adorned with gemstones and cut glass, it produced larger-than-life images, unlike cloth and vellum deviating from North Indian preferences.



Fig. 3.24: Tanjore school of painting

- **Important painting:** Depicting the **coronation of Rama** dated to the early 19th century.
- Tanjore paintings have got **GI protection**.

Mysore Paintings

It was sponsored by the rulers of the Mysore province and continued even during the British period.

- **Theme:** Portrayal of Hindu deities.
- **Feature:** Inclusion of two or more figures in each artwork, with one figure dominating in size and colour.



Fig. 3.25: Mysore Painting

Technique

- Employing **"gesso paste,"** a mixture of white lead powder, gamboge, and glue, which creates a unique base with a glossy background which is balanced by the use of subdued, less vibrant colours to complement the background.

Both Tanjore and Mysore paintings share a common origin, stemming from Vijayanagara paintings initially and subsequently from Nayaka paintings.

Orissa Painting

The earliest surviving examples of miniature painting in Orissa appear to belong to the 17th century AD.

Features

- The style is very **decorative** and is marked by **bold drawing**, stylisation of the tree, **heavy ornamentation** of figures and use of **rich colour** schemes.
- In Orissa, palm-leaf continued to be used even up to the 19th century. The outline drawing was rendered with a stylus on the palm leaf and then charcoal or ink was rubbed on the drawing.
- A few colours were sparingly used to fill in the designs.
- The technique of painting on paper was, however, different and was like the one used in other schools of painting.
- The early manuscripts display a neatness in drawing. Later on in the 18th century, the line became bold and a little crude but the style in general is very decorative and ornamental.

Important paintings

- Court scene and four illustrated leaves from a manuscript of the Gita Govinda.
- Palm leaf manuscript of Ramayana and Bhagavad.

Dhaval, Jaya Dhavala and Maha Dhavala: This manuscript represents the earliest instance of the South Indian illustrated manuscript tradition based on the theme of Jainism, with patronage bestowed by the Hoysala rulers.

In conclusion, from the delicate miniatures of the Mughal courts to the vibrant Rajput paintings and the elegant Pahari style, these miniature artworks offer a glimpse into India's cultural tapestry, encompassing themes ranging from mythology and religion to courtly life and nature. Despite changes in patronage, artistic styles, and techniques over time, the legacy of Indian miniature paintings endures as a testament to the creativity, skill, and cultural diversity of the Indian subcontinent.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

What historical and cultural factors contributed to the decline of mural paintings in India and the rise of miniature paintings as the predominant form of artistic expression?

CHRONOLOGICALLY, MODERN PAINTING SHOULD COME AFTER FOLK PAINTINGS

Introduction

Modern painting in India reflects a dynamic fusion of tradition and innovation, drawing from centuries-old artistic practices while embracing contemporary themes, styles, and techniques. Emerging in the late 19th and early 20th centuries against the backdrop of colonialism, nationalism, and social reform movements, modern Indian painting evolved as artists sought to redefine their cultural identity and express their experiences in a rapidly changing world.

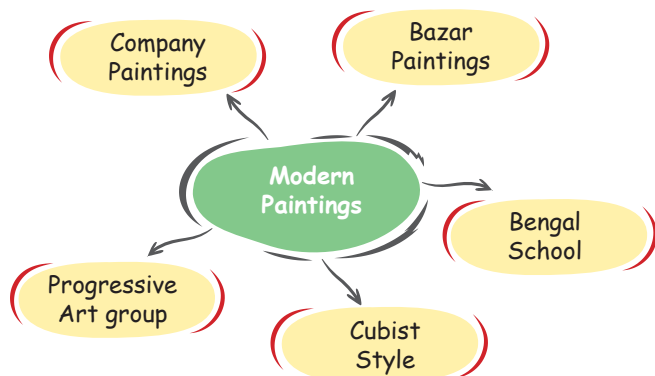


Fig. 3.26: Modern Paintings

Company Paintings

It refers to the style that emerged when local Indian artists adapted their traditional techniques to cater to the tastes and interests of British colonial officials during the 18th century. This style originated in various Indian cities, including Kolkata, Chennai, Delhi, Patna, Varanasi, and Thanjavur.



Fig. 3.27: Style of painting

❑ **Mary Impey** and **Marquess Wellesley** supported numerous painters who depicted India's exotic flora and fauna.

❑ Painters: **Mazhar Ali Khan** and **Ghulam Ali Khan**.

Features

- ❑ Freedom from convention, global perspective, technique, and the emergence of the artist as an individual.
- ❑ Fusing elements of **Rajput, Mughal, and other Indian styles** with **European influences**.
- ❑ Use of **watercolour, linear perspective, and shading techniques**.
- ❑ Representational or figurative art, incorporating impressionism, expressionism, or post-expressionism.
- ❑ They gradually simplified their styles through cubism, abstraction, and various expressionistic trends, often moving towards non-figurative art.

Themes

- ❑ Depicting **social unrest** and **human predicaments**.
- ❑ Exploring Indian philosophy and metaphysics in 'tantric' and symbolically meaningful art.
- ❑ There was a growing interest in surrealism and fantasy.

Bazaar Paintings

It was Influenced by European encounters in India and they adopted **Roman and Greek influences**.

- ❑ It was prominent in the **Bengal** and **Bihar** regions, featuring depictions of Indian bazaars against European backgrounds.

Themes

- ❑ **Indian courtesans dancing before British officials**.
- ❑ Religious themes were also used but figures of **Indian deities** with **more than two axes** and elephant-like faces, such as **Lord Ganesha**, were **prohibited** due to their deviation from European notions of natural human forms.

Bengal School

The Bengal School of Art was an art movement and style that, although initiated in Calcutta, Bengal, extended its influence throughout India, reflecting nationalist sentiments in art. It is also called the **Renaissance School** or the **Revivalist School**.

- ❑ It was spearheaded by **Abanindranath Tagore** (1871–1951), a prominent figure in the nationalist (Swadeshi) movement and supported by **E. B. Havell** (1861–1934), the British administrator and principal of the Calcutta School of Art.
- ❑ Both Tagore and Havell criticised the colonial art schools and their promotion of European tastes.



Fig. 3.28:

Bharat Mata by Abanindranath Tagore

- ❑ It aimed to foster an art form that was distinctly Indian in both style and subject matter.
- ❑ They drew inspiration from traditional Indian art forms like Mughal and Pahari miniatures, rejecting the influences of the Company School of Painting and the European academic style prevalent in colonial art schools.
- ❑ While it had country-wide influence initially, its importance declined by the 1940s and is now essentially inactive.

Important Painters and their Work

- ❑ **Abanindranath Tagore** gained global recognition for his “Arabian Night” series.
 - Infused Swadeshi values into Indian art, countering Western materialistic influences.
 - His renowned works include “Bharat Mata” and various Mughal-themed paintings.
- ❑ **Nandalal Bose**, his iconic white-on-black sketch of **Gandhi** during the Dandi March
 - Illuminated the original Constitution of India document.
- ❑ **Rabindranath Tagore** used dominant **black lines** to emphasize subjects and created small-sized paintings.
- ❑ **Other painters:** Asit Kumar Haldar, Manishi Dey, Mukul Dey, Sunayani Devi, Amrita Sher-Gil, Kshitindranath Majumdar (with works like “Rasa-Lila”) and M. R. Chughtai (famed for “Radhika”).

Raja Ravi Varma (1848-1906)

His school of modern painting earned its name due to its incorporation of Western techniques and themes. Hailing from Kerala, he is often referred to as the ‘**Father of Modern Indian Art**’.



Fig. 3.29: Ravana kidnapping Sita

- ❑ He combined South Indian painting elements with Western styles and colours, making him a unique figure in the art world.
- ❑ Some of his most renowned works include “**Ladies in the Moonlight**,” “**Shakuntala**,” “**Damayanti**,” and “**Swan**.”
- ❑ His paintings depict scenes from the Ramayana, particularly “**Ravana kidnapping Sita and killing Jatayu**.”
- ❑ A film titled “**Rang Rasiya**” was made about his life and work.

Cubist Style of Painting

It drew inspiration from the **European Cubist movement**, characterized by **breaking down, analyzing, and reassembling objects**.

- ❑ Artists adopted abstract art forms to reconstruct this process on canvas, striving to find a harmonious balance between line and colour.
- ❑ **M.F. Hussain**, one of India’s renowned cubist artists, **incorporated the motif of a horse** in his **abstract-themed paintings** to convey the fluidity of motion.

Progressive Art Group

In the post-1947 era, a notable group of artists gained prominence for their progressive and daring themes in art. The artists were inspired by European Modernism and included **6 founding members: F.N. Souza, S.H. Raza, M.F. Hussain, K.H. Ara, H.A. Gade, and S.K. Bakre**. They skillfully combined these themes with more subtle and abstract elements, displaying a lack of uniformity within the group.

In conclusion, the trajectory of modern painting in India is a captivating journey marked by a continuous interplay between tradition and contemporary expression. From the early endeavours of the Bengal School, which sought to revive traditional Indian art, to the avant-garde experimentation of the Progressive Artists’ Group, modern Indian painting has navigated diverse themes, styles, and influences.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

How do contemporary Indian painters draw inspiration from the rich heritage of traditional Indian paintings to create innovative and culturally resonant artworks in the modern era?

FOLK PAINTINGS

India has a rich tradition of folk paintings, each reflecting the culture, traditions, and beliefs of the region it originates from.

Folk Paintings

→ Madhubani Paintings	Thangka Paintings ←
→ Pattachitra (Odissa)	Manjusha Painting ←
→ Patua Art (Bengal)	(Bihar)
→ Santhal Painting	Phad Scroll Painting ←
→ Kalamkari Paintings (Andhra Pradesh)	(Rajasthan)
→ Warli Painting, Maharashtra	Chriyal Scroll ←
→ Sanghi Paintings	Painting (Telangana)
→ Chitrakathi Paintings	Saura Paintings ←
	(Odissa)
	Gond Paintings ←
	Pithora Painting ←
	Mata-Ni-Pachedi ←
	Kalighat Paintings ←

Fig. 3.30: Folk Paintings

Madhubani Paintings or Mithila Paintings

It derives its name from Mithila, the ancient Videha and birthplace of Sita. Origin of this art form at the time of Princess Sita getting married to Lord Rama. These were created by women in villages around Madhubani town in Bihar.



Fig. 3.31: Madhubani Painting

Features

- ❑ These paintings are painted on walls and floors and characterized by **bright colours**.
- ❑ **Themes** cover episodes from the **Bhagavata Purana**, and **Ramayana**, stories of **Shiva-Parvati**, **Durga**, **Kali** and **Rasa-Lila** of Radha and Krishna.
- ❑ No **empty space is left**. Elements from nature like birds, flowers, animals, fish, snakes, the Sun and the moon, which often have symbolic intent, signifying love, passion, fertility, eternity, well-being and prosperity are used to fill the gaps.
- ❑ Created on walls using **rice paste and vegetable colours** on a base of cow dung and mud, but over time, they transitioned to handmade paper, cloth, and canvas.
- ❑ These paintings are **two-dimensional** due to the **absence of shading**.
- ❑ Depict **double-line borders**, bold use of colours, ornate floral patterns, and exaggerated facial features.
- ❑ **Jagdamba Devi** played a significant role in gaining recognition for this art. Other notable painters include **Baua Devi**, **Bharti Dayal**, **Ganga Devi**, **Mahasundari Devi**, and **Sita Devi**.
- ❑ These paintings have received a **Geographical Indication (GI)** status.

Tikuli Art from Bihar

The word "Tikuli" is a local term for "Bindi," the decorative dot worn by women between their eyebrows.

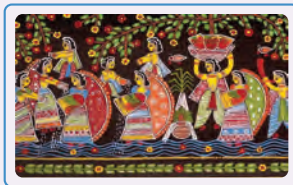


Fig. 3.32: Tikuli Art

- ❑ Paintings are created on a hardboard, which is then cut into various shapes.
- ❑ Four to five enamel coats are applied to provide the artwork with a polished surface.
- ❑ These Tikuli paintings often incorporate Madhubani motifs into their designs.

Pattachitra of Odisha

The name "**Pattachitra**" is derived from the Sanskrit words "**patta**," which means canvas or cloth, and "**chitra**," which means picture. Pattachitra painted on palm leaves is referred to as "**talapattachitra**".

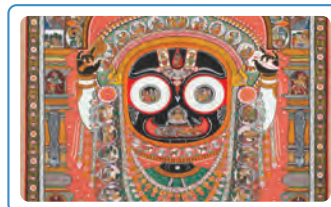


Fig. 3.33: Pattachitra

Raghurajpur in **Odisha** is renowned as a hub for Pattachitra art.

Features

- ❑ Exhibit a **fusion of classical and folk elements**, with a predominant influence of folk art.
- ❑ **Treated cloth** is used as the base material for the paintings.
- ❑ Natural sources, such as burnt coconut shells, hingula etc are used to create the vibrant colours for the artwork.
- ❑ Artists **do not use pencils** or **charcoal** for the initial outlines instead, they **use brushes to draw the outlines** in red or yellow.
- ❑ The background of these paintings is adorned with intricate foliage and floral motifs.
- ❑ A coating of lacquer is applied to give painting a glossy finish after the final lines are drawn.
- ❑ **Themes**: Inspiration from Jagannath and Vaishnava cults, and from the Shakti and Shaiva cults.
 - They often depict images resembling the ancient murals found in the state, particularly those in Puri and Konark.

Patua Art from Bengal

It has a history dating back approximately a thousand years and emerged as a village tradition where painters conveyed **Mangal Kavyas** or auspicious stories related to Hindu deities.

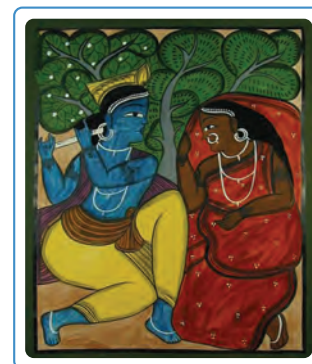


Fig. 3.34: Patua Art

- ❑ Typically **created** on **scrolls** or "**pats**".
- ❑ Most Patuas are **Muslims**, and **depict Hindu myths** in their traditional artwork.
- ❑ **With base Material as** Cloth, contemporary Patua artists often use poster paints on sheets of paper stitched together to comment on political and social issues. Traditionally religious stories used to be portrayed on cloth.
- ❑ The majority are from regions including **Medinipur**, **Murshidabad**, **North** and **South 24 Parganas**, and **Birbhum districts** in Bengal.

Paitkar Painting

It is the traditional **scroll painting** of a small village Amadubi, **Jharkhand**. The word Paitkar is derived from the local word Patekar, or the Pata artists of the region.



Fig. 3.35: Paitkar Painting

- It is known for its **narrative tradition** and performance.
- Cultural significance:** It has a connection with **Ma Mansa**, a prominent goddess in tribal households.
- Themes**
 - Linked to social and religious customs, such as the act of **giving alms** and **conducting yajnas** (ritual offerings).
 - The central theme revolves around the concept of life after death.

Santhal Painting

These paintings are in the form of **narrative scrolls** as well as ritual images on the walls which are drawn by a special community called **Jadu Patua**.



Fig. 3.36: Santhal Painting

Features

- In wall paintings, most of the motifs drawn by Santhal women are geometric figures such as triangles, squares, parallelograms, and creepers. Animals and birds predominate in the imagery decorating the exterior walls of the homes.
- Themes include '**Santhal Janam Katha**' or '**Origin of the Universe**', The Supreme gods **Marang Buru** (the Creator), **Jaher Era**, wife of Marang Buru etc.
- All its tools and colour ingredients are produced by an **indigenous** process.

Kalamkari Paintings (Andhra Pradesh)

The name Kalamkari originates from the Persian words qalam (pen) and kari (craftmanship). The word "kalam" means pen in reference to the tool used for creating these intricate artworks.

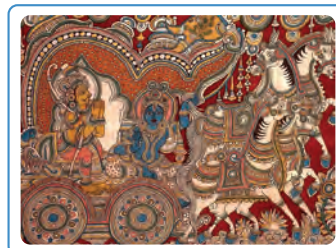


Fig. 3.37: Kalamkari Painting

Features

- Bamboo is used to make the pen, vegetable dyes are used as colours and cotton fabric serves as the canvas.
- Technique:** Images are drawn in a freehand manner.
- Themes:** Primarily from Hindu mythology for their subject matter.
- Primary centers:** **Srikalahasti** and **Machilipatnam** in the state of Andhra Pradesh
- This art form received a **GI tag in 2020**, acknowledging its cultural and regional significance.

Warli Paintings (Maharashtra)

It is named after the Warli people who upheld the ancient artistic tradition dating to 2500-3000 BC. It resembles Bhimbetka murals of Madhya Pradesh.



Fig. 3.38: Warli Painting

Features

- Mixture of mud, branches, and cow dung, resulting in a red-ochre colour is used.
- For painting, a white pigment made from a mixture of gum and rice powder is used.
- These paintings are **now painted on cloth** with a **red or black background** using white poster colour.
- Wall paintings are typically reserved for auspicious occasions like harvest festivals and weddings.
- Technique:** simple shapes such as triangles, circles, and squares are used to represent humans or animals, two triangles are joined at the tip, with circles denoting their heads.

Theme

- The central motif features a "**chaukat**" or "**chauk**" surrounded by depictions of scenes related to **fishing, hunting, farming, dances, animals, trees, and festivals**.
- Representations of **Palaghata**, the goddess of fertility, and **male deities** in human form.

Thangka Paintings

Thangka is a means of reverence, embodying the highest ideals of Buddhism. These paintings are created by Buddhist monks and skill is passed down through generations.

Features

- ❑ Painted on a white cotton canvas, serving as the background.
- ❑ The paints used are derived from natural sources like vegetable dyes or mineral dyes.
 - **Red** symbolizes the intensity of passion, whether love or hatred; **Golden** represents life or birth; **White** conveys serenity; **Black** signifies anger, **Green** symbolizes consciousness; **Yellow** represents compassion.
- ❑ It is framed using colourful silk brocade, enhancing its visual appeal and cultural significance.
- ❑ It is spread in regions like **Sikkim**, **Himachal Pradesh**, **Ladakh**, and **Arunachal Pradesh**.



Fig. 3.39: Thangka Painting of white Tara

Manjusha Painting (Bihar)

It originates from the **Bhagalpur** region of **Bihar** and is alternatively known as **Angika art**, where 'ang' signifies one of the Mahajanapada regions.



Fig. 3.40: Manjusha Painting

- ❑ It often **features snake motifs**, earning them the nickname "snake painting".
- ❑ **Primary canvas:** They are **created on jute boxes and paper**.

Phad Scroll Paintings (Rajasthan)

It is religious art, featuring local deities such as **Pabuji** and **Devnarayan**.

Features

- ❑ It has figures with large eyes and round faces.
- ❑ It features vibrant and celebratory narratives, portraying scenes of processions and festivities.
- ❑ These are crafted using vegetable colours on **elongated cloth** known as "**phad**," which can measure 15 or 30 feet in length.

Cheriyal Scroll Painting (Telangana)

They belong to the **Nakashi art tradition**. In 2010, this art form was granted a **GI tag**.

Features

- ❑ It can be larger in size, reaching heights of up to 45 feet.
- ❑ These are depicted as continuous stories and narrative manners much like comics or ballads, and are often narrated by the **Balladeer community**.
- ❑ Revolve around Hindu Epics and Puranic stories.

Saura Paintings

These are made by the Saura Tribe in Odisha. They are similar to Warli paintings.

Feature

- ❑ Take the form of wall murals and hold significant ritualistic importance.
- ❑ The colour used in these paintings is white, with the background often being red or yellow.
- ❑ Human figures depicted exhibit a distinctive geometric and stick-like appearance.
- ❑ **Material Used:** They extract colours from minerals and plants, emphasizing natural sources.
- ❑ **Theme:** They pay homage to **Idital**, the principal deity of the Sauras.

Gond Paintings

Paintings of Gonds of Mandla and its surrounding regions have recently been transformed into a colourful depiction of animals, humans and flora.

- ❑ Natural phenomena, historical events, ceremonies, and mythological tales are painted.
- ❑ The Gond legend and flag-bearer of Gond art, **Jangarh Singh Shyam**, is credited for helping the art form become so well-known.

Pithoro Painting

This painting was painted by **Rathva Bhils** of the **Panchmahal region** in **Gujarat** and **Jhabua** in the neighbouring State of **Madhya Pradesh**,



Fig. 3.41: Pithoro Painting

- ❑ These paintings are done on the walls of houses to mark special or **Thanksgiving occasions**.
- ❑ These are large wall paintings, representing rows of numerous and magnificently coloured deities **depicted as horse riders**.
 - The rows of horse rider deities represent the cosmography of the Rathvas. The uppermost section with riders represents the **world of gods, heavenly bodies and mythical creatures**.
 - An **ornate wavy line** separates this section from the lower region, where the wedding procession of Pithoro is depicted with minor deities, kings, goddesses of destiny, archetypal farmers, domestic animals, and so on, which represent the earth.

Mata-Ni-Pachedi

The literal meaning of the term 'Mata-ni-pachedi' is "behind the idol of Mother Goddess". In **Ahmedabad**, Mata-ni-pachedi paintings on cloth pertaining to the mother goddess cult are made as votive offerings.

Features

- ❑ The painting is done during the time of Navratri.
- ❑ The **Vaghari community** is especially known for painting these pachedis. Only the men paint; the women are not allowed to conduct the sacred ritual.
- ❑ Mata-ni-pachedi paintings are traditionally in maroon, black, and white, but developments have brought back an exquisite variety of muted colours in vegetable dyes, reviving a 4000-year-old tradition.

Sanjhi Paintings



Fig. 3.42: Sanjhi Painting

The unmarried young girls in the villages of **Punjab, Haryana, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Bihar** and **Uttar Pradesh** prepare the image of the goddess, Sanjhi or Jhanjhi deity, worshipped during Navratri. As these paintings are made in the evening, they are coined with the name 'Sanjhi' or 'Sangya' or 'Chandra Tarayya'. It's a group activity, the tradition of singing songs while making the image dates back to many centuries. The Sanjhi deity represents the nine main goddesses of Hindu tradition.

Chitrakathi Paintings

In medieval **Maharashtra** and some parts of **Andhra** and **Karnataka**, there was a section of people known as Chitrakathis. They travelled from village to village and narrated mythological stories to people with the help of these single-sheet paintings.

- ❑ The Chitrakathi patas draw their **theme** from the **Ramayana** and the **Mahabharata** or the **Puranic legends**.

Kalighat Paintings

These paintings are done by Patua who migrated to **Kolkata** and set up their shop chiefly around the Kalighat temple, where goddess Kali is worshipped. This is how they came to be called 'Kalighat paintings'.

- ❑ These are painted with **watercolour on mill-made paper**.
- ❑ The original subjects of these paintings were **religious figures**, particularly Hindu gods and goddesses. These artworks were eventually utilized to **convey opinions to society**.



Fig. 3.43: Kalighat Painting

- ❑ **Romantic depictions of women, changing roles of women and men** etc. are the themes of more recent work.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

How do Indian folk paintings serve as repositories of indigenous knowledge and ecological wisdom, reflecting the symbiotic relationship between people, nature and spirituality?

Ganjifa Card

The word 'Ganjifa' literally means wealth of money and grains.

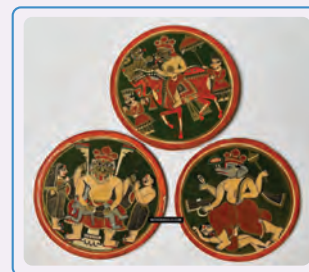


Fig. 3.44: Ganjifa Cards

- ❑ The artists of Bishnupur in the Bankura district of **West Bengal** produced a special set of cards known as Ganjifa cards in the 14th century AD, a substitute for present-day playing cards.
 - They depicted ten avatars or incarnations of Lord Vishnu.
- ❑ Historical references are found in books like **Humayunnama** and **Abul Fazal's Ain-i-Akbari**.
- ❑ These cards are also found in **Odisha, Maharashtra** and **Mysore**.

CONCLUSION

In conclusion, Indian painting has evolved significantly from ancient times to the modern period, reflecting the rich cultural heritage and artistic traditions of the country. From the intricate details of Ajanta and Ellora caves to the vibrant colors of Mughal miniatures and the bold expressions of modern artists, Indian painting has continually evolved, influenced by various cultures and historical events, creating a diverse and dynamic artistic legacy.

INTRODUCTION

Handicrafts refer to the creation of items or goods using manual skills and traditional craftsmanship. They often carry cultural significance, reflecting the heritage and traditions of a particular region or community. Handicrafts can include a vast array of items, such as textiles, pottery, jewellery, woodwork, basketry, and much more.

HANDICRAFTS ON CLOTH

Handloom industry represents the rich cultural and traditional heritage unique to India. India is a major handloom producer in the world, accounting for 85% of the total production globally. The Handloom industry is the second largest employment generator in India, next only to agriculture. Major handloom clusters in India are Bahraich, Bhuj, Karimnagar, Patan, Varanasi, Nawan, Shaher, Boudh, etc. Various handicraft techniques are used on cloth, including weaving, printing, tying and dyeing.

❑ Bandhani or Bandhej

- **Region:** Rajasthan, Gujarat, Andhra Pradesh, and Tamil Nadu.
- Bandhani, also known as Bandhej, is a traditional tie-dye textile art form that originated in the Indian state of Gujarat and has been practiced for centuries. It involves the process of tying small pints or knots on a piece of fabric before dyeing it, resulting in a variety of intricate patterns and designs. Bandhani is commonly used in creating sarees, dupattas, turbans and other traditional garments.

❑ Laharia

- **Region:** Rajasthan.
- It is a tie-and-dye method. It involves **creating ripple or wave-like** patterns which is achieved through the particular technique of folding or rolling the fabric before it is tied.

❑ Ikat

- **Region:** Telangana, Odisha, Gujarat, and Andhra Pradesh.
- Ikat is a fabric dyeing technique from Indonesia. Complex in nature, it is done by applying the concept of **resist dyeing**. Before the cloth is woven, the warp and weft threads are repeatedly dyed.

❑ Kalamkari

- **Region:** Andhra Pradesh.
- It is a **hand-painting technique** on fabrics using vegetable dyes. There are two unique kinds of Kalamkari art in India: the **Machilipatnam style** and the **Srikalahasti style**.

❑ Batik art

- **Region:** Madhya Pradesh and West Bengal.
- It is a way of decorating cloth by covering a part of it with a **coat of wax** and then dyeing the cloth. The waxed areas keep their original colour, and when the wax is removed, the contrast between the dyed and undyed areas makes the pattern.



Fig. 4.1: Ikat Fabric, Kalamkari Fabric, Batik Art

❑ Tanchoi Weaving

- **Region:** Gujarat and UP.
- The weave resembles a delicate **miniature painting** influenced by Chinese techniques.
- Currently, weavers from Banaras hold expertise in Tanchoi silk brocades.

❑ Jamdani

- **Region:** West Bengal.
- It involves **weaving muslin in various styles** with opaque patterns on a transparent background.

❑ Telia Rumal

- **Region:** Andhra Pradesh.
- Telia Rumal is a unique tie and dye technique that uses oil for the treatment of the yarn that helps it retain softness and has a distinct smell of gingelly oil. The earlier patterns used to be strictly geometric or vegetal patterns due to the preference of the patrons, but after the 1930s the craftsmen started incorporating figurative elements like lions, elephants, birds, clocks and even aeroplanes, which required better weaving skills.

❑ Bhavani Jamakkalam (GI)

- **Region:** Tamil Nadu
- These are the blankets and carpets manufactured in the region.

❑ Mata Ni Pachedi

- **Region:** Gujarat
- This is a ritual cloth painting that uses red as the main colour.

❑ Chamba Rumal (GI)

- **Region:** Himachal Pradesh
- The Chamba Rumal or Chamba handkerchief is an embroidered handicraft that was once promoted under the patronage of the former rulers of Chamba kingdom.

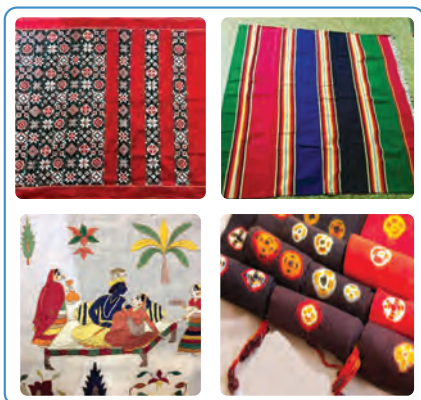


Fig. 4.2: Telia Rumal Shree, Bhawani Jamakkalam, Chamba Rumal, Thigma

❑ Thigma

- **Region:** Jammu and Kashmir.
- A form of tie-resist-dyeing, thigma is practised primarily in the Nubra Valley and Saboo region of Ladakh in northern India.
- Thigma is similar to the technique of Bandhani. Woollen cloth is coloured using natural ingredients.

❑ Ajrakh Printing

- **Region:** Gujarat
- A textile with block printing that has been resist-dyed with natural colours.

❑ Dabu Printing

- **Region:** Rajasthan
- This is a very old and unusual method of hand block printing using mud resist.

❑ Kotpad Handloom Fabric (GI)

- **Region:** Odisha
- Kotpad Handloom is a vegetable-dyed fabric woven by the tribal weavers of the Mirgan community of Kotpad village in Koraput district, Odisha.

❑ Dhalapathar Parda and Fabrics (GI)

- **Region:** Odisha
- A Parda handicraft is usually sewn with a hand-made spinning machine using threads in natural colours.

❑ Madurai Sungudi (GI)

- **Region:** Tamil Nadu
- It is a traditional tie-and-dye technique.

❑ Muthangi

- **Region:** Tamil Nadu
- It is a pearl-studded attire mainly made for idols.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

What role do women play in the production of Indian handicrafts and how does it influence their social and economic empowerment?

Traditional Regional Sarees of India

Region	Saree	Features
Telangana	Pochampally Saree (GI)	They have traditional geometric patterns in the ikat style of dyeing . It blends silk and cotton.
	Gadwal saree (GI)	Cotton and silk yarn is used.
	Narayanpet saree (GI)	It is a cotton saree.
Andhra Pradesh	Uppada Jamdani Saree (GI)	Silk sarees with zari work.
	Mangalgiri Saree (GI)	Mangalagiri saris are a unique variety, woven from cotton and have the most distinguished features such as zari on the border and no woven designs on the body.
	Venkatagiri Saree (GI)	Border and Pallu are decorated with Zari. Soft and Pastel colours are used.
Tamil Nadu	Kandangi Saree (GI)	This saree is made from cotton in the Indian state of Tamil Nadu. Chettinad and Koorainad are two regions in Tamil Nadu that adopt the traditional Kandangi style.
	Kovai Kora Saree (GI)	This is a cotton saree manufactured in Coimbatore.
	Kancheepuram Silk saree (GI)	Mulberry silk is used, and zari work is done on it.
	Thirubuvanam Silk Saree (GI)	Mulberry filature silk yarns are used both in warp and weft with pure gold zari for extra warp and extra weft designing.
	Konrad Saree	It is known for its vibrant colours and traditional motifs.
	Arani Silk Saree (GI)	These sarees are woven with mulberry silk. The border has a thin line of Zari and or small designs.

Kerala	Kasavu Sarees	It is characterised by cream-coloured fabric with golden borders .
	Balaramapuram Saree (GI)	These are woven with kora white cotton yarn.
	Kasaragod Saree (GI)	It is made of coloured cotton yarn .
	Kuthampully saree (GI)	Fine cotton and zari are used as material.
Karnataka	Ilkal (GI)	Cotton warp is used for the saree's body, whereas art silk warp is used for the border and pallu. Kasuti embroidery is used with chariots and elephants as common motifs.
	Molakalmuru Saree (GI)	Material used: Mulberry filature silk and Charkha silk.
	Mysore silk saree (GI)	These are made from 100% pure silk and the zari contains 65% pure silver and 0.65% of gold. It comes in two varieties: crepe de chine and georgette.
	Udupi saree (GI)	It is made of cotton.
Maharashtra	Nauvari Saree	It is a single nine-yard drape, also known as the Kasta saree .
	Paithani	It is celebrated for its elaborate zari work and vibrant colours.
	Karvath Kati saree (GI)	Tussar silk is used as the material.
Odisha	Bomkai saree	Silk and cotton sarees with ikat , embroidery and intricate thread work. It is a GI-protected craft primarily produced by the Bhulia community of Subarnapur.
	Kotpad Saree	Cotton yarn is dyed using natural madder. Designs are mainly inspired by the surroundings.
	Sambalpuri Saree	It is made from Tussar silk and cotton.
	Berhampur Reshma Patta Saree	This is a silk saree.
	Habaspuri saree	Cotton is used to manufacture these sarees.
	Khandua Saree (GI)	Silk and cotton yarn are the main raw materials. However, to make the product more decorative and attractive, the artisans are also using Zari.
	Orissa Ikat (GI)	It is closely associated with Lord Jagannath Temple rituals at Puri, Orissa.
Gujarat	Patan Patola (GI)	Patola is a type of double ikat woven fabric, typically crafted from silk in Patan, located in North Gujarat. Ikat involves tie-dyeing the warp or weft threads before weaving the cloth.
	Rajkot Patola (GI)	These are single ikat sarees woven on silk.
West Bengal	Baluchari Murshidabad Saree (GI)	It depicts ancient stories adorning the border and pallu.
	Tant	It is a crisp cotton and printed saree.
	Jamdani Saree	Opaque patterns are woven on a transparent background with finest muslin as the material.
	Dhaniakhali saree (GI)	Cotton yarn is used to make it.
	Santipur Saree (GI)	Cotton yarn and Tussar silk are used as material.
Chhattisgarh	Kosa Saree	It is crafted from special silk produced in the region.
	Champa silk saree (GI)	It is made from Tussar silk .
Madhya Pradesh	Chanderi Saree (GI)	These are known for their sheer texture and elegant drape .
	Maheshwar Saree (GI)	It is made of Mulberry silk yarn and cotton yarn.
Uttar Pradesh	Tanchoi Brocades	It is a Banarasi saree involving weaving techniques with a single or double warp and two to five colours .
	Mau Saree	It has a GI tag.
Bihar	Bhagalpuri Saree (GI)	It is made of Tussar silk.
Rajasthan	Kota Doria Saree (GI)	Cotton and mulberry raw silk yarn are used to make it.
Jammu and Kashmir	Jamawar	Usually, wool is the base material and just a small amount of cotton is added.

Traditional Regional Shawls in India

❑ Kullu Shawl (GI)

- **Area: Himachal Pradesh**
- This is produced mainly in Kullu valley.
- It features various geometrical patterns and bright colours.

❑ Kinnauri Shawl (GI)

- **Area:** Himachal Pradesh
- It is manufactured mainly in Kinnaur district, having intricate geometrical designs.

❑ Tangaliya Shawl (GI)

- **Area:** Gujarat
- This is a dotted hand-woven textile by the **Dangasia community**.

❑ Kachchh Shawl (GI)

- **Area:** Gujarat
- This shawl is made of acrylic wool.
- Mainly, Vankar and Meghwal communities weave this shawl.

❑ Kani Shawl (GI)

- **Area:** Jammu and Kashmir
- Pashmina wool is used to make it.

❑ Chakhesang Shawl (GI)

- **Area:** Nagaland
- Material used is cotton and natural fibres such as Nettle, Deccan jute and the bark of the Debrege tree.

❑ Puthukkuli Shawl

- **Area:** Tamil Nadu
- Made by the Toda community with Toda embroidery.

❑ Kapdaganda shawl

- The shawl is woven and embroidered by women of the **Dongria Kondh** - a particularly vulnerable tribal group residing in the **Niyamgiri hills (Odisha)**.
- The handcrafted motifs in the shawl are mainly lines and triangular shapes that reflect the importance of mountains for the community. The motifs are embroidered on an off-white coarse cloth by a needle using red, green and yellow threads.
- GI tag has been sought for this product.

Other GI Protected Shawls

State	Shawl	Description
Jammu and Kashmir	Kashmiri Pashmina	Pashmina refers to the cashmere wool of the Changthangi cashmere goat .
Manipur	Shaphee Lanphee	Made by Meiti women.
Mizoram	Hmaram	Belongs to the Lusei tribe.
	Mizo Puanchei	Essential customary wear for Mizo women during auspicious rituals.
	Ngotekherh	It has black and white stripes.
	Tawlhlohpuan	Customarily, it is draped like a warrior wears it.
Nagaland	Chakhesang	Shawl carries motifs and patterns that are symbols of prosperity, beauty and happiness.

Embroidery Craft

Embroidery is the art of **decorating cloth with needlework** using different types of threads to create **fascinating designs**. Embroidery may also include the use of other materials like pearls, beads, sequins, etc. The fabrics are also embellished with community stories, motifs emerging from natural surroundings, religious inscriptions, economic states, etc. Indian embroidery includes **various regional styles** varying by **region** and **materials used**. In India, there are many popular embroidery clusters such as **Chikankari** and **zardosi** of Lucknow, **katha** of Bengal, **phulkari** of Punjab, **kutchi** embroidery of Gujarat and **kashidakari** of Kashmir.

Zari/Zardosi

- ❑ Zari is also known as **Zardosi embroidery**. Zardosi combines two Persian terms: '**zari**' means gold, and '**dozi**' means **embroidery**. Thus, the embroidery is done using **gold** and **silver thread** for embroidery work.



Fig. 4.3: Zari Work

- ❑ **Khandela** (Rajasthan) and **Jaipur** are famous for **Zari work**.
- ❑ The popular styles in Zari embroidery in India are **Salma Sitara, Kamdani, Minakari, Mokaish, Gota, etc.**
- ❑ **Lucknow Zardozi** has **GI** protection.
- ❑ **Surat** is the **home of zari (thread) industry** in India. Other clusters producing zari are Bareilly, Varanasi, Agra, Hyderabad, Lucknow, Vadodara, Lathur, Jaipur, Barmer, etc.
- ❑ Another related technique to Zari is **Karchobi**, which originates from **Rajasthan**. It involves sewing flat stitches onto cotton stuffing to produce an elevated pattern resembling metallic threads, similar to Zari.

Chikankari (Uttar Pradesh)

- ❑ Chikankari embroidery originates from the Persian word "**Chakeen**," denoting elegant patterns on fabric.
- ❑ The embroidery is prominently practiced in **Uttar Pradesh**, particularly in **Lucknow**, renowned as a **Chikankari hub**.



Fig. 4.4: Chikankari Work

- ❑ It is also known as **shadow work**, achieved through herringbone stitches from the fabric's wrong side, creating a shadow effect on the right side and outlining motifs.
- ❑ Traditionally **done on white muslin fabric** with white thread, it is now extended to various materials like linen, georgette, cotton, etc.

Kantha (Bengal)



Fig. 4.5: Kantha Embroidery

- ❑ Bengal has a delightful folk tradition of embroidery and quilting known as Kantha. These are sewn together to make it thick. Women use their spare time to sew these Kanthas by coloured threads from the border of old sarees and are stitched along the border line and the surface is filled with various designs.
- ❑ It has a GI tag.

Kasuti (Karnataka)

- ❑ Kasuti is an art form of women. The word Kasuti is derived from the word **Kai** which means **hand**, and **Suti** means **cotton thread**. Thus Kasuti is the handwork of cotton thread from Karnataka.
- ❑ It is a GI protected craft.
- ❑ Kasuti embroidery **employs a single thread** and requires careful thread counting on the fabric. The patterns are created without knots, ensuring symmetry on both sides of the cloth.
- ❑ The fabric used for kasuti embroidery is **Irkal sarees**.



Fig. 4.6: Kasuti Embroidery

Gara Embroidery (Gujarat)

It is a traditional embroidery style **originating from the Parsi community** in India. It is known for its intricate, highly detailed, floral, **and nature-inspired designs**.

Shamilami (Manipur)

The embroidery originates from Manipur and incorporates a blend of weaving and embroidery techniques.

Karchobi (Rajasthan)

Karchobi, a renowned form of needlework from Rajasthan, features intricate raised zari metallic thread embroidery, executed using flat stitches on a cotton padding.

Gota (Rajasthan)

Tiny segments of gold zari ribbon are affixed onto the fabric, with their edges neatly sewn to form intricate patterns.

Pichwai (Rajasthan and Gujarat)

It is a beautiful and **colourful hanging** used as a **backdrop** to **religious idols**.

Banni (Gujarat)

The **Lohana community** practices this embroidery technique, employing silk floss to embroider geometric motifs, often incorporating glasswork elements.

Kathi Work (Gujarat)

- ❑ It is an embroidery style by nomadic **Rabari tribes** of **Gujarat**.
- ❑ It features **chain stitch work** adorned with tiny mirrors, often done on brightly dyed fabrics.

Jamawar (Kashmir)

Janawar are intricately designed **shawls** made in Kashmir. It is known for fine craftsmanship, with no discernible front or back.

Kashidakari (Jammu and Kashmir)

It involves using simple chain stitches to make floral patterns.

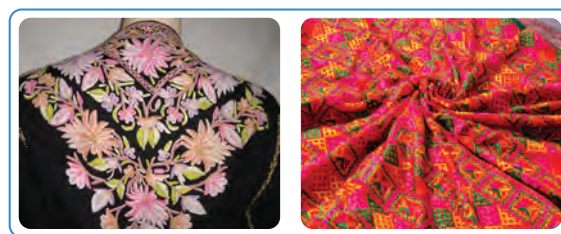


Fig. 4.7: Kashida Embroidery, Phulkari

Phulkari (Punjab and Haryana)

- ❑ Phulkari actually means “flowered work”. This term is used for a type of embroidery practiced by folk women in Punjab.
- ❑ Basic motifs of Phulkari designs are geometric. Squares, dashes, triangles & straight lines and zig-zag lines from endless innovative variation.
- ❑ This embroidery has got GI protection.

Bagh (Punjab)

While akin to phulkari, Akshida embroidery from Bihar distinguishes itself by featuring embroidery throughout the entire fabric surface. It shares similarities with Bagh embroidery as well.

Sujani (Bihar)

Executed on delicate muslin fabric, often in shades of red or white, this embroidery technique involves outlining the main motifs with bold chain stitches and filling them in with an array of colorful threads. It holds a Geographical Indication (GI) protection status.

Phool Patti ka Kaam (Uttar Pradesh)

The embroidery incorporates motifs of flower petals and leaves.

Mukaish/Mukesh (Uttar Pradesh)

Thin metallic threads are twisted to form patterns across the fabric in this technique.

Mirror Work (Rajasthan and Gujarat)

Tiny mirror fragments of various sizes and shapes are interspersed within vibrant embroidery in this technique.

Dharaniya (Gujarat)

These embroidered wall hangings originate from Gujarat state.

Kutch Embroidery (Gujarat and Rajasthan)

- This is an evolving expression of craft and textile traditions of the Rabaris. This folk embroidery is done using cotton/silk threads on cotton cloth.
- This is a GI protected craft.

Toda Embroidery (Tamil Nadu)

It is done by the Toda tribe of Tamil Nadu.

Karchobi (Rajasthan)

This is a form of Rajasthani raised zari metallic thread embroidery, created by stitching flat threads onto a cotton padding.

Pipli Applique Work (Odisha)

- This art has GI protection.
- The central lotus motif is unique to Odisha applique, constructed with concentric rows of triangles and tips of which are filled with cotton to give the petals an extra dimension.

Applique Khatwa Patch Work (Bihar)

- Commonly used on wall hangings, Shamianas, sarees, curtains etc. Applique is a craft which uses waste pieces of cloth as its raw material.
- It has GI protection.

Sandur Lambani (Karnataka)

- This is a special type of needlecraft done only by women.
- The method of using small bits of material and attaching them to make up the whole garment is unique to Lambani.
- This art has GI protection.

Sozni (Jammu and Kashmir)

- This art has a GI tag.
- The motifs are formed using satin stitch and are mirrored on both sides of the fabric. This stitch is occasionally referred to as dorukha.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

To what extent do Indian handicrafts contribute to the promotion of sustainable and ethical tourism, and how can responsible tourism practices help in the preservation of traditional crafts and the livelihoods of artisans?

List of Other GI Registered Textile

State	Textile	Description
Andhra Pradesh	Machilipatnam Kalamkari	It is visually identified by the all-over floral twine/Persian designs, which are block printed and created through traditional laborious methods using natural vegetable dyes.
	Srikalahasti Kalamkari	The fabric is hand-painted using a kalam.
Arunachal Pradesh	Idu Mishmi textile	Usually woven by women. Today synthetic yarns are being excessively used instead of cotton.
Karnataka	Guledgudd Khana	Woven with pure cotton threads and silk yarn. The motifs used for the design are inspired by nature, ancient stone sculptures of Badami and Hindu mythology.
Kerala	Chendamangalam Dhotis and set mundu	Basic raw material used for weaving is cotton. Borders are patterned with kasavu (Zari).
	Kuthampully Dhotis and set mundu	They are woven with fine cotton and pure zari. Basic fabric is generally off-white or non-bleached.
Maharashtra	Solapuri Chaddar	This is a cotton bedcover.
Odisha	Dhalapathar Parda and fabrics	About a century ago, a community known as Rangani produced these paradas. There are temple designs on these pardas.
Tamil Nadu	Kovai Kora Cotton	Woven in the Coimbatore region. Made from a blend of cotton and silk. The fabric developed has bright-coloured border designs.
	Madurai Sungudi	It is a cotton fabric. This textile is produced using tie and dye methods.
	Salem Fabric	This is made of cotton and silk yarn. This is the first GI product from the state.
	Salem Venpattu	Pure mulberry silk is used to make it. Zari is used at the border.
Mizoram	Pawndum	It is a rectangular piece of fabric used as a body wrap by both men and women.

TERRACOTTA CRAFTS

Terracotta is a **semi-baked ceramic** clay known for its **waterproof** and durable properties, making it ideal for **sculpting and architecture**.

- ❑ The ancient Pala period showcases exquisite terracotta art in the form of Buddhist viharas.
- ❑ Notable examples of terracotta craftsmanship include the **Bankura Horse**, **Panchmura Horse**, and **terracotta temples** in West Bengal's Bankura district.
- ❑ Gorakhpur Terracotta was given a GI tag in 2019-20.

CLAY AND POTTERY WORK

Pottery has been called the lyric of handicrafts because of its irresistible and universal appeal. There is a wide range of pottery and clay crafts in India. Some of the most popular

forms of pottery include blue pottery, black and red pottery, roulette ware, and dull red & grey ware. India has a rich tradition of clay crafts and pottery throughout the country. **Asharikandi** in Assam is the largest cluster in India, where terracotta and pottery crafts are found. Other clusters are **Bhadrawati**, **Bulandshahar**, **Nizamabad**, **Pune**, **Chandrapur**, etc.

- ❑ Clay pottery making dates back to around 6000 BC, with evidence found in the **Neolithic site of Mehrgarh**, now in Pakistan.
- ❑ Southern India yielded remnants of '**Roulette Pottery**' from **200-100 BC**, primarily found in **Arikamedu near Puducherry**.
- ❑ With the influence of **Indo-Islamic traditions**, glazed pottery gained prominence.
- ❑ **Each region** of India specialises in distinct types of clay work.

Area	Clay Work	Features
Uttar Pradesh	Khurja (GI)	This robust and vibrant pottery is employed in crafting household essentials.
	Nizamabad Black Pottery (GI)	A glossy dark surface embellished with intricately engraved silver designs.
Rajasthan	Blue pottery (GI)	It hails from Jaipur and is crafted using Multani Mitti clay for pottery making.
	Kagzi Pottery	It originates from Alwar and is characterized by its delicate, thin, and somewhat fragile nature.
	Pokhran (GI)	It is sturdy and long-lasting pottery used for household purposes.
	Molela clay work	Made of natural clay which gives it a characteristic reddish-brown color.
Jammu and Kashmir	Dalgate	It is a unique glazed pottery.
West Bengal	Surai	It is not made on the wheel , but four pieces are joined together to form the base.
Gujarat	Gopichandan	Clay resembling sandalwood , is used to make objects.
Tamil Nadu	Karigiri	It is a specially designed pot used by Nawab of Arcot.



Fig. 4.8: Khurja Pottery, Black Pottery (Nizamabad), Pokhran Pottery

METAL CRAFT

The metal crafts of India display intricate craftsmanship and fine art in shaping gold, silver, brass, and copper into exquisitely designed images, idols, jewellery, and utility items. Different categories of handicrafts that come under metal ware are brass metal ware of Moradabad, metal bidri work and bell metal in Madhya Pradesh, Odisha, and so on. India is the largest brassware producer in the world. Various metal casting techniques are employed in crafts using iron, copper, and bell metal.

Major clusters of metalware are Brassware: Moradabad, Murshidabad, Madurai, Salem, Cuttack and Haryana. Whereas major centers of bell metalware are Salem, Cuttack, Murshidabad, and Tiruchirappalli.

- ❑ The majority of metalwork is used to **create pots and pans**, such as the **badla**, which are **semi-circular or rounded pots** made with **zinc** in Rajasthan's **Marwar region**.
- ❑ **Tarkashi (Rajasthan)** uses **fine copper or brass wires** to create patterns in chiselled grooves on a metallic base.
- ❑ **Marori work (Rajasthan)** involves etching on metal and filling gaps with resin, creating intricate designs.
- ❑ **Koftagiri**, or **damascening**, involves **inlaying a light metal on a dark surface**, perfected by artists in Jaipur and Alwar.
- ❑ **Moradabad** specialises in **Baarik Kaam**, using the **Nakasshi style** to create finely detailed pots.

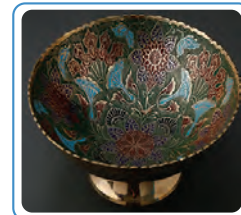


Fig. 4.9: Marori Work

- ❑ **Aranmula Kannadi** (literally meaning Aranmula mirror) is a handmade metal-alloy mirror of **Kerala** having GI tag.
- ❑ **Nettur Petti Jewellery Boxes** from **Kerala** are made using rosewood and brass curios. Its patterns are inspired by the temple architecture and traditional art forms of Kerala.

Bronze Craft

Bronze work is one of the oldest forms of metal craftsmanship, as exemplified by the **Dancing Girl statue from Mohenjo Daro**.

- ❑ The **Matasya Purana** provides **literary evidence** of **early bronze casting** methods, with later texts like **Nagarjuna's Rasa Ratnakar** discussing **metal purity** and **zinc distillation**.
- ❑ **Uttar Pradesh**, with centres like **Etawah, Sitapur, Varanasi, and Moradabad**, is a significant hub for bronze crafts, producing decorative items and ritual objects.
- ❑ **Pahaldar Lamps**: Copper and brass lamps are made in different styles and shapes. These are made in Jaipur and parts of Uttar Pradesh.

Silver Jewellery

Filigree work is a renowned technique in silver jewellery crafting. Two major clusters of silver filigree in India are **Karimnagar in Andhra Pradesh and Cuttack in Orissa**. The practice in Karimnagar is about two centuries old. However, it is also practised in Warangal in Andhra Pradesh.

- ❑ **Odisha** specialises in crafting silver anklets known as **Painri/Paijam** and knitted **silver ornaments called Gunchi**.
- ❑ **Bidri work** is celebrated for its intricate inlay work using silver against dark backgrounds, creating a striking contrast. It travelled from Iran to Ajmer in Rajasthan in the 13th century AD, and from there to Bijapur and flourished during the reign of the Deccan Sultanate. Bidri craft is GI protected. The art is mainly practised in Bidar in Karnataka and Hyderabad in Andhra Pradesh. Apart from these, it is also practised in Aurangabad district in the state of Maharashtra and Hyderabad in Andhra Pradesh.

Other Important Metal Crafts

Centres	Name	Features
Telangana	Pembarthi Crafts	Beautiful brass sheet metal artwork embellishes chariots and temples.
	Adilabad Dhora (GI)	It is a tradition of the Woj community.
	Silver filigree of Karimnagar (GI)	The art form was patronised during the rule of the Nizams of Hyderabad.
Odisha and West Bengal	Dhokra Casting	❑ The lost wax method is used to produce Dhokra objects. ❑ Dhokra is an alloy of nickel, brass, and zinc. ❑ Bastar Dhokra (Chhattisgarh) has a GI tag.
Kerala	Gaja Tandava	Shiva is depicted dancing in the Tandava posture.
	Aramula Kannadi (GI)	It is a handmade metal mirror.
	Brass Broidered coconut shell (GI)	Brass broidered decoration is made through lost wax technique.
	Payyannur Pavithra Ring	This is a gold ring worn during the ritual of Pithru Bali (prayer for a person's dead ancestors)
Karnataka	Rare Jain imagery and icons	Indicate the existence of ancient Jain pilgrimage sites in Karnataka.
	Bidri ware (GI)	Its origin is usually attributed to Bahamani sultans. The metal used is white brass that is blackened and inlaid with silver.
Tamil Nadu	Nachiarkail Kuthuvilakku (GI)	It is an ornamental brass lamp.
	Temple jewellery of Nagercoil (GI)	Stone/ jewel studded temple jewellery.
	Thanjavur Art Plate (GI)	It features designs of deities, birds, flowers and geometric patterns beaten out from the back of copper and silver sheets.
	Swamimalai Bronze Icons (GI)	This craft has been in practice since the Chola period.
Andhra Pradesh	Budithi Bell and Brass Craft	Bindelu vessels are made from brass metal and are only made in Budithi, Srikakulam district. Bells cast from bell metal are used in temples.
Chhattisgarh	Bastar Iron Craft (GI)	Bastar Iron Craft (also known as "Wrought iron craft of Baster") is a traditional Indian iron craft.
Madhya Pradesh	Bell metal ware of Datia and Tikamgarh (GI)	Main feature of Datia is the jali work done on the sides of the product.
Rajasthan	Thewa art work	This art was patronized by royalty. The art can be found on jewellery.
Uttar Pradesh	Banaras Gulabi Meenakari craft (GI)	Art of decorating metal surface by fusing mineral substances on it.
	Moradabad metal craft (GI)	Moradabad metal engraving is a fine and delicate art. This craft shows the traces of Islamic culture.

WOODEN WORK

Wood is a significant product derived from India's extensive forest cover, with furniture being a major commodity. Different types of exquisitely carved woodwork furniture are crafted from **Sheesham wood** and **pinewood**.

- ❑ **Saharanpur** is world famous for its wood carving and is known as "**Sheesham Wood Village**" or "Wood City" of India. Other important centers of wood carving in India are Manipur, Bhopal, Nagpur, Chennai, Madurai, Mysore, etc.
- ❑ **Kashmir** is a prominent center for wooden furniture production, with a tradition dating back to the 13th

century, using **Walnut** and **Deodar** wood extensively. In addition to **furniture**, Kashmiri artists are skilled in **crafting wooden houses** and **houseboats**, adapted to the **cold** and **wet climate** of the region. Kashmiri **lattice work**, including **Acche-dar**, **Khatamband**, and **Azlipinjra**, is renowned for its exquisite craftsmanship.

- ❑ **Gujarat** is another major center for wooden lattice work, commonly used on windows and doors.
- ❑ **Hilly areas** with abundant wood resources, like Himachal Pradesh, excel in wood carving techniques, as seen in temple elements like **Nagbel**, **Kutheriphoor**, **Jali**, and **Dori**.

Other Prominent Centers for Woodwork in India

State	Wood Used	Features
Andhra Pradesh	Raktachandan (Typical Red Sandalwood)	Usen in the Carving of dolls and figurines.
Karnataka	Sandalwood	It is used for carving items like statues of gods and goddesses , utilitarian objects, and sandalwood boxes.
Kerala	Teakwood	They are utilized in crafting Tharavad Houses, renowned for their rich, deep brown hue and intricate wood craftsmanship.
Nagaland	Kumisyng	Among the carved objects, the huge log drum is particularly noteworthy.
Rajasthan	Rohilda	The Pali district in Rajasthan produces thin bowls and other articles.
Maharashtra	Hale and Pangora Woods	Ratnagiri produces lacquered imitation fruits.

Famous Woodcrafts of India

Area	Name	Details
Jammu and Kashmir	Khatamband wood craft (GI)	Basic technique of Khatamband involves joining wooden pieces using three different types of joints.
	Walnut wood carving (GI)	Characterised by high relief and undercut carving style.
	Kashmir Papier Mache (GI)	One of the most attractive handicrafts of Kashmir. Items include a pen stand, coaster, jewellery box, tray, photo stand etc.
Telangana	Nirmal Paintings, furniture, toys and crafts (GI)	This art started during Kakatiya dynasty . This art form entails meticulous painting on wooden surfaces, culminating in a final embellishment with gold.
Andhra Pradesh	Bobbilli Veena (GI)	It is a traditional musical instrument which is also known as Saraswati veena and is an integral part of Carnatic music. It is made up of a single piece of jackfruit wood.
	Etikoppaka Toys (GI)	It is made from locally available Ankudu wood.
	Kondapalli Bommalu (GI)	These toys are made from the wood of tella poniki tree.
	Udayagiri Cutlery (GI)	Believed to have originated in the 14th century, this wood-carving craft is native to Udayagiri town located in Nellore district.
Uttar Pradesh	Saharanpur wood craft (GI)	Wood craft, which is the main handicraft of this district, is about 400 years old. Sheesham wood is the main raw material used in this industry.
	Varanasi Wooden Lacquerware and toys (GI)	These toys are made without joints.
Bihar	Sikki Grass Craft	Ornaments, boxes etc are made.
Chattisgarh	Bastar Wooden Craft	These are made out of the finest teak, Sheesham, sagon and shivna wood.

Karnataka	Santalum	Santalum sandalwood carving is mainly used in the manufacture of religious products.
	Channapatna Toys and Dolls (GI)	In addition to the traditional ivory-wood, other woods—including rubber, sycamore, cedar, pine and teak—are now used as well.
	Kinhal Toys (GI)	This craft of making wooden toys is specially practiced by a community called chitragars.
	Mysore rosewood inlay (GI)	Desired designs are scooped out in the flat surface of the rosewood.
Gujarat	Pethapur Printing Blocks (GI)	These are used for printing on garments.
	Sankheda Furniture (GI)	Crafted entirely from seasoned teak wood, this furniture showcases abstract designs and floral paintings.
Assam	Shital Patti Grass mat	Raw material: Green patidai or long-stemmed knotless mohtra reeds.
West Bengal	Wooden mask of Kushmandi (GI)	Worn during the traditional performance of Gomira dance.
Tamil Nadu	Thanjavur Veena (GI)	The Thanjavur Veena is the first musical instrument in the country to get the GI (Geographical Indication) tag.
	Kallakurichi wood carving (GI)	Kallakurichi Wood Carvings are predominantly made from locally sourced wood, such as teak, sandalwood, and rosewood. The art form gained prominence during the Chola dynasty.
	Arumbavur wood carving (GI)	The 500-year-old Arumbavur Wooden Carving artisans have their origin traced from Madurai.
Goa	Kashtakari Wood carving	Can be seen in churches, temples, houses, household products etc.
Uttarakhand	Likhai wood carving	Tibetan motifs are used on the borders of these wooden doors.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

How has technology, such as e-commerce platforms and digital marketing, impacted the accessibility and visibility of Indian handicrafts on a global scale, and what are the implications for both artisans and consumers?

OTHER HANDICRAFTS

Glassware

- ❑ Early evidence of glass beads comes from the **Painted Grey Ware culture** (around 1000 BC) in the Ganges Valley. The Vedic term for glass was “**kanch**” or “**kaca**”.
- ❑ Archaeological findings in **Brahmapuri and Kolhapur, Maharashtra**, indicate the existence of a glass industry dating from the 2nd century BC to the 2nd century AD, specializing in the production of **lenticular beads**.
 - Other places of glass evidence are **Maski** (Deccan), **Ahar** (Rajasthan), **Hastinapur**, **Ahichchatra** (Uttar Pradesh), **Eran** and **Ujjain** (Madhya Pradesh).
- ❑ References to **spectacles** are found in the Sanskrit text “**Vyasayogacharita**”.
- ❑ The Mughals encouraged the use of glass as an ornament in their monuments, such as the **Sheesh Mahal**.
- ❑ Present areas of glass manufacturing include **Hyderabad** (Churi ka Jodas), **Firozabad** (Chandelier and other decorative pieces), and **Saharanpur** (Panchkora glass toy), Patna (**Tikuli**, decorative glass beads) etc.

- **Firozabad glass** has **GI protection**. Firozabad is the only place that produces glass bangles and glassware made through the **mouth blowing technique**.

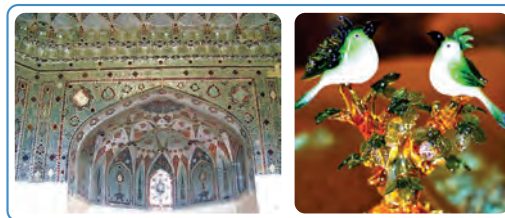


Fig. 4.10: Sheesh Mahal, Panchkora Glass Toys

Ivory Crafting

Ivory carving in India dates back to the **Vedic period**, referred to as ‘**danta**’, indicating **elephant tusks** as the source. During the **Harappan period**, ivory and items like dice made from it were exported to Turkmenistan, Afghanistan, and parts of the Persian Gulf.

- ❑ **Traditional ivory carving centres** include Delhi, Jaipur, and parts of West Bengal, producing items like art objects, caskets, and the **renowned Ambari Hathi**. In addition to this **Painting on ivory** is renowned in **Kerala**, **Jodhpur** specializes in **ivory bangles** and **Jaipur** is celebrated for its **ivory jali work**.

Block Printing in India

Block printing is a form of dying and colouring a fabric using **wooden or metal blocks** to create beautiful designs; sometimes, **linoleum blocks** are also used. India is one of the largest manufacturers and exporters of block-printed fabric in the world. Centres of Block Printing in India are:

Gujarat

- ❑ In Gujarat, this form of hand printing has been practiced and perpetuated by the **Pethapur families**. They make intricate blocks and print their textiles using the **mud-resistant printing method**. These prints are called **Saudagiri (trader) prints**.
- ❑ **Dhamadka village** in Gujarat is known for a block-printed fabric called **Ajrakh**. Ajrakh includes **geometric designs** using natural colours such as red from the madder root, black from a rusty iron solution and blue from indigo.
- ❑ In **Kutch**, the **popular patterns** are **black** and **red designs** of **birds, animals, and dancing girls**.
- ❑ The saris of **Ahmedabad** and **Baroda** have large **mango patterns** against a red or blue background.

Rajasthan

- ❑ The **Chhipa Community** in Rajasthan possesses a majority of block carvers, dyers and printers in India. They make colourful prints of birds, animals, human figures, gods and goddesses.
- ❑ The important centres for hand printing are Jaipur, Bangru, Sanganer, Pali and Barmer.
- ❑ **Sanganer** is famous for its **Calico-printed** bed covers, quilts and saris. In Calico printing, the outlines are first printed, and then the colour is filled in.
- ❑ In **Doo Rookhi printing**, the artists print on both sides of the cloth.
- ❑ **Bagru** (a town in Rajasthan) is famous for its **Syahi-Begar** and **Dabu prints**. The former are designs in black and yellow ochre or cream. The latter are prints in which portions are hidden from the dye by applying a resist paste.

Punjab

The block printing was the art of a group of textile workers called **Chhimba**. The designs were usually floral and geometrical. **Traditional designs** have been **displaced today**, and **chemical ones** have replaced **vegetable dyes**.

GI Registered Stonecraft

State	Craft	Description
Andhra Pradesh	Allagadda Stone Carving	Locally available sandstone is used which is heat resistant and durable. Figurines of Gods and Goddesses are sculpted by strictly following the ancient shilpa shastra manuscripts in the Vijayanagar style.
	Durgi stone carvings	Special type of limestone is used which is native to the region. This craft originated in the 15th century and has flourished since then.

West Bengal

Serampur is the center of block printing. It is well-known for its bold and vibrant patterns.

Andhra Pradesh

The block printing method is applied to create exquisite **Kalamkari Painting**. As the name suggests, Kalamkari is artwork (**Kari**) created with a pen (**kalam**). It is a combination of hand painting and block printing.

- ❑ The two major centers of Kalamkari art are **Srikalahasti** and **Masulipatnam**.
 - **Srikalahasti Kalamkari work**: Here, the themes of **Hindu mythological stories** are painted on the panels, and a script is painted along the border. The popular motifs are Hindu gods and goddesses. The work is done entirely with a **brush-like pen**.
 - **Masulipatnam**: Here, Persian motifs like trees, creepers, flowers and leaf designs are mainly done on bed covers, curtains and garments.

Stone Craft

Stone carving is an ancient art in which pieces of rough natural stone are shaped by the controlled removal of stone. India produces an exquisite range of artistic and decorative stone crafts. The industry evolved from stone carvings for temples and mosques to utility items like candle stands, incense stick holders, jewellery boxes, etc. Stone carving clusters in India are Agra, Bhubaneswar, Puri, Jaisalmer, Cuttack, Cuddapah, Bankura, Kanchipuram, Patna, Mysore, Rajkot, Gwalior, Puducherry, Mahanandi, etc. **South Indian towns** are known for **exceptional stonework**, utilising **sandstone, red stone, and granite**.

- ❑ During the **Mauryan Period**, lifelike sculptures and intricate architectural facades were prominent, as seen in landmarks like the **rock-cut caves** of Ajanta and Ellora, Khajuraho's erotic sculptures, and Buddhist carvings in Sanchi and Bharhut.
- ❑ The **monolithic rock-cut temple at Masrur in the Kangra** district (Himachal Pradesh) stands out as a significant example in hilly regions.
- ❑ In the **Mughal period**, there was a transition from **stone to marble stonework**, with a focus on **Pietra Dura Work**, which involves embedding colourful stones into marble.
- ❑ **Rajasthan** serves as a major hub for sourcing the renowned '**Sang-e-Marmar**' or white **Makrana marble**. Meanwhile, **Jhansi** in Uttar Pradesh specializes in crafting articles from dark brown stone **Sang-e Rathak**.

Odisha	Konark stone carvings	Softstone, redstone and granite have been used for carving. Art dates back to the late 6th century or early 7th century AD.
Tamil Nadu	Mahabalipuram stone carving	Stone sculptures made today are idols from mythologies and deities depicting the divinity.
Uttar Pradesh	Varanasi soft stone jali work	Statues of religious significance, small items of utility and decor are produced.

Toys

The earliest evidence of toy carts can be traced back to the **Harappan civilization**. Archaeological excavations at sites such as **Alamgirpur, Ambikheri, Kalibangan**, and **Lothal** have unearthed models made of copper, bronze, and terracotta. Similar cart models have also been discovered at early historic sites like **Atranjikhhera, Nagarjunakonda, Sambhar, Sonapur, Ujjain**, and **Brahmpuri**.

- ❑ Rajasthan is renowned for **colourful cloth dolls** and **stuffed toys**.
- ❑ Assam's traditional dolls are made from **pith** or **Indian cork**.
- ❑ **Mysore** and **Channapatna** are known for **lacquered wood toys**.
- ❑ **Kondapalli** in Andhra Pradesh is famous for using local **softwood, Ponki**, to create the popular **Ambari Hathi** toy.
- ❑ **Etikoppaka toys** or **Etikoppaka Bommalu**: These are wooden-made toys originating from **Andhra Pradesh**. To protect the wood, they are coated with **lacquer**.
- ❑ Famous **Tirupati dolls** of **Andhra Pradesh** were made of **Redwood**.
- ❑ **Kinnal** (also spelled Kinhal) toys are from **Karnataka**, and date back to the 15th and 16th centuries. The toys **were** patronized by the **kings of the Vijayanagara Empire** and then later by the **nawab of Koppal**.
- ❑ **Laiphadibi dolls** are the traditional **cloth dolls** of the **Meitei** people of **Manipur**.

Leatherwork

The art of **leather tanning** dates back to between **7000 BC and 2000 BC**, with the early use of animal skins like tigers, deer, and later camels.

- ❑ Leather products are produced in several regions, as different regions have different leather products to offer. Tamil Nadu, West Bengal and Uttar Pradesh are the top states in terms of manufacturing (leather products excluding footwear) units.
- ❑ **Rajasthan** is a significant market for leather, mainly camel leather, used to craft various bags.
 - **Jaipur** and **Jodhpur** are renowned for **Mojadis**, specific types of leather footwear.
 - **Bikaner** practices **Manoti Art**, a technique involving the production of **decorative articles** with camel skin.
- ❑ **Kanpur**, in Uttar Pradesh, is famous for its **leather** and **tanned** products.
- ❑ **Maharashtra** is known for its **Kolhapuri chappals**.

- ❑ **Chennai** and **Kolkata** are significant hubs for **leather bags and footwear**.
- ❑ **Punjabi Juttis** are famous for their applique technique, which adds to their beauty.
- ❑ There are many famous types of footwear from different regions like **Ladakh's Paabu Boots, Odisha's Katki Chappal, Punjab's Tilla jutti, Rajasthan's Mojari, West Bengal's Konglan boots** etc

List of GI Registered Leather Craft

State	Craft	Description
Andhra Pradesh	Leather Puppetry	The art goes back to more than 100 years.
Maharashtra	Kolhapuri chappal	These open-toe sandals are made using tanned leather, which is produced using traditional techniques and tools.
Madhya Pradesh	Leather Toys of Indore	The leather toys produced here seem almost lifelike and are moulded in such a way that they appear animated.
West Bengal	Shantiniketan Leather goods	These are famous because of the use of batik, applique, stencilling, modelling and embossed relief work.

Floor Designs

Floor designs, spanning regions and cultures, are a widely cherished art form. These designs are commonly **crafted** during **religious** or **family occasions**. They are usually **created freehand**, using **natural materials and colours**. The choice of materials underscores their **temporary nature** and **easy erasability**, aligning with the art's traditional essence.

- ❑ **Chowkurna (Punjab, Uttar Pradesh)** and **Aipan (Himachal Pradesh)** designs use squares, circles, and triangles as basic motifs.
- ❑ **Mandana (Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh)** features patterns of squares, hexagons, triangles, and circles.
 - The Ground is **coated with cow dung** and finished with crimson red (from mixing reti) for preparation.
- ❑ **Kolam designs** in **South India** link an array of dots made with powdered rice or crushed stone on wet ground. It is also known as **Hase** in **Karnataka**, **Muggulu** in **Andhra Pradesh**, and **Golam** in **Kerala**.
 - **Mandapa Kolams** are large designs exclusively for marriage ceremonies, made with **wet rice paste**.
 - **Graha Kolams** sanctify spaces for worship in households each morning.

□ **Jhonti (Odisha) and Aripana (West Bengal, Assam)** designs feature stylized motifs like conch shells, fish, serpents, and flowers.

- The designs are drawn with chalk powder, and filled with coloured powder or rice paste. Flowers are often placed before each **Aripana design**.

List of Miscellaneous GI Products

State	Product	Description
Gujarat	Agates of Cambay	Agate products include flower vases, ashtrays, bangles, mortar and pestles, necklaces, paperweights etc.
Himachal Pradesh	Kangra Painting	They are painted in small as well as big sizes. The favorite theme of the painter is Rasikpriya by the poet Keshav Das.
	Lahauli Knitted socks and gloves.	The Lahauli socks and gloves are made from indigenous wool sheared from local sheep.
	Chamba Chappal	Chamba Slippers are handcrafted leather made slippers that come in natural leather as well as other colors. Chamba chappals are a tradition that dates back to the times of King Sahil Verman.
Jammu and Kashmir	Kashmiri hand knotted carpet	This is locally known as Kal baffi. It dates back to the 15th century.
Karnataka	Ganjifa cards of Mysore	Ganjifa is a card game believed to have been brought to India from Persia. It became a popular game in India under Mughal emperors.
	Mysore traditional paintings	The distinct school of Mysore paintings evolved from the paintings of Vijayanagara era during the reign of the Vijayanagar kings.
	Navalgund Durries	These are hand woven durries with geometric, bird and animal designs. They are exclusively made by women.
Kerala	Alleppey Coir	Different products like coir mats, rugs, fish nets, plant climbers etc are made of it.
	Maddalam of Palakkad	It is basically a percussion instrument used in Kerala as an accompaniment to temple art forms like Kathakali, Keli etc.
	Screw Pine craft of Kerala	Products include table mats, floor mats, cushion covers, coasters, bags, box covers and wall hanging.
Madhya Pradesh	Bagh Prints	Typically the designs are geometric and are interlaced in such a way that the total effect of the repeating patterns appear harmonious and very attractive.
Maharashtra	Puneri Pagadi	It was introduced in the 19th century by Mahadev Govind Ranade. It is a symbol of pride and honour in the city of Pune.
Manipur	Moirang Phee	This is a traditional fabric which has a specific design called the Moirang Pheejin. Cotton or silk threads are used.
	Wangkhei Phee	This is a traditional product. The method of weaving the fabric is simple and the design is developed without using any implement.
Assam	Muga Silk	This is a wild silk which is not available in any other country in the world.
Bihar	Bhagalpur Silk	It is developed from wild tussar silk.
	Madhubani paintings	This art is practiced in Mithila region of Bihar as well as the adjoining parts of the terai in Nepal.
	Manjusha Paintings	Snake motifs are consistently present, this art form is also referred to as serpent painting. These artworks are crafted on jute boxes and paper.
Jharkhand	Sohrai Khovar Painting	Sohrai Khovar painting represents a traditional and ceremonial form of mural art.
Odisha	Patta Chitra	The theme of these paintings ranges from the episodes from the Krishna's life and the avatars of Vishnu to the epic tales of the Ramayana and Mahabharata.
Goa	Tirukanur Papier Mache Craft	It is made from coarsely meshed paper pulp mixed with copper sulphate and rice flour and then moulded into the desired shape. Touches of the golden color on all the products is an indicative of its roots in Persian design.

Rajasthan	Bagru Hand Block Print and Sangneri Hand Block Printing	The traditional Bagru motifs feature larger sizes and bold lines, whereas in Sangneri motifs, finer lines and subtler colors are employed.
	Kathputlis	The male and female puppets bear strong resemblances to Rajput miniature paintings.
Tamil Nadu	Bhavani Jamakkalam	It is a plain thick durrie.
	Chettinad Kottan	This is a palm leaf basket.
	Pattamadaai Pai	This is a mat woven by the Labbai Muslims using Korai grass.
	Thanjavur doll	Made of plaster of Paris, wood pulp and clay.
	Thanjavur Paintings	Made with the “gem set technique”
	Karuppur Kalamkari Painting	The paintings are intricately made on a cotton cloth using pens or brushes made out of bamboo tree and coconut tree stems.
	Dindigul Lock	Dindigul locks have gained global recognition for their exceptional quality and longevity, to the extent that the city itself is often referred to as Lock City.
Telangana	Cheriyal Paintings	These are painted on Khadi or cotton cloth. These paintings depict the Hindu epics in a narrative format.
	Puttapaka telia rumal	Telia Rumal is a unique tie and dye technique that uses oil for the treatment of the yarn that helps it retain softness and has a distinct smell of gingelly oil. The earlier patterns used to be strictly geometric or vegetal patterns due to the preference of the patrons, but after 1930s the craftsmen started incorporating figurative elements like lions, elephants, birds, clocks and even aeroplanes, which required better weaving skills
Uttar Pradesh	Agra Durrie	It is a thick cotton rug.
	Hand made carpet of Bhadohi	Thick cotton and woollen yarn is used to make these carpets.
	Mirzapur handmade durrie	They are defined essentially by the use of the Panja for weaving and are known for their fairly bold colors and patterns.
	Chunar Glaze pottery	This pottery contains delicate designs made with silver paint. A more elaborate variety is by producing a glossy finish using a special powdery preparation called ‘kabiz.’ This powder is made using the soil taken from rice field
	Mirzapur pital bartan	The “Kasera” community, which produces brass household items, are the custodian of the traditional Mirzapur Pital Bartan industry.
Uttarakhand	Bhotia Dann	It is a rug.
	Uttarakhand Aipan	This is a ritualistic folk art drawn to commemorate auspicious occasions, festivals etc.
	Uttarakhand Tamta	This exquisite craft entailing carving of flowers, petals, creepers, and deity images into copper cooking utensils and vessels, dates back to the 16th century AD.
	Thumla Blanket	A Thulma is a traditional handwoven sheep wool blanket.
	Ringal Craft	It is a bamboo craft.
West Bengal	Purulia Chhau Mask	It is the mask which differentiates the Purulia Chhau from its other two significant branches: the Seraikella Chhau of Jharkhand and the Mayurbhanj Chhau of Odisha. It is the Purulia form only that uses large evocative masks along with elaborate costumes.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

How have Indian handicrafts historically reflected the social hierarchy and caste system?

CONCLUSION

Overall, Handicrafts are profoundly influenced by a multitude of factors including cultural tractions, societal norms, political dynamics and economic conditions. These crafts serve as a catalyst for economic growth, social inclusion, cultural preservation, and sustainable development, making them integral to India’s development narrative.

Dance Forms in India

5

INTRODUCTION

India boasts a vibrant and integral dance tradition with deep roots dating back to ancient times. Abundant evidence, ranging from excavations and inscriptions to chronicles, genealogies of rulers and artists, as well as literary sources, sculptures, and paintings from different eras, attests to the rich legacy of dance. The Vedas, among the earliest literary works, laid the foundation for dance and music, providing the initial references. A more coherent narrative of the history of dance emerges from epics, various Puranas, and the extensive body of dramatic and poetic literature in Sanskrit, known as **Nataka** and **Kavya**.

Dances are generally classified into **Classical and Folk**. Different parts of India have imbibed in them the local traditions and have evolved a particular dance form in its region.

CLASSIC INDIAN DANCE FORMS

Classical Indian Dance, rooted in the classical periods of Indian culture, is a dance form often accompanied by classical music. It is characterized by intricate costumes, opulent sets, and expressive movements.

Bharat Muni's Natya Shastra

Natya Shastra played a crucial role in shaping the foundations of classical dances like Bharatanatyam, Kathak, Odissi, and others.

- ❑ It is the **earliest known treatise** on dance, encompassing **drama, dance, and music**.
- ❑ It was composed between the 2nd century BC and the 2nd century AD and is often regarded as the **fifth Veda (Natya Veda)**.
- ❑ It describes the techniques, postures, emotions, ornaments, stage and audience.
- ❑ It integrates elements from various Vedas, combining **Pathya** (words) from the **Rig Veda**, **Abhinaya** (gestures) from the **Yajur Veda**, **Geet** (music) from the **Sam Veda** and **Rasa** (emotions) from the **Atharva Veda**.

Aspects of Dance

Bharata and **Nandikesvara** view dance as art using the human body as a vehicle of expression.

- ❑ As per the **Natya Shastra**, there are **two primary aspects** of Indian classical dance:

- **Tandava**: It represents **male aspects** of dance which places more emphasis on **rhythm** and **movement**.
- **Lasya**: It represents **female aspects**, denoting **grace, bhava, rasa** and **abhinaya**.



Fig. 5.1: Navarasas, the nine emotions of Indian classical dance

Abhinaya encompasses expression through **angika** (body and limbs), **vachika** (song and speech), **aharya** (costume and adornment), and **satvika** (moods and emotions).

Tandava aspect of dance: The Tandava dance is an ancient form of Indian classical dance believed to have originated from Lord Shiva's cosmic dance. The dance is characterized by powerful movements, quick footwork, and a fierce expression on the face. It is also believed to represent the five elements of nature – earth, water, fire, air, and space.

- ❑ The Natyashastra provides a detailed description of the Tandava dance and its various elements, including hand gestures, footwork, and facial expressions.
- ❑ Approximately seven different types of Tandava dances are discussed in the ancient scriptures: Sandhya, Kalika, Ananda, Tripura, Gauri, Samhara, and Uma.
- ❑ The **Mahabharata** mentions another magnificent instance of the Tandava dance, which took place when Krishna defeated Kalia Nag in the Yamuna River. He played the flute and performed the tandava dance on top of Kalia.

Lasya aspect of dance: Lasya is a vital aspect of classical Indian dance, embodying the feminine aesthetic and expressing a wide range of emotions and narratives through graceful movements and expressions.

- According to **Abhinaya Darpan** (treatise on dance by **Nandikeshwara**), dance is considered to have three aspects:
 - **Natya** emphasizes the **dramatic element**.
 - **Nritya** is **expressive**, conveying the meaning of a theme or idea.
 - **Nritta** is **pure dance**, devoid of mood or meaning.

To present nritya and natya effectively, dancers must communicate the **Navarasas**. Navarasas include- delight (**shringar**), hasya (**laughter**) compassion (**karuna**), valour (**veera**), anger (**raudra**), fear (**bhayanak**), disgust (**bibhatsa**), wonder (**adbhuta**) and peace (**shaanta**).

Eight Classical Dance Forms in India

As per **Sangeet Natak Academy**, there are **8 classical dance forms** in India. However, the **Ministry of Culture** has identified **9 classical dance forms**, including **Chhau dance** of Eastern India.

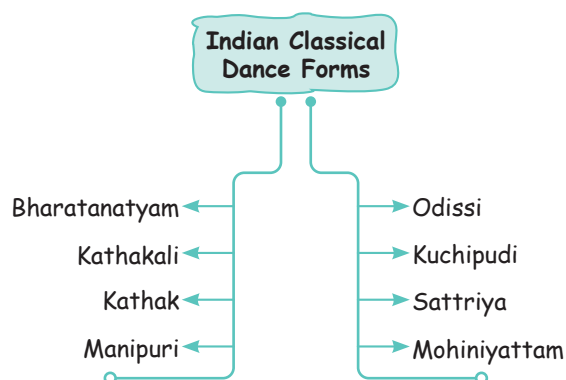


Fig. 5.2: Indian Classical Dance Forms

Bharatanatyam (Tamil Nadu)

Bharatanatyam dance is considered to be over 2000 years old. Several texts provide information on this dance form.

- **Bharata Muni's Natya Shastra** (200 BC to 200 AD) is the first text to mention this dance form.
- The **Abhinaya Darpana** by **Nandikesvara** is one of the main sources of textual material, for the study of the technique and grammar of body movement in Bharatanatyam Dance.



Fig. 5.3: Bharatanatyam

- There is also a great deal of visual evidence of this dance form in paintings and stone and metal sculptures of ancient times.
 - On the gopurams of the **Chidambaram temple**, one can see a series of Bharatanatyam poses, frozen in stone, as it were, by the sculptor.

In the early 19th century, the **Tanjore Quartette** (Ponnayya, Chinnayya, Sivananda, Vadivelu), supported by **Raja Serfoji**, shaped the contemporary Bharatanatyam repertoire. Thus, it is also known as **Tanjore Natyam**.

- It is a **solo dance** where the dancer expresses the **Sahitya** through **movement** and **mime**.
- It is also performed in **Ekaharya style**, where **one dancer performs multiple roles** in a single performance.

Legacy of Devadasis: Devadasis, **girls gifted to temples** and **married to deities**, performed **Bharatanatyam** with offerings in temple courtyards.

Performance Structure

- The performance begins with an **invocation** to the Gods.
- **Alarippu** (to adorn with flowers): It is the **first item** in the performance that blends **pure dance** with the recitation of sound syllables.
- **Jatiswaram** is a short, pure dance piece set to Carnatic music's raga. It lacks **sahitya (words)** and consists of **adavus**, which are pure dance sequences (**nritta**).
- **Shabdham**, which follows the Jatiswaram, is the dramatic element expressed through words.
- **Varnam** is performed next, encompassing **both nritta and nritya** elements. The dancer executes **complex rhythmic patterns** at two speeds, demonstrating rhythmic mastery.
- **Abhinaya** is then used to depict **sahitya lines**, showcasing the **dancer's abhinaya skills** and the **choreographer's creativity**.
 - Common pieces include **Keertanam** (emphasises text), **Kritis** (emphasises music), **Padams**, and **Javalis**. **Keertanam and Kritis** have a **devotional context**, whereas Padams and **Javalis** revolve around themes of love.
- **Tillana:** It **concludes** the performance. It is a vibrant dance accompanied by a musical syllable with a few lines of **Sahitya**.
- The performance wraps up with a **mangalam**, invoking divine blessings.

Features

- Most of the movements in Bharatanatyam resemble a dancing flame. Thus, it is called a '**fire dance**'.
- Equal emphasis is given on the **Tandava** and **Lasya** aspects, with significant emphasis on '**mudras**'.
 - One of the principal mudras is '**Kataka Mukha Hasta**' (three fingers are joined to symbolise '**Om**').

- ❑ While performing, dancers typically **maintain bent knees** and evenly distribute their weight across both feet.
- ❑ The accompaniment includes a **vocalist, mridangam player, violinist** or **veena player, flautist**, and **cymbal player**.
- ❑ The **Nattuvanar** conducts the **dance recitation, coordinating the performance**.

In Bharatanatyam, **Arangetram** refers to the debut performance of a dancer, marking the **completion of their training** and the beginning of their career as a professional dancer.

Famous proponents of Bharatanatyam: Yamini Krishnamurthy, Lakshmi Viswanathan, Padma Subramaniam, Mrinalini Sarabhai, Mallika Sarabhai, Rukmini Devi Arundale etc.

Kathakali (Kerala)

Kathakali, a popular contemporary dance form, is believed to have originated relatively recently. However, it draws its roots from various social and religious theatrical traditions that thrived in the southern region during ancient times. It is also called the **'Ballad of the East.'**



Fig. 5.4: Kathakali

- ❑ The recitals represent the **eternal conflict between good and evil**.
- ❑ The language used for Kathakali songs is **Manipravalam**, which is a **mixture of Malayalam and Sanskrit**.
- ❑ It has evolved from various **social and religious theatrical forms** of ancient Kerala, including **Chakiarkoothu, Koodiyattam, Krishnattam**, and **Ramanattam**.

Artistic Fusion

- ❑ Kathakali synthesises **dance, music, acting**, and **storytelling**, primarily adapted from Indian epics. It combines the four aspects of **abhinaya**.
- ❑ Dancers communicate using **codified hasta mudras** (hand gestures) and **facial expressions**, following the **sung verses** (Padams).
- ❑ Textual guidance for Kathakali is found in the **Balarama Bharatam** and **Hastalakshana Deepika**.
- ❑ Kathakali stories, known as **Attakkathas**, are drawn from epics and myths.

Visual Art and Makeup: Costume and makeup are elaborate and aim to create a **superhuman effect**, adhering to **Natya Shastra** guidelines.

Detailed facial make-up, along with headgear, is used for different characters. A mixture of **rice paste and lime** is applied to create the **chutti**, a distinctive **white facial makeup**.

Green symbolizes nobility, divinity, and virtue, while **red** patches near the nose denote royalty. **Black** represents evil, while **yellow** is reserved for saints and female characters. A **white** beard signifies beings with elevated consciousness and divine qualities. A **fully red face** typically conveys the portrayal of evil characters.

Characteristics

- ❑ The characters in a Kathakali performance are broadly divided into **satvika, rajasika** and **tamasika** types. Apart from these, there are minor characters like **minukku** which are the women and sages.
- ❑ A **simple stage** is used with a **large oil-fed lamp** in front. Two people hold a **curtain** called **Tirasseeela** on the stage.
- ❑ Kathakali **employs the entire body** extensively, including **facial muscles, fingers, eyes, hands** and **wrists**. The weight of the body is placed on the outer edges of the feet, which are slightly bent and curved.
 - No other dance style uses the **movement** of the **eyebrows**, the **eyeballs** and the **lower eyelids** as done in Kathakali.

Kalasams in Kathakali are **pure dance sequences** allowing the actor to showcase their skills, featuring **leaps, quick turns, jumps**, and **rhythmic coordination**.

Performance Structure

- ❑ It is essentially an **all-male troupe** performance. It is generally performed in **open-air theatres** (symbolising the **element of sky**).
- ❑ It is done in the **evening**, accompanied by a continuous sound of drums, **chhenda** and **maddala**.
- ❑ The performance begins with **Kelikottu**, a call to the audience's attention, followed by the **Todayam**, a devotional number to seek God's blessing.
- ❑ It is followed by **Purappadu**, a **pure nritta piece**, and the musicians and drummers entertain with **Melappada**, demonstrating their skills.
- ❑ **Tiranokku** marks the **debut of all characters** on the stage other than **Minukku**.
- ❑ Next is **Ilakiattam**, where characters display their excellence in abhinaya.
- ❑ Throughout the performance, the dancers engage in **Chodiattam** i.e. acting following the **padams** sung by musicians.

Music and Orchestra

- ❑ Kathakali music follows the traditional **Sopana sangeet** of Kerala, which is the ritual singing of the **Ashtapadis** on the flight of steps leading to the **sanctum sanctorum**.

Ancient Depictions and Martial Arts Influence

- ❑ **Temple sculptures** in Kerala and frescoes from the **16th-century Mattancheri temple** display dance scenes featuring the **square** and **rectangular basic positions**.
- ❑ The dancer's body **movements** and **choreographic patterns** draw inspiration from **Kalaripayattu** (Kerala's early martial arts).

- ❑ It has also incorporated **Carnatic ragas** and **talas**.
- ❑ The orchestra includes instruments like **Chenda**, **Maddalam**, **Chengila**, **Ilathalam**, **Idakka**, and **Shankhu**.

Kathakali was revived in the 1930s by the famous Malayali poet **V. N. Menon** under the patronage of **Mukunda Raja**. Its **famous proponents** are Guru Kunchu Kurup, Guru Gopi Nath, Kottakal Sivaraman, Rita Ganguly, etc.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

Classical dance is an important cultural heritage that deserves to be preserved and promoted. Mention some of the steps taken by the government and suggest some innovative steps for its preservation. What role can the diaspora play in propagating these classical dances?

Kathak (Uttar Pradesh)

Initially, it began as an **oral tradition**, where **Kathakars narrated stories** based on epics, myths, and legends. Later, to enhance the storytelling, mime and gestures were added.

- ❑ The rise of the **Vaishnavite cult** and the **Bhakti movement** added a new range of lyrics and musical forms to it.
- ❑ **Raslila** (combined elements of music, dance and narrative), primarily in the **Braj region** (Western UP), provides an extension of the **basic mime** and **gestures** of the Kathakars.
- ❑ **Mughal Influence:**
 - Under the Mughals, it gradually shifted from the **temple courtyard** to the **royal court** (darbar).
 - It became highly stylised and was viewed as a form of entertainment. It acquired its present features and developed into a dance form with a distinctive style.



Fig. 5.5: Kathak

- There was **greater emphasis on nritya** (expression) and **bhava** (mood), adding **grace**, **expressiveness**, and **sensuality** to the dance.
- **Persian costumes** and **styles** of dancing also influenced it.

- ❑ The 19th century marked the **golden age of Kathak** under the patronage of **Nawab Wajid Ali Shah** (Lucknow Gharana).

Performance Structure

- ❑ The **technique** involves equal **body weight distribution** along the **horizontal** and **vertical axis**.
- ❑ The basic stance involves a **straight posture** with one hand held higher than the head and the other extended at shoulder level. There are **no deflections** or use of **sharp bends** or curves of the body.



Fig. 5.6: Birju Maharaj

- ❑ It employs a sophisticated system of **footwork**, emphasising pure dance (nritya).
 - **Full-foot contact** is of prime importance, where only the **toe** or the ball of the **foot** are used, their function is limited.
 - There are no deflections and no use of sharp bends or curves of the upper or lower part of the body.
- ❑ The performance commences with "**Thaat**," introducing **soft gliding movements of the neck, eyebrows**, and **wrists**.
- ❑ This is followed by a formal entry called "**Amad**" (entry) and "**Salami**" (salutation).
- ❑ To recite **rhythmic syllables**, the **dancers pause** before executing corresponding movements.
- ❑ **Rhythmic Structure and Music.**
 - The **nritya** portion of Kathak is performed to the "**nagma**."
 - **Jugalbandi** is the competitive play between the **dancer** and the **tabla player** (playing the **pakhawaj**).
- ❑ **Mime Portions (Nritya or Abhinaya):** These are **short narrative pieces** portraying **episodes from Krishna's life** accompanied by **Dhrupad** music. Other numbers include **thumri**, **bhajan**, and **Dadra**, featuring poetic lines set to music and interpreted with gestures.

Kathak's Unique Identity

- ❑ It is the **only classical dance** form having links with **Muslim culture** and is deeply rooted in **Hindustani or North Indian music**.
- ❑ **Kathak** and **Hindustani music** have grown in parallel, mutually influencing each other.

Famous proponents of Kathak: Birju Maharaj, Lacchu Maharaj, Sitara Devi, Damayanti Joshi, etc.

Manipuri (Manipur)

The dance is associated with rituals and traditional festivals, there are legendary references to the dances of **Shiva** and **Parvati** and other gods and goddesses who created the universe.



Fig. 5.7: Manipuri Dance

- ❑ It was in the reign of King Bhagyachandra that the popular Rasleela dances of Manipur originated.
- ❑ Manipuri dance gained prominence with the arrival of **Vaishnavism in the 15th century**.
- ❑ **Rabindranath Tagore** revived the dance form by introducing it in Santiniketan.

Characteristics

- ❑ The dance themes of Manipuri often revolve around the **stories of Gopis, Radha & Krishna**.
- ❑ **Costume:** Includes an embroidered **stiff skirt**, a delicate **white muslin skirt**, a dark **velvet blouse**, and a traditional **white veil**.
 - Krishna's attire includes a **yellow dhoti**, a dark **velvet jacket**, and a **peacock feather crown**.
- ❑ It incorporates **masculine** and **feminine aspects**. The **masculine aspect** of dance – the **Choloms** are a part of the **Sankirtana tradition**. Male dancers play the **Pung** and **Kartal** instruments during Sankirtana.
- ❑ The **rhythmic complexities are usually overlooked** as the dancers **do not** wear **ankle bells** to stamp out the rhythms.
- ❑ It includes an essential posture **Naga Bandha mudra**, in which the body is connected through curves in the **shape of '8'**.
- ❑ The primary musical instruments are the **Pung** (or the **Manipuri classical drum**), **Pena** (a stringed instrument), **cymbals**, and **flutes** that accompany vocal singing.

Ras, Sankirtana, and Thang-Ta are influenced by Manipuri dance.

- ❑ There are **five principal Ras** dances of which four are linked with specific seasons, while the fifth can be presented at any time of the year.
- ❑ In Manipuri Ras, the main characters are **Radha, Krishna and the gopis**.
- ❑ **Sankirtana**, a congregational singing in the form of Kirtan, accompanies the dance.
- ❑ Sankirtana is a **song and dance** performance.
- ❑ It is performed to narrate the **life and deeds of Lord Krishna**.
- ❑ **Thang-Ta** (the martial art dance tradition): Dancers use swords, spears, and shields to depict real fight scenes.

Famous proponents: Jhaveri sisters- Nayana, Suverna, Ranjana and Darshana, Guru Bipin Singha, etc.

Odissi (Odisha)

The Natya Shastra mentions the **Odhra Magadha style** as a precursor of modern Odissi.



Fig. 5.8: Odissi

- ❑ Odissi is known for its **sensuous** and **lyrical nature**, blending **themes of love, passion, and divinity**.
- ❑ It symbolises the **element of water**.
- ❑ Earlier, **Maharis** (originally temple dancers) were the **custodians** of Odissi, but the dance form **later degenerated** due to **royal court employment**.
- ❑ **Gotipuas** (young boys dressed as females) were trained in the dance form. They danced in the temples and also for general entertainment.

Evidence and Evolution

- ❑ Archaeological evidence was found in the **caves of Udayagiri and Khandagiri** (near Bhubaneswar, Odisha).
- ❑ **The Sun Temple at Konarak** showcases dance movements in its **Natya mandap** (Hall of Dance).

Key Movement and Techniques

- ❑ It is **similar** to **Bharatnatyam** in using Mudras and postures to express emotions.
 - It is known as '**mobile sculpture**' as the dancers create intricate **geometrical shapes** and patterns with their bodies.
 - The '**Tribhanga posture**', i.e. the **three-bended** form of the body, is innate to this dance form.
- ❑ The movements are centred around the **Chowk** (masculine) and the **Tribhanga** (feminine) postures.
 - **Chowk** resembles a square with a balanced body weight.
 - **Tribhanga** displays deflection at the neck, torso, and knees.
- ❑ **Leg movements** follow **spiral or circular patterns** in the air or on the ground, showcasing the dance's intricacy and precision.
- ❑ **Hand gestures** play a dual role: **Decorative embellishments** in **nritya** and a **means of communication** in **nritya**.

Performance Structures

Odissi follows a **systematic order of presentation**, ensuring the desired emotional expression (rasa).

- ❑ **Mangalacharan (Invocation):** The **performance commences** with **Mangalacharan**, where the dancer enters with flowers and offers them to the earth. The item concludes with a **nritya sequence** featuring salutations to God, the Guru, and the audience.

- ❑ **Batu (Basic Dance):** It follows the **fundamental nritta technique**, emphasising the **duality of the masculine and feminine**. It is performed in praise of **Batukeshwar Bhairav** or **Shiva**.
- ❑ **Pallavi (Ornamentation):** It is the **flowering and ornamentation** of music and movements. The dance builds into intricate patterns, highlighting **rhythmic variations** within the **tala structure**.
- ❑ **Abhinaya (Emotive Storytelling):** Dancers also perform from the compositions of **Jayadeva, Upendra Bhanja** and **Gopal Krishna**.

Ashtapadis of Jayadeva's **Gita Govinda** are performed in Odissi. It exemplifies **nayaka-nayika bhava** (hero-heroine sentiment) and poetic richness.

- ❑ **Moksha (Liberation):** It is a **concluding item** consisting of multiple **Pallavi** sections and **Abhinaya-based** items.
- ❑ **Music and Costume**
 - An Odissi orchestra includes a **pakhawaj player** (often the Guru), a **singer**, a **flutist**, a **sitar** or **violin** player, and a **Manjira** player. It is accompanied by **Hindustani classical music**.
 - Odissi dancers carry on the tradition of **devadasis** or **maharis**, aiming for liberation (moksha) through dance, reaffirming the art's spiritual connection.

Famous proponents: Guru Pankaj Charan Das, Guru Kelu Charan Mohapatra, Sonal Mansingh etc.

Kuchipudi (Andhra Pradesh)

The dance form derives its name from the **Andhra village** of **Kuchelapuram**. It was originally performed by a group of actors **going from village to village**, known as **Kusselavas**.



Fig. 5.9: Kuchipudi

- ❑ It symbolises the **element of earth**.
- ❑ It remained confined to villages till the **nineteenth century**, when **Balasaraswati** and **Ragini Devi** revived this dance form.
- ❑ In the 17th century, **Siddhendra Yogi**, a **Vaishnava poet**, introduced the **Kuchipudi style of Yakshagaana** and composed **Bhaamaakalaapam**. He trained young **Brahmin boys** from Kuchipudi village to perform his compositions.
- ❑ In 1675 AD, **Abdul Hasan Tanishah** (Nawab of Golconda) granted the village of Kuchipudi as an **Agrahaarama** to Brahmin families who pursued this art.
- ❑ By the **mid-20th century**, it emerged as a **distinct solo classical** dance style.
- ❑ Thus, now there are two forms of Kuchipudi: the **traditional musical dance-drama** and the **solo dance**.

- Solo dance includes **Manduka Shabdham** (story of a frog), **Jala Chitra Nrityam** (the dancer draws pictures on the floor with his or her toes while dancing) etc.
- Dancers occasionally speaking dialogues are found in Kuchipudi dance but not in Bharatanatyam.

Structure of a Kuchipudi Solo Recital

- ❑ The recitals are based on stories of **Bhagwata Purana** but have a **secular theme**.
- ❑ There is a predominance of **Shringara ras**.
- ❑ The performance has **Sollakath or Patakshara** (Nritta part, where body movement is made) and **Kavutvams** (Nritya part involving extensive acrobatics).
- ❑ **Performance structure:**
 - The dance begins by invoking Gods, followed by **nritta**, involving non-narrative and abstract dancing, often featuring the **jatiswaram**.
 - Next is **shabdham**, a narrative performance with favourites like "**Dashaavataara**."
 - A Natya number succeeds the narrative section like the **entry of Satyabhama** from "**Bhaamaakalaapam**."
 - The recital then transitions to a pure **nritya-abhinaya**, involving literary and musical forms like **padam**, **jaavli**, and **shlokam**.
 - The performance usually concludes with **Tarangam**, where excerpts from **Krishna-leela-tarangini** are sung.
 - ❑ Standing on a **brass plate**, the dancer locks the feet in **shakata-vadanam paada** and **balancing a pitcher of water** on the head, displays acrobatic skills.

❑ Music

- Kuchipudi dance is accompanied by **classical Carnatic music**.
- A **mridangam** player for percussion, a **violin** or **veena** player, and a cymbal player conducts the orchestra and recites the "**sollukattus**" (rhythm syllables).

Famous Proponents: Radha Reddy and Raja Reddy, Yamini Krishnamurthy, Indrani Rehman etc.

Sattriya (Assam)



Fig. 5.10: Sattriya

It originated during the **15th century AD** through the efforts of **Sankaradeva**, to promote the **Vaishnava faith**. The songs are compositions of **Shankaradeva**, known as '**Borgeets**'.

- ❑ The neo-Vaishnava treasure of Assamese dance and drama has been nurtured and preserved by the **Vaishnava maths**, also known as **Sattras**.
 - This dance style has been aptly named **Sattriya** because of its **religious character** and **association** with the Sattras.
- ❑ There were **two dance forms** prevalent in Assam before the neo-Vaishnava movement - **Ojapali** and **Devadasi**.
- ❑ It also drew inspiration from various **Assamese folk dances**, such as **Bihu** and **Bodos**, incorporating shared hand gestures and rhythmic syllables.
- ❑ Sattriya is a combination of music, dance and drama.
- ❑ It is a centuries-old living tradition of Vaishnavites of Assam.

Features

- ❑ It combines **music**, **dance**, and **drama**, which are performed in groups by **male monks** known as '**Bhokots**' as part of their daily rituals or even on festivals.
- ❑ Sattriya dance leans heavily on singing and dancing, with minimal emphasis on speech and dialogue.
- ❑ **Khol** (drum), **Cymbals** (Manjira) and **flute** are the primary instruments used.



Fig. 5.11: Khol and Cymbal

- ❑ **Costumes:**
 - '**Dhoti**' and '**Paguri**' (turban) are worn by male dancers.
 - Females wear traditional Assamese jewellery, '**Ghuri**' and '**Chador**' made in Pat silk.
- ❑ It combines both **Lasya** and **Tandava** elements.
- ❑ The dance adheres to **well-defined principles** governing **hasta mudras**, **footwork**, **aharyas** (costumes), and **music**.
- ❑ The tradition encompasses two distinct streams:
 - **Bhaona** - It is a related repertoire starting from the **Gayan-Bhayanar Nach** to the **Kharmanar Nach**.
 - **Chali**, **Rajagharia Chali**, **Jhumura**, **Nadu Bhangi** etc, which are independent dance numbers. **Chali** is characterised by grace and elegance, while **Jhumura** exudes vigour and majestic beauty.

Famous proponents: Jatin Goswami, Ghanakanta Bora, Krishnakshi Kashyap, etc.

Ankiya Naat

The performances of Shankaradeva's dramas are known popularly as Ankiya naat or **Ankiya bhaona**.



Fig. 5.12: Ankiya Naat

- ❑ The Ankiya naat was created for the **propagation of Bhakti**.
- ❑ Credit for the creation of Ankiya Naat is commonly given to **Srimanta Sankardeva**, a medieval saint and advocate of social reform.
- ❑ It is a theatre form combining **nritta**, **nritya** and **natya**.
- ❑ The dramas were composed in a synthetic language blending Assamese and Maithili known as **Brajavali**.
- ❑ A specific rendition of an Ankiya Naat is termed a **Bhaona**.
- ❑ These performances typically integrate live musicians, vocalists, dance, and intricate costumes.

Mohiniyattam (Kerala)

It is a classical **solo dance form** named after '**Mohini**', the celestial enchantress in Hindu mythology. It symbolises the **element of air**.



Fig. 5.13:

Mohiniyattam

- ❑ **Historical References:** **Vyavaharamala** (by **Mazhamagalam Narayanan Namputiri**) and **Ghoshayatra** (by poet **Kunjan Nambiar**).
- ❑ **Maharaja Kartika Tirunal** and **Maharaja Swati Tirunal of Travancore** (18th-19th century AD) structured the dance into its present-day classical format.
- ❑ The **Nangiars**, women from the **Nambiar community**, still preserve this tradition by performing within temple precincts.

The dance's **origin** is associated with a **Puranic story**, where **Lord Vishnu** assumed the form of **Mohini** to **seduce Asuras** during the churning of the ocean and the slaying of **Bhasmasura**.

Features

- ❑ It combines the grace and elegance of Bharatnatyam with the vigour of Kathakali.
- ❑ It is characterised by **graceful**, **delicate body movements** without abrupt jerks or leaps and **subtle facial expressions**.
 - It belongs to the **lasya style**, emphasising **femininity**, **tenderness**, and **grace**.
 - **Footwork** is rendered **softly** and **without thumping**.

- ❑ Emphasis is placed on **hand gestures** and **Mukhabhinaya**, involving subtle facial expressions.
 - Gestures are borrowed from texts like **Hastalakshana Deepika**, **Natya Shastra**, **Abhinaya Darpana**, and **Balarambharatam**.
- ❑ **Closeness to Natural and Realistic Expressions:** Gestures and facial expressions are more aligned with natural (**gramya**) and realistic (**lokadharmi**) styles, as **opposed to dramatic** or rigidly conventional (**natyadharmi**).
- ❑ **Costume:** **White** and **off-white** saree with **gold-coloured brocade** designs.
- ❑ There is **no elaborate facial make-up**, and the dancer wears a leather strap with bells (**Ghungroo**) on her ankles.
- ❑ **'Atavakul or Atavus'** is a collection of forty basic dance movements.
- ❑ **Musical instruments** are cymbals, veena, drums, flute, etc.
- ❑ **Famous proponents:** Sunanda Nair, Kalamandalam Kshemavathy, Madhuri Amma, Jayaprabha Menon etc.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

Explore the influence of Vaishnavism and Shaivism on the development of distinct dance styles.

IMPORTANT FOLK DANCES OF INDIA

Folk dances are typically impromptu, rudimentary, and performed by the general public without formal training. These regional dances are influenced by mythology, tales, and folklore. Some of the famous folk dances are discussed below.

Chhau

- ❑ Chhau dance is a tradition from eastern India that enacts episodes from epics, including the **Mahabharata** and **Ramayana**, local folklore and abstract themes.
- ❑ Its three distinct styles hail from the regions of **Seraikella (Jharkhand)**, **Purulia (West Bengal)** and **Mayurbhanj (Odisha)**, the first two using masks.



Fig. 5.14: Chhau Dance

- ❑ Chhau dance is intimately connected to regional festivals, notably the spring festival **Chaitra Parva**.

- ❑ Its origin is traceable to indigenous forms of **dance and martial** practices.
- ❑ The dance is performed at night in an open space to traditional and folk melodies, played on the reed pipes **mohuri** and **shehnai**.
- ❑ It was included in the **List of Intangible Cultural Heritage by UNESCO**.

Garba

- ❑ A ritualistic and devotional dance of Gujarat, **Garba** is particularly celebrated for nine days during the festival of Navratri.
- ❑ The festival is dedicated to the worship of the **feminine energy or Shakti**.
- ❑ **UNESCO** has inscribed the popular Gujarati folk dance Garba on its **Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity**.

Kalbelia

- ❑ Kalbelia dance is performed by the women of Kalbelia community of **Rajasthan**.
- ❑ Women in flowing black skirts dance and swirl, replicating the movements of a serpent, while men accompany them on the **khanjari** percussion instrument and the **poongi**, a **woodwind instrument** traditionally played to capture snakes.
- ❑ Traditional Kalbelia songs and dances were included by UNESCO in the **Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity in 2010**.



Fig. 5.15: Kalbelia

Tarangamel

- ❑ This dance form belongs to the state of **Goa**.
- ❑ It is performed by the young generation on the occasions of **Dussehra** and **Shigmo festival on Holi**.

Bhangra and Giddha

- ❑ Punjab is the birthplace of **Bhangra**, a style of traditional Indian dance.
- ❑ The dance was mostly associated with **Baisakhi**, the **spring harvest celebration**.
- ❑ In Punjab, women perform a folk dance called **Giddha**.
- ❑ Women stand in a circle formation and clap rhythms, unlike Bhangra, **Dhol is not required in Giddha**.

Bihu

- ❑ The Bihu dance is an indigenous folk dance from the Indian state of **Assam** that is linked to the **Bihu** festival.



Fig. 5.16: Bihu

- ❑ The Bihu dance style is typified by **quick hand motions and brisk steps**, and it is typically performed by young men and women in groups.

Sankirtana

- ❑ Sankirtana encompasses an array of arts performed to mark religious occasions and various stages in the life of the Vaishnava people of the **Manipur plains**.
- ❑ Performers narrate the lives and deeds of **Krishna** through song and dance.
- ❑ In a typical performance, two drummers and about ten singer-dancers perform in a hall or domestic courtyard encircled by seated devotees.
- ❑ It was added to the List of **intangible cultural heritage by UNESCO in 2013**.

Mudiyettu

- ❑ Mudiyettu is a ritual dance drama from **Kerala** based on the mythological tale of a battle between the **goddess Kali and the demon Darika**.
- ❑ Mudiyettu is performed annually in '**Bhagavati Kavus**', the temples of the goddess, in different villages along the rivers **Chalakkudy Puzha, Periyar and Moovattupuzha**.
- ❑ It was added to the List of **intangible cultural heritage by UNESCO in 2010**.

Paika

- ❑ This is a martial folk dance that belongs to the state of **Odisha**.
- ❑ The dancers carry shields and wooden spears.
- ❑ This dance is related to the **Munda** tribe.

Thang ta



Fig. 5.17: Thang ta

- ❑ This is a martial dance from the state of **Manipur**.
- ❑ Swords, spears and shields are used by the dancers.
- ❑ Actual fight sequences between the dancers demonstrate their advanced physical training and mastery.

Singhi Chham

- ❑ Singhi Chham is a folk dance from the state of **Sikkim**.
- ❑ It is particularly connected to Sikkim's **Bhutia** community.
- ❑ Dancers wear lion costumes to depict the snow lion.
- ❑ It is performed to express gratitude to **Kanchenjunga** mountain.

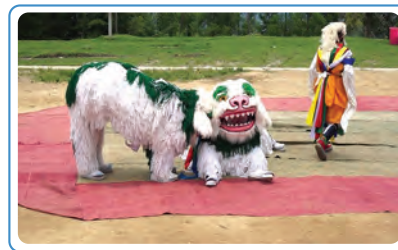


Fig. 5.18: Singhi Chham

Cheraw Dance

- ❑ This folk dance belongs to the state of **Mizoram**.
- ❑ This dance form is popularly known as **Bamboo dance** which is performed by both men and women.
- ❑ Men hold the bamboos and the women dance between the bamboos.



Fig. 5.19: Cheraw Dance

Rangma Dance

- ❑ This dance form belongs to the state of **Nagaland**.
- ❑ This dance symbolizes the culture of **warfare of Nagas**.
- ❑ The dancers use rhythmic movements to the beat of a drum while dressing like warriors.



Fig. 5.20: Rangma Dance

Ghoomar or Gangore

- ❑ This dance form belongs to the state of **Rajasthan**.
- ❑ It is performed by the women of the **Bhil tribe**.
- ❑ The dance is mostly performed by veiled ladies wearing ghagras.

Jat-Jatin

- ❑ This is the folk dance of **Bihar**.
- ❑ This is performed as a duet and deals with socially and emotionally charged topics.

Bidesia

- ❑ Bidesia dance is a popular dance drama performed in the **Bhojpuri-speaking belt of Bihar**.
- ❑ The topics dealt with are mainly contradictory in nature — like tradition and modernity, urban-rural divide, rich and poor etc.
- ❑ Female parts are performed by male actor-dancers.

Tippani

This folk dance is popular in the Saurashtra and coastal regions of **Gujarat** and performed as a means to unwind after a hard day's labour.

Rouf

Practiced during **Eid and Ramazan in Jammu and Kashmir** — is performed by a row of women facing each other and dancing away to intricate footwork.

Yakshagana



Fig. 5.21: Yakshagana

- ❑ This is the folk dance of **Karnataka**.
- ❑ This is a folk theatre form that combines dance music, dialogue, costume and music and is traditionally presented from dusk to dawn.

Butta Bommalu

- ❑ This dance form belongs to **Andhra Pradesh**.
- ❑ It is also known as the Mask Dance, as dancers wear the masks of different characters.

Lavani

- ❑ This is a traditional **Maharashtrian** dance performed by women clad in a nine-yard-length sari to the beats of a dholak.
- ❑ It has been used for social commentary, entertainment and for boosting the morale of the soldiers.

Danda Jatra

- ❑ This folk dance is mainly popular in **Odisha**.
- ❑ This is one of the oldest folk dances of India.
- ❑ It mainly narrates stories about **Lord Shiva**.
- ❑ It is a unique blend of dance, drama and music.

Burra Katha

- ❑ It is a dance form which belongs to the state of **Andhra Pradesh**.
- ❑ The troupe consists of one main performer and two co-performers.
- ❑ It is a narrative entertainment that consists of prayers, solo drama, dance, songs, poems and jokes.

Gaur Maria

- ❑ This folk dance is performed in the Bastar region of **Chhattisgarh**.
- ❑ The dance imitates the movements of a bison and is performed in group by both men and women.

Bathukamma and Bonalu

- ❑ These are the folk dances of **Telangana**.
- ❑ Bathukamma is performed by women during the **Bathukamma festival**.
- ❑ Bonalu is performed by women by balancing pots on their heads.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

Explain how folk dances play an important role in the preservation of diversity and promotion of collective consciousness in the community?

State Wise Folk Dances of India

- ❑ **ANDHRA PRADESH:** Dhimsa, Kolattam, Butta Bommalu.
- ❑ **ARUNACHAL PRADESH:** Ponung (harvest dance performed by Adi tribe), Tapu Dance (war dance performed by only males during the festival of Aran), Pakku Itu (Apatani tribe; depicts the games played between birds and children engaged to protect the seedlings), Rikhampada (Nyishi tribe).
- ❑ **ASSAM:** Oja-Pali, Bihu, Bagurumba (traditional dance of the Bodo people), Jhumura Hobjanai.
- ❑ **BIHAR:** Biraha, Jat-Jatin, Jogira, Chaiti.
- ❑ **CHHATTISGARH:** Saila (post-harvest dance), Suwa or Soowa (parrot dance), Gaur Maria (Bastar).
- ❑ **GOA:** Tarangamel (performed on the occasions of Dushehra and Holi), Ghodemodni (mixture of martial arts and horse dance performed during the festivals of Shigmo), Perni Jagor (ancient mask dance, Republic Day parade 2016), Ranamale, Romta Mel, Fugdi.
- ❑ **GUJARAT:** Tippani, Rathwani Gher, Daandiya Raas, Dholo Rano, Dhamal of Siddhis, Shikaar Nritya, Gheriya Nritya, and Aaleni-Haleni.
- ❑ **HARYANA:** Phag (dance of the farmers), Swang, Dharmyal.
- ❑ **HIMACHAL PRADESH:** Dandras, Charba, Chham Chhanak.
- ❑ **JHARKHAND:** Mardani Jhumar, Paika Dance, Saraikela Chhau Dance.
- ❑ **KARNATAKA:** Yakshagana (song of Yaksha), Dollu Kunitha, Veeragase, Ummatt-aat, Bayalata, Kamsale, Hulivesha (Tiger dance), Buta Kola (kantaara movie), Gaarudi Gombe, Joodu Haligi.

- ❑ **KERALA:** Chakyar Koothu, Nangyar Koothu, Kutiyattam (recognised by UNESCO as a masterpiece of the Oral and Intangible Heritage of Humanity), Pandayani, and Thullal.
- ❑ **MADHYA PRADESH:** Swang, Jawara, Matki, Baredi, Naurata, Ahirai, Bhagoria, and Pardhauni.
- ❑ **MAHARASHTRA:** Dhangari Gaja, Lavani, Povada dance.
- ❑ **MANIPUR:** Thang-Ta, Kartal Chalom or Cymbal Dance, Jagoi, Thabal Chongba, Tandan Pheichak (harvest dance), and Lai Chingthokpa. Lai Haraoba is a form of festival/dance that forms the basis of all stylised dances in Manipur.
- ❑ **MEGHALAYA:** Nongkrem, Chad Laho, Chad Sukra (sowing festival), Chad Pliang or 'plate dance', Ajema Roa (Garo), Chambil Moa, and Napsepgrika.
- ❑ **MIZORAM:** Cheraw, Chheih Lam, So Lakia, Khuallam.
- ❑ **NAGALAND:** Aaluyattu, Agurshikukula, Butterfly Dance, Changai Dance, Leshalaptu, Modse, Monyoasho, Sadal Kekai, Moyashai, Khupielilie, Zeliang Dance, Chang Lo.
- ❑ **ODISHA:** Dalkhai dance, Mayurbhanj Chhau, Danda Jatra, Ranapa, and Ghumura dance.
- ❑ **PUNJAB:** Bhangra, Giddha, Luddi, Julli, Gatka.
- ❑ **RAJASTHAN:** Bhavai, Ghoomar, Kalbelia, and Terah Taali.
- ❑ **SIKKIM:** Bhutia Dance, Lepcha Dance, Singhi Chham.
- ❑ **TAMIL NADU:** Karakattam, Kummi, Kolattam, Mayil Aattam, Poikkal Kudirai Aattam, Theru Koothu, Ottan Koothup, Sevai Attam.
- ❑ **TELANGANA:** Perini Sivatandavam, and Chindu Bhagavatham.
- ❑ **TRIPURA:** Hoza Giri, Dhamail, Maimata, Garia, Lebang Bomani, SangraiMogh Dance, Chawn Lam, Mosak Sumani Pheiphit Lam, Waikhong Lam, Lam-Lam and Dar-Lam, and Khongilaam Dance.
- ❑ **UTTARAKHAND:** Langvir Nritya, Chamfuli, Chholia dance, Chanchari dance, Jhoda dance of Kumaon, and Hurkiya baul.
- ❑ **WEST BENGAL:** Purulia Chhau, Gaudiya Nritya, Alkap, Rabindra Nritya, Dhali, Raibenshe, Bratachari, Kali Naach, Baul Dance.
- ❑ **LADAKH:** Jabro, Tukhstanmo, Shondol, Shon and Koshan.

INTRODUCTION

The history of Indian music is a tapestry woven with the threads of ancient traditions, diverse cultural influences, and a continual evolution that spans thousands of years. At the **Indus Valley Civilization sites**, musical instruments, including the **seven-holed flute** and **Ravanahatha (string instrument)**, were found.

Textual References of Music in India

- ❑ The first proper mention of the art of **music** was made by **Panini** in **500 BC**.
- ❑ **Bharata's Natyashastra** (200 BC - 200 AD) contains the **first** reference to musical theory.
 - It mentions 22 keys or **Shrutis**.
 - Scales, melodic forms, tala, and musical instruments are all covered in Natyashastra.
 - Two standard scales were recognised and referred to as **gramas**.
 - Subsidiary scales are derived from each gram, known as **Moorcchanas**.
- ❑ **Mention of music can also be found in Vedic Literature**
 - The **Rig-Veda's** psalms were referred to as the **Richas**.
 - Religious chants were found in the **Yajur Veda**.
 - **Sama Veda** contains all seven notes of the **raga Kharahapriya**.
 - The **Gandharva Veda**, or the science of music, is an **Upaveda of the Sama Veda**.
 - In **Aitareya Aranyaka**, pieces of the instrument Veena are mentioned.
 - The **Jaimini Brahmana** mentions dance and music. The **Kausitaki Brahmana** blends dance, vocal, and instrumental music as an art form.
- ❑ During the Later Vedic period, **Sangama** was a **type of ritualistic music** that involved chanting of verses that were usually set to musical patterns. The epics were set to a narrative type of music called the **Jatigan**.
- ❑ **Silappadikaram**, written by **Illango (2nd century)**, provides an endless stream of informative musical material.
- ❑ **Brihaddesi**, written by **Mataṅga Muni**, (6th-8th century), explains aspects such as Nada, Shruti, Swara, Tana, etc.
- ❑ The 11th-century text **Sangeeta Makaranda** was composed by **Narada Nanda**, who enumerated 93 ragas and classified them into feminine and masculine forms.

- ❑ **Sangeeta Ratnakara** by **Sarangadeva** (13th century) mentions approximately 264 ragas. It recognises, characterises, and categorises the numerous **microtones**.
- ❑ **Sangita Darpan** is a Sanskrit treatise, authored by **Damodara Misra** in the 17th century, is a significant work.
- ❑ **Abhijilashitarta Chintamani** is attributed to **Someshwara III (ruled 1126-1138 AD)**, a **Chalukyan king**.
- ❑ **Sangraha Choodamani** is associated with **Govindacharya** and deals with Carnatic.

FUNDAMENTALS OF INDIAN MUSIC

Indian music is a complex and highly structured art form with deep roots in ancient traditions. Here are the key fundamentals of Indian music:

- ❑ **Swara**: It refers to **pitch**, '**note**' or '**degree of scale**' in composition. **Twelve** of the twenty-two notes are called **Swarasthana**, and the remaining notes are played in ragas. Swaras, according to the Hindustani system of music:

Sadja (Sa), Risabha (Re), Gandharva (Ga), Madhyama (Ma), Panchama (Pa), Dhaivata (Dha) and Nishada (Ni).

- ❑ **Raga**: It signifies the **basis of melody**. A combination of swaras gives rise to ragas.

Six principal ragas in Hindustani music:

Raga	Season	Time	Mood
Bhairav	Any Season	Dawn	Peace
Hindol	Spring	Morning	Youthful romance
Deepak	Summer	Night	Compassion
Megh	Rainy	Late Night	Courage
Shree	Winter	Evening	Happiness
Malkaush	Winter	Midnight	Bravery

- ❑ **Taala**: It signifies the **basis of rhythms**. The tala is one of India's distinctive contributions to musical rhythm. Tala is a system of time units arranged cyclically. The **laghu**, **guru** and **pluta** are the fundamental units of time division.

Rasa

Ragas were composed with the intention of evoking strong emotions in both the performer and the listener. We refer to these emotions as rasas.

Types of Rasas	Emotion it evokes	Types of Rasas	Emotion it evokes
Shringara	Love	Adbhuta	Wonder
Hasya	Humour/ Laughter	Bibhatsya	Disgust
Karuna	Pathos	Shant	Peace or calm
Bhayanak	Horror	Veer	Bravery
Raudra	Anger		

Musical Forms

They are divided into two broad categories: **Anibaddha** (open or free) and the **Nibaddha** (closed or bound) Sangeeta.

- ❑ **Anibaddha Sangeeta** is one that is not restricted by meaningful words and tala. It is a free improvisation. The finest form is the **alap**.
- ❑ **Nibaddha Sangeeta**: The earliest known nibaddha is the Prabandha giti. **Jayadeva's Gita Govinda** is the best-known prabandha.

CLASSICAL MUSIC (SHASTRIYA SANGEET)

Classical music is a term that encompasses a broad and sophisticated tradition of music that has developed over centuries with a focus on form, structure, and artistic expression. It is characterized by intricate compositions, detailed notation, and a strong emphasis on tradition and technique. Over time, two distinct schools of Indian classical music have evolved:

- ❑ **Hindustani Music** (Northern parts of India)
- ❑ **Carnatic Music** (Southern parts of India, mostly confined to Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, and Kerala)

Hindustani Music

In **Haripala's 'Sangeeta Sudhakara'** (14th century AD), the terms **Carnatic** and **Hindustani** were found for the first time. The origin of Hindustani classical music can be traced to **Amir Khusrau**, who promoted the practice of **performing music on specific instruments**. He is associated with the introduction of **new ragas** and the **invention of the sitar and tabla**.

Features

- ❑ It adopted the **Shudha Swara Saptaka scale**, also known as the **Octave of Natural Notes**.
- ❑ It was transmitted from one person to another through the **Guru-Shishya Parampara** in earlier times.
- ❑ It is played on the **tabla, sarangi, sitar, flute, violin, and santoor**.
- ❑ It has **ten primary vocal styles** - **Dhrupad, Khayal, Tappa, Chaturanga, Tarana, Sargam, Thumri and Ragasagar, Hori, and Dhamar**.

Major Styles of Hindustani Music

Dhrupad Style

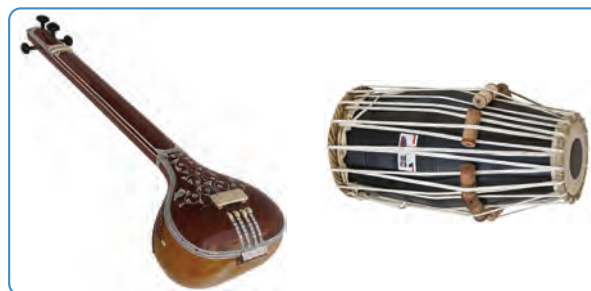


Fig. 6.1: Tanpura, Pakhawaj

- ❑ Dhrupada, one of the most ancient and majestic styles in Hindustani classical music, intricately weaves together the precise and methodical elaboration of ragas with poetic expression.
- ❑ Its roots can be traced back to the chanting of Vedic hymns and mantras found in the Samveda, as referenced in the Natyashastra.
- ❑ In structure, dhrupad has two parts:
 - **Anibaddha**: It is a free alap, and it is not restricted by meaning words and tala.
 - **Sanchari Dhrupad proper**: The Dhrupad proper is a song in **four parts**: **Asthayee, Antara, Sanchari** and **Abhoga**.
- ❑ **Raja Man Singh Tomar** of Gwalior played a significant part in the growth of Dhrupad.
 - It attained its peak under **Tansen, Baba Gopal Das** and **Haridas** in Emperor Akbar's court.
 - Its other proponents were **Baiju Bawra** and **Swami Haridas**.
- ❑ **Alap**, the exposition that comes before the composed verses, is typically the **longest part** of the **performance**. Dhrupad emphasises a slow, meditative rendition of the alap using sacred Sanskrit syllables derived from Sanskrit mantras.
- ❑ Usually, it is sung with the accompaniment of **Tanpura and Pakhawaj**.
- ❑ There were **four schools or vanis** of singing the dhrupad.
 - **Gauhar vani** developed the raga or unadorned melodic figures.
 - The **Dagarvani** emphasized melodic curves and graces.
 - The **Khandar vani** specialised in quick ornamentation of the notes.
 - **Nauhar vani** was known for its broad musical leaps and jumps. However, these vanis are now indistinguishable.
- ❑ The dhrupad has somewhat receded to the background and is not so popular with the masses. Today the pride of place in classical Hindustani Music is occupied by the Khyal.

Khayal Style

It is credited to **Amir Khusrau** and is also called “**Bandish**.” It is based on a collection of **brief songs with two to eight lines**, Khayal has a brief text and is composed in **a specific raga and tala**. However, it allows room for **improvisation**.

- ❑ Praise of kings, descriptions of the seasons, Lord Krishna's antics, divine love etc., are among the texts' principal themes. It is **more lyrical than the dhrupad**.
- ❑ As sung today, the khayal has two varieties: the **slow or vilambit khayal** and the **fast or drut khayal**. In form, both are similar, they have two sections – the **asthayee** and the **antara**. The vilambit is sung in a slow tempo, and the drut at a faster speed. In technique, the exposition is less grave than the dhrupad.
- ❑ Comparable to the **Vanis** in Dhrupad, we have **Gharanas** in the khayal.
 - **Gwalior Gharana**: This is the oldest among all gharanas. Its founder, **Nathan Peerbaksh**, established it in Gwalior, hence the name. He had two grandsons, **Haddu Khan** and **Hassu Khan**, who were esteemed as exceptional masters of this tradition during the 19th century. The distinguishing features of this gharana include a resonant voice, precise articulation of lyrics, and a thorough focus on melody (raga), notes (swara), and rhythm (tala). **Notable musicians** associated with this gharana include **Krishna Rao Shankar Pandit** and **Raja Bhaiya Poonchwale**.
 - **Kirana Gharana (Awadh)**: The Kirana Gharana is renowned for its attention to note expression and precision tuning. Its proficiency with slow-tempo ragas is what makes them a prominent group. They place a great focus on the song's melody and the text's accurate pronunciation. Famous singers: **Pandit Bhimsen Joshi** and **Gangubai Hangal**.
 - **Agra Gharana**: The Agra Gharana is believed to have been established by **Khuda Baksh** from Agra. While he received training from Nathan Peerbaksh of Gwalior, he eventually forged his own distinctive style. In this gharana, emphasis is placed on a resonant and articulate voice. A notable characteristic is the **bol taan**, wherein rapid or moderate layakari passages utilize the words (bols) of the song. The rendition of the song itself typically occurs at a moderate tempo. Among the **renowned musicians** associated with this gharana in recent times are **Vilayat Hussain Khan** and **Fayyaz Khan**.
 - **Jaipur Atroli gharana**: It is known for its direct lineage from dhrupad, with its origins linked to **Alladiya Khan** in the 19th-20th century. In this tradition, khayal compositions are consistently performed at a moderate pace, with a focus on clear and resonant

pronunciation of lyrics. Notably, the gharana is characterized by passages predominantly built on alankars - repetitive melodic motifs - and a rhythmic precision akin to a metronome in tala division. Among the notable musicians of recent times associated with this gharana are **Mallikarjun Mansur** and **Kishori Amonkar**.

- **Rampur Saheswan gharana**: It derives its name from its association with Rampur in Uttar Pradesh, where its early practitioners hailed from. This tradition typically features both slow and fast Khayals, often followed by Tarana compositions. Renowned for its lyrical essence and intricate melodic ornamentation, the style is characterized by delicate tonal embellishments. Among the notable musicians from recent times associated with this gharana are **Nisar Hussain Khan** and **Rashid Khan**.
- **Patiala Gharana**: They place a strong emphasis on using more rhythm. They often incorporate ornamentation or alankaras into their music since their works emphasize emotions. They emphasize using elaborate tanas. Famous singers: **Bade Ghulam Ali Khan Sahab**.
- **Bhendibazaar Gharana**: These performers were able to sing lengthy stretches in a single breath by controlling the breath for a long time. They are also distinct because they incorporate certain Carnatic ragas into their impressive repertoire.

Gharanas

A gharana is a system of social organisation in Hindustani music that ties musicians or dancers together through apprenticeship, ancestry, and devotion to a specific musical style. It also denotes a comprehensive ideology of music.

Tarana Style

- ❑ In this style, **rhythm** is extremely essential to it. **Melody makes up most of the structure**.
- ❑ It is sung at a **fast tempo** and incorporates a **lot of words**. Its origin dates back to **Amir Khusro**. 10th sikh guru, **Guru Gobind Singh** also used Tarana in his compositions. **Nissar Hussain Khan**, who received Padma Bhushan in 1971, was also a Tarana singer.

SEMI-CLASSICAL STYLES OF HINDUSTANI MUSIC

Semi-classical styles in Hindustani music encompass a diverse range of genres that blend elements of classical music with popular or folk influences. These styles often **exhibit more flexibility in structure and incorporate improvisation** to a varying extent.

Thumri

- ❑ It began in the 18th century in **Eastern Uttar Pradesh**, primarily in **Lucknow** and **Benares**.
- ❑ It is a sensual and romantic singing style that is sometimes referred to as **"the lyric of Indian classical music."**
- ❑ The majority of compositions deal with **love, separation, and devotion** and are **written** in **Braj Bhasha**.
- ❑ **Unique feature:** Stories of **Lord Krishna** and **Radha**.
- ❑ A Khayal concert typically **ends** with a **Thumri** performance.
- ❑ There are **three** primary thumri Gharanas: **Benaras, Lucknow, and Patiala**.
- ❑ **Begum Akhtar** is its exponent thumri style.

Tappa

- ❑ Originating in the Punjab region, Tappa is a lively and rhythmic style known for its fast tempo and playful melodies.
- ❑ **Rhythm** is extremely crucial to this music style.
- ❑ The folk songs of **North-West Indian camel riders** were the source of development in the late 18th century AD.

Ghazal

- ❑ The Ghazal comprises concise poems composed of rhyming couplets known as bayt or sher.
- ❑ A poetic rendering of the **suffering caused by separation or loss** as well as the **beauty of love despite that suffering**.
- ❑ One of the earliest people to explain the art of writing ghazals was **Amir Khusrau**.
- ❑ Famous personalities associated with Ghazals: **Mirza Ghalib, Muhammad Iqbal, Rumi (13th Century), Kazi Nazrul Islam**, etc.

CARNATIC MUSIC

Carnatic music is a classical music tradition that originated in South India and has a rich and ancient heritage.

Different Compositions in Carnatic Music

- ❑ **Gitam:** The simplest kind of composition is called a Gitam. It has a very easy and melodic musical flow and a very simple structure.
- ❑ **Suladi:** The Suladis are of a higher calibre than the gitam, but have a devotional theme. **Vilambita, Madhya, and Drupata** are the three tempos in which suladis are composed.
- ❑ **Svarajati:** They are a precursor for learning varnams. It is divided into three parts: **Pallavi, Anupallavi, and Charanam**.
- ❑ **Varnam:** It is an example of masterful musical craftsmanship that incorporates every defining element of the raga it is based on.

- ❑ **Jatiswaram:** It has no sahitya or words and is very similar to the svarajati in musical structure. It falls under the dance music category.
- ❑ **Kirtanam:** The kirtanam is replete with **Bhakti bhava**. It is appropriate for both solo performances and group singing. The first kirtana composers to use the sections pallavi, anupallavi, and charanas were the **Talapakam composers** of the fifteenth century.
- ❑ **Kriti:** It is a very **advanced genre of music**. In this form, the rich and varied colours of the raga and bhava are brought out. The three basic and necessary **angas of a kriti are the pallavi, anupallavi, and charanam**.
- ❑ **Pada:** Padas are academic works written in Tamil and Telugu. The music is sombre and slow-moving. The music flows naturally with harmony between the lyrics and the music. **Madhura bhakti**, represented by Antar bhakti and Bahir Sringara, is the theme.
- ❑ **Javali:** A composition that falls into the category of light classical music is called a javali.
- ❑ **Tillana:** The Tillana is a short and crisp form. It is mainly a dance form, but on account of its brisk and attractive music, it sometimes finds a place in music concerts as a conclusion piece.
- ❑ **Pallavi:** This is the most significant area of creative composition. The first three words in the term Pallavi are **Padam** (words); **Layam** (time); and **Vinyasam** (variations).
- ❑ **Tanam:** This belongs to the raga alapana branch with a noticeable rhythm to it. It has intriguing patterns and rhythmic flow. The word **"Anantam"** is **skillfully incorporated into the melodic patterns**.

Proponents of Carnatic Music

- ❑ **Annamacharya (Grandfather of Telugu songwriting)**, popularly known as **Annamayya**, was a **15th-century** musician, composer, and a Hindu saint. He is the **earliest known Indian musician** to compose songs called **samkirtanas**. His devotional samkirtanas were in the **praise of Venkateswara**, a form of Vishnu. His compositions are classified as **Adhyatma (spiritual)** and **Sringara (romantic)**. He was one of the first few who opposed the social stigma towards the untouchable castes in his era.
- ❑ **Purandara Dasa (16th century):** Revered as the **"Pitamaha of Carnatic Music,"** he composed hymns dedicated to Lord Krishna. His renowned works include compositions known as **Dasa Sahitya**.
- ❑ **Kshetreyya (17th century):** His **Telugu padams** in praise of Lord Krishna are still sung, particularly in **Bharatnatyam** and **Kuchipudi** performances.



Fig. 6.2:
Annamacharya

- ❑ **Bhadrachala Ramadasu (17th century):** He was a renowned Telugu poet who praised Lord Rama in his compositions. As a notable Vaggeyakara, he not only wrote lyrics but also skillfully arranged them into music.
- ❑ **Venkatamakhin (17th century):** He wrote **Chaturdandiprakashika** in which he introduced the **Melakarta system** of classifying Ragas.
- ❑ The works in Carnatic music can be credited to **three** composers who flourished from **1700 to 1850 AD**. They were **Thyagaraja, Mutthuswami Dikshitar, and Shyam Shastri, the 'Trinity of Carnatic music.'** All three were contemporaries and were born in **Tiruvarur**.
- ❑ Some notable musicians of the 19th century were: **Maha Vaidyanath Ayyar, Patnam Subrahmanya Ayyar** and **Ramnad Srinivasa Iyengar**.
- ❑ The **Sangeeta Sampradaya Pradarsini**, written by **Subbarama Dikshithar** in the year 1904, serves as an authority for information regarding the music, musicians and composers of the previous centuries.

- ❑ **Tyagaraja** composed thousands of devotional compositions, mostly in **Telugu** and in **praise of Rama**, the most popular being "**Nagumomu**", Pancharatna Kritis, and Utsava Sampradaya Krithis.



Fig. 6.3:
Tyagaraja

- ❑ **Mutthuswami Dikshitar:** Compositions in **Sanskrit** related to Hindu Gods. He played veena and emphasised the use of ornamentation.
- ❑ **Shyam Shastri:** Oldest in the trinity, his **Telugu** compositions are in praise of Goddess Kamakshi. He started the **Svarjati** musical genre.

COMPARISON BETWEEN HINDUSTANI AND CARNATIC MUSIC

Similarities

- ❑ The evolution of both forms of music was **influenced by Vedic tradition** as well as Sanskrit language scripts, with common religious and spiritual themes.
- ❑ The basic elements of **swara, raga** and **taala** serve as the **foundation of both**.
- ❑ Both have **Raga as their central notion**.
- ❑ The **melody** is the **main feature** of both styles.

Differences

Hindustani Music	Carnatic Music
❑ Ragas are divided into Thaat , and there are six ragas.	❑ Ragas are divided into Melakarta raga and Janya raga.

- | | |
|---|---|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ❑ There are different Gharanas within the musical system. ❑ Equal emphasis on instruments and vocals. ❑ More scope for improvisation. ❑ The main focus is on Ragas. ❑ Influence of Afghan, Persian and Arab elements. ❑ Traditionally, Flute, Violin, Tabla, sarangi, Sitar and Santoor were used. | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ❑ No such concept of gharanas. ❑ More emphasis on vocal music. ❑ Less scope for improvisation. ❑ The main focus is on Taal. ❑ It is based on indigenous elements. ❑ Traditionally, Flute, Violin, Veena, Mridangam and mandolin were used. |
|---|---|



IGNITE YOUR MIND

The Changing taste of the new generation in music has impacted the reception and promotion of Indian classical music. What role can digital platforms and social media play in revitalizing the interest of this generation in classical music?

FOLK MUSIC

Folk music in India reflects the cultural diversity and regional identities across the country. It encompasses a wide range of traditional musical styles and genres passed down through generations within communities.

Important Folk Music Traditions in India

Rasiya Geet (Uttar Pradesh)

- ❑ The rich tradition of singing Rasiya Geet flourished in Braj.
- ❑ This is not confined to any particular festival, but is closely woven into the very fabric of daily life and day to day chores of its people.

Pankhida (Rajasthan)

- ❑ Sung by the peasants of Rajasthan while doing work in the fields, the peasants sing and speak while playing alghoza and manjira.
- ❑ The literal meaning of the word 'Pankhida' is lover.

Lotia (Rajasthan)

- ❑ 'Lotia' is sung in the Chaitra month during the festival – 'Lotia'.
- ❑ Women bring lotas (vessels to fill water) and Kalash (vessels considered to be auspicious to fill water during worship) filled with water from ponds and wells. They decorate them with flowers and come home.

Pandavani, Chhattisgarh

- ❑ In Pandavani, **tales from Mahabharata** are sung as a ballad, and one or two episodes are chosen for the night's performance.
- ❑ The main singer continuously sits throughout the performance, and with powerful singing and symbolic gestures, he assumes all the characters of the episode one after another.

Shakunakhar – Mangalgeet (Kumaon)

- ❑ Shakunakhar are sung during religious ceremonies of baby-shower, child-birth, Chhati (a ritual done on the sixth day from the birth of a child), Ganesh pooja etc.
- ❑ These songs are sung by only ladies, without any instrument.

Barhamasa (Kumaon)

- ❑ This regional music from Kumaon describes the twelve months of a year, each with its specific qualities.
- ❑ In one of the songs, the Ghughuti bird symbolizes the onset of Chaitra month. A girl at her in-laws place asks this bird not to speak because she is disturbed by the memories of her mother (Ija), and she is feeling sad.

Mando (Goa)

- ❑ Mando, the finest creation of a Goan song, is a slow verse and refrain composition dealing with love, tragedy and both social injustice and political resistance during Portuguese presence in Goa.

Alha (Uttar Pradesh)

- ❑ Alha, a typical ballad of Bundelkhand, narrates the heroic deeds of Alha and Udal, the two warrior brothers who served Raja Parmal of Majoba.
- ❑ The Alha is full of tales of feudal chivalry, which have appeal to common men. It highlights the high principles of morality, chivalry and nobility prevalent in those times.

Hori (Uttar Pradesh)

- ❑ The history of Hori, its evolution and tradition is quite ancient. It is based on the love pranks of 'Radha-Krishna'.
- ❑ Hori singing is basically associated with the festival of Holi only.

Sohar (Bihar)

- ❑ North India has a strong tradition of singing 'Sohar' songs when a son is born in a family.
- ❑ This has influenced the Muslim culture, and a form of 'Sohar' song gained currency in the Muslim families living in some regions of Uttar Pradesh. 'Sohar' songs unmistakably point to the mingling of two cultures.

Chhakri (Kashmir)

- ❑ Chhakri is a group song that is the most popular form of Kashmir's folk music.
- ❑ It is sung to the accompaniment of the noot (earthen pot) rababs, sarangi and tumbaknari (an earthen pot with a high neck).

Laman (Himachal Pradesh)

- ❑ In Laman, a group of girls sing a stanza, and a group of boys give a reply to the song. This continues for hours.
- ❑ Most of these songs are sung especially in Kullu Valley.

Kajri (Uttar Pradesh)

- ❑ Kajri is a folk song sung by women, from Uttar Pradesh and adjacent regions, during the rainy season.
- ❑ On the third day, in the second half of the bhadra, women sing Kajri songs all through the night while dancing in a semi-circle.

Powada (Maharashtra)

- ❑ The word Powada itself means "the narration of a story in glorious terms".
- ❑ The narratives are always odes in praise of an individual hero or an incident or place.
- ❑ The chief narrator is known as the Shahir, who plays the duff to keep the rhythm.
- ❑ The tempo is fast and controlled by the main singer, who is supported by others in chorus.
- ❑ The earliest notable Powada was the Afzal Khanacha Vadh (The Killing of Afzal Khan) (1659) by Agnidass which recorded Shivaji's encounter with Afzal Khan.

Teej Songs (Rajasthan)

- ❑ Teej is celebrated with great involvement by women of Rajasthan.
- ❑ This is a festival celebrated on the third day after the new moon or Amavasya of Shraavana month.
- ❑ The theme of the songs sung during this festival revolves around the union of Shiva and Parvati, the magic of monsoon, greenery, peacock dance etc.

Burra-katha (Andhra Pradesh)

- ❑ Burra-katha is a highly dramatic form of ballad.
- ❑ A bottle-shaped drum (tambura) is played by the main performer while reciting a story. The ballad singers, like stage actors, wear make-up and a highly stylised costume.

Bhakha (Jammu and Kashmir)

- ❑ Bhakha is sung by the villagers when harvesting is done.
- ❑ It is considered to be the regional music with the most melodic and harmonious elements.
- ❑ It is sung to the accompaniment of instruments like harmonium.

Bhuta Song (Kerala)

- ❑ The basis of Bhuta song is rooted in superstitions.
- ❑ Some communities of Kerala do Bhuta rituals to send away evil ghosts and spirits. This ritual is accompanied by vigorous dancing and the music has a piercing and eerie character.

Daskathia (Odisha)

- Daskathia is a form of ballad singing prevalent in Odisha.
- Daskathia is a name derived from a unique musical instrument called “Kathi” or “Ram Tali”, wooden clappers used during the presentation.
- The performance is a form of worship and offering on behalf of the “Das”, the devotee.

Bihu Songs (Assam)

- Bihu songs are blessings for a happy new year and the dance is associated with an ancient fertility cult.
- During Bihu, a festive occasion, young men and women of marriageable age seize the opportunity to express their sentiments and even select their potential partners.

Sana Lamok (Manipur)

- Sana Lamok is sung at the time of the coronation ceremony by the Maaiba (priest). It may also be sung to welcome the king.
- It is sung to evoke the spirit of Pakhangba, the presiding deity.

- There is a belief that this song is potent with magical powers.

Saikuti Zai (Mizoram)

- Saikuti, a poetess of Mizoram composed songs in praise of warriors, brave hunters, young men aspiring to be great warriors and hunters etc.

Chai Hia, Songs of the Chai Dance (Mizoram)

- Special occasion for singing and dancing is called ‘chai’ and songs are known as ‘chai hia’ (chai songs).

Villu Pattu, “Bow Song” (Tamil Nadu)

- The lead singer also plays the role of the main performer. He also handles the dominating instrument which is bow shaped.
- The songs revolve around theological themes and the conquest of good over evil is emphasised.

Ammanaivari (Tamil Nadu)

- Ammanaivari are songs sung in praise of the Chola monarch.
- Ammanai is a wooden ball and the women folk sing appropriate songs while playing the ball.

List of Other Folk Music Traditions

Folk Music	Specifications	Folk Music	Specifications
Baul (West Bengal)	Sung by the Baul sect, having both Bhakti and Sufi influences.	Basant Geet (Garhwal, Uttarakhand)	During Basant Panchami festival.
Wanawan (Jammu and Kashmir)	Sung during wedding ceremonies.	Lai Haroba Festival (Manipur)	For Umang-Lai, the forest deity.
Bhakha (Jammu and Kashmir)	Bhakha is sung by the villagers when harvesting is done.	Ghasiyari Geet (Uttarakhand)	Sung by women who have to go into far-off forests to get grass for their cattle.
Panihari (Rajasthan)	Songs about scarcity of water. Romantic and domestic themes.	Pai (Madhya Pradesh)	Songs for a good monsoon and harvest. Saira dance is performed.
Dandiya (Gujarat)	Associated with scenes of Holi and lila of Krishna and Radha at Vrindavan. It is a featured dance of Navratri evenings.	Veeragase (Karnataka)	During Dusshera procession. It is based on Hindu mythology.
Lavani (Maharashtra)	Traditional dance and song performed on Dholki.	Khubak Eshei (Manipur)	A song accompanied entirely by clapping.
Dhadi (Punjab)	They sing ballads of bravery.	Ougri Hangen, Heijing Hirao (Manipur)	They are the song of creation and a ritualistic song, respectively sung on the last day of the Lai Haraoba festival.
Bhavageete (Karnataka and Maharashtra)	Themes include nature, love and philosophy. It is similar to Ghazals.	Khongjom Parva (Manipur)	A musical narration of the Battle of Khongjom fought between the British army and the Manipuri forces in 1891.
Hereileu (Nagaland)	War songs	Tikir (Assam)	Embodies the teachings of Islam.

Kolanallu (Andhra Pradesh)	Also known as Kolattam. Similar to "Dandiya".		
Neuleu (Nagaland)	It is about legends and myths.	Ja-jin-ja (Arunachal Pradesh)	Sung during marriage.
Sukar ke Biah (Bihar)	Celebrating the love between cosmological deities-Shukra & Brihaspati.	Zikir (Assam)	Embodies the teachings of Islam.
Nyoga (Arunachal Pradesh)	Sung at the end of the marriage ceremony.	Heliameu (Nagaland)	Dancing songs.
Hekaileu (Nagaland)	Songs about oneself.	Dollu Kunita (Karnataka)	Performed by the people of Kuruba Community.
Nattupura Paattu (Tamil Nadu)	Consists of village folk music and city folk music.		
Khubakeshei (Manipur)	A song accompanied entirely by clapping.	Manganiars (North West India)	Songs of Alexander, local kings and battles.
Saikuti Zai (Mizoram); Ovi (Maharashtra and Goa); Barahamasa (Uttarakhand).			

FUSION OF CLASSICAL AND FOLK MUSIC

Over time, both the classical and folk elements intermingled together, giving rise to new forms.

Sugam Sangeet: It is the genre that brings classical and folk elements together. It includes:

- ❑ **Bhajan:** The most popular type of devotional singing prevalent in North India, owing its origin to the Bhakti movement. The stories from the life of the god and goddess or from the Mahabharata and the Ramayana are popular subjects for bhajans. The major expounders of the bhajans in the medieval period were **Mirabai, Tulsidas, Surdas, Kabir**, etc.
- ❑ **Shabad:** **Guru Nanak** and his disciple **Mardana** were responsible for the development and popularity of Shabd.
- ❑ **Qawwali:** These are devotional songs in **praise of Allah** or **the Prophet Muhammad** or any other Sufi or Islamic Saint. They are composed of a **single raga** and are generally written in Urdu, Punjabi or Hindi. They are usually performed in Sufi shrines.
- ❑ **Other types of Sugam Sangeet:**
 - **Abhangs (Maharashtra):** Sung in praise of Lord Vithoba.
 - **Kirtana (West Bengal):** Gita Govinda inspired the singing and dancing of kirtans.
 - **Bhatiali (West Bengal):** Sung by boat drivers about nature.
 - **Tevaram (Tamil Nadu):** Sung by Shaivite Communities like Odudars.

Rabindra Sangeet: It is a mixture of **classical elements** and **Bengali folk** strains that recreates the music produced by **Rabindranath Tagore**. Its prominent elements include the **spirit of patriotism**.

Haveli Sangeet: It developed in **Rajasthan** and **Gujarat**. Currently practiced by **Pushtimarg Sampradaya** or the community that believes in Pushtimarg as the way to salvation.

Gana Sangeet: A type of fusion music that is **sung in groups or chorus**. Themes include **patriotism and protests** against **malpractices** in society. **Vande Mataram** is a Gana Sangeet.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

How do themes, instruments and styles in folk music reflect the distinctive identities of various ethnic groups and communities in India?

MUSICAL INSTRUMENTS

Musical instruments are the tangible representation of music. A study of these helps in tracing the evolution of music and also explains many aspects of the material culture of the group of people to which these instruments belong. For instance, the hair used for making the bow, the wood or clay used for making the drum, or the hide of animals used in the instruments, all tell us about the flora and fauna of a particular region. Based on how sound is produced, musical instruments are **categorised into four main groups according to the Natya Shastra:**

Tata Vadya- Stringed Instruments

- ❑ An instrument in which a string or chord vibrates to produce sound is called a tata vadya. On the taut string, these vibrations are produced by bowing or plucking.

- ❑ The tata vadya are divided into two broad categories
 - **Plucked (Sitar, Veena and Tambura)** and
 - **Bowed (Sarangi, Esraj and Violin).**
- ❑ The **Kamaicha** is a bowed lute played by the Manganiars of West Rajasthan.
- ❑ **Other examples:** Tumbi, Ektara, Dotara, Onavillu, Tingteila, Sarinda, Esraj, Chikara etc.

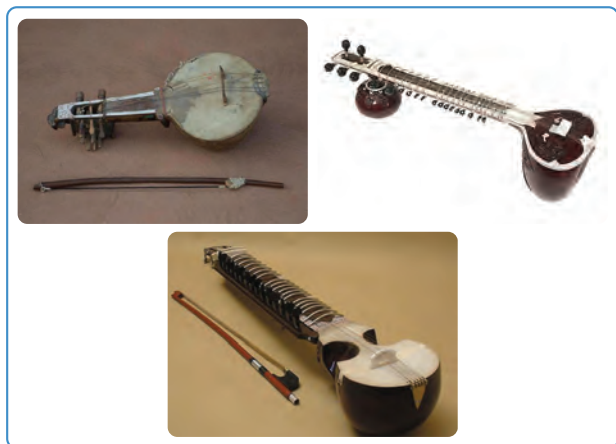


Fig. 6.4: Kamaicha, Sitar, Esraj

Sushira Vadya- Wind Instruments

- ❑ In the Sushira Vadya group, the sound is produced by **blowing air into a hollow column**. The pitch of the note is determined by **controlling the air passage**, and the melody is played by using the fingers to open and close the instrument.
- ❑ The wind instruments are roughly divided into two categories on the basis of how sound is produced.
 - **Flutes:** Pandit Hariprasad Chaurasia is a famous flautist from India.
 - **Reed instruments** like Shehnai and Nadaswaram. **Ustad Bismillah Khan** was a famous Shehnai Player.

Examples include **Algoza, Titti, Mashak, Gogona, Been, Ejuk Tapung, Tangmuri** etc.

Avanaddha Vadya- Percussion Instruments

- ❑ In the Avanaddha Vadya category of instruments, sound is produced by **striking the animal skin** which has been **stretched across** an earthen or metal pot or a wooden barrel or frame.

- ❑ Seals excavated from Indus Civilization sites show figures of men playing the horizontal drums hung from the neck.
- ❑ Drums have been divided into different categories on the basis of their shapes and structure as well as the position and placement for playing. These include **Oordhwaka** (Tabla and Chenda), **Ankya** (Mridangam, Pakhawaj), **Alingya** (Dufflies), and **Damaru**.
- ❑ Other examples include **Ghumot, Tamak, Diggi, Udukai, Idakka, Sambal** etc.



Fig. 6.5: Ghumot



Fig. 6.6: Manjira

Ghana Vadya- Idiophone Instruments

- ❑ It is the genre of solid instruments that do not require any tuning.
- ❑ They are also called the Idiophone instruments. The most popular examples of Ghana Vadya are **Manjira, Jaltarang, Kanch-Tarang, Jhanj, Khartal, chimata, Andelu, Gharha** etc.

CONCLUSION

In conclusion, the musical landscape of India is incredibly diverse, vibrant, and deeply rooted in its cultural heritage. From the classical traditions of Hindustani and Carnatic music to the colourful tapestry of folk, devotional, and popular music forms, India offers a rich array of musical expressions that captivate audiences both within the country and around the world. This multifaceted musical heritage serves as a testament to India's cultural richness, regional diversity, and historical depth, showcasing the profound impact of music in shaping identities, fostering community cohesion, and transcending boundaries. As India continues to evolve and embrace modern influences, its music remains a dynamic force, constantly innovating while preserving the timeless beauty of its ancient traditions.

Indian Theatre and Cinema

7

Theatre in India began as a **narrative art form** encompassing **music, dialogue, poetry, dance and acting**, making drama in itself a complete form of art. They are presented during religious festivals, fairs, gatherings and rituals. They incorporate the common people's **social attitudes, perceptions**, and **classical elements**. The excavated ruins at **Sitabenga** and **Jogimara caves (Chhattisgarh)** represent the world's oldest amphitheatres. **Natya Shastra** of **Bharat Muni** is the first formal treatise on dramaturgy. It contains **ten types of play** to cover all aspects of **classical Sanskrit literature**. Vedic texts such as the Rigveda provide evidence of drama plays being enacted during Yajna ceremonies.

CLASSICAL SANSKRIT THEATRE

The Sanskrit word '**Nataka**' originated from the root word '**Nata**', meaning a **dancer**. The drama was also referred to as **Rupaka**, **Drishyakavya** and **Preksakavya**.

- In ancient India, plays were generally of two types:
 - **Lokadharmi**: These were **realistic** depictions of **daily life**.
 - **Natyadharmi**: These were **conventional plays** with a more stylised narration and overt symbolism.
- **Ritualistic progression in Classical Sanskrit play**
 - The play begins with **purva-raga** (pre-play rituals).
 - Following this, **Sutradhar** (the stage manager and director), **dressed in white**, would offer **worship to the deity** and seek his blessings.
 - Following this, the **leading lady** was summoned, and the Sutradhar announced the time and place of the play. He also gave a **brief introduction** to the **playwright**.
 - The stages were two-storeyed (the **upper floor** represented the **celestial sphere** and the **lower floor** represented the **terrestrial sphere**).
 - **Curtains** were used to intensify the impact of play. However, **masks** were **not used**.
- **Characters in Sanskrit plays** were of **three kinds** which are **Nayaka** (Hero or the Protagonist), **Nayika** (Heroine) and the **Vidusaka** (Clown).

Important Sanskrit Playwrights and Plays

- **Ashvaghosha**: Renowned as a trailblazer in Sanskrit drama, he is most celebrated for his masterpiece, **Buddha Charita**. Additionally, he crafted **Sariputraprakarana**, a nine-act composition.

- **Buddhacharita** is a poetic narrative of the life of the Buddha.
- In **"Sariputraprakarana,"** Ashvaghosha explores the life, teachings and spiritual journey of Sariputra (disciple of Buddha), providing insights into Buddhist philosophy and practice through the lens of Sariputra's experiences.



Fig. 7.1: A scene from Abhijnana Shakuntalam

- **Harshavardhan**: He ruled North India from 606 AD to 647 AD, **North India** with his capital at Kannauj. He is credited with having written the plays **Ratnavali**, **Naganada** (Buddhist drama) and **Priyadarsika**.
 - **"Ratnavali"** is a romantic comedy that revolves around the love story of King Udayana and Princess Ratnavali.
 - **"Nagananda"** is a drama that narrates the tale of Jimutavahana, a prince who sacrifices himself to save a serpent and is subsequently reborn as a king. The play explores themes of sacrifice, redemption, and the triumph of good over evil.
 - **"Priyadarsika"** is another romantic comedy that centers around the love story between Prince Udayana and Priyadarshika, the daughter of King Dridhavarman.
- **Kalidasa**: A member of the illustrious nine gems at the court of Chandragupta II, he produced some of his finest works during the reign of Kumargupta I. Notable among his creations are **Malvikagnimitra**, **Vikramorvashi** and **Abhijnanasakuntalam**.



Fig. 7.2: Kalidasa

- **Malvikagnimitra**: The narrative revolves around **King Agnimitra's** schemes to win the affection of **Malavika**, a talented female dancer whom he loves.

- **Vikramorvashi:** The play's focus lies in the affection of a mortal for a celestial maiden. Within the play, there is a notable "mad scene" where the king, overwhelmed with sorrow, roams through a beautiful forest, addressing various flowers and trees as if they were his beloved.
- **Abhijnanasakuntalam:** Adapted from ancient lore, the narrative recounts the enchantment of the nymph **Shakuntala** by **King Dushyanta**, his initial rejection of her and their child, followed by their eventual reunion in the celestial realm.
- **Visakhadatta:** An esteemed poet and playwright renowned for crafting the celebrated plays **Devichandraguptam** and **Mudrarakshasa**, depicting the rise of Chandragupta Maurya.
 - **Devichandraguptam:** Within the play, **King Ramagupta** opts to hand over his queen, **Dhruvadevi** ("Devi"), to a Shaka adversary during a siege. In a daring move, Ramagupta's younger brother, **Chandragupta**, infiltrates the enemy camp disguised as the queen and assassinates the enemy ruler.
 - **Mudrarakshasa:** The narrative recounts the rise of King Chandragupta Maurya to authority in India.
- **Bhavabhuti:** As a court poet under King Yashovarman of Kannauj, he authored **Mahaviracharitra**, detailing the early life of Rama, as well as **Uttaramacharitra**, which chronicles the later stages of Rama's life, alongside **Malatimadhava**.
 - The **Mahaviracharitra** ("The Exploits of the Great Hero") is based on Rama's battle with Ravana, and the **Uttaramacharita** ("The Later Deeds of Rama") is based on the life of Rama after he has abandoned Sita.
 - **Malatimadhava:** The plot revolves around the love stories of Malati, daughter of the minister Bhurivasu and Madhava. A side plot involves the lovers' friends Makaranda and Madayantika. After numerous travails, all ends well, with the two couples uniting.
- **Shudraka:** His most famous play is **Mricchakatika** (The little clay cart) which is a story of Charudatta, an impoverished Brahmin who falls in love with a courtesan Vasant Sena who is being pursued by somebody else.
- **Bhasa:** Credited with crafting 13 plays employed in Koodiyattam, he is renowned for his composition **Swapna-Vasavadatta**, a romantic drama featuring King Udayana of Vatsa and Vasavadatta, the daughter of the ruler of Avanti.
 - The main theme of the drama is the sorrow of **Udayana** for his queen **Vasavadatta**, believed by him to have perished in a fire, which was actually a rumour spread by a minister of Udayana to compel his king to marry **Padmavati**, the daughter of the king of Magadha.

FOLK THEATRE

Folk Theatre reflects the various aspects of the **local lifestyle**, including **social norms**, beliefs and customs. It had **rural roots** and a rustic flavour. They emerged around the **15th - 16th century AD** with **devotional themes**, but later they adopted secular tones.

Ankia Nat

- It is an **Assamese** traditional one-act play.
- It was founded by the well-known Vaishnava Saint **Sankaradeva** and his follower Mahadeva in the sixteenth century A.D. It portrays events from Krishna's life and is staged in the style of an opera.
- A group of musicians known as Gayan-Bayan Mandali play the "**khol**" and "**cymbals**" in addition to the Sutradhar, or narrator.
- The usage of masks to represent specific expressions is one of this type of theatre's distinctive characteristics.

Bhuta Aradhana

In **Karnataka**, the ancient tradition of Bhuta worship, **honouring deceased ancestors** and avatars of Hindu Gods, is deeply rooted. The primary expression of this reverence is through **Kola**, the predominant form of Bhuta worship.

Ramlila

Ramlila is a well-known folk theatre in **Uttar Pradesh**. It is an enactment of the Ramayana. It is typically performed by male actors who also play feminine characters.

Ramman

- This is the **Garhwal** region of Uttarakhand's ritualistic theatre, which is devoted to the local god, Bhumiya Devta.
- It is included on the Representative List of the **Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity** maintained by UNESCO.
- The holy mask worn by people represents **Narasimha**, the half-lion, half-man figure.
- Many tales recount the exploits of Lord Rama.

Jatra

- This form was born and nurtured in **Bengal**.
- Krishna Jatra became popular due to Chaitanya's influence. Later, however, worldly love stories too, found a place in Jatra.
- The earlier form of Jatra has been musical. Dialogues were added at a later stage. The actors themselves describe the change of scene, the place of action, etc.

Bhand Pather

- It is the traditional theatre form of **Kashmir**.
- Bhand Pather is a unique combination of dance, music and acting.
- Satire, wit and parody are preferred for inducing laughter.
- In this theatre form, music is provided with surnai, nagaara and dhol.

Bhaona

- ❑ Bhaona is a **presentation of the Ankia Naat** of **Assam**.
- ❑ In Bhaona, cultural glimpses of Assam, Bengal Orissa, Mathura and Vrindavan can be seen.
- ❑ The Sutradhaar, or narrator, begins the story, first in Sanskrit and then in either Brajboli or Assamese.

Bhavai

- ❑ Bhavai is the traditional theatre form of **Gujarat** in the **Kutch** and **Kathiawar** regions.
- ❑ The instruments used in Bhavai are: bhungal, tabla, flute, pakhaawaj, rabaab, sarangi, manjeera, etc.
- ❑ In Bhavai, there is a rare synthesis of devotional and romantic sentiments.

Burra Katha

- ❑ It is the traditional art form of **Andhra Pradesh**.
- ❑ It is an oral storytelling technique consisting of a **main artist or narrator** and two **vanthas** or co-artists who **provide the rhythm** and the **chorus**.
- ❑ **Burra** is the **percussion instrument** used during the performance.

Chavittu Natakam

It is a popular Christian art form in **Kerala**, which originated during 17th century AD. It is also called **stamping drama**, as the artist stamps the floor.

Dashavatar

- ❑ Dashavatar is the most developed theatre form of the **Konkan** and **Goa regions**.
- ❑ The performers personify the ten incarnations of Lord Vishnu-the god of preservation and creativity.
- ❑ The ten incarnations are Matsya (fish), Kurma (tortoise), Varaha (boar), Narsimha (lion-man), Vaman (dwarf), Parashuram, Rama, Krishna (or Balram), Buddha and Kalki.
- ❑ Apart from stylized make-up, the Dashavatar performers wear masks of wood and papier mache.

Daskathia

- ❑ This theatre form belongs to **Odisha**.
- ❑ There are two narrators – **Gayaka** (chief singer) and **Palia** (co-narrator) who mainly narrate the story of Shiva and other Gods.
- ❑ The narration is accompanied by music composed using a wooden musical instrument called **kathia**.

Garodas

- ❑ It is a theatre form from **Gujarat**.
- ❑ It is a popular art form of the '**Garoda**' community.
- ❑ It uses **painted pictures** to narrate stories of **romance and valour**.

Kariyila

- ❑ It is an open-air theatre from **Himachal Pradesh**.
- ❑ The performance occurs throughout the **night** and comprises a **series of small plays** and skits.

Koodiyattam

- ❑ It is one of the oldest traditional theatre forms of **Kerala**, and is based on Sanskrit theatre traditions.
- ❑ It involves distinct characters, including **Chakyaar** (actor), **Naambiyaar** (instrumentalists), **Naangyaar** (women's roles), **Sutradhar** (narrator), and **Vidushak** (jesters).



Fig. 7.3: Koodiyattam

- ❑ Emphasis on hand gestures and eye movements makes this dance and theatre form unique.
- ❑ It is listed as a **UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage**.

Krishnattam

- ❑ This is a folk theatre of **Kerala** which came into existence in the middle of the 17th century A.D. under the patronage of **King Manavada** of Calicut.
- ❑ Krishnattam is a **cycle of eight plays** performed for eight consecutive days. The plays are Avataram, Kalamandana, Rasa krida, kamasavadha, Swayamvaram, Bana Yudham, Vivida Vadham, and Swargarohana.



Fig. 7.4:
Krishnattam

- ❑ The episodes are based on the **theme of Lord Krishna** – his birth, childhood pranks and various deeds depicting victory of good over evil.

Kuruvanji

- ❑ This theatre form belongs to **Tamil Nadu**.
- ❑ The first Kuruvanji was composed by **Thirukutarajappa Kaviyar**.
- ❑ The **basic theme** revolves around a **love-struck heroine**.
- ❑ It is performed in a **dance ballet** form with **Bharatnatyam**.

Mudiyettu

- ❑ Mudiyettu, traditional folk theatre form of **Kerala** is celebrated in the month of Vrischikam (November-December).
- ❑ It is primarily performed in Kali Temple.



Fig. 7.5: Mudiyettu

- ❑ It serves as an **offering to the Goddess** and portrays the **triumph** of **goddess Bhadrakali** over the **asura Darika**.
- ❑ The performance features **seven characters**, including Shiva, Narada, Darika, Danavendra, Bhadrakali, Kooli, and Koimbidar, all adorned with elaborate makeup.

Maach

- ❑ Maach is the traditional theatre form of **Madhya Pradesh**.
- ❑ The term Maach is used for the stage itself as also for the play. In this theatre form songs are given prominence in between the dialogues.
- ❑ The term for dialogue in this form is bol and rhyme in narration is termed vanag.
- ❑ The tunes of this theatre form are known as rangat.

Oja-Pali

- ❑ Oja-Pali is a narrative theatre from **Assam**.
- ❑ It is associated with the festival of **Manasa** or the serpent goddess.
- ❑ **Oja** is the **main narrator**, and **Pali** are the members of the **chorus**.

Powada

- ❑ This theatre form belongs to **Maharashtra**.
- ❑ It represents the heroic deeds of **Shivaji against Afjal Khan**.
- ❑ Songs are sung by the folk musicians known as **Gondhalis and Shahirs**.

Raasleela

- ❑ This theatre form belongs to **Uttar Pradesh**.
- ❑ It is based on **Lord Krishna's** legends. It's believed that **Nand Das** wrote the initial plays. It combines **prose dialogues** with **songs** and scenes.

Swang

- ❑ This is a folk theatre of **Punjab** and **Haryana**.
- ❑ Initially, it was **music-based** but gradually incorporated **prose** into its dialogues.
- ❑ The two important styles of Swang are from **Rohtak** and **Haathras**. In the style belonging to Rohtak, the language used is Haryanvi (Bangru) and in Haathras, it is Brajbhasha.

Tamaasha

- ❑ This theatre form belongs to **Maharashtra**.
- ❑ It has evolved from the folk forms such as Gondhal, Jagran and Kirtan.
- ❑ Unlike other theatre forms, in Tamaasha the female actress is the chief exponent of dance movements in the play. She is known as Murki.
- ❑ Classical music, footwork at lightning-speed, and vivid gestures make it possible to portray all the emotions through dance.

Therukoothu

- ❑ Therukoothu, the most popular form of folk drama of **Tamil Nadu**, literally means "street play".
- ❑ It is mostly performed at the time of annual **temple festivals of Mariamman (Rain goddess)** to achieve a rich harvest.
- ❑ At the core of the extensive repertoire of Therukoothu, there is a cycle of eight plays based on the life of Draupadi.
- ❑ Kattiakaran, the Sutradhara of the Therukoothu performance, gives the gist of the play to the audience and Komali entertains the audience with his buffoonery.



Fig. 7.6:
Therukoothu

Villu Pattu

It is a form of **musical theatre** in which stories of **Ramayana** are narrated. This theatre form is popular in **Southern India**.

Yakshagana

- ❑ It is an open theatre form from **Karnataka**.
- ❑ It presents prominent episodes from the **Mahabharata** and **Ramayana**.
- ❑ It had its origins in the royal courts of the Vijayanagar dynasty and It was performed by a certain group of people known as Jakkula Varu

Pagati Veshalu

It is a widely practiced folk tradition in **Andhra Pradesh** as well as **Telangana**. The main character known as vesham (disguise), and several other characters center around this role-playing act.

Bayalata

Karnataka has a practice of performing theater outside while worshipping a local deity. The stories are based on the love of Radha Krishna.

Theyyam

- ❑ Theyyam is an open air theatre performance that is held in **Kerala**.
- ❑ It is comparable to the Bhuta Kola tradition in Karnataka.
- ❑ These days, **themes** of **Shaivism**, **Shaktism**, and **Vaishnavism** are prevalent.
- ❑ The performers dress in vibrant clothes and ornate headdresses.



Fig. 7.7: Theyyam

Tal-Maddale

- ❑ This theatre form belongs to **Karnataka**.
- ❑ Maddale is a type of drum and Tal is a type of cymbal.
- ❑ It is usually regarded as Yakshagana's forerunner. The performance is done in a seated manner without the use of acting, dancing, or costumes.
- ❑ A Bhagavata narrates with the help of a group of Arthadharis.

Other Theatre Forms: Naqal/Bhand (Punjab), Nautanki (Uttar Pradesh), Oggukatha (Andhra Pradesh), Zadipatti (Maharashtra), Ranmale and Tiatr (Goa), Nacha (Chattisgarh) etc.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

What role do classical and folk theatre play in addressing the value mismatch that leads to intergenerational conflicts?

INDIAN CINEMA

Indian cinema is incredibly diverse, vibrant and influential, reflecting the rich cultural tapestry of the country. It encompasses a wide range of genres, languages, and styles, with Bollywood often being the most recognized globally. However, Indian cinema is much more than just Bollywood; it includes regional industries such as Tamil, Telugu, Malayalam, Kannada, Bengali, and many others, each with its own distinct characteristics and audience.

History of Indian Cinema

Lumiere Brothers (inventors of Cinematograph) introduced **motion pictures** to India. They exhibited **six soundless short films** in Bombay in 1896.

- ❑ The first Indian film, "**Coconut Fair and Our Indian Empire**," was shot in **1897**.
- ❑ Italian duo, **Colorello and Cornaglia**, held exhibitions in Bombay with films like "**The Death of Nelson**" and "**Noah's Ark**" in 1898.

Pioneer in Indian Film Making

- ❑ **Harishchandra Bhatvadekar**, known as **Save Dada**, created two short films in 1899.
- ❑ **F.B. Thanawalla** and **Hiralal Sen** were notable Indian filmmakers during the early 1900s.
- ❑ **Warwick Major** established the **first cinema house in Madras** (now Chennai) in 1900.
- ❑ **Jamshedjee Madan** found the **Elphinstone Picture House** in Calcutta (now Kolkata) in 1907.
- ❑ **Universal Studios** established the first Hollywood-based agency in India in **1916**.

Evolution of Indian Cinema

❑ The Era of Silent Films (1910 to 1920)

- Despite being called "silent," these films featured music and dance accompaniments.
- Dadasaheb Phalke produced "**Raja Harishchandra**" in **1913**, the first indigenous Indian silent film, earning him the title of the father of Indian cinema.
- Fatma Begum became the first woman filmmaker who produced and directed a film called **Bulbul-e-Paristan**.

❑ Talking Films: "**Alam Ara**," the first talking film, was produced by the Imperial Film Company.

❑ Emergence of Major Film Banners

- During **late 1930s**, prominent film banners like Bombay Talkies, New Theatres, and Prabhat emerged.
- The studio system was first employed in 1935 in P.C Barua's film "**Devdas**."

❑ Introduction of Color Films

- "**Sairandhri**" in 1933 was the first Indian colour film (though it was processed and printed in Germany).
- "**Kisan Kanya**," in 1937, which holds the distinction of being the first indigenous colour film.

❑ Independence Struggle in the 1940s was prominently displayed in films such as "**Dharti ke Lal**" and "**Do Aankhen Baarah Haath**."

❑ Post Independence the **Central Board of Film Certification** was established in 1950s to regulate the content of the films.

- This era witnessed the rise of "**film stars**" who became household names and achieved unprecedented fame.
- **E.g.: Trinity of Hindi cinema**, consisting of Dilip Kumar, Dev Anand, and Raj Kapoor, emerged.

❑ Shift Towards Women-Centric Themes (1980s)

- Several female directors gained recognition, including **Sai Paranjpye** ("**Chasme Baddoor**," "**Sparsh**"), **Kalpna Lajmi** ("**Ek Pal**"), and **Aparna Sen** ("**36 Chowringhee Lane**").
- Internationally, Meera Nair's "**Salaam Bombay**" won the Golden Cannes Award in 1989. These films often explored the changing roles of women in Indian society.

❑ The phase of Romantic Cinema (1980-2000)

- During this phase, movies addressed social issues, romantic films, and family dramas gaining substantial audiences.

❑ Impact of Liberalization, Globalization, and Privatization (LPG) reforms This phase promoted technological advancements, including

- **India's first 3D movie**, "**My Dear Kuttichatan**" (dubbed in Hindi as "**Chhota Chetan**").
- The introduction of the Dolby sound system through "**1942: A Love Story**" marked this period.

National Film Awards

The awards **started in 1954**.

- ❑ The **first-ever feature film** to receive this honour was **Shyamchi Aai**.
- ❑ The **Best Short Film Award** was presented to **Mahabalipuram**.
- ❑ Sohrab Modi's **Mirza Ghalib**, released in 1954, became the first film to win the President's Gold Medal.

The Cinematograph (Amendment) Bill, 2023

The historic bill was passed by the Parliament, amending the Cinematograph Act after 40 years as the last significant amendments in the Cinematograph Act, 1952, were made in the year 1984.

Objectives

- ❑ The Bill attempts to address the issue of unauthorised recording and exhibition of films and curb the menace of film piracy by transmission of unauthorized copies on the internet.
- ❑ The Bill attempts to improve the procedure for certification of films for public exhibition by the Central Board of Film Certification, as well as improve categorisations of the certifications of the films.
- ❑ The Bill attempts to harmonise the law with extant executive orders, Supreme Court judgements, and other relevant legislations.

Provisions of the Bill

- ❑ To check film piracy by way of cam-recording in the theatres and, most importantly, also prohibit any unauthorized copying and online transmission & exhibition of a pirated copy of any film, strict penal provisions have been incorporated. The Bill has provisions for a jail term from 3 months to 3 years and a fine from Rs. 3 Lakhs to 5% of the audited gross production cost.
- ❑ **Autonomy** of the **Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC)** has been emphasized by limiting the revisional powers of the central government over CBFC's decisions as per the judgment of the Supreme Court in the case of **K.M. Shankarappa vs Union of India (2000)**.

- ❑ **Age-based categories of certification** by further subdividing the existing UA category into three age-based categories, viz. **seven years (UA 7+)**, **thirteen years (UA 13+)**, and **sixteen years (UA 16+)** have been introduced. These age-based markers would be only recommendatory, meant for the parents or guardians to consider whether their children should view such a film.
- ❑ Television broadcast of adult-rated films is forbidden. As a result, broadcasters choose to voluntarily make cuts and apply for CBFC re-certification for a U/A grade. Films can now be recertified for television and other media as Bill formalizes this process.
- ❑ The **validity of the certificate** has been extended **from 10 years to perpetuity**.
- ❑ It attempts to include **copyright protection** into the purview of the Cinematograph Act, 1952, which was mainly concerned with censorship.

Cinematograph Act of 1952

- ❑ Section 3 of the Act mandates the establishment of the Central Board of Film Certification /Censor Board.
 - CBFC is a **statutory body** under the **Ministry of Information and Broadcasting**.
- ❑ It also provides for the establishment of an Appellate Tribunal to hear appeals against the decisions of the Board.

CONCLUSION

Theatre and Cinema in India stand as pillars of cultural expression, entertainment and societal reflection. With deep historical roots and continuous evolution, both forms of art have played integral roles in shaping the cultural identity of the nation. As India continues to embrace modernity while cherishing its traditions, theatre and cinema remain vital components of the nation's cultural landscape. Through their power to entertain, educate, and inspire, they bridge the gap between the past and the present, offering glimpses into India's complex and ever-evolving identity.

Puppetry in India

8

INTRODUCTION

Puppetry in India has a rich and diverse history, where each region boasts its unique style, technique and **storytelling** traditions. India is said to be the origin of puppetry, with multiple puppet forms, themes and styles found across the length and breadth of the country. Puppetry in India can be broadly classified into four categories, i.e. **String** Puppets, **Shadow** Puppets, **Rod** Puppets and **Glove** Puppets.

Historical References

- ❑ The excavation sites at **Harappa and Mohenjo-Daro** have yielded **puppets with sockets** attached to them.
- ❑ It finds mention in **Silappadikaaram** (composed around the 1st – 2nd Century BC).
- ❑ **Natyashastra** mentions **Sutradhar** (holder of strings) as producer-cum-director of the human theatre.

STRING PUPPETS

String puppets, also known as **string marionettes**, are a type of puppet controlled by strings or wires attached to various parts of the puppet's body. The puppeteer exerts control by **attaching strings** to small openings in the **hands, head, and back** of the puppet's body. They have **jointed limbs** that allow greater **flexibility**, making them **more articulate**.

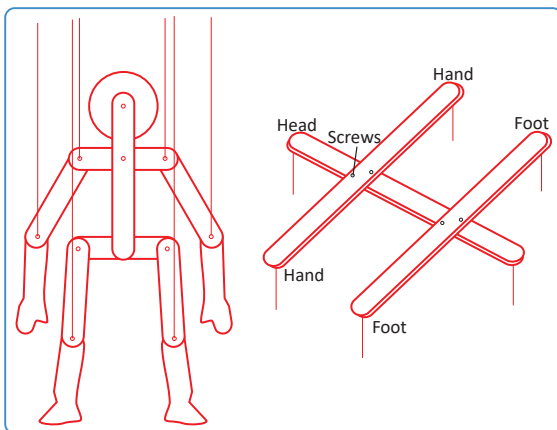


Fig. 8.1: Jointed limbs in a string Puppet

- ❑ The puppets are **carved from wood**, and **oil colors** are applied to give them lifelike features.
- ❑ **Limbs** are fashioned from small wooden pipes, the body is adorned with **vibrant outfits** and **miniature jewellery** is affixed to give it an authentic feel.

Kathputli

- ❑ The traditional marionettes of **Rajasthan** are known as Kathputli.
- ❑ The name is derived from two joining words of Rajasthani language that is 'kath' meaning wood and 'putli' meaning a doll which has no life.
- ❑ Carved from a **single piece of wood**, these puppets are like **large dolls** that are **colourfully dressed** in medieval Rajasthani-style outfits.
- ❑ These puppets wear **long trailing skirts and do not have legs**.
- ❑ Distinct facial features include **Oval faces, large eyes, arched eyebrows and large lips**.
- ❑ The Kathputli is accompanied by **highly dramatized regional music**.



Fig. 8.2: Kathputli

Kundhei

- ❑ The string puppets of **Odisha** are known as Kundhei.
- ❑ Made of light wood, the Odisha puppets **have no legs** but wear long flowing skirts.
- ❑ They have **more joints** and are, therefore, **more versatile**, articulate and easy to manipulate.
- ❑ The puppeteers often hold a **wooden prop, triangular** in shape, to which strings are attached for manipulation.
- ❑ The costumes resemble those worn by actors of the **Jatra traditional theatre**.
- ❑ The accompanying music is regional and often inspired by **Odissi**.



Fig. 8.3: Sakhi kandhei

Gombeyatta

- ❑ The string puppets of **Karnataka** are called Gombeyatta.
- ❑ The Gombeyatta puppet figures are **highly stylized and have joints at the legs**, shoulders, elbows, hips and knees. They are manipulated by **five to seven strings** tied to a prop.
- ❑ They are styled and **designed** like the characters of **Yakshagana**, the traditional **theatre** form of the region. Episodes are based on the **Prasangas of the Yakshagana plays**.

- ❑ Some of the more complicated movements of the puppet are manipulated by **two to three puppeteers at a time**.
- ❑ The music that accompanies it is dramatic and beautifully blends folk and classical elements.

Bommalattam



Fig. 8.4: Bommalattam

- ❑ Puppets from **Tamil Nadu**, known as Bommalattam combine the techniques of both rod and string puppets.
- ❑ The Bommalattam puppets are the **largest, heaviest, and most articulate** of all traditional Indian marionettes, up to **4.5 feet tall** and weighing up to **10kgs**.
- ❑ They are made of **wood**, and the **strings** for manipulation are tied to an **iron ring** which the **puppeteer** wears like a **crown** on his head. A few puppets have jointed arms and hands, which are manipulated by rods.
- ❑ Bommalattam theatre has **elaborate preliminaries** which are divided **into four parts** – **Vinayak Puja, Komali, Amanattam** and **Pusenkanattam**.

SHADOW PUPPETS

India has the richest variety of types and styles of shadow puppets. Shadow puppets are flat and translucent cut out from treated leather. Shadow puppets are pressed against the screen with a strong source of light behind them. The **manipulation between the light and the screen makes silhouettes or colourful shadows**, as the case may be, for the viewers who sit in front of the screen. This tradition of shadow puppets survives in Orissa. Kerala, Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, Maharashtra and Tamil Nadu.

Togalu Gombeyatta

- ❑ The shadow theatre of **Karnataka** is known as Togalu Gombeyatta.
- ❑ Togalu Gombeyatta puppets are **mostly small** in size.
- ❑ A unique feature of the Togalu Gombeyatta puppets is the variation of puppet size based on social status, for instance, **large sizes for kings** and religious characters and **smaller sizes for common people** or servants.

Tholu Bommalata

- ❑ Tholu Bommalata, **Andhra Pradesh's** shadow theatre has the richest and strongest tradition.
- ❑ Tholu Bommalata puppets are **large in size** and have **jointed waists, shoulders, elbows and knees**.
- ❑ They are **coloured on both sides**. Hence, these puppets throw coloured shadows on the screen.

- ❑ The **music** is influenced by regional classical music, while the puppet play themes that are drawn from **Ramayana, Mahabharata and Puranas**.



Fig. 8.5: Tholu Bommalata

Ravana Chhaya

- ❑ **This type of shadow puppetry belongs to Odisha.**
- ❑ Ravana-chhaya puppets are in one piece and have **no joints**. Thus, the manipulation requires **great dexterity**.
- ❑ The puppets are made of **deer skin** and are conceived in **bold dramatic poses**.
- ❑ Although, Ravana Chhaya puppets are smaller in size-the largest not more than two feet have no jointed limbs, they create very sensitive and lyrical shadows.
- ❑ Props such as **trees, mountains, chariots**, etc. are also used along with human figures.

ROD PUPPETS

Rod puppets are an **extension of glove puppets** but are **often much larger** and supported and **manipulated by rods** from below. This form of puppetry is now found **mostly in West Bengal and Orissa**.

Putul Nautch

- ❑ The traditional rod puppet form of **West Bengal** is known as Putul Nautch.
- ❑ The Bengal rod puppets are **about 3 to 4 feet** in height. They are **carved from wood** and follow the various artistic styles of a particular region.
- ❑ The music, costume and verbal text closely follow the **Jatra theatre style**. In the **Nadia district** of West Bengal, **rod puppets used to be of human size** like the Bunraku puppets of Japan. This form is now **almost extinct**.
- ❑ These puppets have **mostly three joints**. The heads, supported by the main rod, are joined at the **neck, and both hands** attached to rods are joined at the **shoulders**.
- ❑ A bamboo-made hub is tied firmly to **the waist** of the puppeteer on which the **rod holding the puppet** is placed.
- ❑ The **singing puppeteer** is accompanied by a group of **musicians with a drum, harmonium and cymbals**.



Fig. 8.6: Putul Nautch

Kathi Kandhe (Odisha Rod Puppetry)

- ❑ The Kathi Kandhe puppets are **much smaller in size**, usually about twelve to eighteen inches.
- ❑ They also have **mostly three joints**, but the hands are tied to strings instead of rods. Thus elements of rod and string puppets are combined in this form of puppetry.
- ❑ The technique of manipulation is somewhat different. The Orissa rod-puppeteers squat on the ground behind a screen and manipulate.
- ❑ It is more operatic in its verbal contents since impromptu prose dialogues are infrequently used. Most of the dialogues are sung. The music blends folk tunes with classical Odissi tunes. The music begins with a short piece of ritual orchestral preliminary called Stuti and is followed by the play.
- ❑ The puppets of Orissa are **smaller than** those from **Bengal or Andhra Pradesh**.

Yampuri

- ❑ The traditional Rod puppet of **Bihar** is known as Yampuri.
- ❑ These puppets are made of **wood**. Unlike the traditional Rod puppets of West Bengal and Orissa, these puppets are in one piece and have no joints.
- ❑ As these puppets have **no joints**, the manipulation is different from other Rod puppets and requires greater dexterity.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

How can puppetry be integrated into broader social campaigns and movements to maximize its impact?

GLOVE PUPPETS

Glove puppets are also known as **sleeve, hand or palm puppets**. The head is made of either papier mache, cloth or wood, with two hands emerging from just below the neck. The rest of the figure consists of a long flowing skirt.

- ❑ The movements are controlled by the **human hand the first finger** inserted in the **head**, and the **middle finger** and the **thumb** are the **two arms** of the puppet.

- ❑ The tradition of glove puppets in India is popular in **Uttar Pradesh, Odisha, West Bengal** and **Kerala**.
- ❑ In **Uttar Pradesh**, glove puppet plays usually present **social themes**, whereas in **Odisha** such plays are based on stories of **Radha** and **Krishna**.
- ❑ In Odisha, the puppeteer plays on the **dholak** with one hand and **manipulates the puppet** with the other. The delivery of the **dialogues**, the **movement of the puppet** and the **beat of the dholak** are well **synchronised** and create a dramatic atmosphere.

Pavakoothu

- ❑ In **Kerala**, the traditional glove puppet play is called Pavakoothu.
- ❑ It originated in the **18th century** influenced by Kerala's famous classical dance-drama, **Kathakali**.
- ❑ Puppet height ranges from **one to two feet**, with **wooden head** and **arms** joined by thick cloth. **Face** of the puppet is adorned with paints, gilded tin, peacock feathers, etc.
- ❑ The musical instruments used during the performance are Chenda, Chengiloa, Ilathalam and Shankhathe conch.
- ❑ Themes are drawn from episodes of **Ramayana** or **Mahabharata**.



Fig. 8.7: Pavakoothu Glove Puppet

CONCLUSION

Overall, puppetry in India transcends its role as mere entertainment to become a powerful medium for expressing, preserving and celebrating the country's rich cultural heritage and identity. It continues to thrive as a vibrant art form that entertains, educates, and inspires audiences across the nation.

Religion in India

9

INTRODUCTION

Religion in India is a dynamic and integral aspect of its cultural, social and historical identity. With a history spanning millennia, India has been the birthplace and nurturing ground for several major world religions, as well as numerous indigenous faiths and belief systems. According to the data of **Census 2011**, alongside **Hindus (96.63 Cr./ 79.8%)**, India is also home to significant **Muslim (17.22 Cr./ 14.2%)**, **Christian (2.78 Cr./ 2.3%)**, **Sikh (2.08 Cr./ 1.7%)**, **Buddhist (0.84 Cr./ 0.7%)**, **Jain (0.45 Cr./ 0.4%)** and **other religious communities (0.79 Cr./ 0.7%)**.

HINDUISM

It is very difficult to describe a single belief system as comprising Hinduism. As such, it is very difficult to identify a single concept of God, holy book or even religious practice to define Hinduism. There are a set of belief systems that constitute Hinduism. In spite of this diversity, there do exist common threads binding a large number of people following Hinduism.

Majorly Common Characteristics of Hinduism

- ❑ **Brahman:** Hindus believe in an eternal, infinite and all-embracing ultimate force called Brahman. Brahman is present in all forms of life. The relationship between Brahman (the universal soul) and Atman (the individual soul) has been the main concern in Hinduism.
- ❑ **Atman:** The Atman is considered indestructible and passes through an endless migration or incarnations of human, animal or super human forms.

By gaining correct knowledge of Atman and Brahman, it is possible to become free from suffering and bondage and attain a state of immortality, everlasting peace and fulfilment known as **Moksha**.

- ❑ **Dharma:** In the religious context, it includes cosmological, ethical, social and legal principles that provide the notion of an ordered universe. In the social context, it refers to the rules of social intercourse laid down for all the categories of people.
- ❑ **Purusartha:** A complete life according to Hinduism pertains to four pursuits:

- Dharma
- Artha (material pursuits)
- Kama (love desires)
- Moksha (salvation).

A successful life should be able to integrate these pursuits:

- ❑ **Karma:** Karma, in simple terms, is spending life according to the code laid down by Dharma: Natural law of living with good deeds, contention and happiness, so that one can avoid misery and suffering.
- ❑ **Kama:** It denotes the desire to pursue pleasure and enjoyment in life. It must be pursued along with other three elements.
- ❑ **Artha:** It is the pursuit of attaining material comfort to live in this world with ease.

Pre-Vedic Religion

Hinduism had its **origins** in the **Harappan civilization**, and they worshipped mainly the **elements of nature** like **trees (peepal)** and **animals (humped bull) etc.**

Phallus Worship

- ❑ Phallicism which **started in the days of Harappa**, came to be recognized as a respectable form of worship in Hindu society.
- ❑ Numerous symbols of the phallus and female sex organs made of stone have been found in Harappa, possibly meant for worship.
- ❑ The **Rig-veda** also speaks of the **non-Aryan people who were phallus worshippers**.
- ❑ In later times, phallus worship became intimately connected with **Lord Shiva**.
- ❑ The Harappans looked upon the **Earth** as a **fertility goddess** and worshipped her in the same manner as the **Egyptians worshipped the Nile Goddess 'Isis'**.
- ❑ The **male deity** in the Indus Valley is represented on the Pasupathy seal with **three heads** and **horns**. The four animals, **Elephant, Tiger, Rhinoceros and Buffalo** below his throne may have served as **vehicles for Gods**.
 - In later Hinduism, every god is supposed to have his own conveyance for his movements.
- ❑ There were **no temples** for worshipping God, as seen in ancient Egypt and Mesopotamia.
- ❑ Belief in **spirits** and **ghosts** was present as seen with the prevalence of **amulets**.

Vedic Religion

Aryans personified the **natural forces** and looked upon them as **living beings** to whom they gave human or animal attributes.

- They composed many **hymns** in honour of the gods and goddesses they worshipped. These were compiled into **four Vedas**.

The word **Veda** means wisdom of the **sacred spiritual knowledge**. These Vedas were considered **infallible** as they imparted the highest spiritual knowledge.

The four Vedas are:

- **Rig Veda:** It contains hymns dedicated to various Vedic Gods. It is the **oldest text**.
- **Yajur Veda:** It concentrates on rites and mantras of different types of sacrifices prevalent in the Vedic times.
- **Sama Veda:** It concentrates on the melody or songs and provides tunes for various hymns. It has been called the **Book of Chants**.
- **Atharva Veda:** It contains a great deal of animistic beliefs. It deals mostly with magic and medicines. (Animism is the belief that objects, places, and creatures all possess a distinct spiritual essence)

Rig Veda

Yajur Veda

Sama Veda

Atharva Veda

Fig. 9.1: The four Vedas

- Scholars divided the Vedic period into **Earlier** and **Later Vedic periods**. The earlier is represented by the **Rig Veda**, while the latter is represented by all other Vedic literature, including the **Brahmanas, Aranyakas and Upanishads**.

Early Vedic Period

- The dominant mode of worship in this period was through **recitation of prayers** and **offering of sacrifices**. Both collective and individual prayers were made.
- Every tribe or clan was the **votary** of a **special God**, and in the case of sacrifices, **Agni** and **Indra** were invited to partake in the sacrifices made by the whole tribe.
- Offerings of **vegetables, barley** etc., were made to Gods, but this process was **not accompanied by any ritual or sacrificial formulae**.
- Worship was mainly for **Praja** (children), **Pasu** (cattle), **food, wealth, health** etc. but not for spiritual uplift.

Rig Vedic Gods

- The **most important** one is **Indra**, who is called **Purandara** or **breaker of forts**. He played the role of **warlord** and was also considered to be the **Rain God**. Rig Veda devoted **250 hymns** to him.

- The **second** position was occupied by **Agni** (fire God). He acted as an **intermediary between the Gods and the people**. The oblations offered to Agni were transmitted to God in the **form of smoke**. The cult of fire was also found in **Iran**. Rig Veda devoted **200 hymns** to him.
- The **third** important position is occupied by **Varuna**, who personified **water**. He was supposed to uphold the natural order, and whatever happened in the world was thought to be a reflection of his desires.
- Other important Gods are **Soma** (God of plants), after whom an intoxicating drink was named, **Maruts** (personify the storm), **Aditi** and **Ushas** (representing the dawn).

Later Vedic Period

- **Indra** and **Agni** were **less significant** in the later Vedic era, and a **new Trinity of Gods** took their place: **Brahma** held the position of Supreme Deity, **Vishnu** served as the preserver, and **Shiva** completed the Trinity.
- In addition, some **symbolic objects** began to be worshipped, and we noticed signs of **idolatry**.
- Some social classes came to have their **own deities**. **Pushan**, who was supposed to look after the **cattle**, came to be regarded as the **God of Sudras**.
- The religion became extremely **ritualistic**. **Sanskrit mantras** which were the monopoly of Brahmins, became an **essential** part of all religious functions.
- **Sacrificial ceremonies** attained significance during this time.
- Participation in the rituals was restricted to the upper three classes Brahmana, Kshatriya and Vaisya.

Sacrifices

- It involved the killing of animals on a large scale, especially **cattle**.
- The guest was known as **goghna**, or one who was fed on cattle, and the sacrificer was known as the **yajamana**, the performer of yajna.
- Sacrifices were performed both publicly by the King and privately by the individuals in their houses.
 - Kings performed **Ashvamedha, Rajasuya** and **Vajapeya** sacrifices to establish their position.
 - Much of the success of the sacrifice depends on the **magical power of words** uttered which had to be carefully pronounced according to a formulae. These formulae were invented by the **priests** called **the Brahmanas**.
- Brahmanas were only **one** of the **sixteen types of priests** who officiated the sacrifices and were rewarded with **Dakshina or gifts**.

Worship of Goddess in Hinduism

- Hinduism took a while to develop the worship of the Supreme Goddess, despite the fact that there is evidence of Mother Goddess devotion throughout the Harappan Civilization.
 - Only from the **sixth century AD**, various mother goddesses such as **Durga, Amba, Kali, Chandi** etc., came to be regarded as goddesses in the Puranas and in the Tantra literature. In the course of time, every village came to have its own **separate goddess**.

Hinduism in the Post-Vedic Era

Hinduism changed significantly throughout history. It gave rise to a number of other religious groups with distinct customs and beliefs within itself.

Transformation of Vedic Brahmanism into Puranic Hinduism

- The transformation of the **ancient Brahmanical** faith into **modern Hinduism** can be regarded as the most distinguishing feature from the **Gupta period** onwards.
- During the **Gupta period**, Buddhism no longer received as much royal patronage as it did earlier. **Brahmanism** had come to the **forefront**.
- The Gupta rulers encouraged the **Bhagavata sect of Hinduism**. They called themselves **Bhagavatas** and worshipped **Lord Vishnu** as the preserver of **Dharma**.
- The Puranas were finally compiled in this age. **Vishnu Purana** had numerous legends around Vishnu and a law book called **Vishnumriti** was also named after him.
- By the 4th century AD, there came into being a famous Vaishnava work called 'Shrimadbhagavad-purana' which taught devotion to Lord Krishna.
- A few Gupta Kings were also worshippers of **Shiva, the God of destruction** and also worshipped Brahma, Surya, Kartikeya, Ganesha, Durga, Lakshmi, Saraswathi and others.

- The **snakes, the Yakshas and the Gandharvas** also continued to be revered, and idol worship became popular.

- Numerous religious sects arose in the **middle Gangetic basin** in the **sixth century BC**. We hear as many as **62 religious sects** in this period which were based on regional customs and rituals practiced by different people living in North-East India.
- Of these, **Jainism and Buddhism** became the most important, and they emerged as the most potent religious reform movements.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

Analyze the role of hierarchical social structure, power dynamics and economy in shaping Hinduism.

Different Sects of Hinduism

Vaishnavism

The **Vasudeva-Bhagavata cult**, which had its birth during the Gupta period, grew steadily, absorbing within its fold other Vedic and Brahmanic divinities like **Vishnu** (primarily an aspect of the Sun) and **Narayana** (a cosmic God).

- **Bhagavatism**, which was a **contemporary** to **Buddhism** and **Jainism**, owed its birth to the stream of thought which began with **Upanishads** and became the most popular sect during the Gupta age.
- From the late Gupta period, the name mostly used to designate this Bhakti cult was **Vaishnava**, indicating the predominance of the Vedic Vishnu element in it with emphasis on the **doctrine of incarnations** (avatars).
- The movement was based upon devotion towards a **Sakar form** of God, mainly **Rama** and **Krishna**, who were seen as incarnations (avatars) of Lord Vishnu.
- Vaishnava poet-saints known as **Alvars** (a Tamil word denoting those drowned in Vishnu-bhakti) preached single-minded devotion (**ekatmika bhakti**) for Vishnu, and their songs were collectively known as **prabandhas**.

Prominent Sects under Vaishnavism

Sect	Features
Ramanandi Sampradaya	□ The largest monastic group within Hinduism is comprised of Vaishnava monks known as Ramanandis, Vairagis or Bairagis. □ Primarily settled around the Gangetic Plains, they engage in meditation and rigorous ascetic practices. □ These ascetics follow the teachings of the Advaita scholar Ramananda and center their worship on Rama, one of the ten incarnations of Vishnu.

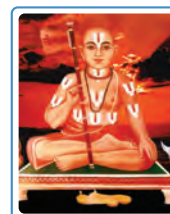


Fig. 9.2: Ramananda

Pushti Marg Sampradaya	- Found by Vallabhacharya around 1500 AD, this devotional tradition centers around pure love for Lord Krishna. - The philosophy espoused by its followers asserts that the ultimate truth is singular, represented by Brahm.
Nimbarka Sampradaya	Referred to as the Hamsa Sampradaya or Kumara Sampradaya, this tradition involves the worship of the deities Radha and Krishna.
Brahma Sampradaya	- Madhvacharya was the founder of this sampradaya. - This spiritual tradition is linked to Lord Vishnu, the Universal Creator. - Gaudiya Vaishnavism, advocated by Chaitanya Mahaprabhu, and ISKCON are affiliated with the Brahma Sampradaya.
Warkari Sampradaya	- This community worships Lord Vishnu in his manifestation as Vithoba, with spiritual epicentre being the temple at Pandharpur in Maharashtra. - Notable figures associated with this tradition include Jnaneswar, Namdev, Eknath and Tukaram. - Various events, such as Ringan and Dhava, are organized during the pilgrimage. In the Ringan event, a sacred horse dashes through rows of pilgrims, who eagerly attempt to catch dust particles kicked off by the horse and apply them to their heads as a sacred ritual.



Fig. 9.3: Warkari community celebrating Palkhi festival

Shaivism

Unlike Vaishnavism, Shaivism had its origin in antiquity.

Panini refers to a group of Shiva- worshippers as **Shiva-bhagavatas**, who were characterised by the iron lances and clubs they carried and their skin garments.

- The Shiva movement in the South flourished because of the activities of 63 Saints known in Tamil as **Nayanars**.

- Nayanars hailed from all castes, and their appealing emotional songs in Tamil were called **Tevaram Stotras**, also known as **Dravida Veda**, and ceremonially sung in local Shiva temples.

Different Sects under Shaivism

Sect	Features
Aghoris	- They worship Bhairava (Manifestation of Shiva). - They do sadhana on cremation grounds to seek salvation from the cycle of reincarnation. - Tamasic ritual practices are part of their worship. - They believe in the removal of bonds from their life, which are sensual pleasure, anger etc.
Lingayatism	- It is a distinct Shaivite tradition that believes in monotheism through worship centered on Lord Shiva in the form of Linga. - It was established in the 12th century AD by Basava. - Authority of the Vedas and the caste system is rejected by them. - It is also known as Veerashaivism. - They questioned the theory of rebirth.
Nathpanthis	- Another name for it is Siddha Siddanta. - They worship Adinath, a manifestation of Shiva, and follow the teachings of Gorakhnath and Matseyndranath. - These are a nomadic bunch of rovers who never settle down for long. They maintain a sacred fire called Dhuni when they stop walking. - In addition to covering themselves in ashes and wearing dhotis and loincloths, the monks also tie their hair up in dreadlocks. - To bring the body into a condition of awakened self's identity with absolute reality, they employ the Hatha Yoga technique.

Siddhars or Siddhas	□ Siddhars were Saints, doctors, alchemists and mystics all in one from Tamil Nadu. □ They were monotheistic and condemned idolatry. □ Siddhars were said to have special eight powers. □ The creators of Varmam, a martial art that serves as a medicinal treatment and self-defence technique, are also thought to be Siddhars. □ They achieve spiritual perfection by practising unique, highly secret rasayanas that enable them to maintain extended periods of meditation and a type of pranayama that significantly lowers the frequency of their breaths.
Dashanami Sanyasis	□ They are Adi Shankaracharya's disciples and belong to the Advaita Vedanta tradition. □ They are further divided into ten groups thus, they are also called "Dash Nam Sanyasi".

Other Minor Sects of Hinduism

- **Shaktism**: It considers feminine and the **Devi** or **goddess** as supreme. It is known for its various sub-traditions of Tantra.

Tantrism

- Both **Shaivism** and **Buddhism** were influenced by these ideas.
- Two basic principles form the basis of all Tantrism
 - It doesn't accept the authority of the Vedas.
 - Fertility rites form a major part of Tantrism.
- Earliest indirect textual reference of Tantrism
 - **Kadambari** and **Harshcharita** by Banabhatta
 - **Mattavilasa** by Mahendravarman
 - **Dashkumarcharita** by Dandin
- **Epigraphical evidence**: Inscription of Vishnavarman (Gangadhar, Rajasthan)(423AD)
- **Tantric practices**
 - The female principle (Prakriti) is of greater importance than the male one (Purusha).
 - They disregarded caste, patriarchy, and class distinctions during rituals.
 - It doesn't believe in idol worship, as the body is considered a microcosm of the universe.

- **Smarta tradition**: It is based on teachings of **Puranas** and they believe in the domestic worship of five shrines with **five deities** all treated as equals: **Shiva, Shakti, Ganesh, Vishnu** and **Surya**.
- **Shrautism**: It belongs to **ultra orthodox** Nambudiri Brahmins of Kerala. They follow the "**Purva- Mimamsa**" school of philosophy and place importance on the performance of Yajna.

BUDDHISM AND JAINISM

Buddhism and Jainism were among the major **heterodox** sects that emerged during the **post-Vedic era**.

Major Reasons for the Emergence of Buddhism and Jainism

- These were a response to the Kshatriya opposition against the dominance of Brahmin rituals.
- The Vedic practise of killing cattle indiscriminately in sacrifices stood in the way of the progress of the **new agricultural economy**, which required the **use of cattle**.
- These religions received support from the **Vaisya community** because:
 - They supported **non-violence**, thus reducing the scope for wars and thereby facilitating trade and commerce.
 - Dharmasutras decried lending money on interest which was rejected by Buddhism and Jainism.
 - Initially, they did not attach any importance to the existing varna system favouring improvement in the position of Vaisyas.

Buddhism

Gautama Buddha, or Siddhartha, was born in **563 BC** into the **Sakya Kshatriya** family in **Lumbini** near Kapilavastu (Nepal). He was a contemporary of Mahavira.

- At the age of 29, he departed the city on a chariot with his beloved **horse Kanthaka** and **Channa, the charioteer**, in search of **eternal truth**. This is known as **Mahabhinishkramana** or the **Great Departure**.
- In Buddhist traditions, nirvana is often described as the extinction of three fires- **Greed (raga)**, **aversion (dwesha)** and **ignorance (moksha)**. When these flames are extinguished, the cycle of rebirth is skipped.
- The **Mauryan pillar** capital, found at Sarnath, popularly known as the **Lion Capital**, symbolises Dhammachakra Pravartan.
- He sat under a **peepal tree (Bodhi tree)** and attained **Nirvana (enlightenment)** at the age of 35, earning the title "**Buddha**" or "**the enlightened**."
- He delivered his **first sermons** at **Sarnath (Deer Park)** in Varanasi. This event is described as **Dharmachakra-Pravartana** or setting in motion the '**wheel of great law**'.

- ❑ He spoke about the **Four Noble Truths** and **the Middle Path** and established **Sangha** to spread his ideas far and wide.
- ❑ The prominent disciples of Buddha were **Sariputta, Mahamoggallana, Mahakaccayana and Ananda**.
- ❑ Buddha had a huge following among both royalty and lay persons.

- Ashoka adopted ideas from Buddhism in his state policy.

Gautama Buddha passed away at the **age of 80** in **483 BC** at **Kushinagar**, in eastern Uttar Pradesh. This is known as **Parinirvana/Mahaparinirvana**.

Events	Symbolic Form	Physical Form
Birth	Elephant /Lotus	Maya's dream
Renunciation	Horse	Buddha (in monk dress) along with Horse
Enlightenment	Peepal Tree	Bhumisparshamudra
First Sermon	Wheel (8 spokes showing 8 paths)	Dharmachakrapravartana
Death	Stupa (holy relics are buried there)	Mahaparinirvana mudra Lying on one side and head resting on the palm.

Code of Conduct	
Common People	Monks
(To stay away from) ❑ Coveting the property of others. ❑ Committing violence. ❑ Using intoxicants. ❑ Speaking a lie. ❑ Indulging in corrupt practices.	❑ Restrictions on monks' food, attire, and sexual conduct. ❑ Prohibition from accepting gold, silver, or engaging in buying and selling. ❑ Resembled a form of primitive communism.

Special Features of Buddhism

- ❑ There are three main elements (**Triratna**) in Buddhism: **Buddha, Sangha** and **Dhamma**.
- ❑ **Spread of Buddhism**
 - Magadha, Kosala, Kausambi, and various republics turned to Buddhism due to Brahmin discrimination, drawn by its **perceived liberalism and democracy** in contrast to Brahmanism.
 - Emperor Ashoka promoted its global spread, particularly in Central Asia, West Asia, and Sri Lanka.

❑ Sangha, or religious order

- Open to everybody, **irrespective of caste and sex**.
- Initially, **only men joined the sangha**, but later, **it admitted women**, facilitated by **Ananda**.
- Monks should faithfully observe the **rules and regulations of the sangha**.
- **Debtors** and **Slaves** were **not** permitted to be members of the sangha without the permission of their masters/superiors.
- ❑ The **first human statues** to be worshipped in India were probably those of the Buddha.
- ❑ Buddha didn't name his successor. He said his teachings would be the guide for his followers.
- ❑ It promoted **rationalism**, thus encouraging critical thinking and logic over superstition.
- ❑ Buddhism does **not accept the authority of Vedas and rejects the existence of the soul as well**.

Buddhist texts mention the term '**Kutagarashala**', which literally means a hut with a pointed roof or groves where travelling mendicants halted. It was a place of intellectual debate and discussion.

Buddhist Councils

Date	Place	King	President	Events
1st Buddhist Council (483 BC) (just after Buddha's death)	Sattapani cave at Rajagriha	Ajatashatru	Maha Kassapa	Upali recited Vinay Pitaka and Ananda recited Sutta Pitaka.
2nd Buddhist Council (383 BC) (a century after Buddha's death)	Vaishali	Kalashoka	Sabbakami	Buddhist order split into Sthaviravadin (Believers in the Teachings of the Elders) and the Mahasamghika (Members of the Great Community).
3rd Buddhist Council (250 BC)	Patliputra	Ashoka	Moggaliputta-Tissa	❑ The last section, called "Kathavatthu", was added to Abhidhamma Pitaka. ❑ Sthaviravadins established themselves firmly and expelled the heretics.

4th Buddhist Council (72 AD)	Kundalvana, Srinagar	Kanishka	- Vasumitra (Monk of Sarvastivada school) - Ashwaghosh (Vice President)	- Commentaries on Pitaka were written. - Sarvastivadin doctrines were compiled in Mahavibhasa. - Division of Buddhism into Mahayana & Hinayana.
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Buddha **taught orally**, and none of Buddha's speeches were written down during his lifetime.

Buddhist Sects

Sthaviravada or Theravada

Theravada in Pali means **"Way of the Elders"**. It is considered an **orthodox form** of Buddhism with the **primary goal** of achieving the **cessation of Kleshas (defilements) and attaining Nirvana**.

- Theravada adheres to **Vibhajjavada (the teaching of analysis)**. This doctrine says that insight must come from **experience, critical investigation**, and **reasoning** of an individual instead of blind faith.
- This branch is prevalent in Southeast Asian countries like Myanmar, Cambodia and Sri Lanka.
- Visuddhimagga** (The Path of Purification) is a theravada text written by **Buddhaghosa** in 5th Century BC in Sri Lanka.

- A subdivision within the Sthaviravadins emerged in the 3rd century BC when the **Sarvastivadins** (school of realistic pluralism) broke away from the **Vibhajjavadins** (analytical school).
- Other prominent offshoots of the Sthaviravadins were the **Sammattiyas** and **the Vatsiputriyas**, both known for their theory of the **Pudgala** (person).

Mahasanghikas

The **first division** in the Buddhist community occurred during the **Second Buddhist Council** when the **Acariyavadins** (followers of the traditional teaching) split away from the **Sthaviravadins** (followers of the Way of the Elders) and formed their own school, known as the **Mahasanghikas**.

- The Mahasanghikas's views on the nature of the Buddha and the Arhat (saint) foreshadowed the development of the Mahayana form of Buddhism.
- Further subdivisions of the Mahasanghikas over the next seven centuries included the **Lokottaravadins, the Ekavyavaharikas, and the Kaukkutikas**.

Hinayana (Lesser Vehicle)

It is a **conservative** and **orthodox** form of Buddhism prevalent in Sri Lanka, Burma, Thailand, and Southeast Asia. It emerged after the fourth Buddhist council.

Characteristics

- Buddha is theoretically neither a god nor a supernatural being.

- They reject idol worship.
- Buddha and the events of his life were represented symbolically.
- There were five principal Buddhas, of whom Gautama was one. One Buddha, Maitreya, was yet to come.
- Buddha's worship or veneration is helpful, but not essential, to the achievement of the salvation goal. This is to be reached by something like the process Gautama taught, namely, meditation, observing four noble truths and keeping of the Dharma, in short, becoming a monk.
- The goal of the Hinayana was to become an **Arhat**, that is, to arrive at Nirvana in the present life; an ideal of salvation of the self, with no reference to the welfare of others, and thus an **egoistic ideal**. It was this fact that caused the followers of the Mahayana school to call the older school the 'little vehicle'.
- Sthaviravada or Theravada is one of the sects of Hinayana.
- Pali language was used predominantly.

Emperor **Ashoka** famously patronised Hinayana Buddhism. **Hiuen Tsang**, who visited Tamil country, mentions in his travel accounts about several **Buddhist Stupas** built by **Asoka** in **Kanchipuram**.

Mahayana Buddhism (Greater Vehicle)

The term "Mahayana" translates to "Great Vehicle" in Sanskrit, signifying a more inclusive and expansive approach to the path of enlightenment. Here are some key features and characteristics of Mahayana Buddhism:

- It considers **Buddha as a God** and focuses on the **Law of Karuna** or compassion over and above the Law of Karma.
- The deification of Buddha started the practice of **idol worship**.
- The concept of **Bodhisattvas** emerged.
 - Bodhisattvas were seen as compassionate beings who, instead of attaining Nirvana, accumulated merit to help others in the world. Those who completed this goal were called **Samyaksambuddha**.
- Sanskrit was their predominant language.
- Its main center was Nalanda University (under Pala Patronage). **Dinnaga** and **Dhammapala**, eminent Buddhist scholars from Kanchipuram, headed the famous Nalanda University.
- This sect was propagated by **emperor Kanishka**.
- It spread to **China & Japan**.

Pala Kings were the great patrons of Buddhism, which supported its growth in the region.

- ❑ Vikramshila and Somapuri monasteries were established under the patronage of Dharmapala, who also bestowed 200 villages upon Nalanda University.
- ❑ Devapala, another significant supporter of Buddhism, allocated five villages to the monastery at Nalanda. His court poet, the Buddhist scholar Vajra-Datta, authored the Lokeshvara-Sataka.
- ❑ Mahipala commanded the restoration of numerous Buddhist edifices.

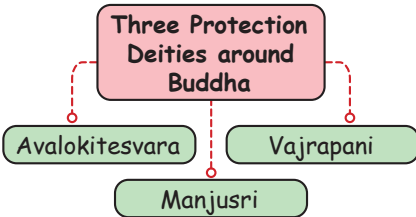
Bodhisattva	Attributes and Roles		
Avalokiteshvara	❑ Known as “The Lord Who Looks Down”, Padmapani (Sanskrit), Lokesvara (Theravada Buddhism). ❑ Manifests Buddha’s Compassion.	 Three Protection Deities around Buddha Avalokitesvara Vajrapani Manjusri Fig. 9.4: The three Bodhisatvas which act as protection deities of Buddha	
Manjusri	❑ Male Bodhisattva, Interlocutor on ultimate truth. ❑ Also known as Wenshu (China) and Jampelyang (Tibet). ❑ Wields a flaming sword (to destroy falsehood) & holds a book. ❑ He is one of the protective deities around Buddha.		
Vajrapani	❑ Manifests Buddha’s Power.		
Tara	❑ Female Bodhisattva in Mahayana, Female Buddha in Vajrayana. ❑ Also known as Jetsun Dolma (Tibetan Buddhism). ❑ Represents compassion and protection.		
Ksitigarbha	Means “ Earth Womb ,” He is the guardian of children.		
Maitreya	Also known as Ajita Bodhisattva, the future Buddha. Accepted by both Mahayana and non-Mahayana traditions.		
Samantabhadra	Associated with meditation.		
Amitabha	Buddha of infinite light, the great saviour Buddha.		
Akasagarbha	Associated with elements of space.		
Vasudhara	Buddhist goddess of wealth, fertility, and well-being.		
Skanda	Devoted guardian of Buddhist monasteries who protects the teachings of Buddhism.		

Fig. 9.4: The three Bodhisattvas which act as protection deities of Buddha

Schools of Thought Associated with Mahayana

Madhyamika (Sunyavada, i.e. all is void)	Yogacara (Practice of Yoga)
❑ Thinker: Nagarjuna from 2nd century AD. ❑ Basic Tenet • The central teaching of the Madhyamaka school is the concept of sunyata, or emptiness. Nagarjuna taught that all phenomena lacked inherent, independent existence. Emptiness does not imply non-existence but rather the absence of inherent essence or self-nature. Understanding emptiness is crucial for overcoming ignorance and achieving liberation from suffering.	❑ Also known as Vigyanavada (Doctrine of Consciousness), propounded by Asanga and his brother, Vasubandhu. ❑ It lays emphasis on meditative and yogic practices to study cognition and perception. ❑ It focuses on consciousness & knowledge (idealism). ❑ The only reality is “suchness” (tathata), also known as Dharmadhatu. ❑ Its basic text is called Sutralankara.
• Follows the middle path i.e., neither nihilism (nothing exists) nor realism (everything self-exists & is permanent). • It believes that there is no difference between Samsara and Nirvana. ❑ Its basic text is called Mula Madhyamika karika. ❑ Middle position between Sarvastivada school (Doctrine That All Is Real) and Yogacara (mind-only) school.	❑ Vasubandhu (converted from Sarvastivada to the Mahayana) wrote commentary on the Abhidhamma from the perspectives of the Sarvastivada and Sautrāntika schools.

Vajrayana (Vehicle of the Thunderbolt)

It is an offshoot of Mahayana Buddhism and referred to as **Mantrayana** (emerged after the 5th century AD.)

- It was practiced in regions of **Bengal, Bihar, and Nepal** and eventually spread to **Tibet** in the 11th century AD. Its main center was **Vikramasila University** in Bihar.
- Monks in this tradition distanced themselves from mainstream society and transitioned from **Pali (the People's Language)** to **Sanskrit (an intellectual language)**.
- This branch emphasised **Tantrism**, incorporating rituals, chanting, and tantric techniques. Thus the influence of Hinduism can be noticed in Vajrayana.
- It incorporates a strong female element, and sculptures like the 10th-century Bihar statue of the **Buddhist goddess Marichi** exemplify this trend.
- Worship of deities like **Tara** is intended to cultivate inner qualities for a better understanding of the external world.



Fig. 9.5: Tara

Various Mudras Under Buddhism

- Dhyana Mudra:** This mudra symbolises meditation, concentration, and inner peace.
- Anjali Mudra:** Represents respect, greeting, and gratitude.
- Vitarka Mudra:** This mudra is also known as the "teaching mudra" or "gesture of discussion" and represents the transmission of knowledge and the communication of the Buddha's teachings.
- Varada Mudra:** Represents generosity, compassion, and the granting of wishes.
- Abhaya Mudra:** Represents fearlessness, protection, and the dispelling of negativity.
- Bhumisparsha Mudra:** Represents the moment of the Buddha's enlightenment, and the gesture symbolises the earth witnessing his attainment of enlightenment.
- Uttarabodhi Mudra:** This mudra represents the union of wisdom and compassion, the balance of masculine and feminine energies, and the attainment of enlightenment through the integration of all aspects of thyself.
- DharmaChakra Mudra:** Dharmachakra in Sanskrit means the wheel of Dharma. This mudra represents the setting into motion of the wheel of the teaching of Dharma.



Fig. 9.6: Various mudras under Buddhism

- Karana Mudra:** Represents depictions of the Buddha or bodhisattvas as a symbol of protection and dispelling of negativity. The index finger is said to represent the energy of wisdom and the ability to overcome obstacles.
- Jnana Mudra:** Represents the unity of individual and universal consciousness and the connection between the practitioner and the teachings of the Buddha.
- Tarjani Mudra:** Represents a symbol of warning or protection against evil forces.
- Vajra Mudra:** This hand gesture represents the fiery thunderbolt gesture and serves as a symbol for the five elements of nature.
- Cosmic Mudra:** The Cosmic Mudra symbolizes the harmony and balance between heaven and earth, the inner and outer worlds, and the unity of opposites. The oval or circle formed by the hands represents the cosmos, wholeness, and the infinite nature of reality. It also signifies the interdependence of all phenomena and the realization of oneness or non-duality.

Causes of Decline of Buddhism

- Buddhism declined throughout the phase of the **Bhakti** movement, absorbing Hindu aspects, with some lineages regarding Buddha as an **avatar of Vishnu**.
- Adoption of **Sanskrit** over **Pali**.
- Corrupt practices in monasteries, like deviation from Buddha's teachings.
- Buddhism lost its royal patronage after Harshavardhana.
- The Turks invaded monasteries for their riches.

Important Facts Related to Buddhism

- Upasaka** are lay followers of Buddhism who are not monks.
- Parivrajaka** literally means **male renunciant** & wanderer. Eg: Buddhist Bhikkhu.
- Shramana** is a **wandering monk** in certain ascetic traditions, including Jainism, Buddhism & Ajivikas.
- Paramita (perfection)** are the noble qualities or transcendental virtues that are practiced by bodhisattvas in Buddhism.
- Chaitya:** It was the place of worship and congregation.
- Vihara:** It was the place of residence of Buddhist monks.
- Stupa:** Relics of the Buddha, such as his bodily remains or objects used by him, were buried here.
- Kingdoms associated with Buddha are **Kosala, Magadha, Vaishali, Rajgir** etc.
 - Buddha travelled through the kingdoms of Kosala, Magadha, Vaishali and Vajji in order to preach his philosophy.
 - As per various Pali texts, it is known that Prasenjit, king of Kosala, was a contemporary of Buddha.
- Upasatha:** Ceremony held on full moon and new moon.

- ❑ **Upasampada:** Ordination ceremony when the novice becomes a full-fledged member of the monastic community.
- ❑ **Nibbana** means breaking free from the cycle of life and death.
- ❑ **Pravrajya:** Ceremony to mark a person's going forth from home into homelessness and his/her becoming a novice under a preceptor. Involved shaving the head and donning ochre robes.
- ❑ **Gajalakshmi/Maya (mother of Buddha):** Women surrounded by Lotuses and elephants (Used as a symbol in Sanchi Stupa).
- ❑ **Navayana Buddhism:** This branch of Buddhism is propounded by B.R. Ambedkar. Teachings of Buddhism are reinterpreted in light of inequality and class struggle.

Jainism

Introduction

Jainism or Jaina is derived from the word 'Jina', which means **conqueror**. Jain monks were also known as **Nirgranthas** (free from bonds). **Risabhath** was the **1st Tirthankara** and **founder** of the sect. Mahavira was the last Tirthankara of Jainism and is considered its most influential figure.

Vardhamana Mahavira

- ❑ Vardhamana Mahavira (referred to as **Nigantha Nataputta** in Buddhist texts) was born in **540 BC** in **Kundagrama near Vaishali** (identical to Basarh), North Bihar.
- ❑ His father, **Siddhartha**, was the chief of the **Jnatika clan**, and his mother, **Trishala**, was a **Lichchavi princess**. They were **connected with the royal family** of Magadha, Anga and Videha.
- ❑ Mahavira left worldly life at the age of 30 to become an ascetic. He practised **severe austerity** and discarded his garments.
- ❑ For 12 years, he wandered continuously, during which he met **Gosala** and spent **six years** with him before they parted due to differences.
- ❑ In the 13th year of his wandering, **at the age of 42**, Vardhamana attained **enlightenment or Kaivalya (complete knowledge/intellect)**. Through Kaivalya, he conquered **misery** and **happiness**. He then became a Tirthankara and came to be called a **Jina** or **Mahavira (the Great Conqueror)**, and his followers were known as Jaina.



Fig. 9.7: Vardhamana Mahavira



Fig. 9.8: Jal Mandir, Pavapuri

- ❑ Mahavira propagated Jainism for 30 years, travelling to regions like **Kosala, Magadha, Mithila, and Champa**.
- ❑ He **died** at the age of 72 in **468 BC** at **Pavapuri**, near Rajgir.

Tirthankara	Symbol
Rishabhadeva also known as Adinatha (1st)	Bull
Neminatha(22nd)	Conch
Parsvanatha(23rd)	Snake
Mahavira(24th)	Lion

Yajur Veda mentions three of the **Tirthankaras**, viz., **Risabha, Ajitanatha** and **Aristanemi**.

Tenets of Jainism

- ❑ Householders were expected to observe the milder form of the practice of these virtues called **anuvrata** (small vows) in comparison to the monks.
- ❑ Mahavira **rejected Vedic authority**.
- ❑ Jainism **denies the existence of God**.
- ❑ Jainism **acknowledges the existence of the soul**.
- ❑ Jain philosophy holds that the world is created and maintained by **Universal laws**. Jainism does not support belief in the creator deity. According to Jain doctrine, the universe and its constituents (soul, matter, space, time and motion) have always existed. All the constituents and actions have always existed.
- ❑ According to Jaina teachings, the **cycle of birth and rebirth** is shaped through **karma**.
 - Asceticism and penance are required to free oneself from the cycle of karma. This can be achieved only by renouncing the world therefore, monastic existence is a necessary condition of salvation.
- ❑ Jainism is an egalitarian religion that rejects inequality based on birth. It **rejected the strict Varna order and Vedic rituals**. It believes that "by one's action one becomes a Brahmin, a Kshatriya, or a Vaishya, or a Sudra."
- ❑ Women were allowed into the monastic order, but they **could not achieve salvation directly**; instead, they can accumulate merit through good deeds and be reborn as men to pursue salvation.

Divisions of Jainism

About 500 years after Mahavira's death, in about 79 or 82 AD, a schism occurred in Jainism. Magadha was affected by **severe famine**, and some of the Jaina monks under **Bhadrabahu** went South to maintain their strict discipline. They remained without garments and were known as **Digambaras (space-clad or naked)**. Other monks who stayed back under the leadership of **Stulabhadra** and adopted a white garment were known as **Svetambaras (white-clad)**.

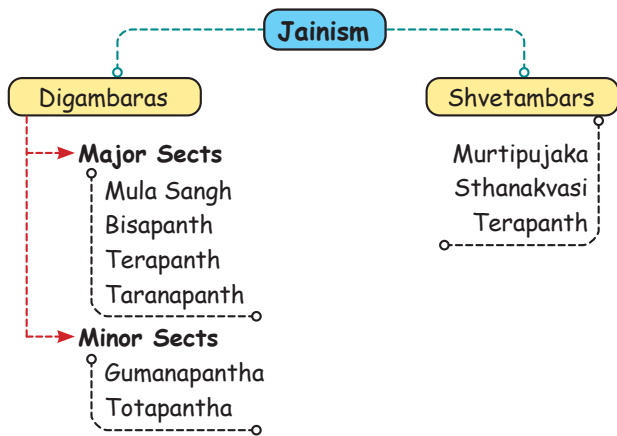


Fig. 9.9: Jainism

Sub sects of Digambaras

- Major Sub-Sects: **Mula Sangh**, **Bisapanth**, **Terapanth**, and **Taranapanth (Samaiyapantha)**
 - Mula Sangh is the original community, the rest three are modern communities.**
- Minor Sub-sects are **Gumanapantha** and **Totapantha**

- Sub-sects of Svetambaras:** **Murtipujaka** (worship idols of Tirthankaras in temples), **Sthanakvasi** (worship saints instead of an idol in the temple), **Terapanth** (worship saints).
- The schism weakened Jainism in Magadha, but it found ardent followers in Gujarat, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Orissa and Karnataka.

Shwetambara	Digambara
- People of this sect wear white clothes. Beliefs: - Attainment of liberation (Moksha) is possible for a woman. - Mahavir Swami was married. 19th Tirthankara Mallinath was a woman.	- The people of this sect don't wear clothes and perform austerity (Tapsya). Beliefs: - Salvation (Moksha) is not possible for a woman. - Mahavir Swami was unmarried. - The 19th Tirthankara, Mallinath was a man.

Jain Councils

Date	Place	President	Event
First Jain Council (300 BC)	Patliputra	Sthulbhadra	Compilation of 12 Angas (limbs) was done.
Second Jain Council (512 AD)	Vallabhi	Devardhi Kshmasramana	12 Upangas (minor sections) were added.

Jain literature is called '**Aagam**' (Principle). It consists of **12 Angas**, **12 Upanga**, **10 Prakirnakas**, **6 Ched Sutras**, **4 Mool Sutra**, **2 Chulika Sutra**.

- 12 Angas** are Acharanga-Sutra, Sutrakrtanga, Sthananga, Samavayanga, Bhagavati Vyakhyaprajnapiti, Inatrdharmakatha, Upasakadasah, Antakrddasah, Anuttaraupapatikadasah, Prasnavyakarana, Vipaksruta and Dristivada.
- Every Anga has **Upanga**, which provides the description of the universe, classification of beings, astronomy, time division, description of posthumous life, etc.

Patron Kings of Jainism

Magadh Empire	Bimbisara, Ajatasatru, Samprati, Chandragupta Maurya, Bindusara		
Kharavela(Kalinga)	Hathigumpha inscription in the Udayagiri hills near Bhubaneswar provides an account of support for Jainism.		
Kadamba dynasty	King Kakusthavarman	Rashtrakuta dynasty	Amoghavarsha
Ganga dynasty	King Shivamara I; King Butuga II	Chalukya (Solanki) dynasty	Kumarapala

Reasons for the Decline of Jainism in India

- Absence of royal patronage.
- Internal division between Digambaras and Swetambaras.
- Limited missionary efforts.
- Factionalism within the Jain community.
- The rigorous and austere practices associated with Jainism.

Important Facts Related to Jainism

- Sallekhana or Santhara:** A ritual fast to death which Jains regard as the "culmination of our lives as ascetics".
- During the reign of Ganga ruler Rachamalla IV (Panchamalla), Prime Minister **Chavunda raya** built a huge Jain statue of **Bahubali (Gomateshwar)** around 982-983 AD. It is situated in **Shravanabelagola** (Karnataka).

- Bahubali is considered the son of Rishabhdev, the first Tirthankar.
- **Mahamastak-abhishek** is an important festival held at Shravanabelagola in Karnataka State every 12 years.
- ❑ **Chandragupta Maurya (322-298 BC)** played a role in Jainism's spread in Karnataka by embracing it, abdicating his throne, and living as a Jaina ascetic.
- ❑ Epigraphic evidence of Jainism in Karnataka dates back to the third century AD, and from the sixth century AD, **Basadis (Jaina monastic establishments)** proliferated, receiving royal land grants for support.
- ❑ Jainism's **strict adherence to non-violence** limited engagement in other occupations, **including agriculture**, due to the prohibition against intentional or unintentional killing. Hence, they adopted occupations like **trading** and **money-lending**. As a result, they were closely associated with urbanisation.

Jain Temples

- ❑ **Ranakpur temple (Rajasthan):** Built by Darna Shah in 1437 AD. It is a Svetambara Jain temple dedicated to Tirthankara Rishabhdev.
- ❑ **Mount Mangi Tungri (Maharashtra):** It enshrines images of Tirthankaras in several postures, including Padmasana and Kayotsarga.
- ❑ **Shikharji (Jharkhand):** It is located on **Parasnath Hill**. It is an important Jain Tirtha for both Digambara and Svetambara. It is where twenty of the twenty-four Jain Tirthankaras attained Moksha.
- ❑ **Khajuraho Group of Monuments (Madhya Pradesh):** The Jain temples are located in the southeast region of the Khajuraho monuments.
- ❑ **The Dilwara Temples or Delvada Temples** are a group of **Śvētāmbara Jain temples in Mount Abu** is made of marble. They were built by the Samanta **Vimalshah** of Chalukya (Solanki) ruler **Bhimdev I** of Gujarat.
- ❑ **Sittanavasal Paintings:** These represent the theme of Jain Samasvasarana.
- ❑ **Ellora Caves (Maharashtra), Udaygiri Caves (Odisha), and Sittanavasal Caves (Tamil Nadu)** also depict Jain influence.



Fig. 9.10: Ranakpur Temple

Differences between Jainism and Buddhism

- ❑ Buddhism **neither accepted nor denied** the existence of **God**, whereas Jainism **does not believe in a personal God or a creator God**.
 - According to Jainism, God is that soul who has completely removed all the Karmas. The defining characteristic of Godhood is identical to that of liberation itself.
- ❑ Jainism **did not condemn the varna system** as Buddhism did.
 - Mahavira believed a person's varna in this life was determined by their past-life virtues and sins, extending liberation prospects to lower caste members.
- ❑ Buddhism advocated a middle path, i.e., avoidance of extremities of penance and enjoyment, whereas **Jainism advocated extreme penance and asceticism**.
- ❑ Jainism believes **in the transmigration of the soul**, while **Buddhism does not**.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

Schism within Buddhism and Jainism gave rise to more accommodative sects which at first weakened these religions but later ensured their continuity in the wake of modernity. Discuss.

Important Terms Related to Jainism

❑ Derasar or Basadi: Jaina monastic establishment	❑ Chaitanya: Consciousness
❑ Avadhijnana: Superhuman cognition	❑ Mohaniya: Delusion
❑ Ganadharas: Chief disciplines of Mahavira	❑ Gunasthanas: Stages of purification
❑ Siddha: Fully liberated	❑ Arhat: Who has entered the stage of Kevalajnana.
❑ Pudgala: Aggregates of atoms that have form, colour, taste and smell, and can be touched and felt.	❑ Tirthankara: Arhat, who has already acquired the capability of teaching the doctrine

BHAKTI MOVEMENT

Hinduism in the Medieval period underwent many ideological changes because of the spread of **Buddhism** and **Jainism** on the one hand and **Islam** on the other hand. All these gave rise to several theistic systems of thought, and the most important among them was the **Bhakti movement**. The Bhakti movement **first appeared** between the **seventh** and **twelfth centuries** in the Southern regions of India, particularly in **Tamil Nadu**. It gradually moved to the Northern region by the end of the fifteenth century.

Salient Features of Bhakti Movement

- ❑ The Bhakti movement was characterized by **three** important features:
 - Concept of the **oneness of God** and the **brotherhood** of all human beings.

- **Surrender to God**, who is all pervasive and capable of solving the problems of the devotees.
 - Intense **personal devotion to God** with an emphasis on a good moral life.
- ❑ The Bhakti movement focuses on the **importance of the guru** or **spiritual teacher**, whose function was to guide the people on the path of bhakti. This brought in a system of **pahul**.
 - **Pahul** was the sanctified water offered by a master to the pupil or shishya as a token of his being accepted as a trainee on his journey to moksha.
 - ❑ The Bhakti Saints **attacked** the **rigidity in religion**, disregarded the **caste** and encouraged **women** to join in their religious gatherings.
 - ❑ The Bhakti Saints belonged to various backgrounds but mainly from the **lower castes** and stressed the need for **tolerance** among humans and religions.
 - ❑ According to Bhakti tradition, a true devotee **does not want heaven** or **moksha**. He only wants to chant the Lord's name and be born again and again to sing his praise.
 - ❑ They criticized **idol worship** and **condemned ritualism, pilgrimage** and **fasts**.

Note: Bhakti and Sufi movements have been discussed in a separate chapter.

SIKHISM

The word 'Sikh' is derived from the Sanskrit word Shishya, meaning a disciple. Guru Nanak (1469–1539), one of the greatest saints of the Bhakti movement, was the first Guru and Guru Gobind Singh (1666–1708) was the last guru.

Teachings of Guru Nanak

- ❑ There is one God. His name is truth, he is the creator. He is without fear and without halt. He is beyond time immortal; His spirit pervades the universe.
- ❑ God is formless.
- ❑ Caste system and idolatry should be rejected.
- ❑ Superstitions should be condemned.
- ❑ The virtues of humility, charity, forgiveness, and truthfulness should be inculcated.



Fig. 9.11: Guru Nanak Dev

Principles of Sikhism

- ❑ The Supreme purpose of human existence was **salvation**, and it could not be achieved by worshipping idols but by **right belief, right worship** and **right conduct**.
- ❑ He regulated the community life of his followers by bringing in **Congregational worship** in a **dharmasala** and dining together to bring people together. He also developed new forms of worship like **community kitchens** (langar).

- ❑ Nanak's religion is a very practical one, and he does not ask for asceticism but instead asks his followers to live like an **ideal man** who **runs his household** on the basis of his own labour and attends the **Sangat** and **kirtan**.
 - This seemed to be one of the major attractions to the **Khattari traders** and **merchant-class people**.
- ❑ **Music** has always been an important feature of Sikhism, and they believed that through music, one can attain ecstasy or samadhi.

Gurus of Sikhism

- ❑ **Guru Nanak** was the **first** of the ten Sikh gurus. The gurudom was conferred on the **son** and sometimes on the **best disciple**.
- ❑ The **second** Sikh guru, **Guru Angad**, developed the **Gurmukhi script** to preserve the founder's compositions for future generations.
- ❑ The **fifth** guru, **Guru Arjan Dev**, became the **first great martyr** in Sikh history when **Emperor Jahangir** ordered his execution. **Guru Arjan Dev** gave the Sikhs three things:
 - **Adi Granth**, which contains sayings of five gurus and other allied Saints.
 - The **standardized script** of **Gurmukhi** in which the Adi Granth was first written.
 - The site and foundation of **Harmandir Sahib** or **Golden Temple** and **Akal Takht** at Amritsar.
- ❑ The **sixth** guru, **Guru Hargobind**, was the first one to gird the two swords as the symbol for Sikhs, which symbolized the spiritual (**Piri**) and temporal (**Miri**) authority and represented the combination of Bhakti and Shakti.
 - He constructed **Akal Takht** and **Lohgarh Fort** to conduct daily business and defence.



Fig. 9.12: Harmandir Sahib, Amritsar

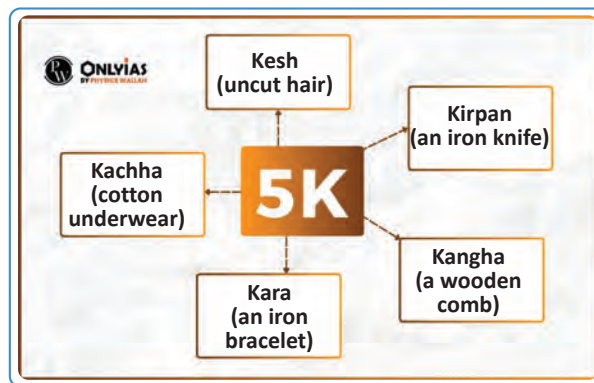


Fig. 9.13: Five vows in Sikhism

- ❑ The next two gurus, **Guru Har Rai** and **Guru Har Krishan** were in constant conflict and were eventually **detained** by **Aurangzeb**.

- ❑ The ninth guru, **Guru Tegh Bahadur** wanted to establish sovereign authority of the Sikhs in the dominions but he was put to **death** in **1675** on the orders of **Aurangzeb**.
- ❑ The **tenth** Guru, **Guru Gobind Singh** created the **Khalsa**, which is a Sikh warrior community.
- ❑ He also ordained the Sikhs to take **five vows** namely, keeping of **kesh** (long hair and a beard), **kangha** (comb), **kada** (a metallic bangle), **kirpan** (a sword) and **kaccha** (an underwear extending to a little above the knees).

- ❑ Guru Nanak was preaching during the time when the Lodi dynasty fell and Babur took over.
- ❑ **Panj Pyare**
 - It is the term used for the **Five Beloved**, the men who were **initiated** into the **khalsa** (the brotherhood of Sikh faith) under the guidance of **Guru Gobind Singh**.
- ❑ The Panj Pyare are deeply respected by Sikhs as symbols of devotion and steadfastness.

- ❑ He further added that after his death, the **Guru Granth Sahib** will be **the Guru** of the Sikhs.
- ❑ The **Guru Granth Sahib**, apart from the teachings of its other gurus, incorporates the writings of many Bhakti poets and Sufi saints such as **Ramananda**, **Namadeva**, **Kabir** and **Sheikh Farid**.

Takhts and Gurudwaras

- ❑ The worship places of Sikhs are known as the Takhts. The five 'Takhts' include
 - **Sri Akal Takht (Amritsar, Punjab)**, founded by **Guru Hargobind Singh**.

- ❑ **Gurdwara Janam Asthan/ Nankana Sahib** is among the most important religious sites for the Sikh religion as it is the birthplace of Guru Nanak Dev. It is located in Punjab province of Pakistan.
- ❑ **Kartarpur Sahib/ Gurdwara Darbar Sahib** is located in the Punjab Province of Pakistan. Guru Nanak Dev lived here for 18 years until his death in 1539.
- ❑ Kartarpur corridor connects the Dera Baba Nanak site in Gurdaspur, Punjab to the Kartarpur Sahib. This corridor facilitates visa-free movement of Sikh pilgrims from India to the other side of the border.
- ❑ **Golden Temple:** Guru Granth Sahib was installed for the first time here. Later it was shifted to Damdama Sahib.

- **Takht Sri Keshgarh Sahib (Anandpur Sahib, Punjab)**, where Khalsa Panth originated.
- **Takht Sri Damdama Sahib (Talwandi Sabo, Punjab)**, where the complete version of Guru Granth Sahib was written by Guru Gobind Singh.
- **Takht Sri Hazur Sahib (Nanded, Maharashtra)**, where Guru Gobind Singh took his last breath.

- **Takht Sri Patna Sahib (Patna, Bihar)** is situated on the banks of the River Ganga. This is the birthplace of Guru Gobind Singh.

- ❑ Gurudwaras are significant from the pilgrimage point of view. Gurudwara stands for 'the doorway to the master' in India.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

Elaborate on the cultural and religious influences that contributed to the formation of Sikhism as a synthesis of Hindu and Islamic traditions.

ZOROASTRIANISM

The Parsi or Zoroastrian religion was founded by **Zarathushtra** or **Zoroaster**, in Persia, in the **eighth century BC**.

- ❑ **Zarathushtra** taught the **worship of fire** and the presence of good and bad in the form of **Ahura Mazda** and **Ahura Man**. The struggle between these two is eternal and the day when good will win over evil will be the last day.
- ❑ He also taught the ethical doctrine of **kindness** and **charity**. These doctrines are enshrined in the **Zend Avesta**.
- ❑ They believe that dead matter is a corrupting element to everything and hence they place the **dead bodies** in the open to be **eaten by the vultures**.
 - These open spaces are called **Dhakma** or **towers of silence** and Vultures that eat them are called **Dhakma Nashini**.
- ❑ Their **fire temples**, called **Atash Bahram**, are rare, and only eight known temples exist in the entire country.

Spread of Zoroastrianism in India

The **first** contact of the Zoroastrians with **India** was probably between the **8th to 10th century AD** when they fled from **Iran** because of the Islamic invasions.

- ❑ They are commonly known as **Parsis** and **Iranis** and live mostly in **Mumbai**, **Goa** and **Ahmedabad**. In India, Iranis are recent arrivals and are comparatively a smaller community than Parsis.



Fig. 9.14: Tower of Silence, Mumbai

- ❑ Zoroastrianism is **not** a **proselytizing religion**, and no new entrants are accepted into its fold under any circumstances.
- ❑ They have contributed a lot to Indian culture, and National leaders like **Dadabhai Naoroji** and industrialists like **Jamshedji Tata** were Parsis.

CHRISTIANITY

Christianity was founded by **Jesus Christ** in **Jerusalem**, and it became the largest religion in the world. From his followers, Jesus had chosen twelve men to be his Apostles. His Apostles set out to spread his teachings. The most famous of the Apostles were **Saint Peter** and **Saint Paul**, who founded many Christian churches. Their stories about the life of Jesus are written in the New Testament of the Bible. The early Christians were Jews, but Christianity and Judaism separated in 381 A.D.

Spread of Christianity in India

- ❑ It is believed that **Saint Thomas**, one of the disciples of Jesus, travelled to India and reached Muziris (western coast). He established churches, and his followers are known as Saint Thomas Christians in India.
- ❑ The coming of the Portuguese to India during the 14th century opened a new vista in the history of Christianity. Consequently, they established churches on the western coast of India. It was at this time when the Portuguese Christian mission under **Francis Xavier** (1506-52), a Jesuit priest, was sent to India. He became successful in converting a large number of people into Christianity, on the western coast. Emperor Akbar gave freedom to Christian missions to establish their Church, propagate their religion and to celebrate their religious festivals.
- ❑ Institutions like the Young Men's Christian Association (YMCA) take the message of Christ to smaller tribal parts of India and provide education and health facilities.

Various Aspects in Christianity

- ❑ **Concept of God:** According to the Christian faith, God is one but has revealed himself as three persons - the **Father, the Son and the Holy Spirit**. This concept of God is described as Unity in the Trinity.
- ❑ **The Bible**
 - The Bible is the holy book followed by the Christians. It consists of two collections of books: The **Old Testament** and the **New Testament**.
 - The Old Testament contains the sacred scriptures of the Jews as well as the early Christian scriptures. The Old Testament was originally written in **Hebrew**.
 - The New Testament was written in the 2nd half of the first century A.D. It was originally written in **Greek**. It contains the life and deeds of Christ, the works of his companions and other saints and covers a wide range of things.
- ❑ **Body, Soul, Salvation:** According to the Christian belief, man has a body and a soul. The former perishes while the latter survives eternally. Salvation means the continued existence of an individual in heaven after death. Christianity does not believe in the transmigration of souls.
- ❑ **Baptism:** According to Christian faith, nobody is considered a born Christian. One has to enter into the faith through a religious ceremony called baptism.

Major Sects and Divisions

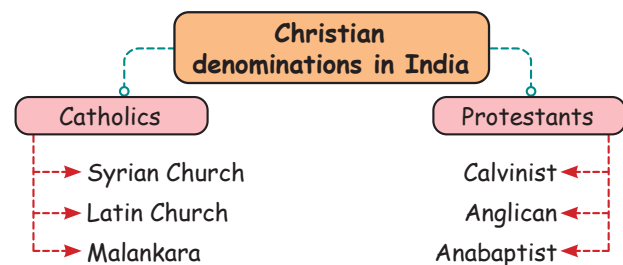


Fig. 9.15: Christian denominations in India

Christians in India have two major denominations: **Catholics** and **Protestants**.

- ❑ The Protestants claimed that the church and society was in a state of crisis. They demanded reforms in such a situation. The Catholics on the other hand felt that there was no crisis.
- ❑ The Protestants do not believe in the authority of the Pope which Catholics consider him as the main authority.
- ❑ Main **Protestant sects** in India are **Calvinist, Anglican** and **Anabaptist**.
- ❑ Main **Catholic sects** in India are **Syrian Church, Latin Church** and **Malankara**.

JUDAISM

It is one of the oldest religions across the globe and their followers are called **Jews**.

- ❑ This religion **predates Christianity** and **Islam**, with these two borrows a lot from Judaic Philosophies.
- ❑ It is a **monotheistic religion** and believes in **Yahweh** or one true God who was instituted by **Abraham**, and they also believe in the **day of judgment**.
- ❑ Their **religious book** is called **Torah**, and they follow **religious services** called the **Eliyahu-Hanabi** or the Thanksgiving to Elijah the Prophet.
- ❑ It is one of the most targeted religions globally, and the worst case was by **Hitler**, who tortured and killed several millions of Jews in Germany.
- ❑ **Five major Jewish communities in India**
 - **Cochin Jews** (speak Malayalam)
 - **Bene Israel Jews** (speak Marathi, largest in number)
 - **Baghdadi Jews** (Came from West Asia and can be found in Mumbai and Kolkata).
 - **Bnei Menashe** (comprises Kuki, chin and Mizo tribes and live in Manipur and Mizoram)
 - **Bene Ephraim** (speaks Telugu)

ISLAM

Islam is a monotheistic religion. The literal meaning of Islam is 'Peace and Submission'. Islam as a religion was established by Hazrat Mohammad in Mecca in 570 AD.

Prophet Muhammad

- Prophet Mohammad was born around 570 A.D. in the **Quraysh tribe of Arabia**.
- He tried to oppose idol worship, but he was persecuted by the people of Arabia. The conflict between Mohammad and his opponents on idol worshipping continued for 13 years. It is marked by his first divine revelation. Revelation means guidance by God for mankind. However, circumstances forced him to migrate from **Mecca to Medina** in 622 AD. His migration is called **Hijrah**.
- He migrated to Medina from Mecca in **622 A.D** and this marked the **beginning of the Hijra Era**.
- The travel of the Prophet back to Mecca is the Holy route that became **Hajj** and every Muslim has to undertake this pilgrimage once in his lifetime.

Spread of Islam in India

The Muslims **first** came to India in the **eighth century AD**, mainly as **traders**. They were followed by the Turks, who established their Sultanate (State) in India. In 1526, the Mughals established their rule in India. Thus, in brief, this political establishment opened a new vista for the spread of Islam and Indo-Islamic culture in the Indian subcontinent. A significant aspect of Indo-Islamic culture and heritage is the role of Sufis in India.

Principles of Islam

- Islam talked of **equality, brotherhood** and the **existence of one God**.
- The **five fundamental principles** of Islam are:
 - **Tawhid** (belief in Allah)
 - **Namaz** (prayers, five times a day)
 - **Roza** (fasting in the month of Ramzan)
 - **Zakat** (giving of alms)
 - **Hajj** (pilgrimage to Mecca)
- They also believe in the **Day of Judgement** where the merits and bad deeds will be judged and one would be sent to hell or heaven accordingly.

Fundamental Principles of Islam

Tawhid
Namaz
Raza
Zakat
Hajj

Fig. 9.16:

Fundamental principles of Islam

Different Sects of Islam

There are various sects in Islam, but the two major subdivisions are:

- **Shia**: They claimed that Ali, the prophet's son-in-law is his successor.
- **Sunni**: They believed that the successor should be from those close to the Prophet and who were his initial followers like Abu Bakr.

Although the majority of Muslims in India are Sunni, the presence of Shia is made known on Muharram, where they reenact the gruesome death of **Imam Hussain** (the younger son of Ali).



IGNITE YOUR MIND

How has the Indianisation of Islam influenced the religious practices and cultural expressions of the Muslim community in India?

Holy Books of Islam

The Holy book of **Quran** was compiled **before the prophet's death**, and it was verified twice by him before being transformed into book form after his death.

Sufism

Sufism is a common term used for **Islamic mysticism**. Sufism **originated** in **Iran** and found a congenial atmosphere in India under the Turkish rule.

Principles of Sufism

- The Sufis were very **liberal** in their religious outlook and believed in the essential **unity of all religions** and **respect for all human beings**.
- They preached the **unity of God** and **self-surrender to him** in the same way as the Nirgun Bhaktas.
- In order to attain a state of **mystical ecstasy**, the Sufis listened to **poetry and music (Sama)**, which were originally in **Persian** but later switched to **Hindawi or Hindustani**.
- According to Sufi Saints, one must have the guidance of a **pir or guru**, without which spiritual development is impossible. These also started the tradition of **piri-muridi (teacher and the disciple)**.
- According to the Muslim belief, **the Quran** is the message of Allah revealed to Mohammad through his archangel **Gabriel**. It has been translated into several languages.
- Prophet Mohammad's sayings are preserved after his death in what is called the **Hadith or Hadees**.
- The Holy **Quran** and Sunnah form the basis for Islamic laws or **Sharia**.

CONCLUSION

From the ancient traditions of Hinduism, Buddhism, Jainism, and Sikhism to the later arrivals of Islam, Christianity, Zoroastrianism, Judaism and India has been a **melting pot of religious ideas**, practices and philosophies. This diversity has fostered a **spirit of pluralism and syncretism**, where different religious communities have coexisted and often influenced each other. As India continues to navigate the complexities of modernity and globalization, its religious diversity remains a source of strength, resilience, and unity. By embracing the principles of **tolerance, dialogue and mutual respect** with a constitutional backing (**Right to Freedom of Religion- Article 25-28**), India stands as a shining example of a nation where people of different faiths can coexist harmoniously, contributing to the mosaic of humanity's spiritual quest.

BHAKTI MOVEMENT

The term Bhakti is derived from the Sanskrit root word “Bhaj,” which means to serve. It is defined as “devotion” or passionate love for the divine. It centers around the **relationship between the devotee and a personal God**. It emerged in Southern India with the rise of **Alvars** and **Nayanars**. No such parallel movement was seen in Northern India for centuries to come. The later phase of the Bhakti movement emerged in 14th century AD and reached its peak in 15th and 16th century AD.

Sources to Study the Bhakti Movement

- ❑ **Literature, devotional songs and poetry** in regional languages served as primary sources.
 - Jayadeva’s “**Gita Govinda**” depicts the love between Krishna and Radha, **Alvars’** Tamil hymns etc.
- ❑ **Hagiographies**: Biographical accounts of Bhakti saints written by their followers or sect members provide insights into their lives and teachings.
 - “**Janam-Sakhi**” is based on the life of Guru Nanak.
- ❑ Oral transmission, oral narratives, and storytelling serves as a literary source as well.
 - **Burra Katha**- A Telugu storytelling art form of Andhra Pradesh

Causes for the Birth of Bhakti Movement

The Bhakti movement, which emerged in medieval India, had several causes:

- ❑ Superstitious beliefs among Hindus make the religion complex in nature.
- ❑ The caste system, untouchability and inequality in society caused dissension among different sections of the people. Further, Islam preached the unity of God and brotherhood of man, which attracted the oppressed common masses.
- ❑ There was a need to reform and consolidate Hinduism in the midst of turmoil in the mainstream Hindu religion and socio-religious and political changes.

So, Religious leaders in different parts of India preached pure devotion called Bhakti to remove evils like fanaticism, bigotry, and religious intolerance which gave rise to a movement called Bhakti Movement.

Main Features of the Bhakti Movement

- ❑ Preached **monotheism** (oneness of God).
- ❑ **Salvation** (freedom from the cycle of death and birth) could be attained only by **deep devotion and faith in God**.
- ❑ **Criticised Idol worship** and condemned ritualism, pilgrimages, and fasts.
- ❑ Guru could act as a guide and preceptor.
- ❑ Advocated the principles of universal brotherhood and **denounced the caste system**.
- ❑ Superstitious practices are to be given up.
- ❑ Didn’t consider any language sacred and composed poems in the **language of the common masses**.

Philosophies Characterising Bhakti Movement

The Bhakti movement in India was characterized by several key philosophical principles, which varied slightly depending on the region and the specific bhakti tradition. However, some common philosophies that characterized the Bhakti movement include:

- ❑ **Vedantism**
 - Teachings of Shankaracharya, Ramanuja etc. had an effect in reducing the influence of ritualism and orthodox practices. It paved the way for the growth of the Bhakti movement.
- ❑ Elements of both **Dvaita and Advaita philosophy** can be found in the Bhakti movement.
- ❑ **Sufism** and **Bhakti movement** grew parallely having an impact on each other.
- ❑ **Saguna Bhakti** (with form or attributes): The emphasis is on worshipping human-like figures of deities and their avatars. **For example**: Worship of lord Krishna by Chaitanya Mahaprabhu.
- ❑ **Nirguna Bhakti** (without form or attributes): Worship of an abstract form (**nirankar**) of God. **For example**: God in Sikhism is formless.

Early Proponents: Alvars and Nayanars

The Bhakti movement in India had several early proponents who played significant roles in shaping its philosophy and spreading the message of devotion.

- ❑ Early bhakti movements around the sixth century were led by **two groups**:
 - **Alvars** were the devotees of **Vishnu**. **Nammalwar, Tirumangai Alwar, Andal and Perialwar** were famous Alvar saints.
 - **Nayanars** were the devotees of **Shiva**. **Appar, Sundarar, Thirugnana Sambandar,** and **Manickavachakar** were famous Nayanar saints.
- ❑ They carried their message of love and devotion to various parts of South India through the medium of the local language preaching among the common masses. It helped some of the followers of the Vedic faith revive the old Vedic religion.
- ❑ Their hymns were integrated into temple rituals, and worship of their idols became a temple tradition.
 - **For example: Sri Ramanathaswamy Temple** (Rameshwaram; dedicated to Lord Shiva).
- ❑ **Alvars** and **Nayanars** challenged the caste system and **Brahmanical dominance** with support from diverse social groups of artisans, farmers, and marginalized “**untouchable**” castes.

Women Devotees

Women were at the **bottom of the traditional hierarchy of society**. Only through demonstrations of their **utter devotion to the Divine** and **stubborn insistence on their spiritual equality** with their contemporaries were these women reluctantly acknowledged and accepted within their ranks. Many of them **rejected asceticism** as the crucial means towards liberation.

Some of the noted women devotees are:

- ❑ **Akkamahadevi**, also known as Akka or Mahadevi, was a devotee of Shiva who lived in southern region of Karnataka, South India in 12th Century.
- ❑ **Karaikkal Ammaiyar**, a devotee of **Shiva**, pursued extreme asceticism to achieve her spiritual goals.
 - **Andal**, a woman Alvar, composed verses expressing her love for Vishnu.

These women chose a path of renunciation but didn't join formal religious orders or become nuns. Their “Din-i Ilahi” challenged patriarchal norms in society.

Chola's Relations with the Bhakti Tradition

- ❑ Bhakti hymns often opposed Buddhism and Jainism. Thus **Chola rulers** patronised Brahmanical and Bhakti traditions, funding land and constructing temples for Vishnu and Shiva, echoing the visions of these saints to gain their support and showcase power. **For example:** Shiva temples at **Chidambaram, Thanjavur, and Gangaikondacholapuram**.
- ❑ Chola rulers promoted the singing of **Tamil Shaiva hymns (Nayanar)** in temples.

- ❑ A 945 A.D. inscription indicates that Chola ruler **Parantaka I** placed metal statues of Appar, Sambandar, and Sundarar in a Shiva temple, which were paraded during their festivals.

Veerashaiva/Lingayat Tradition

The Veerashaiva movement, also known as Lingayatism, is a significant religious and social movement that emerged in Karnataka, India, primarily during the 12th century.

- ❑ **Basava**, also called **Basaveshwara** and **Basavanna**, a minister for **Kalachuri** ruler **Bijjala II** was the **founder** of this movement. He was a 12th-century CE Indian statesman, philosopher, poet and Hindu Shaivite social reformer.
- ❑ **Practices of Lingayats**
 - **Lingayats worship Shiva as a linga** and men usually wear a small linga in a silver case on a loop strung over the **left shoulder**.
 - Those who are revered include the **Jangams (wandering monks)**.
 - They **bury their dead**, believing they'll unite with Shiva after death and won't reincarnate. They do not practice funerary rites such as cremation, prescribed in the Dharmashastras.
 - **They opposed** the traditional customs of the **caste** system and questioned the theory of rebirth.
 - **Supported** practices like **widow remarriage** and **post-puberty marriage** which were disapproved in the Dharmashastras.
- ❑ **Essential features**
 - They promoted the exclusive worship of Lord Shiva, **rejecting idolatry** and the veneration of multiple deities.
 - They **discouraged temple visits**, especially those with installed Lingas, and **participation in sacrificial rites**. According to them, pilgrimages to holy places did not ensure true spiritual purity. Donation to temples was seen as fostering inequality.
 - Members refrained from adhering to the “**Pancha Sutakas**”(birth, death, menstruation, spittle, and caste contact), five Pollutions integral to **Brahmanical Hinduism's beliefs** and practices.
 - **Shasthala, Ashtavaranas, and Panchacharas**
 - ❑ **Shasthala** outlined six stages to unite with Lord Shiva.
 - ❑ **Ashtavarana** shielded individuals from spiritual obstacles.
 - ❑ **Panchachara** consisted of five religious postures essential for Veerashaivites to safeguard their faith.
 - **Kayaka-** Under this, they emphasized **equality in all work** and valued dedication. They believed salvation comes through devotion to one's occupation.

- ❑ The Lingayat tradition is known through '**Vachanas**' (**Verses of a devotional nature**) in **Kannada**, composed by both male and female followers.
- ❑ This tradition shares similarities with the Bhakti movement in the sense that it emphasized the element of bhakti to one God, Shiva, collective participation with a feeling of brotherhood and equality etc.

Religious Ferment in North India

Vishnu and **Shiva** were venerated in temples supported by rulers in North India, but compositions akin to Alvar and Nayanar did not appear until the 14th century. **Nathpanthis**, **Siddhacharas** and **Yogis** were religious groups that **criticised orthodox rituals** and social order, using logical arguments in vernacular language. They advocated intense training of the mind and body through practices like yogasanas, breathing exercises and meditation as the path for salvation.

- ❑ The **arrival of the Turks** and the establishment of the **Delhi Sultanate** in the **13th century** weakened the Rajput states and their associated Brahmanas and shifted the region's cultural and religious dynamics.
- ❑ Growth of Sufism was promoted due to the influence of Islam.
- ❑ Turmoil in the mainstream Hindu religion necessitated reforms in Hinduism.

These factors led to the rise of the Bhakti movement in North India.

PROPOSERS OF BHAKTI MOVEMENT

Adi Shankaracharya (788-820 AD)

- ❑ He was born in Kaladi, Kerala. Adi Sankara's arrival marked the **beginning of philosophical Bhakti discourse in Sanskrit**.
- ❑ He propounded the **theory of Advaita Vedanta** (Non-Dualism). Sankara's Advaita, or non-dualism, had its **roots in Vedanta or Upanishadic philosophy**.



Fig. 10.1: Adi Shankaracharya

- ❑ The **two main thrusts** of the Sankara school were the **organisation of monasteries** and the **preservation of Sanskrit scriptures**. His attempts to root out Buddhism and to establish **smarta** (traditionalist) **mathas** resulted in the establishment of monasteries in different places, viz., Sringeri, Dvaraka, Badrinath, and Puri, which were headed by Brahmin pontiffs.
- ❑ Sankara looked upon Saiva and Vaishnava worship as two equally important aspects of the Vedic religion.
- ❑ A magnificent 12-feet statue of Adi Guru Shankaracharya was unveiled at the seer's reconstructed samadhi in Kedarnath.

Ramanuja (1017-1137 AD)

- ❑ A **southern reformer** who made a pilgrimage to some of the holy places in **Northern India**.

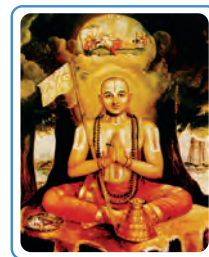


Fig. 10.2: Ramanuja

- ❑ He challenged the monist ideology of Adi Sankara and **propounded Vishistadvaita** (Qualified Monoism).
- ❑ Ramanuja took an interest in propagating the doctrine of Bhakti to social groups outside the **varnashrama system**. He influenced temple authorities to permit them to enter the temple at least once a year. He firmly believed that **intense devotion to Vishnu** was the **best means to attain salvation**.
- ❑ His **teachings** were based on the **Upanishads** and **Bhagwad Gita** and he **used a common language**.
- ❑ He was **influenced by** the teachings of the **Srirangam school of thought**. Ramanujan joined it and was later declared the head of a monastery in Srirangam.
- ❑ His disciple, **Ramanand**, later propagated his message in Northern India.
- ❑ A century **after his death**, there was a schism which developed into **two separate schools** under **Vedanta Desikar and Manavala Mamuni**.
- ❑ Recently, the **Statue of Equality** was constructed in Hyderabad to commemorate the 1000-year anniversary of Ramanujacharya.

Madhvacharya (1238-1317 AD)

- ❑ He was a proponent of **Dvaita school** of Vedanta Philosophy and emphasised on subtle but fundamental difference between atma and Brahma.
- ❑ His philosophy is named **Tatvavada**.

Nimbarka (12th Century)

- ❑ He was a proponent of **Dvaita-advaita philosophy**.
- ❑ **Nimbarka Sampradaya** was founded by him which he was fondly addressed as 'Mahaprabhu' by his followers. His Radha Madhav.

Namdeva (1270-1350 AD)

- ❑ He came from a family of tailors. He popularised the Bhakti Movement in **Maharashtra** and was **closely associated with the Varkari Sect**. He was converted to the path of bhakti under the influence of Saint **Janadeva**.



Fig. 10.3: Namdeva

- ❑ He wrote many **abhangs** (songs composed and sung in the glory of God) in Marathi and Hindi, and later, some of his verses were added to **Guru Granth Sahib**.
- ❑ Love god with all your heart to lead a pious life, surrendering everything to him with steadfast devotion is the essence of his message.

Varkari Sect

Devotion to **Lord Vitthala** gave rise to the Varkari sect, which laid emphasis on an annual pilgrimage to **Pandharpur** (Maharashtra). The Vaishnava poet-saints of Maharashtra, such as **Jnaneshwar, Namadeva, Eknath and Tukaram** were devotees of lord Vitthala.

Jnaneshwar (1275-1296 AD)

- He was a 13th-century Indian Marathi saint, poet, philosopher and yogi of the Nath and Varkari tradition who revered **Vishnu as Vithoba or Krishna**.
- He translated the **Bhagavad Gita** from Sanskrit to Marathi, called **Jnaneshwari**.

Ramananda (1400-1470 AD)

- He was a follower of **Ramanuja** and preached **Vaishnavism** in Hindi. He was the **first to preach his doctrine of devotion in Hindi**, the vernacular language.
- A devoted **worshipper of Rama**, he was educated in Benaras. By establishing his own sect based on the philosophy of love and devotion to Rama and Sita, Ramananda introduced radical changes in Vaishnavism. **He substituted the worship of Rama in place of Vishnu**.
- He advocated **equality before God** and **rejected the caste system**, particularly the supremacy of Brahmins.
- He welcomed **followers from all castes and backgrounds** and had twelve chief disciples, which included **Saint Kabir, Ravidas** and a woman named **Padmavathi**.
- He famously used to say, **"Let no man ask a man's sect or caste"**.



Fig. 10.4: Ramananda

Kabir (1398-1448 AD)

- He was probably a **weaver**, born in **Varanasi**.
- **Learned Vedanta philosophy** from **Swami Ramananda**. He was a Nirguna saint.
- According to **Tazkirah-i-Auliya-i-Hind** (Lives of Muslim Saints), he was a disciple of the Muslim Sufi, **Shaikh Taqi**.
- **His poems** express a wide range of ideas, blending **Sufi** and **Hindu** ideas like **'zikr'** and **Naam-simran** and taught that Allah and Ishwar, Ram and Rahim are one and the same.
- He had no faith in idol worship polytheism and denounced the caste system.
- He equally condemned Muslim formalism.



Fig. 10.5: Kabir

- Kabir's **verses exist in three distinct** traditions:
 - **Kabir's Bijak** is preserved by the **Kabirpanth** (the path or sect of Kabir).
 - **Kabir Granthavali** by Dadupanth in Rajasthan.
 - **Adi Granth Sahib**.
- His poems (called **banis**) often invert everyday meanings ("**Ulatbansi**" or **upside-down sayings**) to hint at the complexity of expressing the Ultimate Reality.

Guru Nanak Dev (1469-1538 AD)

- He was born in **Nankana Sahib** (near the **Ravi** river) in 1496 AD.
- Advocated **Nirguna bhakti**, believing in a formless, genderless absolute god called "**rab**."
- He **dismissed** rituals, sacrifices, and the scriptures of both **Hindus** and **Muslims** and emphasised connecting to the Divine by repeating the Divine Name through "**shabad**" hymns.
- He established a community of followers and set guidelines for collective worship, or "**sangat**," centered on collective recitation. He founded the Sikh religion during the period of **Sikander Lodi** (1489-1517) and when **Babur** was strengthening the Mughal dynasty.
- The teachings of Guru Nanak is the **Adi Granth**.

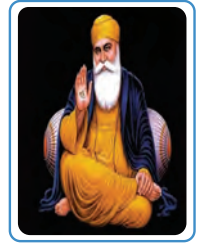


Fig. 10.6: Guru Nanak Dev

Vallabhacharya (1479-1531 AD)

- Vallabhacharya, the **founder of Pushtimarg** (the path of grace), emphasised devotion to the **child Krishna** through **Vatsalya Bhakti**.
- He travelled across India, establishing **eighty-four Pushtimarg seats** during his pilgrimages.
- He propounded the theory of **Shuddadvaita (pure non-dualism)**.
- Advocated **householdership** for Vaishnava devotees.

Chaitanya (1485-1533 AD)

- He was fondly addressed as 'Mahaprabhu' by his followers. His songs are still very popular in **Bengal**. He was a Bengali saint devoted to **Krishna**.
- He started a **revivalist movement** as he wanted to exalt the superiority of Krishna over all other deities. His movement became popular in **Bengal and Orissa**.
- Considered an incarnation of **Vishnu** by his followers. He championed love and tolerance and opposed caste inequalities.
- Sri Chaitanya Mahaprabhu brought widespread attention to '**Sankirtan**', the public singing of God-praising songs, and the chanting of the **Hare Krishna mantra** in Bengal.



Fig. 10.7: Chaitanya Mahaprabhu

- Additionally, he utilized **jatra**, the folk theatre of eastern India, as a means to spread the teachings of Krishna.
- Consequently, it's evident that the Bhakti movement underwent a significant transformation with the arrival of Sri Chaitanya Mahaprabhu.

Shankaradeva (1449-1568 AD)

- He championed **Vaishnavism in Assam** (especially in the **Kamarupa** region) through his **Bhagavati dharma** teachings, drawing from the Bhagavad Gita and Bhagavata Purana.
- **The Ekasarana movement** (Neo-Vaishnavite movement) was started by him. He believed in the worship of one God/ Ekasarana in the form of Krishna.
- He emphasised surrendering to Vishnu and endorsed '**naam kirtan**' - reciting the lord's names in devout congregations (**sat sang**).
- He advocated for '**satra**' (monasteries) and '**naam ghar**' (prayer halls) for spiritual growth.
- "**Kirtana-ghosha**" (written in **Brajavali language**) is a notable poetical composition of Shankaradeva.

Dadu Dayal (Late 16th Century)

- He was a **nirguna saint** from **Gujarat**.
- He composed mostly in **Braj language**.
- He inspired the formation of a sect called **Dadu Panth**.
- Dadu Dayal rejected the authority of the Vedas, caste distinctions, and external forms of worship such as temple visits and pilgrimages. Instead, he emphasized practices like japa (repetition of the name of God)
- He focused on themes such as the soul's union with God.
- His followers abstain from alcohol, follow a vegetarian diet, and the Dadu Panth also includes a significant ascetic aspect.

Tulsi Das (1532-1623 AD)

- He popularised the **Rama cult** through his **Hindi** rendition of Rama's story.
- His notable works include **Janaki Mangal**, **Parvathi Mangal**, **Ramcharitmanas**, **Vinay Patrika**, **Dohavali** and **Gitavali**.
- He was a **contemporary of Akbar and Jahangir**.

Tukaram (1608-1649 AD)

- He penned **Abhangas** in **Marathi**, devotional songs praising **Lord Vithoba** of **Pandharpur**.
- He was a contemporary of **Chhatrapati Shivaji**, **Jahangir**, **Shahjahan** and saints like **Eknatha** and **Ramdas**.



Fig. 10.8: Tukaram

- He believed in a **formless god** and rejected Vedic sacrifices, pilgrimages, and idol worship.
- He promoted equality and brotherhood and tried to foster Hindu-Muslim Unity. This theme is covered in a few of his verses.

Guru Samarth Ramdas (1608-1681 AD)

- He was a worshipper of Lord Rama and Hanuman from Maharashtra.
- He founded the Samarth sect to revive spirituality among the various sections of Indian society.
- He stressed the **equality of all** men before God.
- Not just a **religious preacher** but also a **visionary nation-builder**.
- He was a renowned teacher and **spiritual guide** to **Chhatrapati Shivaji**. His works provided inspiration to **Bal Gangadhar Tilak** as well.

Janabai (1258-1350 AD)

- Born in **Maharashtra** in a 'low' caste family, she served as a disciple of **Namadeva**.
- Penned over 300 poems, highlighting the challenges of her low-caste status and the confines of domestic life.

Narsinh Mehta (1414-1481 AD)

- He was a Bhakti saint (Vaishnavism) from Gujarat.
- He authored Mahatma Gandhi's favourite bhajan, "Vaishnava jan ko".
- He is credited with the composition of Padas (verses).
- He is acclaimed as Adikavi.

Mirabai (1498-1546 AD)

- Born in **Merta** (Rajasthan), great-granddaughter of **Rana Jodhaji**, she was married to Bhoj Raj, son of Rana Sanga of Mewar. She escaped from the palace and gave up traditional marital roles to live as a wandering saint, composing songs that are characterised by intense expressions of emotion and devoting herself to **Krishna**.

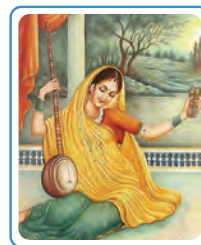


Fig. 10.9: Mirabai

- A prominent female poet in the bhakti tradition, **advocating the** form of **Saguna bhakti**. She wrote **Rag-Govind**.
- Mirabai's guru, **Raidas**, was a leather worker, highlighting her **rejection of caste norms**.
- While she did not form a sect, her songs (Bhajans) remain popular among underprivileged communities in Gujarat and Rajasthan.

Sur Das

- Sur Das lived at the court of **Akbar** and was popularly known as the **blind bard of Agra**. Sur Das is believed to have been a **disciple of Vallabhacharya**.
- He was a Saguna saint.
- He preached a religion of love and devotion to a personal God. He wrote inspiring Hindi poems about **Lord Krishna**.
- Krishna's **Baal Lila** constitutes the first great theme of Sur Das's poetry.
- His popular works are **Sur Sagar**, **Sur Saravali** and **Sahitya Lehari**. His monumental work Sur Sagar is a story of Lord Krishna from the birth to the departure for Mathura.



Fig. 10.10: Sur Das

Bahinabai or Bahina (1628-1700 AD)

- Poet-saint from Maharashtra **wrote abhangas**, songs depicting women's daily labours.
- Her poems are autobiographical, detailing her life stages and marital conflicts due to her profound love for **Lord Vithoba**, a form of Krishna.
- While dedicated to her divine love, she respected her marital duties, as reflected in her writings on the responsibilities of women toward their husbands.
- Though from a Brahmin background, she revered the low-caste poet-saint **Tukaram**, prioritising devotion over traditional purity norms.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

To what extent did the Bhakti Movement revitalize the adaptability in Hinduism?

SUFI MOVEMENT

Introduction

Sufism, known as tasawwuf in the Arabic-speaking world, is a form of Islamic mysticism that emphasizes introspection and spiritual closeness with God. As the Caliphate's materialism increased around the beginning of 12th century AD, some religious individuals in Persia became ascetic. They came to be known as "Sufis." Its essence is **seeking deeper, personal communion with God**.

Origin of Sufism in India

- With the expansion of the Muslim empire, the Sufi movement spread all over the Muslim world with a missionary zeal to preach Islam.
- In India, it **started with the advent of trade** when foreign merchants started to settle on the western coast. Later on, with successive Muslim invasions, Sufis gained prominence in India.

- Shaikh Ali Hujwari** of Data Gunj was the **first reputed Sufi in India**. He paved the path for the future of sufis in India through his book, **Kashf-ul-Mehjub**. He emphasized the **basic doctrines** of Sufism, like worship of God, love of God, knowledge of God, purification, and annihilation.

Stages in the History of Sufism

Stage	Period	Character
Stage:1 Khanqah	10th century	Age of Golden Mysticism
Stage:2 Tariqa	11-14th century	Institutionalization of Sufism
Stage:3 Tarifa	15th century	Sufism became a popular movement

Main Characteristics of Sufism

- Direct communion with **divine reality (Haqiqat)** can be established by traversing the **Sufi path (tariqa)** only under the strict supervision of a **shaikh, pir, or murshid**, who had himself successfully traversed it.
- Disciple (**murid**) progressed through the 'stages' by practicing spiritual exercises such as self-mortification, **recollection of God's name** to attain concentration (**Zikr**), and contemplation.
- The use of music, particularly in **Sufi gatherings (Sama)**, has been a source of spiritual inspiration and expression. E.g., **Khwaja Moinuddin Chisti** popularised music recitations called **Sama (Mehboob-i-ilahi)**.
- The **hospice (Khanqah)** was the center of the activities of a Sufi order, which was **supported by endowment and charity**. It was the place where the pir imparted spiritual training to his disciples. The popularity of the Khanqah and its capacity to attract disciples depended on the reputation of the 'pir'.
- Sufis emphasize **personal spirituality** over ritualistic practices.
- They sought a **deeper connection with God** through meditation, chanting, and personal interpretations of the Qur'an. They also believe in **Tawakkul** (meaning completely trusting in the plan of God. It symbolized the idea of observing containment).



IGNITE YOUR MIND

Discuss the interfaith dialogue and harmony fostered by Sufi movement in India.

Orders of Sufism (Silsilah)

There are many major and minor orders. Some of them were founded in India itself. The major orders are as follows.

- Chishtiya Silsilah**
- Suharwardiya Silsilah**
- Qadriya Silsilah**
- Naqshbandi Silsilah**

The minor orders emerged as the offshoot of one or the other major orders.

Chishtiya Order

The Chishtiya Order was founded in India by **Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti**, who migrated to India from Central Asia at the behest of his peer (guide), Khwaja Usman. He came with the army of **Muhammad Ghori** in 1192 and settled at **Ajmer**. He maintained that devotional music was one way of coming close to God.

- ❑ They were the most influential Sufi group due to their successful adaptation to local customs and incorporation of Indian devotional traditions.
- ❑ Practices such as bowing before the Shaikh, offering water to visitors, shaving the heads of initiates, and yogic exercises represented attempts to assimilate local traditions.
- ❑ Visitors to Chishti Khanqah included poets such as **Amir Hasan Sijzi** and **Amir Khusrau** and the court historian **Ziyauddin Barani**.
- ❑ **Pilgrimage to Sufi saints' tombs (Ziyarat)** is a common practice for seeking **spiritual grace (Barakat)**. It involves music, dance, and mystical chants by qawwals for divine ecstasy, blending indigenous devotional traditions.
- ❑ The **shrine of Khwaja Muinuddin, "Gharib Nawaz,"** is most revered. It is situated on the Delhi-Gujarat trade route, it became popular with travellers.
- ❑ Sufis invoke God through '**zikr**' (**Divine Names**) and '**sama**' (**audition**) or mystical music performance, a key aspect for Chishtis, bridging indigenous devotional traditions.

Languages and Communication

- ❑ **Chishti Sufis in Delhi** used **Hindavi**, the common language, for communication.
- ❑ Sufi poets often used long poems, using human love to symbolise divine love. E.g.:- **Malik Muhammad Jayasi's "Padmavat"** narrates the story of **Padmini and Ratansen** to represent the soul's journey to the divine.
- ❑ **Bijapur** and **Karnataka** saw the creation of Sufi poetry, specifically in **Dakhani**, a form of Urdu associated with Chishti Sufis. The Sufis in this region drew inspiration from the **bhakti tradition** of **Kannada Vachanas**.

Chishtis and the State

- ❑ The Chishti tradition **maintained austerity but not political isolation** and accepted grants and tax-free lands from rulers.

Example: The **Shrine of Khwaja Muinuddin** received early funding from **Sultan Ghiyasuddin Khalji** of Malwa in the late 15th century.

- ❑ Their piety, scholarship, and perceived miraculous abilities made them popular, attracting the support that kings desired.

Example: **Emperor Akbar** frequently visited the shrine of **Khwaja Muinuddin (Ajmer)**, giving generously and building a mosque on the premises. Shah Jahan, along with his daughter Jahanara, also visited the shrine.

- ❑ Rulers of the Delhi Sultanate sought approval from Sufis, who had direct divine authority, to counterbalance the ulema's push for shari'a law.

Example: **Sultan Muhammad bin Tughlaq** was the first Sultan to visit the **shrine of Khwaja Muinuddin**.

- ❑ Instances of conflict arose between Sultans and sufis, often stemming from specific rituals, such as **Sijdah (prostration)** and **Paibos (foot-kissing)**.

Example: Disagreement of Chishti Sufis over the policies pursued by Muhammad Tughlaq.

- ❑ **Sufi Shaikhs** were occasionally **honoured with titles**.

Example: The disciples of **Nizamuddin Auliya** addressed him as **Sultan-ul-mashaikh**.

- ❑ Sufis, like the **Suhrawardi under the Delhi Sultans** and the **Naqshbandi under the Mughals**, had connections with the state. Still, their methods of association **differed** from the Chishtis in their approach towards spiritualism and donations from the state.

Example: **Bahauddin Zakariya** received the title **Shaikh-ul-Islam** and wealth from **Iltutmish**, adopting a more worldly approach.

- ❑ Some Sufis even accepted courtly positions.

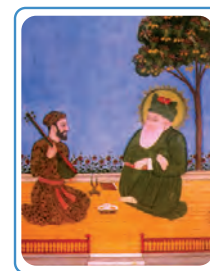


Fig. 10.11: A 17th century painting of Shaikh Nizamuddin Auliya and his disciple Amir Khusrau

Jahanara's biography of **Moin-ud-din Chishti**, titled **Munis al Arwah** (The Confidant of Spirits).

Major Teachers of the Chishti Silsila

Sufi Saints	Important Points	Location of Dargah	Time
Shaikh Muinuddin Sijzi/Moinuddin Chishti	Came to India at the time of the Ghori conquest.	Ajmer (Rajasthan)	1143-1235
Khwaja Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki	Qutb Minar is dedicated to him.	Delhi	1173-1235
Shaikh Fariduddin Ganj-i Shakar/Baba Farid	Guru Granth Sahib includes hymns written by him.	Ajodhan (Pakistan)	1178-1271
Shaikh Nizamuddin Auliya	Witnessed the reign of seven successive Sultans of Delhi.	Delhi	1238-1325
Shaikh Nasiruddin Chiragh-i Dehlavi	Also known as Roshan Chirag-e-Delhi or 'illuminated lamp of Delhi'	Delhi	1274-1337

Shaikh Nizamuddin Aulia

He was the disciple of **Baba Farid**. He guided the common masses and the aristocrats. The kings paid him great respect and often sought his exhortations, particularly at the time of invasion.

- ❑ **Amir Khusrau**, a **disciple of Shaikh Nizamuddin Auliya**, introduced the **qaul, a hymn**, which was sung at the start or end of qawwali performances.
- ❑ Qawwali blends Persian, Hindavi, and Urdu languages and remains a widespread tradition at shrines in the subcontinent.
- ❑ His teachings were compiled in the book '**Fawaidul Fawad**' by **Amir Hassan Sizzi**.
- ❑ He was also known as '**Mehboob-e-Ilahi**.'

Qadriya Order Pandharpur

- ❑ **Founder: Abdul Qadir Jilani** (migrated into India from the Persio-Arab land); **Shah Namatullah** was another saint associated with it.
 - **Muhibullah Shah, Miyan Meer, and Dara Shikoh** (the eldest son of Shahjahan) were the representative sufis of this order.
- ❑ The Qadriya order in India was introduced quite late in the last decades of the 14th century. The order **became more popular in the Muslim world**, including India, due to the **induction of Ibnul Arabi** into the fold.
- ❑ Most of its followers, therefore, were staunch supporters of the very controversial **theory of the unity of existence, Wahdat-ul Wujood**.
- ❑ The Qadriya order **remained less significant in India** as compared to the other three major orders.
- ❑ Urdu poets **Hasrat Mohani** and **Muhammad Iqbal** were associated with this order.

Suhrawardi Order

- ❑ **Founder: Sheikh Shahabuddin Suharwardi Maqtul**. He introduced the **doctrine of light (Nur)** into Sufism.
 - **Bahauddin Zakarya, a contemporary of Shaikh Nizamuddin Auliya**, was the most important Sufi of the Suharwardi order in India. He **made it popular**, particularly **in Northern India**.
- ❑ Unlike the Chishti saints, the Suharwardis considered the **accumulation of wealth** indispensable to offer better services to humanity.
- ❑ Introduced later than Chistiya, the order remained popular only for a short time.

Naqshbandi Order

- ❑ **Khawja Baha-ul-din Naqsh band** was **the founder** of Naqshbandi order. This order was popularised by **Khawja Naseer-ul-din Ubaidullah Ahrar**. He lived in the Turkish

Empire in the city of Samarqand. He encouraged the Timurid princes to invade the states like Tashqand and merge them into their kingdom.

- ❑ The Naqshbandi order was **introduced in India** with the **invasion of Babar**. It became popular during the reign of Akbar and had Aurangzeb as one of its followers.
- ❑ Naqsh bandya order was **less tolerant** as compared to the Chishtis, Qadries, and Suhawardies.
- ❑ Naqshbandies traced their **origin** from the first caliph, **Abu Bakr**, unlike the other three orders.
- ❑ Their puritanical approach made them austere and obstinately hard-liners. They recommended to the Mughal kings to impose **Jizya** (a kind of tax) on the Hindu subjects. The Mughal kings, however, never acted upon their advice.
- ❑ **Shaikh Ahmad Sir Hindi**, a noted Naqsh Bandi Saint, vehemently **criticised Akbar** for his policy of "**Sulah-e-Kul**" (compromise with all and his religion), "**Din-i Ilahi**" the religion of God, which Akbar founded for the fulfilment of his mission.
- ❑ The early Nakshbandies were inclined towards **Wahadata-ul-Wadjoood**, the unity of existence, the theory of **Ibnul-Arabi**.
- ❑ Later on, **Shaikh Ahmad Sir Hindi** propounded another theory known as the unity of appearance, **Wahadul-ul-Shahood**. According to this doctrine, the experience of unity between God and creation is purely subjective and occurs only in the mind of the Sufi who has reached the state of **fanaa-fillaah** (mysticism; to forget about everything except Almighty Allah).
- ❑ It produced many notable saints like Khwaja Khurd, Ahmad Sirhindi, Khawaja Masoom, Shah Wali-Ullah, and his son Shah Abdul Azeez.
- ❑ **Shah Wali-ullah** was another outstanding **sufi of this order**. He also asserted that the Wahdut-ul-wujood and wahdut-ul-Shahood are simply two stages in the mystic journey.

CONCLUSION

Sufism and Bhaktism have had a profound and positive impact on individuals and societies alike, promoting love, compassion, spiritual growth, and social harmony. But despite their efforts, Sufis and medieval mystic saints faced several challenges in modifying the religious ideas and practices of Hindu and Muslim societies due to the orthodox resistance from both Hindu and Muslim communities, limited social reach, as their teachings resonated primarily with specific sections of society and regional variations and a diversity of beliefs and practices, which made it challenging to establish a unified or coherent impact on the religious ideas and social structures of Hindu and Muslim societies.

Schools of Indian Philosophy

11

INTRODUCTION

The religion of the Rig Vedic people was very simple in the sense that it consisted mainly of the worship of numerous deities representing the various phenomena of nature through prayers. It was during the later Vedic period that definite ideas and philosophies about the true nature of the soul or Atman and the cosmic principle or Brahman, who represented the ultimate reality, were developed.

Indian philosophy encompasses several philosophical traditions that originated in the Indian subcontinent, including Hindu, Buddhist and Jain philosophy. They include both **orthodox** (Astika) systems, such as the Nyaya, Vaisheshika, Sankhya, Yoga, Purva-Mimamsa (or Mimamsa), and Vedanta schools of thought, and **heterodox** (nastika) systems, such as Buddhism and Jainism.

ORTHODOX SCHOOL OF PHILOSOPHY

The Orthodox School of Philosophy, also known as the **Astika schools**, refers to the **six major schools of Indian philosophy** that **accept the authority of the Vedas** as their foundational texts.

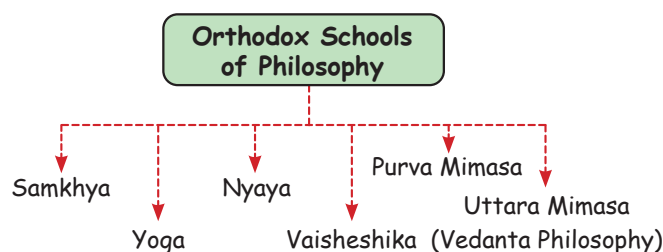


Fig. 11.1: Orthodox Schools of Philosophy

Samkhya

- The propounder of samkhya philosophy was **Kapila**, who wrote the **Samkhya sutra**.
- It holds that **reality** is constituted of two principles: one **female (Prakriti)** and the other **male (Purusha)**.
 - **Purusha** is mere consciousness and cannot be modified or changed.



Fig. 11.2: Maharishi Kapila Muni

- **Prakriti**, on the other hand, constitutes of three attributes, thought, movement, and the change or transformation of these attributes brings about the change in all objects.
- Prakriti and Purusha are completely independent and absolute.
- This philosophy tries to establish some relationship between Purusha and Prakriti to explain the **creation of the universe**.
- Samkhya school explained the phenomena of the doctrine of evolution.
- This school believed in **Dvaitavada** or **Dualism**, that the soul and the matter are separate entities.
- The Samkhya school **denies** the **existence of God**. However, **rebirth** and **transmigration of the soul** are inherent in the Samkhya School.
- It holds that it is **self-knowledge** that leads to **liberation** and not any exterior influence or agent.
- In the beginning, the Samkhya school of philosophy was materialistic. Then it tended to be spiritualistic.
 - The original Samkhya school had a more scientific view of the creation of the universe and considered that no divine agency was necessary for this. They, unlike the new Samkhya school, neglected the importance of Purusha for the creation of the universe and credited Prakriti for the existence of the world.

Yoga

- The origin of yoga is found in the **Yogasutra** of **Patanjali**, which is believed to have been written in the second century BC.
- Yoga literally means the **Union of the two principal entities**.
- By purifying and controlling changes in the mental mechanism, yoga systematically brings about the **release of Purusha from Prakriti**.
- Yogic techniques **control the body, mind and sense organs**. Thus this philosophy is also considered a means of achieving freedom or mukti.

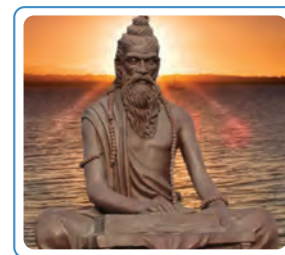


Fig. 11.3: Maharishi Patanjali

- ❑ This freedom could be attained by :
 - **Yama**: Self-control.
 - **Niyama**: Rule of conduct.
 - **Asana**: Fixed postures.
 - **Pranayama**: Breath control.
 - **Pratyahara**: Control his/her sense organs and avoid being attracted by worldly objects.
 - **Dharana**: Fixing the mind
 - **Dhyana**: Concentrating on the chosen object.
 - **Samadhi**: Merging of the mind and the object.
- ❑ Yoga admits the **existence of God as a teacher and guide**.

Nyaya

- ❑ **Gautama**, the founder of this school of philosophy, is said to be the **author** of the **Nyaya Sutras**.
- ❑ According to Nyaya, **valid knowledge is defined as real knowledge**, that is, one knows about the object as it exists.
- ❑ It believes in the technique of **logical thinking** to achieve **salvation**.
- ❑ This philosophy considers God as the one who creates, sustains and destroys the universe.
- ❑ The Nyaya school asserts that there exist four legitimate avenues of acquiring knowledge:
 - **Direct perception** (pratyaksha)
 - **Logical inference** (anumana)
 - **Analogical reasoning** (upamana)
 - **Authoritative testimony** (shabda)
- ❑ Knowledge is considered unreliable when it involves elements such as recollection, uncertainty, misconception, and speculative reasoning.



Fig. 11.4: Maharishi Gautama

Vaisheshika

- ❑ **Kanada** wrote the basic text of this philosophy.
- ❑ Vaisheshika system is considered the **realistic and objective philosophy of the universe**.
- ❑ They believe that **God is the guiding principle** and that the creation and destruction of the universe was a cyclic process and took place in agreement with the wishes of God.
- ❑ Vaisheshika thinkers believe that **all objects** of the universe are composed of **five Elements: earth, water, air, fire and ether**. These materials are also called **Dravya**.

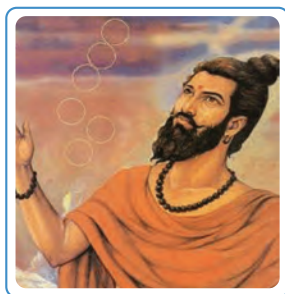


Fig. 11.5: Maharishi Kanada

- ❑ According to this philosophy, living beings were rewarded or punished according to the **law of karma**, based on actions of merit and demerit.
- ❑ Vaisheshika School of philosophy explained the phenomena of the universe by the **atomic theory**, the combination of atoms and molecules into matter and explained the mechanical process of formation of the Universe.
- ❑ They believed in redemption as well, but it was in tandem with the cyclic process of the Universe's creation and destruction, which was determined by God's intentions.

Mimamsa

- ❑ Mimamsa philosophy is basically the analysis of interpretation, application and use of the text of the Samhita and Brahmana portions of the Veda.
- ❑ Sutras of **Rishi Jaimini** describe this philosophy.
- ❑ According to this philosophy, **Vedas are eternal** and possess all knowledge, and religion means the fulfilment of duties prescribed by the Vedas.
- ❑ This philosophy **encompasses the Nyaya-Vaisheshika systems** and emphasizes the concept of **valid knowledge**.
- ❑ This system lays **stress on the ritualistic part** of Vedas, but it also stresses that it is necessary to understand the justification and reasoning behind Vedic rituals.
- ❑ It stresses the **doctrine of "karma"**. It says that liberation is possible by means of performing Karma.
- ❑ This philosophy inherently legitimized the **social distance** between the various classes.
- ❑ **Jaimini, Sabar Swami and Kumarila Bhatta** were the main proponents of this school.



Fig. 11.6: Maharishi Jaimini

Vedanta

- ❑ Vedanta is made of two words - Veda and Ant meaning the **end of the Vedas**.
- ❑ This school upholds the **philosophies of life** as elaborated in the **Upanishads**.
- ❑ The oldest text that formed the basis of this philosophy was **Brahmasutra** of **Badarayana**.
- ❑ According to Vedanta philosophy, **Brahman is true, the world is false. The self, and Brahman are not different**.
- ❑ **Adi Shankaracharya** and **Ramanuja** were major philosophers of this school.
- ❑ **Shankaracharya** believes that the Brahman is existent, unchanging, the highest truth and the ultimate knowledge.

- ❑ The core message of Vedanta is that **every action must be governed by the intellect**: The discriminating faculty.
- ❑ Vedanta enables the practitioner to access the realm of spirit through the intellect.
- ❑ The knowledge of Brahman is the essence of all things and the ultimate existence.
- ❑ Vedantic philosophy was considered as one philosophy that reached the **climax of philosophic thought** that the human mind can possibly reach.
- ❑ Vedanta theory also gave credence to the **Theory of Karma** and believed in the theory of **Punarjanma or Rebirth**.

Sub-schools of Vedanta

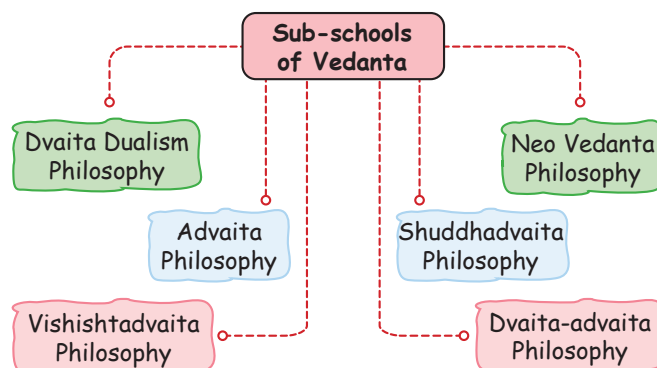


Fig. 11.7: Sub-schools of Vedanta

Advaita Philosophy

- ❑ It was propounded by **Adi Shankaracharya** (8th century).
- ❑ At its core, Advaita Vedanta teaches that the **ultimate reality, Brahman, is beyond attributes and distinctions**.
- ❑ It posits that the individual self (atman) is essentially identical to Brahman, and the apparent diversity of the world is a result of ignorance (avidya).
- ❑ He considers **knowledge or Gyan** to be the main means of attaining salvation.

Vishishtadvaita Philosophy

- ❑ It was propounded by **Ramanuja** (11-12th century AD).
- ❑ **Brahman** is the **supreme reality**, characterized by attributes (Saguna).
- ❑ **Individual souls (Jivas)** are considered distinct from Brahman but are inseparable parts of Brahman. They possess consciousness and individuality but are dependent on Brahman for their existence.
- ❑ The material world (**Prakriti**) is not an illusion but a manifestation of Brahman's divine qualities.
- ❑ Practitioners engage in loving **devotion** to God as a means of realizing their unity with Brahman.

Dvaita Dualism Philosophy

- ❑ It was proposed by **Madhavacharya** (1238-1317 AD).
- ❑ Unlike Advaita and Vishishtadvaita, which proposed varying degrees of non-duality, Dvaita maintains a **clear and eternal distinction** between the **soul (jiva)** and **Brahma**.
- ❑ Brahma is also identified as having attributes.
- ❑ The **material world (Prakriti)** is **separate** from both **Brahman** and the **individual souls**. It is considered real but dependent on Brahman for its existence and sustenance.
- ❑ This school advocates for the path of devotion as the means to attain spiritual liberation.

Dvaita- Advaita Philosophy

- ❑ It was proposed by **Nimbarka** (13th century AD).
- ❑ The **Jiva** and **Brahman** are **simultaneously different** (Bheda) and **non-different** (Abheda).
 - Like Dvaita, it acknowledges the reality of individual souls (jivas) as distinct from the supreme reality, Brahman.
 - It recognizes that while there is a difference between individual souls and Brahman, there is also a non-dual aspect to reality where everything ultimately emerges from and exists within Brahman.
- ❑ The path to liberation emphasizes both knowledge (jnana) and devotion (bhakti).

Suddha-Advaita Philosophy

- ❑ It was proposed by **Vallabhacharya** (1479-1531 AD).
- ❑ He wrote commentaries on Vedanta Sutra and Bhagavad Gita. For him, Brahman (God) was Sri Krishna, who manifested himself as soul and matter. **God and soul are not distinct but one**.

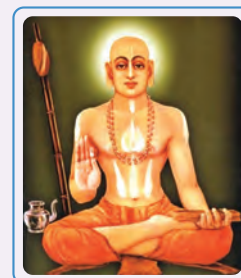


Fig. 11.8:
Madhavacharya

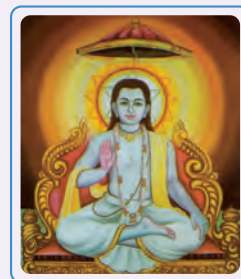


Fig. 11.9: Nimbarka

- ❑ The stress was on pure non-dualism. His philosophy came to be known as **Pushtimarga** (the path of grace), and the school was called **Rudrasampradaya**.

Neo Vedanta

In the 19th and 20th centuries, a modern reinterpretation of Vedanta emerged, with influential figures such as **Ramakrishna, Vivekananda, and Aurobindo** playing significant roles as teachers within this school of thought. This movement sought to adapt traditional Vedantic teachings to contemporary contexts and **address the challenges of modernity while retaining the essence of Vedanta's timeless wisdom**.

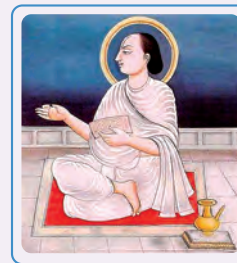


Fig. 11.10:
Vallabhacharya



IGNITE YOUR MIND

How do orthodox schools of philosophy reconcile traditional teachings with modern advancements and societal changes?

HETERODOX SCHOOL OF PHILOSOPHY

They **do not believe** in the originality of the **Vedas** and question the existence of God. They are divided into three major sub-schools: **Buddhism, Jainism and Lokayata**.

Charvaka or Lokayata Philosophy

Brihaspati laid the foundation stone of this school.

- ❑ This philosophy is mentioned in the **Vedas** and **Brihadaranyaka Upanishad**.
- ❑ This school was the main propounder of the **materialistic view** of life and is also known as the **philosophy of the masses**.
- ❑ They argued against the need to achieve **salvation** and also **denied** the **existence of Brahma and God**.
- ❑ They also argued against **God's representatives on Earth**, the priestly class. They argued that Brahmins **manufacture false rituals** so as to acquire **gifts** (Dakshina) from the followers.
- ❑ They **do not** consider **Ether** as one of the **five essential elements** because it cannot be experienced through perception but believe in the other four elements (fire, air, water and earth).
- ❑ This school argues that there is **no other world** after this one. Hence death is the end of a human being, and pleasure should be the ultimate objective of life. They propounded the theory of '**eat, drink and make merry**'.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

How do orthodox and heterodox schools of philosophy in India contribute to the concept of unity in diversity?

Buddhism

Buddha presented simple principles of life and practical ethics that people could follow easily. He considered the world as full of misery. Man's duty is to seek liberation from this painful world. He strongly criticized blind faith in the traditional scriptures like the Vedas.



Fig. 11.11: Gautama
Buddha

Philosophy of Buddha

- ❑ The World is transient or 'Impermanence' (**anicca**).
 - ❑ It is also soulless (**anatta**) with nothing permanent in it.
 - ❑ Sorrow (**dukkha**) is intrinsic to human existence.
- Thus, following the path of **moderation** between **severe penance** and **self-indulgence**, human beings can rise above these worldly troubles.

Four Noble Truths

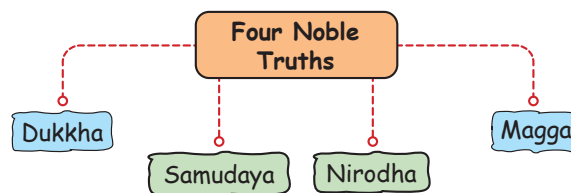


Fig. 11.12: Four Noble Truths

The knowledge realized by Buddha is reflected in the following **four noble truths**:

- ❑ **There is suffering in human life (Dukkha).**
- ❑ **There is a cause of suffering (Samudaya):** It is a desire that motivates the cycle of birth and death.
- ❑ **There is a cessation of suffering (Nirodha):** When passion, desire and love of life are totally destroyed, pain stops.

- ❑ **Path of Liberation (Magga):** The fourth Noble Truth leads to a way that takes to liberation. Buddha suggests that the way or the path leading to liberation is eight-fold. According to Buddha, the Middle Path describes the character of the Noble Eightfold Path that leads to liberation (Moksha).

The Eight Fold Path to Liberation (Nirvana)



Fig. 11.13: Eight fold Path (Astangika Marga)

- ❑ **Right Vision:** One can attain the right vision by removing ignorance. Ignorance creates a wrong idea of the relationship between the world and the self.
- ❑ **Right Resolve:** It is the strong willpower to destroy thoughts and desires that harm others.
- ❑ **Right Speech:** Man should control his speech by right resolve.
- ❑ **Right Conduct:** It is to avoid activities that harm life.
- ❑ **Right Means of Livelihood:** Right livelihood means to earn one's bread and butter by right means.
- ❑ **Right Effort:** It is also necessary to avoid bad feelings and bad impressions.
- ❑ **Right Mindfulness:** It means to keep one's body, heart and mind in their real form. Bad thoughts occupy the mind when their form is forgotten.
- ❑ **Right Concentration:** If a person pursues the above seven Rights, he will be able to concentrate properly and rightly.

Buddhist Philosophical Schools

There are four principal Buddhist philosophical schools, which are the four pillars of Buddhist doctrine.

- ❑ **Vaibhashikas:** It transformed Buddha's concept of 'no soul' into a consistent philosophy of '**pudgal nairatmaya**' (**non-substantiality of everything**). Non-substantiality is not only in the case of human beings, but is applied to the whole material world, i.e. things are without essence. Another view that is closely connected with this insubstantiality is the idea of the **momentariness**

of all entities. Still, they accepted three moments in this change; past, present and future; that which causes that which is destroyed and that which endures.

- ❑ **Sautrantikas:** The Sautrantikas asserted that while events (dharma) exist only momentarily, there exists a continuous underlying consciousness that carries within it latent seeds of goodness present in every individual.
- ❑ **Cittamatrins:** It asserts that all phenomena are ultimately nothing but mind or consciousness. According to this school of philosophy, external objects, the physical world, and even the notion of an individual self are considered manifestations of the mind.
- ❑ **Madhyamikas:** The name of this school comes from Buddha's famous 'middle position' (Madhyama pratipad). Hinayana schools mostly took its ethical implication, i.e. not going to the extremes of indulgence or practice. But this school takes it in a metaphysical sense. Middle position is the rejection of the extreme metaphysical positions of 'is' and 'is not' (Sasvatavada and Uchedavada).

❑ Triratnas of Buddhism

- **Buddha** (the enlightened one)
- **Dhamma** (teachings of Buddha)
- **Sangha** (the monastic order).

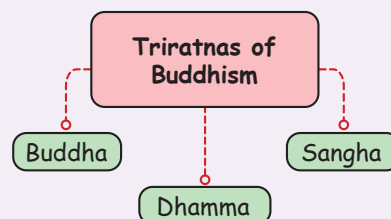


Fig. 11.14: Triratnas of Buddhism

- ❑ Buddhism **does not recognize the existence of God and the soul.**
- ❑ Buddhism also **rejects the authenticity of the Vedas.**
- ❑ It **attacked the Varna system**, and people were taken into the Buddhist order without any consideration of caste.
- ❑ Buddhism emphasized on **non-violence** and focused on **protection of cattle.**

Jainism

Like the Charvakas, the Jains too, do not believe in the Vedas. They also agree with the orthodox tradition that suffering (pain) can be stopped by controlling the mind by seeking the right knowledge and perception, and by observing the right conduct. Jainism made the first serious attempt to mitigate the evils of the Varna order and the ritualistic Vedic religion.



Fig. 11.15: Mahavir

Philosophies of Jainism

- ❑ Jainism promotes **dualism**, making the distinction between **soul (jiva)** and **matter (ajiva)**. The coming together of jiva and ajiva creates **karma (action)**, which leads to an **endless cycle of birth and rebirth**. To free oneself from karma, one has to practice **severe austerities** and **self-mortification**.
- ❑ Although Jainism recognises the soul, it rejects the notion of an ultimate, universal soul.

“Souls are not only the property of animal and plant life, but also of rocks, running water and many other natural objects not looked on as living by other religious sects.”

- ❑ Jainism propagates the theory of **‘The Doctrine of Relativity of Knowledge and Judgments.’**
- ❑ Jainism divides all knowledge into two classes:
 - the **Mediate (Paroksha)**, which can be sensed through sensory organs) and
 - the **Immediate (Aparksha)**, which can be obtained without sensory organs).
- ❑ Immediate knowledge is divided into **Avadhi, Manahparyaya, and Kevala**.
- ❑ Mediate knowledge is divided into **Mati and Shruta**.

Avadhi (Clairvoyance)	Knowledge is limited.
Manahparyaya (Telepathy)	Direct knowledge of the thoughts of others.
Kevala (Omniscience)	Absolute knowledge.
Mati (Sensuous Cognition)	Sensory comprehension.
Shruta	Knowledge obtained from authority.

- ❑ **Philosophy of Syadavada (Syad: relative to some standpoint, vada: doctrine, theory, view)**
 - Knowledge is **partial** and always **relative** to some particular point of view and about particular aspects of objects.
- ❑ **Philosophy of Anekantavada (theory of plurality):** Ultimate truth and reality are complex and have multiple aspects/perspectives.

Principles and Doctrines of Jainism

- ❑ The three principles of Jainism also known as **Triratnas** are:
 - **Right faith (Samyak darshana)**
 - **Right knowledge (Samyak gyana)**
 - **Right conduct (Samyak charitra)**
- ❑ The **five doctrines** of Jainism (**Anuvrata**) are:
 - Do not commit violence (**Ahimsa**)

- Do not speak a lie (**Satya**)
- Do not steal (**Asteya**)
- Do not acquire property (**Aparigraha**)
- Observe continence (**Brahmacharya**).

The word **shramana** means one who performs the act of **austerity** and **ascetic**. The various **Shramana schools** include:

- ❑ **Charvakas**
- ❑ **Buddhism**
- ❑ **Jainism**
- ❑ **Ajivikas**
- ❑ **Ajnanas**

Ajivikas

This school was founded by **Makkhali Goshala** in the 5th century BC.

- ❑ **Shravasti** in Uttar Pradesh is believed to be the centre of Ajivikas.
- ❑ This school revolves around the **Niyati (Fate)** doctrine of **absolute determinism**. It believes that there is no free will and everything is **predetermined**.
- ❑ Ajivikas led a **simple ascetic life** without clothes and material possessions.
- ❑ They **did not believe** in **Karma** and considered Karma as a fallacy, however, they **believed** in the **existence of the soul**.
- ❑ They **rejected** the authority of **Vedas**.
- ❑ **Bindusara** was one of its followers, and **Ashoka's seventh pillar edicts** mention Ajivikas.

Ajnanas

- ❑ They believed in **radical scepticism**.
- ❑ They believed that it is **impossible to attain knowledge about nature**, and even if it is possible, it is useless for attaining Salvation.
- ❑ According to this school, **“Ignorance is Best”**.

CONCLUSION

In conclusion, logical analysis of Nyaya to the metaphysical exploration of Samkhya, from the ritual interpretation of Mimamsa to the meditative practices of Yoga, and from the non-dualism of Advaita Vedanta to the ethical teachings of Buddhism and Jainism, Indian philosophy offers a wealth of insights and approaches to understanding the human condition and the universe. This multiplicity of philosophical perspectives reflects the depth and complexity of Indian intellectual heritage, influencing not only the spiritual and religious landscape of India but also making significant contributions to global philosophical discourse.

Indian Literature and Language

12

INTRODUCTION

With a history spanning millennia, Indian literature encompasses a vast array of genres, styles and themes, which reflects the deep-rooted traditions and rich heritage of the Indian subcontinent. One of the distinguishing features of Indian literature is its multi-lingual nature. Each language has its own unique literary tradition, with masterpieces spanning centuries.

LITERATURE IN ANCIENT INDIA

Literature in ancient India encompasses a vast and diverse body of texts that were composed over millennia. These texts cover various subjects, including philosophy, religion, science, medicine, poetry, drama, and more.

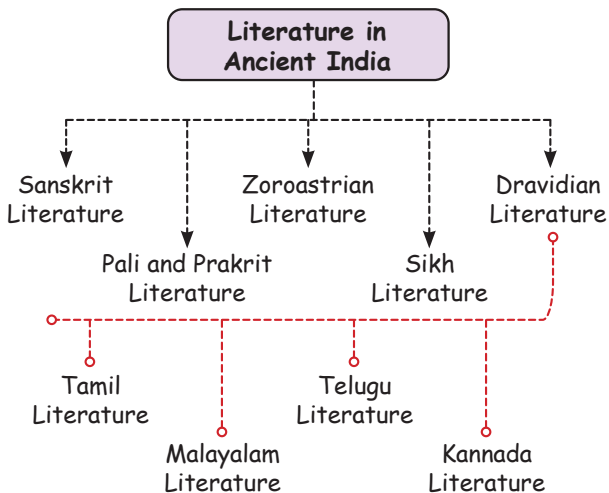


Fig. 12.1: Literature in Ancient India

Sanskrit Literature

The Sanskrit language, considered sacred in Hinduism, has been a vehicle for expressing religious, philosophical, literary, and scientific ideas. The vast corpus of Sanskrit literature encompasses various genres, including epics, poetry, drama, philosophy and scientific treatises.

Vedic Literature

The Vedas constitute a vast compilation of religious texts originating from ancient India. Penned in Vedic Sanskrit, these writings represent the **oldest corpus of Sanskrit literature** and serve as the earliest scriptures of Hinduism. There are four Vedas:

- ❑ **Rig Veda** is the **oldest** of the Vedas, it consists of **hymns** dedicated to various deities and natural forces.
- ❑ **Yajur Veda** deals with rituals **and sacrifices**.
- ❑ **Sama Veda** primarily focused on **songs** and **melodies** practised during religious rituals and sacrifices.
- ❑ **Atharva Veda** contains many **spells, incantations**, and **charms** for addressing various aspects of daily life, including healing and protection.

Classical Sanskrit Literature

The Puranas

- ❑ Puranas were written to **illustrate and expound the truth of the Vedas**.
- ❑ There are **18 main Puranas** whose names were discovered after the **third century AD**.
- ❑ The popularity of these Mahapuranas gave rise to another sub-genre, Upapuranas, or minor Puranas.

Brahmanas: These are a category of ancient Indian texts that form part of the Vedas. These are important for understanding the ritualistic practices and religious beliefs of ancient Vedic society.

Aranyakas: These are a part of the Vedas. The Aranyakas contain philosophical, mystical and symbolic interpretations of Vedic rituals and teachings. They also provide guidance on meditation, contemplation and spiritual realization.

Together with the Brahmanas, the Aranyakas bridge the gap between the ritualistic concerns of the earlier Vedic texts and the philosophical inquiries and spiritual aspirations found in the later Upanishads.

Upanishads: The Upanishads are a collection of ancient Indian philosophical texts that form the culmination and essence of the Vedic teachings. They discuss metaphysical concepts such as the nature of existence, consciousness, and the relationship between the **individual soul (jivatman)** and the **universal soul (paramatman)**.

Philosophical Literature

- ❑ **Yoga sutras:** The Yoga Sutras of Patanjali are 196 Indian aphorism/sutras. It is a foundational text of the Yoga school of Hindu philosophy.
- ❑ **Nyaya sutras:** The Nyaya Sutras is an ancient Indian Sanskrit text composed by Aksapada Gautama and the foundational text of the Nyaya school of Hindu philosophy.

- ❑ **Vaisesika sutras:** It is also called Kanada sutra. It is written in Sanskrit and is the foundational text of Vaisesika Hindu philosophy. The sutra was authored by the Hindu sage Kanada who was also known as Kashyapa.
- ❑ **Mimamsa sutras:** Also known as the Purva Mimamsa sutras, was written by Rishi Jaimini. It is one of the most important ancient Hindu philosophical texts. It forms the basis of Mimamsa Hindu philosophy.

Mahakavya

They refer to **epic poems** typically narrating heroic tales and are often drawn from **mythology** or historical events. E.g., **Ramayana** and **Mahabharata**.

- ❑ **Mahabharata:** It was compiled by **Ved Vyas** in **Sanskrit**.
 - Initially, it had **8800 verses** and was called **Jaya gita** (the story of **victory**), and later, the total verses were increased to 24000 and renamed '**Bharata**' after the early Vedic tribes.
 - A further expanded version of 1,00,000 verses was named Mahabharata.
 - It includes a vital Hindu text called the **Bhagavad Gita**.
- ❑ **Ramayana:** Sage **Valmiki** compiled its first version, which is often referred to as **Adikavya**, signifying its status as the first poetry of its kind. It is divided into **seven** books called **Khandas**.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

Discuss the thematic and stylistic differences between the Rigveda, one of the oldest texts in Sanskrit literature, and a Mahakavya such as Kalidasa's 'Meghaduta,' highlighting how they represent distinct periods and genres within the Sanskrit literary tradition.

Sanskrit Drama

- ❑ **Rajatarangani** is a vivid account of the **kings of Kashmir**, composed by **Kalhana** in the mid-12th century. The text mentions the Karkota, Varman and Yashaskara Dynasty.
- ❑ **Kathasaritsagara** (**Somadeva, 11th century AD**), also known as the "**Ocean of the Streams of Stories**". The book showcases the tragic **history of Kashmir** during that period.
- ❑ **Kalidasa** was a renowned Sanskrit poet and dramatist of the **Gupta period** (contemporary of **Chandragupta II**).

Kalidasa's Work

Abhijñānaśākuntalam	It contains the story of Shakuntala and King Dushyanta.
Vikramorvashi	It contains the tale of Urvashi and her union with King Vikram.
Malavikagnimitra	❑ The love story of the Sunga king, Agnimitra and Malvika, a maid. ❑ Provides accounts for the Rajasuya Yajna performed by Pushyamitra Sunga.
Raghuvamsa	It narrates the ancestry of Lord Rama's Raghu Vamsa.
Kumarasambhava	It depicts the birth of Kartikeya, the son of Shiva and Parvati.
Meghaduta	It focuses on a cloud messenger's journey.

- ❑ **Shudraka (5th century AD):** He composed **Mrichchhakatika** (The Little Clay Cart), **Vinavasavadatta**, and a **Bhana** (a short one-act monologue).
 - **Mrichchhakatika** presents a **Sanskrit social drama**. The story is about a merchant named Charudatta who fell in love with a rich courtesan named Vasantsena.
 - The first four acts of Mrichchhakatika are virtually a copy of the corresponding acts from Bhasa's unfinished play Charudattam.
- ❑ **Bhasa (4th century BC - 2nd century AD):** He wrote 13 plays that were discovered at the beginning of the 20th century. The most popular is **Swapnavasavadatta**, showing romantic narratives about Kaushambi king **Udayana** and **Vasavadatta** (Avanti Princess).
 - **Urubhanga**, written by **Bhasa**, is the story of **Duryodhana** during and after his fight with **Bhima**.
- ❑ **Uttararamacharita:** It was a **seven-act Sanskrit play** written by **Bhavabhuti**. It depicts the later life of **Lord Rama** after Rama's return from exile.
- ❑ **Mudrarakshasa:** Sanskrit play written by **Vishakhadatta** (4th century AD) that narrates the ascent of the king **Chandragupta Maurya** to power with the aid of **Chanakya**.
- ❑ **Devichandraguptam:** It is a **political drama** composed by **Vishakhadatta**. The play revolves around **King Ramagupta's** decision to surrender his queen, **Dhruvadevi**, to an encroaching Shaka enemy during a siege.
 - A **Persian play**, taken directly from **Devi Chandraguptam**, is found in the 11th-century manuscript **Majmal-ut-Tawarikh**.

Harsha's Work

Ratnavali	It is a Sanskrit drama centered around the characters of Princess Ratnavali and King Udayana. The text contains one of the early documented references to the Holi festival celebration.
Nagananda	- It is a Sanskrit drama that narrates the story of Prince Jimútaváhana, a divine magician, and his selfless act to protect the Nagas. - The text also includes an invocation to Buddha within the Nandi verse.
Priyadarshika	It is a Sanskrit play that mentions the union of King Udayana and Priyadarshini, daughter of Emperor Dridhavarman.

- ❑ **Gita Govinda** (12th century) It was composed by **Jayadeva** and describes the love between **Krishna** and **Radha**.

Didactic fables like **Panchatantra** by **Vishnu Sharma** and **Hitopadesha** by **Narayan Pandit** are part of classical Sanskrit literature that offer practical wisdom and advice.

Buddhist Scriptures in Sanskrit

While the primary language of early Buddhism was Pali, there are also Buddhist scriptures and texts written in Sanskrit. These Sanskrit Buddhist scriptures played a significant role in the development and transmission of Buddhist teachings, especially in Mahayana Buddhism.

- ❑ The '**Buddhacharita**' by **Ashvaghosha** was written in the **early second century AD**. It is an epic poem written about the life of **Gautam Buddha**.
- ❑ **Mahavibhasa Shastra** is a **Mahayana** text, written in **150 AD** that contains discussions about other **non-Buddhist philosophies** also.
- ❑ **Lotus Sutra** is also known as the "**Saddharma Pundarika Sutra**". It is a key scripture in Mahayana Buddhism.
- ❑ **Abhidharmamoksha** was written by **Vasubandhu**. It contains a discussion on Abhidharma (commentaries on the Law).
- ❑ **Udanavarga** contains the compilation of **utterances of Buddha** and his disciples.

Jain Scriptures in Sanskrit

Jainism, like Buddhism, has a rich textual tradition with scriptures composed in various languages, including Sanskrit. These Sanskrit Jain scriptures are fundamental to the Jain tradition and contain teachings, principles, and narratives central to Jain philosophy and practice.

- ❑ **Upamitibhava Prapancha Katha** was composed by **Siddharasi** in **906 AD** and is often called the "**Tale of Upamiti Bhava**".

- ❑ **Tattvartha-sutra** was composed by **Umaswati** during the **2nd-5th century AD**, addressing logic, epistemology, ethics, and astronomy. Both the Digambara and Svetambara sects accepted the text.
- ❑ **Shantinatha Charitra** is an important Jain text concerning the **16th Tirthankara Shantinatha**, written in Sanskrit and recognised as a **global treasure by UNESCO**.
- ❑ **Adipurana** is written by Digambara monk **Jinasena**. It narrates the lives of the first twenty-two Tirthankaras.
- ❑ **Samantbhadra's work (Digambar scholar)**
 - Ratna Karanda Sravakachara
 - **Aptamimansa** is a treatise that discusses the Jaina view of reality, dealing with the concept of omniscience and its attributes.
- ❑ **Acharya Jinasena's work (Digambara monk)** include **Mahapurana** and **Harivamshapurana**.

Pali and Prakrit Literature

In the post-Vedic era, literature expanded beyond Sanskrit and included Prakrit and Pali languages. Both languages gained prominence in the creation of religious texts by Buddhists and Jains.

Buddhist Literature

Pali is a **Middle Indo-Aryan language** that is closely related to the ancient Indian language Sanskrit. Buddhist literature in Pali primarily consists of the canonical texts of **Theravada Buddhism**, the oldest surviving school of Buddhism. Buddhist literature is broadly categorised into canonical and non-canonical works.

Canonical Literature

Buddhist literature comprises '**Tipiṭaka/Tripitaka**', written in Pali and divided into three parts:

- ❑ **Vinaya Pitaka** contains the monastic rules of the Order of Buddhist monks.
- ❑ **Sutta Pitaka** is the collection of the teachings of the Buddha.
- ❑ **Abhidhamma Pitaka** elucidates the various topics dealing with ethics, psychology or theory of knowledge.

Non-Canonical Literature: A prime example of Buddhist non-canonical literature is the '**Jatakas**'. The **Jataka stories** narrate the previous births of the Buddha.

Buddhist Texts

Dipavamsa	- It was written in the 3rd-4th centuries BC in Anuradhapura (Sri Lanka). - It provides a historical account of Buddhism in Sri Lanka and narrates Buddha's visit to Sri Lanka and the relics of Buddha.
Milinda Panho	The book mentions the dialogue between King Meander (or Milinda) and Buddhist monk Nagasena .

Mahavamsa	- It is a Sri Lankan Pali account and were combined and compiled into a single document in the 5th century CE by Buddhist monk Mahathera Mahanama. - It provides a historical account of various kingdoms of South Asia.
Mahavastu	It contains Jataka and Avadana tales written in Sanskrit, Pali, and Prakrit.
Lalitavistara Sutra ("The Play in Full")	It is a Mahayana text that narrates various stories related to the life of the Buddha until his first sermon at Sarnath.
Udana	It is one of the oldest Theravada texts and includes the story of the "Blind Men and the Elephant."
Bodhi Vamsa	It is a prose poem written in the 10th century AD by Upatissa in Pali , Sri Lanka.
Visuddhimagga	It is a Theravada text written by Buddhaghosa in the 5th century AD in Sri Lanka . It includes discussions on various teachings of the Buddha.
Buddha Charita	It was written by Asvaghosa . It is also called Buddha Carita-kavya-sutra in Sanskrit. It is an epic poem written on the life of Gautama Buddha . It tells the whole life of Buddha from his birth to death in 28 chapters .

Jain Literature

Jain Literature is generally written in **Prakrit, Ardha Magadhi, Sanskrit, etc.** They are divided into **Canonical** or religious texts called Jain Agamas or Agam and **non-canonical** literary works.

- **Jain Agamas** are canonical **religious texts** written in **Prakrit** that contain the **teachings** of **Jain Tirthankaras**.
 - Initially, the Ganadharas, the principal followers of Mahavira, **compiled** them.
 - The present **Angas** (a subset of the Agamas) were **recompiled** in a **council of monks** of the **Svetambara** sect held in **Vallabhi, Gujarat**, during the **mid-5th century AD**.
 - The **Digambaras reject Agamas**.
 - The Agamas consist of 46 texts - 12 **Angas**, 12 **Upanga**, 10 **Prakirnakasutras**, 4 **Mulasutras**, 6 **Chedasutras**, and 2 **Chulikasutras**.
 - The **12 Angas** are: Acharanga Sutra; Sutrakritanga; Sthananga Sutra; Samavayanga Sutra; Vyakhyaprajnapati or Bhagavati Sūtra; Upasakadasa; Antakrddasah; Anuttaraupapatikadasah; Prasnavyakaranani; Vipakasruta; and Drstivada.
- **Gatha Saptasati**: The Gatha-Saptasati is an anthological treatise (a Kosa-grantha) written in Maharastri Prakrit language. It contains 700 verses, with **King Hala** contributing 44 verses. The women poets wrote the other verses. It is often considered the opposite of the **"Kamasutra"**.

- **Uvasaggaharam Stotra**: It was composed by **Acharya Bhadrabahu** in Prakrit. It is an adoration of the twenty-third Tirthankara **Parsvanatha**.
- **Kalpa Sutra**: It is a **Śvetāmbara canonical** scripture written partly in **prose** and partly in **verse** in Prakrit language.
- **Kalakacharya Katha**: It tells the story of Kalak, a great Jain muni of the Shwetambar school and his sister. It is written in Prakrit language.
- **Acharya Kundkund's work (in Prakrit Language)**
 - Samayasāra** expounded the Jain concepts like Karma, Asrava, Bandha, Samvara, Nirjara and Moksha.
 - Niyamasara** discusses the road to emancipation.
- **Silappadikaram**: A moralistic treatise, Ilango Adigal's Silappadikaram is regarded as one of the best epics in Tamil literature and was composed in the second century AD. It centers on Kannagi, who exacts retribution on his kingdom after losing her husband to injustice in the Pandyan Dynasty court.
- **Civaka Cintamani**: Written by Tirutakkatevar is also one of the epics of Tamil literature.
- **Nalatiyar**: It is an ancient Tamil text composed by Jain monks.
- **Tattvartha Sutra**: It was written in Sanskrit by Umaswati between 2nd and 5th century AD. It deals with logic, epistemology, ethics, and astronomy. It is accepted both by the Digambara and Svetambara sects.
- **Mahapurana and Adipurana**: It was written in Sanskrit by Jinasena, a revered Jaina Digambara monk and a disciple of Virasena.
- **Haribhadra Suri**, who lived around 5th-6th century AD, wrote in Sanskrit.
 - He was a Svetambara Jain.
 - He wrote Saddarsanasamuccaya, which compares Jainism with other schools of Indian Philosophy.
 - Samaraiccakaha is another book he wrote which illustrates the works of Karma.
- **Kalikala Sarvajna, which means the all-knowing of the Kaliyuga**, is a title bestowed upon Jain monk Hemachandra Suri who lived in the 12th century. He was a famous Jain scholar who wrote on the grammar of Sanskrit and Prakrit, poetry, and prosody.
- **Pampa, Ponna and Ranna**, who are regarded as the three gems of Kannada literature, wrote extensively in Kannada between the 9th and 12th centuries. They were all Jaina monks and wrote about Jainism.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

What lessons can be drawn from ancient philosophical texts like the Upanishads or the teachings of Buddha to promote mindfulness and mental well-being in today's society?

Zoroastrian Literature

Zoroastrian literature in India primarily refers to the literary works produced by the Parsi community, who follow the Zoroastrian faith and migrated to the Indian subcontinent centuries ago.

- ❑ **Avesta** is a compilation of diverse writings spanning religious beliefs, practices, and guidance. It was written in **Avestan**, a language related to Sanskrit that is now extinct.
 - **Zend Avesta: Zarathushtra** also taught the ethical doctrine of **kindness** and **charity**. These doctrines are enshrined in the **Zend Avesta**. Written in Old Avestan and consists of **Gathas** (17 sacred songs) and the **Athuna Vairyo** (sacred chant), which was supposedly written by Zarathushtra himself. The translation and glossaries were compiled together and called **Zend** which is divided into **five parts**:
 - ❑ **Yasna**: Worship with ceremony and offerings.
 - ❑ **Vendidad**: Laws against the demons or evil spirits.
 - ❑ **Yashts**: to worship through praise.
 - ❑ **Khordeh Avesta**: Book on common prayers.
 - ❑ **Gathas**: part of Yasna texts.
- ❑ **Denkard**: It is a compilation of books & regarded as the **Encyclopedia of Zoroastrianism**. It was composed in the **10th century AD**.
- ❑ **Bundahishn**: The text provides an insight into the religion's creation theory.

Sikh Literature

Sikh literature in India is a vibrant and integral part of the Sikh tradition. Sikh literature is primarily written in Gurmukhi script and is central to the dissemination of Sikh philosophy and teachings.

- ❑ **Adi Granth**: It was written in **Gurmukhi script** by **Bhai Gurdas** under the aegis of the fifth guru, **Guru Arjan Dev**, in **1604**. It is a **predecessor** to **Guru Granth Sahib** and contains the teachings of the Sikh Gurus and fifteen Bhagats of Bhakti and Sufi traditions.
- ❑ **Guru Granth Sahib**: It is an expansion of Adi Granth under the tenth guru, **Guru Gobind Singh**, in **1678**. It is regarded as the **eleventh** and final spiritual authority of the Sikhs.
 - It is written in **Gurmukhi script** and '**Sant Bhasa**' language. Sant Bhasa contains Punjabi, Apabhramsa, Hindi, Braj Bhasa, Sanskrit, Khadiboli, and Persian words.
 - The book contains the teachings of **fifteen Bhakti saints**, called '**Bhagats**', like Ramananda, Namadev, Ravidas, Parmanand, Sain, Surdas, Kabir and Baba Farid.
- ❑ **Dasam Granth**: The Dasam Granth is a collection of various poetic compositions attributed to Guru Gobind Singh. The compilation includes fables and Puranic stories, with certain hymns being part of the daily prayers known as "**Nitnem**".

- ❑ **Janamsakhis**: These books contain **mythological stories** about the life of **Guru Nanak** (first guru).
- ❑ **Ardas** are prayers performed during **daily rituals in Gurudwaras**. These are recited during the opening and closing of Guru Granth Sahib.
- ❑ Guru Gobind Singh had written poetry in Punjabi called **Savaiye**.

Dravidian Literature

Dravidian literature comprises the **Tamil, Telugu, Kannada**, and **Malayalam** languages, all of which have been influenced by Sanskrit.

Tamil Literature

Early classical Tamil literature is called **Sangam literature**. The Sangam classics comprise **18 works** (eight anthologies of lyrics and ten long poems) written by 473 poets, 30 of whom were women. Sangam literature mainly has **two schools of poets**:

- ❑ **Aham**, which deals purely with the subjective emotions of the lover.
- ❑ **Puram** is **objective and public poetry** which deals with all kinds of emotions, mainly the valour and glory of kings and about good and evil.

Sangam literature makes references to the social classification of Varna. **Arashar** (kings), **Vaishiyar** (traders), and **Velalar** (farmers) are mentioned.

The Sangam literature is broadly **categorized into two groups**: Narrative and Didactic.

Narrative	Didactic
❑ These texts include Melkannaku, or eighteen major works, comprising Ettuthogai, a collection of eight long poems, and Pattupattu, a collection of ten small poems. ❑ These narrative texts focus on heroic poetry, glorifying heroes and wars while providing insights into the process of state formation in South India.	❑ These texts include Kilkannaku, or eighteen minor works, including Tirukural and Naladiyar. ❑ These works prescribe a code of conduct for kings and society and shed light on various social groups and occupations.

The Sangam literary collection encompasses several essential works

- ❑ **Tolkappiyam**: It was the **earliest Tamil literary work**, composed by the sage **Tolkappiyar** or **Tolkappiyam Periyathar**. It is a **grammar treatise** to understand early Tamil poetry.

- **Tolkappiyam** is divided into three books: **Eltuttatikaram** (deals with the Tamil script and phonology), **Sollatikaram** (focuses on Tamil **grammar** and **morphology**), and **Porulatikaram** (delves into the subject matter or **content of literature**).

- ❑ **Ettuthogai**: It is a collection of classical Tamil poetry, and “Ettuthogai” translates to “**Eight Anthologies**” in English. These **eight anthologies** are Aingurunooru, Narrinai, Aganaanooru, Purananooru, Kurunthogai, Kalithogai, Paripadal, and Padirrupattu.
- ❑ **Pattuppattu** or The **Ten Long Poems** include: Kurincipattu, Porunararruppatai, Cirupanarruppatai, Perumpanarruppatai, Maturaikkanci, Malaipatukatam, Pattinappalai, Mullaippattu, Netunalvatai and Tirumurukarruppatai.
- ❑ **Pathinenkilkanakku** contains **eighteen texts** encompassing many themes, including love, **ethics**, war, and ancient Tamil society’s **general way** of life.
- ❑ **Silappatikaram/Cilappatikaran**: It was composed by **Ilango Adigal**. It is a tale of love (the love story of **Kovalan** and **Kannagi**), betrayal, and justice that unfolds in **three Kantams** or books.
 - The text also contains overtones of **Jain philosophy**.
- ❑ **Manimegalai**: It is a classical Tamil epic poem counted among the **five great epics of Tamil literature**.
 - It was composed by poet **Sattanar** and was a sequel to the renowned Tamil epic **Silappatikaram**.
 - It prominently features themes related to **Buddhism**.
- ❑ **Valayapathi**: It is said to be written by Tamil Jain ascetic Kamil Zvelebil. To instill Jain ideas and ideals is the main goal of this epic, and love is its dominating emotion.
- ❑ **Civaka Cintamani**
 - It is said to be written by Tamil Jain ascetic **Tiruttakkatēvar** in the early 10th century.
 - It is a story of a prince who is the perfect master of all arts, the perfect warrior and the perfect lover with numerous wives.
 - The poetic style of the Civakacintamani epic is found in Tamil poetic literature that followed among Hindu and Jain scholars, attesting to its literary significance.
- ❑ **Kundalakesi**: It is said to be written by Tamil Buddhist monk Nathakuthanaar, likely sometime in the 10th-century.

Malayalam Literature

Ezhuthachan, a proponent of the **Bhakti movement**, is the father of Malayalam literature.

- ❑ **Kokasandisan** is a significant work in Malayalam literature.
- ❑ **Bhasa Kautilya** is a commentary on the ancient Indian treatise on statecraft and economics, the **Arthashastra**.
- ❑ **Ramacharitam** was **composed** by the ancient Malayalam poet **Cheeraman** in the **13th Century**. The poem narrates the story of Lord Rama and his adventures.

Telugu Literature

Nannaya (AD 1100) was considered the **first poet in Telugu**. However, Telugu literature reached **its zenith** during the **Vijayanagara period**.

Some Major Works in Telugu Literature

- ❑ **Uttaraharivamsam**: It was written by **King Bukka I’s** famous court poet, **Nachana Somanatha**.
- ❑ **Manu Charitra**: It was written by **Allasani Peddana** (also known as Andhra Kavita Pitamahudu).
- ❑ **Parijatapaharanamu**: It was written by **Nandi Thimmana**.
- ❑ **Panduranga Mahatmayam**: It was written by **Tenali Ramakrishna** (a court jester and poet who was said to have a close association with the king Krishna Devaraya).
- ❑ **Vasucharitram and Narasabhupaleeyamu**: It was written by **Ramaraja Bhushanudu** (also known as Bhattumurti).
- ❑ **Nalopakhyanamu**: It was written by **Harishchandra**.
- ❑ **Rajasekaracharitra**: It was written by **Madayyagari Mallana**. The text narrates the love and war of **King Rajasekara** of the **Avanti** kingdom.
- ❑ **Ramabhudayamu**: It was written by Ayyalaraju Ramabhadhrudu.

Krishnadevaraya was a great scholar and a patron of literature.

- ❑ His court housed eight accomplished Telugu poets, collectively known as “**Ashtadiggajas**.”
- ❑ He patronised **Haridasa** (a Tamil poet) and **Kannada poets** such as Mallanarya, Chatu Vittalanatha, and Thimmana.
- ❑ During his Kalinga campaign, he composed **Amuktamalyada**, a treatise recounting the instance of **Lord Vishnu** in his dream.
- ❑ He also authored **Krishna Deva Rayana Dinachari** (in Kannada) and Sanskrit treatises, including **Madalasa Charita**, **Satyavadu Parinaya**, **Rasamanjari**, and **Jambavati Kalyana**.

Kannada Literature

Kannada literature, beginning with the seminal work **Kavirajamarga**, is predominantly characterized by its association with three major faiths: **Jainism**, **Veerashaivism**, and **Vaishnavism**, with the dominance of literature composed by the Jains.

Some Major Works in Kannada Literature

- ❑ **Dharmanath Purana**: It was written by **Madhava** on the life of the **fifteenth Tirthankara**.
- ❑ **Dharma Parikshe**: **Uritta Vilasa** wrote it on the Jain teachings.
- ❑ **Kavirajamarga**: It was written by **Nripatunga Amoghavarsha I**, a powerful **Rashtrakuta king**.

- ❑ **Harishchandra Kavya** and **Somanatha Charita**: These were written by **Harishvara**.
- ❑ **Harivamshabhyudaya** and **Jiva Sambodhana**: These were written by **Bandhuvarma**.
- ❑ **Jagannathavijaya**: It was written by **Rudra Bhata**.
- ❑ **Madana Vijaya or Kabbigara Kava**: It was written by **Andayya**. The text was celebrated as it was the **first pure Kannada text** that did not have any Sanskrit words.
- ❑ **Shabdamanidarpana**: It is a **grammar book** composed by **Kesirja**.
- ❑ **Suktisudharnava**: It is a collection of poems written by **Mallikarjuna**.
- ❑ **Tarave Ramayana**: It was composed by Narahari and written entirely in **Kannada**. It was the **first story on Rama** inspired by the **Valmiki Ramayana**.
- ❑ **Jaimini Bharata**: It was written by **Lakshamisha** and it is also called the **Kamata-Karicutavana-Chaitra** (the spring of the Karnataka mango grove).
- ❑ **Hadibadeya Dharma (Duty of a devout wife)**: It was written by **Honnamma** (a female Kannada poet).

The '**Ratnatraya**' or 'the three gems' of the **Kannada language** include:

- ❑ **Pampa** (9th-10th century AD)
 - He is also called the **Father of Kannada language**.
 - Two of his most renowned poetic works include, **Adipurana** (written in the Champu style) and **Vikramarjuna Vijaya**.
 - He is known for his **mastery of rasa** in poetry and served at the court of Chalukya Arikesari.
- ❑ **Ponna** (9th-10th century AD) authored the famous treatise **Shanti Purana**.
- ❑ **Ranna** (10th-11th century AD) authored the famous treatise **Ajitha Purana**.
- ❑ **Vachana Sahitya**
 - Vacahanas were composed in Kannada by saints of the **Lingayat faith**. It was part of the **Sharana movement** in Karnataka. It evolved in the **11th century** and flourished in the **12th century**.
 - Vachanas literally meant as said. They are **intelligible prose texts** and are noted for their **simplicity and directness**. They often address **social issues and personal devotion**.
 - About **22,000 vachanas** have been published.
 - More than **200 Vachanakaras** have been recorded. Of them **30 were women**.
 - Notable Vachanakaaras were **Basavanna, Akka Mahadevi and Allama Prabhu**. **Jedara Dasimaiah** is regarded as **Adya Vachanakara**.

India through the Eyes of Foreign Travellers

Megasthenes

- ❑ He was a Greek, who visited India during the reign of Chandragupta Maurya for a period between 302-298 BC.
- ❑ He wrote the book **Indica**, which is an account of Mauryan India. It walks through the sub-continent's rich legacy, evolution, flora and fauna, geography etc.

Fa Hien

- ❑ He was a Chinese traveller who came to India during the period of Chandragupta Maurya between 405-411 AD.
- ❑ He wrote **Fo-Kwo-Ki** which is a record of Buddhistic Kingdoms in the sub-continent. It provides crucial insights into the Buddhist way of life in the Indian subcontinent.

Hiuen Tsang

- ❑ He was a Chinese traveller who visited India between 630- 645 AD during the reign of **Harshavardhana**.
- ❑ He wrote Great Tang records which is a narrative of Xuanzang's nineteen-year journey from Chang'an in central China to the Western Regions of Chinese historiography.

LITERATURE IN MEDIEVAL INDIA

Around 1000 A.D., local differences in Prakrit grew more and more pronounced, which later came to be known as **Apabhramsa**, and this led to the modern Indian languages taking shape and being born. A significant transformation occurred with the ascent of Persian as the predominant written language during the reigns of the Delhi Sultanate and the Mughal Empire.

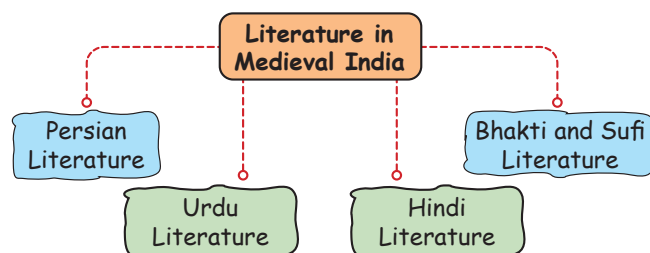


Fig. 12.2: Literature in Medieval India

Persian Literature

The Persian language made its way to India in the twelfth century when the Turks and Mongols arrived in the sub continent. It became the court language of the Delhi Sultanate and Mughal Empire which aided in its promotion in India.

Persian Literature	
Divan (a collection of Persian poetry), Nuh Sipihr , and Duval Rani-Khizr Khan (a tragic love poem) were written by Amir Khusrau Dehlvi .	
Tarikh-e-Firuz Shahi	- It was written by Zia-ud din Barani. - The best example of Indo-Persian historiography written in India during the Sultanate era is Tarikh-i Firoz Shahi.
Tuzuk-i-Babari (Babarnama)	It is the autobiography of Zahiruddin Muhammad Babur, the founder of the Mughal empire in India. The book is originally written in Turki (Chagatai) language, later translated into Persian.
Humayun-Nama	Written by Gulbadan Begum (half sister of Humayun), it is a fascinating history of Humayun.
Ain-e Akbari and Akbarnama	- Written by court historian Abul Fazl and commissioned by Akbar himself. - The third volume of the Akbarnama, the Ain-i-Akbari, is an administrative report book that serves as a gazetteer of information on Akbar's reign.
Padmavat	- Written by Malik Muhammad Jayasi. Jayasi wrote Padmavat in Persian Script and Hindustani language of Awadh. - It is an epic poem that relates an allegorical fictional story about Delhi Sultan Allaudiin Khilji's desire for the titular queen of Chittor Padmavati.
Shahjahannama	- Written by Inayat Khan. - It is a group of works written as the official history of the reign of Mughal emperor Shah Jahan.
Kulliyat (collection of verses)	- Written by Mir Jafar Zatali. - It is a collection of verses of Urdu and Persian often called as 'Rekhta'.
Padshahnama	- Written by Abdul Hamid Lahori. - It is a group of works written as the official history of the reign of Mughal Emperor Shah Jahan.
Razmanama (Book of War)	It was the first-ever Persian translation of the Mahabharata under the order of Emperor Akbar .
Yoga Vasistha was translated into Persian by Nizamuddin Panipati during the reign of Akbar.	

This literature not only mirrored the political, social, and cultural realities of the period but also served as a crucial bridge, connecting the Indian and Persian cultural spheres and fostering a unique synthesis between them.

Urdu Literature

Urdu emerged around the 12th century AD, **blending** elements of **Hindi** and **Islamic cultures**. It draws from **Arabic** and **Persian**, as well as **Sanskrit-based Prakrit vocabulary**

- Amir Khusrau contributed to the development of Urdu in its nascent stage.
- Urdu primarily follows **Khadi Boli grammar** and **Persian script**.
- Along with names such as Hindavi, Zuban-e-Dehlvi, it was also referred to as **Dakkani** (Southern) due to its use in the Bahmani States of Ahmadnagar, Golconda, Bijapur, and Berar.
- Eminent Urdu poets include **Mirza Ghalib**, **Sauda**, **Dard**, and **Mir Taqi Mir**.
 - Ghalib composed a collection of poetry (**Diwan**) in Urdu.
- In the 20th century, **Iqbal**, who wrote poems imbuing patriotism including the Tarana-e-Hind (popularly known as Saare Jahan Se Achcha), became a significant figure in Urdu literary writing.

Hindi Literature

Hindi is an **Indo-Aryan language** and is borrowed from Classical Persian. During the reign of the Delhi Sultanate, the confluence of Hindu and Muslim cultures, the base of Sanskrit and Prakrit, gave rise to Old Hindi loaning words from Persian. The extraction of Persian and Arabic words eventually led to the evolution of the Hindustani Language, which is now spoken as Hindi in the North Indian belt.

Some Important Books in Hindi

Prithviraj Raso	It is a Braj language epic poem attributed to Chand Bardai, which documents the life and challenges faced by Prithviraj Chauhan.
Ramcharitmanas, Dohavali, Gitavali, and Vinaya Patrika	These were written by Tulsidas .
Sur Sagar	Written by Surdas, it is a collection of poems based on the stories of the childhood of Krishna found in the Bhagavata-purana.

Bhakti and Sufi Literature

The Bhakti and Sufi movement flourished between the eighth and seventeenth centuries AD and embodied the socio-religious reforms in its journey. It was distinguished by its socially inclusive outlook and usage of regional languages. The movement used songs and stories to reach people leading to the development of regional literature.

Bhakti Literature

- ❑ **Alvars** and **Nayanars** asserted the significance of their traditions **equal to that of the Vedas**.
- ❑ **Literature created by Alvars**
 - **Nalayira Divyaprabandham**, a “**four thousand sacred collection**” of compositions by the **12 Alvars**, was compiled in the 10th century by **Nathamuni** and is often referred to as the **Tamil Veda**.
 - The collection of devotional songs of **Andal** is called **Thiruppavai**. Andal's Tamil works include **Thiruppavai** and **Nachiar Tirumozhi**.
- ❑ **Literature created by Nayanars**: The Saiva literature was canonized as the **Panniru Tirumurai** (12 volumes).
 - **Tevaram/Thevaram** is a compilation of devotional poetry by Tamil poets **Appar**, **Sambandar**, and **Sundarar** which forms the initial seven volumes of **Saiva Tirumurai**. The Eighth Thirumurai consists of the hymns of Manickavasakar.
 - **Manickvachakar's** songs are known as **Tiruvachakam**.
 - **Periyapuranam**, written by **Sekhizhar**, tells us the life stories of the Nayanars. It is the twelfth Thirumurai of the Saiva canon.
- ❑ **Other Bhakti Literature**
 - **Abhangs** by **Namadeva** in Marathi and Hindi which were later added to **Guru Granth Sahib**. Namadeva was a **Marathi Vaishnav saint** and is widely regarded as the founder of **Varkari tradition**.
 - **Ashtadasha Shiva Hikari** is a poetic compilation of 18,000 verses on lord Shiva, written by **Jnaneshwar**, who was a 13th-century **Marathi saint**.
 - “**Kirtana-ghosha**” (written in Brajvali language) is a notable poetical composition of **Shankardeva**, who was a 15th-16th century **Bhakti saint from Assam**.
 - The important books written by **Tulsi Das** are **Janaki Mangal**, **Parvathi Mangal**, **Ramcharitmanas**, **Vinay Patrika**, **Dohavali**, and **Gitavali**. Tulsi Das was a Vaishnava Hindu saint and poet. He is believed to be a reincarnation of Valmiki.
 - **Sur Das** wrote **Sur Sagar**, **Sur Saravali** and **Sahitya Lehari**. He was a 16th-century Hindu blind poet and singer. He was a Vaishnava devotee of Krishna.
 - **Bahinabai's Abhangs in Marathi** were very popular. She was a **Varkari female saint-poet** of Maharashtra. Her Abhangs mirror her compromise between her devotion to her husband and god.
 - Many of **Vachanas (by Basava)** are collected in the book “**Sanya Sampadava**”. Basavanna or Bhakti Bandari Basava, was a 12th century social reformer in Karnataka. He through his Vachana sahitya, tried to create social awareness and equality in the society.

Sufi Literature

- ❑ **Malfuzat**: A collection of conversations of **Shaikh Nizamuddin Auliya**, compiled by **Amir Hasan Sijzi Dehlavi**.
- ❑ **Maktubat**: Letters written by Sufi masters addressed to their disciples.
 - **Maktubat-i Imam Rabbani** are the letters of the noted **Naqshbandi Shaikh Ahmad Sirhindi**, whose ideology is often contrasted with the liberal and non-sectarian views of Akbar.
- ❑ **Tazkiras (biographies)**: **Siyar-ul-Auliya** of Mir Khwurd Kirmani was the first sufi tazkira written in India. It dealt principally with the Chishti saints. The most famous tazkira is the **Akhbar-ul-Akhyar** of **Abdul Haqq Muhaddis Dehlavi**. The authors of the tazkiras often sought to establish the precedence of their own orders and glorify their spiritual genealogies.

India Through the Eyes of Foreign Travellers

Al Masudi

- ❑ He was an **Arab** traveller who visited India in 956 AD.
- ❑ He has written ‘**The Meadows of Gold and Mines of Gems**’, which is a combination of world history with scientific geography, social commentary and biography.
- ❑ **Muruj adh-Dhahab** is his famous travel manuscript.

Al Biruni

- ❑ He was from Khwarazm who visited India between 1024-1030 AD.
- ❑ He has written **Kitab al Tafhim** in both Persian and Arabic.
- ❑ **Kitab-ul-Hind** is a voluminous text that covers a wide range of subjects like religion, philosophy, festivals, astronomy, alchemy etc, in Arabic.

Marco Polo

- ❑ He was a **Venetian** merchant, explorer and writer who visited India between 1292 - 1294 AD.
- ❑ He visited the **Pandyan kingdom**.
- ❑ ‘**The Travels of Marco Polo**’ account for his travels from one country to another.

Ibn Batuta

- ❑ He was from **Morocco** who visited India between 1333-1347 AD.
- ❑ He visited India during **Muhammad Bin Tughlaq**.
- ❑ He has written ‘**Rihla**’ in Arabic which provides details about the social and cultural life of India in the 14th century.

Nicolo de Conti

- ❑ He was from **Venice** and visited India between 1420-1421 AD.
- ❑ He visited during **Devaraya I** of **Vijayanagara dynasty**.

- ❑ He has written '**De varietate fortunae**' ("On the Vicissitudes of Fortune") in Latin which describes Southeast Asia in terms of wealth, culture and magnificence.

Abdur Razzaq

- ❑ He was from **Persia** and visited India between 1443-1444 AD.
- ❑ He visited India during the reign of **Devaraya II** of the **Vijayanagara dynasty**.
- ❑ **Matla-us-Sadain wa Majma-ul-Bahrain** is a narrative of his mission to India.

Domingo Paes

- ❑ He was from **Portugal** who visited India between 1520-1522 AD.
- ❑ He visited India during the reign of **Krishnadevaraya** of **Vijayanagara** dynasty.
- ❑ **Chronica dos reis de Bisnaga** ("Chronicle of the Vijayanagar kings") provides an in-depth record of his journey to India and provides in-depth information about the Vijayanagara period.

Sir Thomas Roe

- ❑ He was from **England** and visited India between **1615-1619 AD**.
- ❑ He visited India during the reign of **Jahangir**, the Mughal emperor.
- ❑ The book "**The Embassy of Sir Thomas Roe to the Court of the Great Mogul, 1615-1619**" is a narration of a valuable contribution to the history of India in the early 17th century.
- ❑ '**Journal of the Mission to the Mughal Empire**' is a treasured contribution to the history of India is his work.

Jean Baptiste Tavernier

- ❑ He was from **France** and visited India between 1638-1643 AD.
- ❑ He visited India during the reign of **Shah Jahan** the Mughal emperor.
- ❑ The book '**Travels in India**' describes the Mughal empire in India.

Nicolao Manucci

- ❑ He was from **Italy** and visited India between 1653-1708 AD.
- ❑ He visited India during the reign of **Dara Shikoh** of the Mughal dynasty.
- ❑ The book '**Storia del Mogol**' describes the Mughal empire in India.

Francois Bernier

- ❑ He was from **France** and visited India between 1656-1717 AD.
- ❑ He visited India during the reign of **Dara Shikoh** of the Mughal dynasty.
- ❑ The book '**Travels in the Mogul Empire**' describes the Mughal empire in India between 1656-1668.
- ❑ He also wrote '**The History of the Late Revolution of the Empire of the Great Mogol**'.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

Sufi and Bhakti literature deeply influenced regional languages, shaping their syntax, vocabulary, and literary norms. This fusion of spirituality and language fostered communal identity and enriched India's cultural diversity through flourishing regional literature. Comment.

LITERATURE IN MODERN INDIA

The freedom struggle, which took place in 1857 or shortly thereafter, is considered to mark the beginning of the modern era in practically all Indian languages. A large number of writers opted for a synthesis between Indianization and Westernization in their search for a national ideology. All these attitudes were combined to bring about the renaissance in 19th-century India.

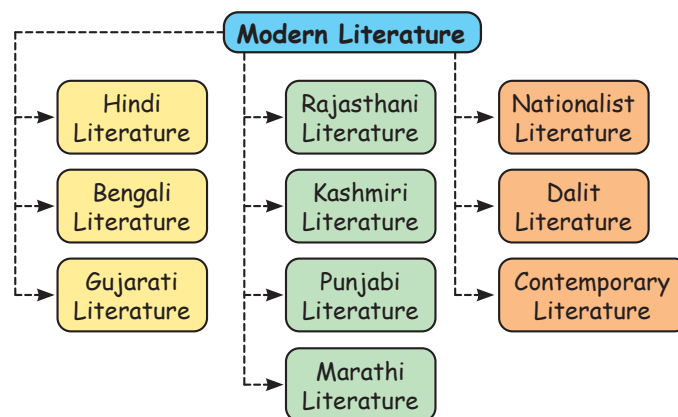


Fig. 12.3: Modern Literature

Hindi Literature

Post arrival of the British in India, there was a noticeable shift in Hindi literature. It turned more nationalistic. **Bharatendu Harishchandra**, **Swami Dayanand**, **Munshi Premchand** and **Mahadevi Varma** spearheaded this movement in Hindi Literature.

Andher Nagari (City of Darkness)	It is a political satire by Bharatendu Harishchandra (Father of Modern Hindu Literature).
Bharat Durdasha	It is a renowned nationalist piece written by Bharatendu Harishchandra .
Satyarth Prakash (1875)	Written by Swami Dayanand .
Godan and Bade Bhai Sahab	Written by Munshi Premchand .
Ateet Ke Chalchitr, Smriti ki Rekhaye and Path Ke Sathi	Written by Mahadevi Varma .

Bengali Literature

Bengali language was developed more than 1300 years ago, and its literature has a millennial history. Charyapada, a compilation of mystic songs dating back to the 10th and 11th centuries, holds the distinction of being the oldest literary record in the Bengali language. Bengali literature extensively developed during the Bengali Renaissance and is regarded as one of the most prolific and diverse literary traditions in Asia.

Durgesh Nandini (1865)	Written by Bankim Chandra Chatterjee .
Anand Math (1882)	Bankim Chandra Chatterjee wrote it, and our national song (Vande Mataram) is taken from this novel.
Geetanjali	It was composed by Rabindranath Tagore .

Gujarati Literature

Gujarat was the epicentre of the Bhakti movement, as was previously established, and this had an impact on the literature written there.

- **Narsinh Mehta**, who blended devotional hymns for Lord Krishna with local folk traditions, was highly popular in the 15th century.
- In the 19th century, **Narmad** was a renowned poet.
- The classic Gujarati Novel **Saraswati Chandra**, which was recently made into a television series, was written by **Govardhan Ram**.
- **Dr K.M. Munshi** wrote 'Prithvi Vallabh' in 1928.

Rajasthani Literature

Rajasthani is an Indo-Aryan language mostly based on Marwari.

- Various dialects characterized medieval Rajasthani literature and have two primary forms of fictional writing: **Dingal** and **Pingal**.
 - In this context, Dhola Maru stands out as the most renowned text.
- Rajasthani tales were frequently transmitted orally and by bards performing Virkavya, or triumphant poetry songs.

Kashmiri Literature

Kashmiri is a Dardic Indo-Aryan language spoken in the Kashmir region. Kashmiri stands as one of the ancient languages of India, with its roots tracing back to as early as the 5th to 6th century AD. Throughout its evolution, it has been shaped by a diverse array of linguistic influences, including Sanskrit, Hindi, Persian, and others. The **Kashmiri Perso-Arabic script** is the officially recognised script of the Kashmiri language and is derived from the Persian alphabet.

- Kalhana's **Rajatarangini** was the earliest text from Kashmir, written in Sanskrit in the 12th century AD.

- During the early medieval period, as the Bhakti movement thrived, the Kashmiri language saw the emergence of its first female poetess, **Lal Ded**, a Shaivite mystic.
- **Noor Din**, who was also known as **Nund Rishi**, brought in Hindi and Islamic elements together in his poetry.

Punjabi Literature

- Local Punjabi literature focused on love stories and epics, such as Sohni-Mahiwal, Sassi-Punnu by Hashim Shah, and Heer-Ranjha by Waris Shah.
- **Baba Farid** and **Bulley Shah's** Sufi poetry, known as **Kafis**, became well-liked by the populace and rulers through popular singing.
- Modern Punjabi literature was influenced by nationalistic writing, exemplified by Bhagat Singh's legendary work **Rang de Basanti Chola**.

Marathi Literature

Marathi is written in Devanagari and **Modi script**. Though the epigraphic evidence suggests that Marathi was a standard written language by the 12th century, the earliest records appear only in the late 13th century.

- The oldest known Marathi work dates back to the **13th century**, by **Saint Jnaneshwar**, who had initiated **Kirtan** and **written** a detailed commentary on the Bhagavad Gita.
- **Janabai**, a female writer from the 13th-14th century, is the earliest known female Marathi writer.
- **Eknath**, a famous saint from the 16th century, wrote commentaries on **Bhagavata Purana** and **Ramayana** and composed famous vernacular works.
- During the nationalist movement, **Bal Gangadhar Tilak** published the regional newspaper **Kesari** in **Marathi**.

Nationalist Literature

As a reaction against foreign rule, writings with topics of national interest started to flourish in the 19th century. The nationalistic voice of that age was expressed by **Bharatendu Harishchandra** in Hindi, **Rangalal** in Bengali, and **Mirza Ghalib** in Urdu. Historical novels depicting India's glorious history and inspiring nationalist passion in her people were written by writers such as **Bankim Chandra Chatterjee** (Bengali) and **Hari Narayan Apte** (Marathi). Some important literary work:

- **Tagore** began work on the novel **Gora** (1910), which aims to reinterpret Indian nationalism and question colonial authority, standards, and control.
- Soz-e-watan is a collection of short stories written in Urdu by Premchand under his then pen name of 'Nawab Rai'. It was a collection of stories rife with patriotic fervor. The British authorities banned it stating reasons of it being a seditious work.

- ❑ **Devi Chaudhurani** is a Bengali novel written by **Bankim Chandra Chatterjee** closely after *Anandmath*. This novel fuelled the patriotic struggle for Indian Independence.
- ❑ **Gadar di Gunj** is a compilation of nationalist literature in the early Gadar movement in **Gurumukhi** and **Shahmukhi**. It covered and addressed the political situation in India. They were deemed seditious publications and banned from publication and circulation in India.
- ❑ **India Wins Freedom** by **Maulana Abul Kalam Azad**, which throws light on the political situation in India.
- ❑ **Nil Darpan** is a Bengali language play written by **Dinabandhu Mitra** in 1858-59. It was about the **Indigo revolt**, which happened in Bengal and was banned by the British.
- ❑ **Anand Math of Bankim Chandra Chatterjee** was hugely popular and an excerpt from this novel **Vande Mataram became our national song**.
- ❑ **'Rang de Basanti Chola'** was the nationalistic writing of **Bhagat Singh** in Punjabi.
- ❑ **Subramania Bharati** wrote three of his best pieces: **Kuyil Pattu, Panchali Sapatham, and Kannan Pattu**. All these were of nationalistic fervour and ignited a sense of patriotism in the people.
- ❑ **Mahatma Gandhi: The story of my experiments with truth, Hind swaraj, Satyagraha in South Africa, Gokhale: My political Guru** etc. were written to inspire people to fight against the British for independence.
- ❑ The third wave of Malayalam writers, such as **N. Prabhakaran** and **P. Surendran**, favour the label of anti-modernism over post-modernism. They are satisfied with merely recounting human stories devoid of overt social commentary or philosophical aspirations.
- ❑ Stories without any ideological bias are presently being written by **Surendra Prakash** (Urdu) and **Ijayadan Detha** (Rajasthani, under the Hindi umbrella language).
- ❑ **Birendra Kumar Bhattacharya** (Assamese), **Sunil Gangopadhyay** (Bengali), **Pannalal Patel** (Gujarati), **Mannu Bhandari** (Hindi), **Nayantara Sahgal** (English), **V. Bedekar** (Marathi), **Samaresh Basu** (Bengali), and various other writers have depicted the comprehensive Indian experience through their nuanced understanding of both rural and urban life.
- ❑ Women writers across all Indian languages have prominently emerged with emancipatory narratives, aiming to challenge male-dominated societal norms. They create alternative myths and metaphors, seeking to subvert established social hierarchies. Notable figures include **Kamala Das** (Malayalam, English), **Krishna Sobti** (Hindi), **Ashapurna Devi** (Bengali), **Rajam Krishnan** (Tamil), and many more.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

The use of vernacular languages in literature, particularly in regional novels and poetry, helped to democratize nationalist discourse, advocated for social reforms and made it accessible to a broader section of society. Comment.

Dalit Literature

Writings by outcasts were a powerful literary force throughout the post-modernist era, and this was one of its most important aspects. The label of Dalit literature is applied to literature that emphasizes the socio-political significance of the underdogs and focuses on the socially disadvantaged.

- ❑ Under **Dr. B.R. Ambedkar's** direction, writers in Marathi, Gujarati, and Kannada began the Dalit literary movement.
- ❑ Marathi writers like **Daya Pawar** and **Laxman Gaikwad**, as well as poets like **Namdev Dhasal** and **Narayan Surve**, depict the suffering of their communities in their works and call for the creation of a fair and practical future for the poor and social outcasts.
- ❑ In their works, **Mahadev Devanur** (in Kannada) and **Joseph Macwan** (in Gujarati) discuss exploitation, resistance, and violent experiences.

Contemporary Literature

- ❑ The goal of the Uttara Adhunik (post-modern) era is to be socially conscious, natural, Indian, and close to the average person.

LANGUAGES IN INDIA

India, a linguistically diverse nation, boasts a multitude of languages that reflect its rich cultural and historical tapestry. The linguistic diversity is not only in terms of the number of languages but also in the script systems employed. The study of languages in India goes beyond mere linguistic analysis; it offers a window into the diverse traditions, literature, and cultural expressions that characterize different regions of the country.

Ancient Scripts of India

Ancient scripts have been pivotal in recording language and communication in India. Two **primary ancient scripts** are **Brahmi and Kharosthi**, which have significantly influenced the development of various modern scripts.

Ancient Scripts	Features And Significance
Brahmi Script	- It is considered as the precursor to many modern Indian scripts, including Devanagari, Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, Odia, Assamese, and Bengali. - It is written from left to right.
Grantha Script	- Widely used from the 6th to the 20th centuries in South India, especially in Tamil Nadu and Kerala. - Used for writing Sanskrit and Manipravalam. - It is a Brahmic script, evolving from Brahmi in Tamil Nadu, and a precursor to Malayalam, Tigris, and Sinhala scripts.
Gupta Script	- Associated with the Gupta Empire, it was used for Sanskrit. - Descended from Brahmi. - Gave rise to various scripts, including Nagari, Sharada, Siddham, Devanagari, Gurmukhi (for Punjabi), Assamese, Bengali, and Tibetan scripts.
Devanagari Script	- This script is used to write the Sanskrit, Prākṛit, Hindi, Marathi, and Nepali languages. - This is developed from the North Indian monumental script known as Gupta and ultimately from the Brahmi alphabet, from which all modern Indian writing systems are derived.
Gurmukhi Script	- It was standardized during the 16th century by Guru Angad and derived from the Sarada script. - Used for writing the entire Guru Granth Sahib and is commonly used by Sikhs and Hindus for Punjabi language.
Indus Script	The Indus Valley Civilization produced it. It comprises symbols, but it has not been deciphered to date.
Kharosthi Script	- It is considered the Sister script of Brahmi and was used in ancient Gandhara to write Gandhari Prakrit and Sanskrit. - The Kharosthi script was deciphered by James Prinsep as well through coins in the 19th century. - It includes numerals similar to Roman numerals. - It is written mostly right to left, but some inscriptions show left to right direction.
Modi Script	- Historically, it was used to write Marathi and other languages. - It was Marathi's official script until the 20th century when Devanagari was promoted. - Known to have been used for Urdu, Kannada, Gujarati, Hindi, and Tamil.
Sharada Script	- It developed around the 8th century and was written in Abiguda style. - Initially used for Sanskrit and Kashmiri, but later limited to Kashmir. - At present, it is rarely used except for ceremonial purposes by the Kashmiri Pandit community.
Urdu Script	- It is written from right to left by modifying the Persian alphabet. - It was influential in the development of the Nastaliq style of Perso-Arabic script. - Its expanded form, Shahmukhi, is used for writing other Indo-Aryan languages like Punjabi and Saraiki.
Vatteluttu Script	- It was developed from Tamil-Brahmi and written in Abiguda style. - Used to write Grantha, Pallava, and Tamil scripts.

Classification of Indian Languages

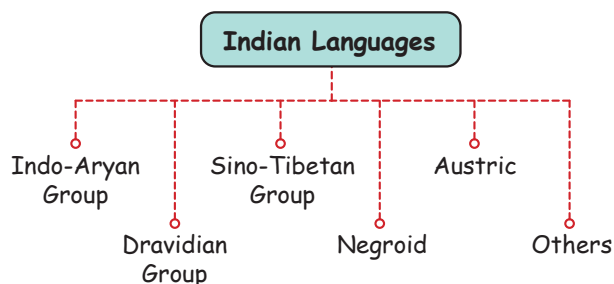


Fig. 12.4: Indian Languages

A **method of communication** through voice, language is a **collection of sounds** that are understood to have a common meaning by a group of people.

Indo-Aryan Group

- It came to India with the advent of the **Aryans**.
- It is the **largest language group** in India.
- 74% of Indians** speak the languages of this group.
- Depending upon the time period of their origin, it is sub divided into three groups:

Old Indo-Aryan Group

- ❑ It originated in approximately **1500 BC**.

Sanskrit Development

- ❑ Around 500 BC, **Panini** composed his seminal work **Ashtadhyayi**, recognized as the **oldest Sanskrit grammar book**.
 - ❑ Sanskrit finds usage even in Buddhist writings of both the **Hinayana** and **Mahayana schools**.
 - ❑ The Hinayana school's Mahavastu contains a wealth of stories.
 - ❑ Sanskrit was employed in composing **Ashvagosha's Buddhacharita** and **Lalitavistara**, the highly esteemed Mahayana classic.
 - ❑ Between 300 BC and 200 BC, Sanskrit underwent a refined evolution, adopting a pure form within the Vedic tradition.
 - ❑ The **Rudradamana inscriptions** discovered in present-day Southern Gujarat, specifically at Junagarh, offer the earliest evidence of Sanskrit usage.
 - ❑ Although **Sanskrit** was utilized in **poetry** during the Gupta era, it was during this period that authentic literature, such as **Mahakavyas (epics)** and **Kandakavyas (semi-epics)**, began to emerge.
- ❑ Sanskrit emerged from this group.
 - The **Vedas, Dharmasutras, Puranas and Upanishads** were all written in the older form of Sanskrit.
 - Sanskrit is considered to be the **mother of many Indian languages**. It is also the **oldest language** of our country.

Middle Indo-Aryan Group

- ❑ This linguistic subgroup began to take shape with the emergence of the Prakrit language and persisted from **600 BC to 1000 AD**.
- ❑ Prakrit, characterized by its organic, distinctive, and informal nature, served as the common tongue, hence lacking rigid usage guidelines.
- ❑ **All languages** within the **Middle Indo-Aryan group** are typically categorized under the broader term "**Prakrit**."
- ❑ The Prakrit language has been the source of various languages, including **Ardha-Magadhi**, **Pali** (utilized by Theravada Buddhists), and **Apabhramsha**.
- ❑ It was considered the language of the common people.
- ❑ In the **Jain "Agamas"**, Prakrit and Ardha-Magadhi were the predominant languages used.

Languages that Come Under Prakrit

Pali

- ❑ Magadhi was widely spoken in the region of **Magadha** and enjoyed popularity between the **fifth and first centuries BC**.

- ❑ It exhibits close linguistic connections with **Sanskrit**, with the **Brahmi script** commonly employed for writing in **Pali**.
- ❑ Pali was also the language used for **transcribing** the **Buddhist Tripitaka** and served as the **common language** of **Theravada Buddhism**.
- ❑ There is a belief that the Buddha delivered his teachings in Ardha-Magadhi rather than Pali.

Magadhi Prakrit or Ardha-Magadhi

- ❑ This variant of Prakrit holds paramount significance, especially after the decline of Sanskrit and Pali around 1000 AD.
- ❑ Its literary usage gained momentum with the expansion of the Prakrit language.
- ❑ There is speculation that **Mahavira** and the **Buddha** might have communicated in **Ardha-Magadhi**.
- ❑ It was spoken at the courts of a few **Mahajanapadas** and during the **Mauryan dynasty**.
- ❑ Additionally, several **Jain texts** and **Ashoka's Rock edicts** were composed in Ardha-Magadhi.
- ❑ Subsequently, it paved the way for the development of Eastern Indian languages such as **Bengali, Assamese, Odia, Maithili, Bhojpuri**, and **others**.

Shauraseni Prakrit

- ❑ **Jain monks** predominantly utilized this variant of Prakrit for writing purposes.
- ❑ Shauraseni is employed in scripting "**Shatkhandgama**," recognized as one of the most important texts among the Digambar sect.

Maharashtri Prakrit

- ❑ Until the ninth century AD, it served as the **precursor to Marathi and Konkani languages**, being spoken extensively across western and southern India.
- ❑ Additionally, it served as the **official language** of the **Satavahana monarchy**.
- ❑ Notable works in this language include tragedies like "**Gaha Kosha**" by **King Hala** and "**Gaudavaho**," recounting the narrative of Vakpati's slaying of Gauda's ruler.

Elu

- ❑ Pali is comparable to the ancient form of the present **Sinhala language spoken in Sri Lanka**.

Paishachi

- ❑ Frequently labelled as the "**dead language**" or "**Bhuta-Bhasa**," Paishachi is often mistaken for Prakrit.
- ❑ The sixth-century epic **Brihatkatha** by **Gunadhya** is composed in Paishachi, which is often considered a minor dialect.

□ Apabhramsa

- By the sixth or seventh century, “Apabhramsa”—**characterized by corruption or grammatical deviation**—had started to emerge.
- Another term used for dialects apart from Sanskrit or Prakrit is apabhramsa, marking the transition from the Middle to the Modern Indo-Aryan Group of Languages.
- **Bhamaha**, a renowned poet from Kashmir who lived during the sixth or seventh century, categorized **poetry into three forms: Sanskrit, Prakrit, and Apabhramsha**.
- Additionally, according to Dandin, Apabhramsa refers to the **vernacular spoken by common people**.
- Notable authors and their works include **Dhanapala’s Bhavisayattakaha** and **Pushpadanta’s Mahapurana**, which is a Digambara Jain scripture.

Modern Indo-Aryan Group

- This group includes languages like **Bengali, Gujarati, Marathi, Punjabi, Rajasthani, Sindhi, Odia, Urdu, Hindi, Assamese**, and so on.
- The **northern, western, and eastern** regions of India are home to the majority of speakers of these languages.

Hindi

- Hindi originated mostly from the following dialects: **Brajbhasa, Awadhi, Rajasthani, Maithili, Bhojpuri, Malwi**, etc.
- Another hybrid form of Hindi that emerged in the 15th and 16th centuries was called **Khari Boli**.
- Hindi has its roots in the seventh and tenth centuries.
- During this time, Hindi began to diverge from Apabhramsha.
- With the widespread impact of the Bhakti movement, the Hindi literary language flourished, emerging from a fragmented version of Sanskrit called “Maghadi-Prakrit”.

Urdu

- The name originated as a dialect among the Muslims who governed Deccan and South India starting in the 14th century, and it was taken from the Turki word “Urdu,” which meant a military camp.
- Urdu was taken to different parts of the country by soldiers, saints and Sufis and even by the common people. Urdu also went to the Deccan where it developed to its full length. It gave rise to a literary discourse known as “Dakhani,” which dates back to the fifteenth century.

- Urdu, unlike Arabic and Persian languages, is an Indo-Aryan language akin Hindi. If we compare and contrast the structures of these two language we find that both the languages share the same Indic base especially at the phonological and grammatical levels.

Punjabi

- The language of Punjab originated from a fragmented variant of Sanskrit called **Savraseni Prakrit**, or more appropriately, **Sauraseni Apabhramsa**.
- Punjabi shares a grammatical basis with Brajabhasa and Rajasthani.

Bengali

- Following the arrival of Sri Chaitanya, Bengali literature and language flourished in the East.
- The saint’s mystical teachings served as an inspiration for the Vaisnava poets.
- Bengali medieval poets also wrote in **Brajabuli**, which is basically maithili but its forms are modified to look like Bengali.

Dravidian Group

- The languages spoken in **southern India** make up the majority of this group.
- This group includes about **25% of the Indian population**.
- The **21 Dravidian languages are descended from Proto-Dravidian**.
- Three groupings can be used to classify them broadly:
 - the Northern group,
 - the Central group, and
 - the Southern group.

Northern Group

- It is categorized into three languages: **Kurukh, Malto, and Brahui**.
- **Kurukh** is spoken across **Bengal, Odisha, Bihar, and Madhya Pradesh**, while **Brahui** is primarily spoken in **Balochistan**, along with **Malto** in the tribal regions of **Bengal and Odisha**.

Central Group

- Among the eleven languages in this group are **Gondi, Khond, Kui, Manda, Parji, Gadaba, Kolami, Pengo, Naiki, Kuvi, and Telugu**.
- While the rest of the languages are tribal in nature, **Telugu**, spoken in the states of Andhra Pradesh and Telangana, has developed into a civilized language.

Southern Group

- This group comprises seven languages, including Kannada, Tamil, Malayalam, Tulu, Kodagu, Toda, and Kota. Among them, Tamil is the oldest.

- Within the twenty-one Dravidian languages, the four main ones are as follows:
 - **Telugu**, the most populous among them.
 - **Tamil**, is considered the most pristine and ancient.
 - **Kannada** and **Malayalam**, the smallest and most recently developed of the Dravidian languages.

Sino-Tibetan Group

- The languages spoken by this ethnic group exhibit **Mongoloid characteristics** and are prevalent across the **Himalayas, North Bihar, North Bengal, Assam**, and the **northeastern borders** of the country.
- These linguistic variations are considered older than the Indo-Aryan languages and were referred to as **Kiratas** in ancient Sanskrit literature.
- Approximately **0.6%** of Indians speak these languages.
- The Sino-Tibetan linguistic community is further categorized as follows:
 - **Tibeto-Burman**: The Tibeto-Burman language family is further subdivided into four groupings.
 - **Tibetan: Sikkimese, Bhutia, Sherpa, Lahuli and Ladakhi**
 - **Himalayan-Kinnauri and Limbu**
 - **North Assam-Abor, Miri, Aka, Dafla and Mishmi**
 - Languages such as **Assam-Burmese-Kuki-Chin, Mikir, Bodo**, and **Naga** fall under the same subgroup. **Manipuri** or **Meithi** is considered the most significant language spoken within the Kuki-Chin sub-group.
 - **Siamese-Chinese**
 - **Ahom** is a language within this category, nevertheless, speakers of this language have already disappeared from the Indian subcontinent.

Austriac

- The languages within this group belong to the **Austro-Asiatic subfamily**, exemplified by the **Munda** or **Kol** languages spoken in **North, East, and Central India**.
- Additionally, some of them, like **Khasi** and **Nicobarese**, are classified as **Mon-Khmer**.
- These languages, referred to as **Nisadas** in ancient Sanskrit literature, predate the arrival of the Aryans.
- The principal language of the Santhal tribal people in Jharkhand, Bihar, and Bengal is known as Santhali.
- With the exception of Santhali and Khasi, many Austro-Asiatic languages spoken in India are currently facing the risk of extinction.

Others

- This group contains a number of Dravidian Adivasi languages that are too unique to be placed in any of the other groups, such as Gondi, Oraon, Praji, etc.

Language Differences Between the Dravidian and Indo-Aryan Groups

- The two language families have different **root words**.
- The two groups' **grammatical structures** differ from one another.
- The Dravidian family's grammatical structure is **agglutinative, or word combinations** where the original words are combined with little to no form modification or word loss.
- The Indo-Aryan group has an **inflected grammatical structure, meaning that words vary in spelling or ending** depending on how they are used in sentences.

Official Languages of India

- **Article 343 (1)** mentions, "The **Official Language** of the **Union Government** shall be **Hindi** in Devanagari script."
 - "**Unless Parliament decided otherwise**, the use of English for official purposes was to cease 15 years after the Constitution came into effect", i.e. on 26 January 1965.
- The **Official Language Act of 1963** declared **Hindi in Devanagari script** as the **official language** of the Union, while **English** retained the status of a **subsidiary official language**.
- The **Indian Constitution** allows **each state** to choose **its official language** for state-level communication.

Hindi is the **most spoken language** in **India**.

- According to the **2011 census**, **~44%** of the people speak Hindi as their mother tongue.
- After English and Mandarin, Hindi is also the **third** most spoken language **in the world**.
- India's second most spoken language is **Bengali**.

Languages In the Eighth Schedule

Currently, there are **22 languages** listed in the **Eighth Schedule** of the Indian Constitution.

Initially, **14 languages** were included in the **Eighth Schedule**:

- Assamese, Hindi, Malayalam, Punjabi, Telugu, Bengali, Kannada, Marathi, Sanskrit, Urdu, Gujarati, Kashmiri, Odia, and Tamil.
- **21st** Constitutional Amendment Act of 1967 added **Sindhi**, **71st** Amendment Act of 1992 added **Konkani**, **Manipuri**, and **Nepali** and **92nd** Amendment Act of 2003 added **Bodo**, **Maithili**, **Dogri**, and **Santhali**.

Important Points

- ❑ Neither the Constitution nor any Act defines the **national language of India**.
- ❑ Official languages of States **not listed** in the Eighth Schedule:
 - **Tripura**: Kokborok; **Puducherry**- French; **Mizoram**- Mizo; **Nagaland and Meghalaya**- English.

Classical Languages in India

In **2004**, the **Indian government** established **criteria** for classifying languages as “Classical Languages in India.” These criteria include:

- ❑ **High Antiquity**: Languages must have early texts or recorded history spanning **1500-2000 years**.
- ❑ **Ancient Literature**: The language should possess a body of ancient literature valued by generations of speakers.
- ❑ **Originality**: The literary tradition should **not be borrowed** from another speech community.
- ❑ **Distinctiveness**: Classical language and literature should be distinct from modern forms or offshoots, even exhibiting discontinuity.

Classical Languages in India

Tamil (2004); **Sanskrit** (2005); **Telugu** (2008); **Kannada** (2008); **Malayalam** (2013) & **Odia** (2014)

Benefits of Getting the Status of Classical Language

- ❑ Scholars of eminence in Classical Indian languages receive two major international awards annually.
- ❑ Establishment of a **“Centre of Excellence for Studies in Classical Languages.”**
- ❑ **University Grants Commission** can be requested to create a specific number of Professional Chairs for Classical Languages in Central Universities for distinguished scholars in such Languages.

CONCLUSION

It could be argued that no individual Indian literary tradition is entirely comprehensive on its own, and therefore, studying it solely within the confines of one language cannot fully capture its essence or honour its writers, who emerge from a shared cultural milieu. What stands out is that Indian literature thrives in numerous languages, yet there exists a vibrant interconnection among them, facilitated by multilingual fluidity, cross-language translations, common themes, forms, concerns, as well as mutual influences and movements. These dynamics continually breathe life into the overarching ideals of Indian literature, sustaining its relevance even in contemporary times.

Science and Technology Through Ages

13

The journey of science and technology through the ages in India is a compelling narrative of innovation, ingenuity, and intellectual prowess. India boasts a rich heritage of contributions to science and technology, spanning thousands of years and touching upon various domains, including mathematics, astronomy, medicine, engineering, and beyond. Across epochs, from ancient civilizations to contemporary times, Indian intellectuals, scholars and pioneers have left indelible marks on the world stage, significantly shaping global understanding and advancement in these fields.

SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY DURING ANCIENT INDIA

India has a glorious culture of education, science and technology since ancient times and has made significant contributions in the fields of astronomy, arithmetic, geometry, metallurgy, Ayurvedic system of medicine and surgery.

Mathematics

- ❑ **Harappan town planning** reflects advanced knowledge of measurement and geometry in ancient India.
- ❑ **Sulvasutras** written by **Baudhayana** in the 6th century BC is supposed to be the source of Indian mathematics which later developed as a separate stream of study by the third century AD.
 - Sulvasutra mentions '**Pi**' and some concepts very similar to the **Pythagoras theorem**.
- ❑ **Apastamba** in the second century BC, introduced **practical geometry** involving acute angle, obtuse angle and right angle. This knowledge helped in the construction of **fire altars**.
- ❑ The three main contributions to the field of mathematics were the **notation system, the decimal system and the use of zero**. The notations and the numerals were carried to the West by the Arabs. These numerals replaced the Roman numerals.
- ❑ Zero was discovered in India in the second century BC. **Brahmagupta's Brahmasputa Siddhanta** mentioned '**zero**' as a number. He is credited for operations like addition and subtraction with zero.



Fig. 13.1:
Aryabhatta

- ❑ **Aryabhatta** discovered **algebra** and also formulated the area of a triangle, which led to the origin of **Trigonometry**. He is credited with using zero in the decimal system.
- ❑ **Varahamihira's Brihatsamhita** (6th century AD) was a pioneering work in both **astronomy and mathematics**. Varahamihira's observation that the **moon orbits the earth** and the **earth orbits the sun** gained recognition and influenced later discoveries.
- ❑ **Ganit Sara Sangraha**, ("Compendium of the Essence of Mathematics") written in 9th century AD by **Mahaviracharya** is a **textbook** on **arithmetic**.
- ❑ **Bhaskaracharya** was one of the **leading mathematicians** in the **12th century AD**. His book, **Siddhanta Shiromani**, deals with **four sections**: **Lilavati** (dealing with arithmetics), **Beejganita** (dealing with algebra), **Goladhyaya** (about spheres) and **Grahaganita** (mathematics of planets).

Lilavati mentions the **Chakrawat method**, or the **cyclic method**, to solve **algebraic equations**.

- ❑ **Faizi**, the court poet of **Akbar**, translated **Lilavati** into **Persian**.
- ❑ In the **19th century**, **James Taylor** translated **Lilavati** and made it known to people across the globe.

Astronomy

The early expositions of Indian astronomy were designed to organize large sacrifices. These were recorded in the **Jyotisha Vedanga**.

- ❑ **Bhaskaracharya (5th century)** predated astronomer **Smart** in accurately calculating Earth's orbit time.
- ❑ **Kanad's** ancient atomic theory, predating **Dalton**, proposed the existence of "**Anu**", or indestructible particles akin to **atoms**.
- ❑ **Aryabhatta's** book **Aryabhattachiya** has dedicated two out of four sections to **Astronomy**.
 - The book covered various aspects of astronomy, including definitions, methods for determining **planetary positions**, descriptions of **sun and moon movements**, and **eclipse calculations**.
 - The book mentions that **Earth is a sphere** and rotates on its axis. **Lunar eclipses** occur when **Earth's shadow** falls on the **moon**, and **solar eclipses** happen when the **moon's shadow** falls on **Earth**.
 - '**Khagol**' was the famous astronomical laboratory in **Nalanda** where Aryabhatta studied.

- ❑ **Varahamihira** summarized the observations of **five schools of astronomy** (namely the **Surya, Romaka, Paulisa, Vasistha** and **Paitamaha** Siddhantas) in his text, the **Panch Siddhantika**.

- ❑ The impact of **Varahamihira** on the fields of ecology, hydrology, and geology cannot be overlooked. He was one of the **nine gems in Vikramaditya's court** during the **Gupta era**.
- ❑ He connected the production of strange clouds, subterranean water, animal behaviour, vegetation, and underwater activity to earthquakes.

Medicine

Diseases, cures and medicines were mentioned for the first time in the Atharva Veda. During the Vedic times, the **Ashwini Kumars** were **medicine practitioners** and were given divine status. **Dhanvantari** was the **god of medicine**.

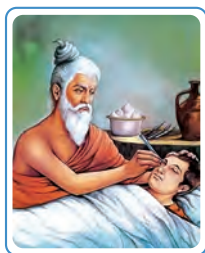


Fig. 13.2: Sushruta

- ❑ In 800 BC, **Sage Atreya** and **Sage Agnivesha** dealt with **Ayurvedic principles**.
 - Eight parts of Ayurveda include: **Kaumarabhrtya** (Paediatrics), **Salakya-tantra** (Minor surgery), **Bhutavidya** (Demonology), **Kayachikitsa** (Therapeutics), **Rasayana-tantra** (Geriatrics), **Agada-tantra** (Toxicology), **Vajikarana-tantra** (Vilification) and **Salya-tantra** (Major surgery)
- ❑ From 600 BC, began the period of rational sciences. **Takshila** and **Taranasi** emerged as centres of medicine and learning.
- ❑ Two significant texts in this field were **Charaka Samhita** by **Charak** and **Sushruta Samhita** by **Sushruta**. These were the codified documents on Ayurveda. Both the Charaka Samhita and the Sushruta Samhita became the predecessors of the development of Indian medicine in the later centuries.

Charaka, the father of medicine, consolidated Ayurveda 2500 years ago.

Charak Samhita provides in detail the use of **plants and herbs** for medicinal purposes.

- ❑ The book contains an extensive note on **digestion, metabolism, and the immune system**, with more emphasis on **prevention than cure**.
- ❑ The book also mentions Genetics.
- ❑ **Sushruta Samhita** deals with practical problems of **Surgery** and **Obstetrics**.
- ❑ **Surgery** was mentioned as a distinct stream around the fourth century AD, with **Sushruta** pioneering this discipline.

- ❑ **Sushruta** regarded surgery as the **highest division** of the **healing arts** and described **121 surgical instruments**, along with methods for operations, bone setting, and cataract surgery.
- ❑ The Surgeons in ancient India were familiar with plastic surgery (repair of nose, ears and lips).
 - The Greeks were influenced by Indian **medicines** during the **Indo-Greek rule** in India in 180 BC-10 AD.

Alternate System of Medicine

Yoga

- ❑ The origin of Yoga can be traced to northern India over 5,000 years ago and around 200 BCE to 200 AD, the sage Patanjali compiled the Yoga Sutras.
- ❑ It encompasses **four** main categories: **Karma Yoga** (engaging the body), **Jnana Yoga** (engaging the mind), **Bhakti Yoga** (engaging the emotions), and **Kriya Yoga** (engaging energy).

Sowa-Rigpa

- ❑ **Yuthog Yonten Gonpo**, hailing from Tibet, is credited as the progenitor of Sowa-Rigpa.
- ❑ The foundational text associated with this system is **Gyud-Zi**.
- ❑ This system is commonly referred to as the **Amchi system of medicine**.
- ❑ Much of the theory and practice within Sowa-Rigpa closely aligns with Ayurveda.
- ❑ In India, Dharamshala (Himachal Pradesh) and Ladakh are the prominent centers.

Metallurgy

- ❑ Indus Valley excavations **reveal advanced metallurgical practices**, evident in glazed potteries, bronze, and copper artefacts.
- ❑ Vedic people demonstrated knowledge of **fermenting** grain, fruit, leather tanning, and dyeing processes.
- ❑ One of the famous alchemists of ancient times was **Nagarjuna**. He was an expert in transforming the base metals into gold.
- ❑ By the **first century AD**, mass production of various **metals** (iron, copper, silver, gold) and **alloys** (brass, bronze) was underway.
- ❑ The **Iron pillar** in the **Qutub Minar complex** attests to high-quality **alloying** techniques. A notable discovery includes a two-meter-high **bronze Buddha image** found at **Sultanganj** (near Bhagalpur).
- ❑ Alkali and acids were produced and utilised for making medicines.
- ❑ **Textile dyeing** was a popular craft.
- ❑ The **Ajanta frescoes** reflect on the quality of colour. These paintings have survived till date.

Navigation

In the ancient period, voyages and navigation were not a familiar foray for the Indians. However, **Lothal**, a site in Gujarat, has the remains of a dockyard proving that trade flourished in those days by sea.

- ❑ Indians also contributed to **shipbuilding**. The “**Yukti Kalpa Taru**” is an **ancient Sanskrit treatise** that provides comprehensive insights into the shipbuilding techniques of its time.
- ❑ In ancient India, Ships were primarily categorized into two classes: the “**Samanya**”, or Ordinary class, and the “**Vishesha**”, or Special class.
 - The **Ordinary class** was designed for **sea voyages** and included two distinct types: the “**Dirgha**,” characterized by its **long and narrow hull**, and the “**Unnata**,” distinguished by its **higher hull**.
 - Additionally, ships were further classified based on their length and cabin placement. “**Sarvamandira**” vessels featured cabins spanning the entire deck, often used for **royal voyages** and **transporting horses**. “**Madhyamandira**” referred to ships with cabins situated in the middle section of the deck, typically utilized for **leisurely trips**.
 - Lastly, “**Agramandira**” denoted vessels specially designed for **warfare**.

Chemistry

Ancient literature was typically preserved on **palm leaves in South India** and **birch-bark (bhoj-patra)** in **northern regions** before the use of writing paper.



Fig. 13.3: Nagarjuna

- ❑ **Nagarjuna** was blessed with the power of changing base metals into gold and extracting the “**Elixir of life**” as per the beliefs of the people.
 - He wrote a book on chemistry called **Rasaratnakara**, which is written as a dialogue between him and the gods. The manufacturing of liquids, primarily mercury, is the primary topic of this dissertation.
 - Nagarjuna also wrote **Uttaratantra**, which is a supplement to Sushruta Samhita and deals with the preparation of medicinal drugs.
- ❑ The extraction of zinc from zinc ore was known to Indians in 3rd and 2nd Millennia before the British invention.
 - Ancient Indians forged **Wootz Steel**, famed for making **Damascus swords**. Known as **Ukku**, **Hindwani**, and **Seric Iron**.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

How did ancient Indian religious beliefs influence the development of scientific and technological practices?

SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY DURING MEDIEVAL TIME

For a period, the exchange between indigenous Indian sciences and those introduced by newcomers remained constrained. Nonetheless, astronomy and medicine found enthusiastic support from the Delhi Sultans, as well as from the Mughal Emperors and their elite circles. Achievements in various areas of science in medieval India are discussed in the following sections.

Mathematics

- ❑ In the **medieval period**, mathematical masterpieces like **Ganita Kaumudi** and **Bijaganita Vatamsa** were created by **Narayan Pandit**.
- ❑ **Nilakantha Somasutvan** wrote **Tantrasamgraha**, which contains the rules of trigonometric functions.
- ❑ **Ganesa Daivajna** produced **Buddhivilasini**-a commentary on Lilavati - containing a number of illustrations.
- ❑ **Nilakantha Jyotirvida** compiled **Tajik**, dealing with a large number of **Persian technical terms**.
- ❑ Akbar mandated the **inclusion of mathematics** in the educational curriculum.
- ❑ Mathematicians like **Bahauddin-Amili**, **Nasir al-Din al-Tusi Arraq**, and **Al-Kashi** made significant contributions to the field.
- ❑ **Nasir al-Din al-Tusi**, the **founder and director** of the **Maragha observatory**, was widely recognized as an authority in mathematics.

Astronomy



Fig. 13.4: Jaipur Observatory by Sawai Jai Singh

- ❑ **Firoz Shah Tughlaq** established an observatory in **Delhi**, while **Firoz Shah Bahmani**, with the guidance of **Hakim Hussain Gilani** and **Syed Muhammad Kazimi**, set up an observatory in **Daulatabad**.

- ❑ **Mahendra Suri**, a court astronomer of **Firoz Shah**, created an innovative astronomical instrument known as **Yantraja**.
- ❑ **Parameshvara** and **Mahabhaskariya** were renowned families of astronomers.
- ❑ **Nilakantha Somasutvan** authored a commentary on Aryabhatta's work.
- ❑ Kamalakar delved into Islamic ideas on astronomy and was an authority on Islamic knowledge.
- ❑ Jaipur Maharaja, **Sawai Jai Singh II**, established five astronomical observatories (**Jantar Mantar**) in Delhi, Ujjain, Varanasi, Mathura, and Jaipur.

Medicine

- ❑ **Surgery in India** suffered **setbacks** in the **early medieval times** as the **act of dissecting** with a **razor** became the **work of a barber**. Some of the developments during this time are:
 - The **Unani medicine system** came to India along with the **Muslims** around the **eleventh century**. The **Unani Tibb** is an important system of medicine that flourished in India.
 - **Pulse and urine examinations** were conducted for diagnostic purposes. The **Sharangadhara Samhita** recommended the use of opium for medicines.
 - The **Rasachikitsa system** dealt principally with a **host of mineral medicines**, including metallic preparations for curing diseases.
 - The **Tuhfat-ul-Muminin** was a Persian treatise written by **Muhammad Munin** in the **seventeenth century** that discusses **physician's opinions**.
 - **Ali ibn Sahl Rabban al-Tabari** summarized the whole system of **Greek medicine** as well as the **Indian medical knowledge** in the book **Firdausu-Hikmat**.
 - **Hakim Diya Muhammad** compiled a book, **Majinye Diyae**, incorporating Arabic, Persian and Ayurvedic medical knowledge.
 - The **Tibbi Aurangzebi**, dedicated to Aurangzeb, is based on **Ayurvedic sources**. The **Musalajati-Darashikohi** of **Nuruddin Muhammad**, dedicated to **Darashikoh**, deals with **Greek medicine**.

Siddha, a regional Ayurvedic variant, **originated in Indian Tamil culture**. It emphasises the use of **metals, minerals, and chemicals**.

- ❑ In this system, the human body is understood to consist of 96 tattvas.
- ❑ A branch of Siddha medicine dealing with traumatology and injuries is called **Varmam**.
- ❑ **Alchemy** has its origins in the Siddha system.

Biology

- ❑ In the 13th century, **Hamsadeva** compiled "**Mrigapakshi-shastra**" offering a general account of hunting beasts and birds.
- ❑ Akbar focused on breeding **high-quality domestic animals**, including **elephants** and **horses**.
- ❑ **Role of Jahangir**:
 - Jahangir's work, "**Tuzuk-e-Jahangiri**", **documented** observations and experiments in weeding and hybridization, discussing around **thirty-six animal species**.
 - He was also a keen **naturalist** who, along with his court artists, documented around fifty-seven plant species in their floral portraits.

Chemistry

- ❑ **Paper production** began in the medieval period, with notable centres in Kashmir, Sialkot, Zafarabad, Patna, Murshidabad, Ahmedabad, Aurangabad, and Mysore.
 - **Paper-making techniques** were similar across the country, differing only in the preparation of pulp from various raw materials.
 - During **Tipu's reign** in **Mysore**, a special type of **paper** with a **gold surface** was produced in a dedicated factory.
- ❑ **Tipu Sultan** was the first to develop **iron-cased rockets in the 1780s**.
- ❑ The Mughals had **knowledge** about **gunpowder production** and its use in firearms.
 - Fireworks encompassed rockets, sparklers, coloured flares, and explosive devices.
 - **Tuzuk-i-Baburi** details the process of **casting cannons**, involving melting metal and pouring it into moulds.
- ❑ In addition to explosives, other items were manufactured. **Ain-i-Akbari** mentions the regulations of **Akbar's Perfume Office**, highlighting the popularity of **rose attar**.
- ❑ Glazed tiles and pottery were also notable creations of this period.
- ❑ **Metallurgy**: **Ali Kashmiri ibn Luqman** created the first seamless celestial globe in Kashmir during Akbar's reign.

Agriculture

Notable **regional specialties** included **black pepper** from the Western Ghats, **saffron** and **fruits** from Kashmir, **ginger, cinnamon** from Tamil Nadu, **cardamom, sandalwood**, and **coconuts** from Kerala.



Fig. 13.5: Persian Wheel

- ❑ New plants like **tobacco, chillies, potato, guava, custard apple, cashew, and pineapple** were introduced into India in the 16th and 17th centuries. Foreigners introduced new crops, trees, and horticultural plants. Principal crops included **wheat, rice, barley, millets, pulses, oilseeds, cotton, sugarcane, and indigo**.
- ❑ Regions like Malwa and Bihar were known for **opium production** from poppy plants.
- ❑ Horticultural techniques, like **systematic mango grafting** introduced by **Jesuits in Goa**.
- ❑ Irrigation methods included **wells, tanks, canals, rahats, charas (leather buckets), and Dhenkli** (a device to lift water with yoked oxen).
 - The **Persian wheel** was used around the **Agra region** for irrigation.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

In what way does the current state of the Islamic education system contrast with the historical support for scientific inquiry and technological advancements during the Islamic rule in medieval times in India?

Science and Technology During the Sultanate Period

Textile Technology

- ❑ The most important technological revolution in the textile sector was the introduction of the **spinning wheel** (charkha) through the agency of the Muslims during the 13th-14th centuries. The first literary reference to charkha comes from **Isilmi's Futuh-us Salatin**.
- ❑ We get the first evidence of a **pit loom** (treadle loom) in the **Miftah-ul Fuzala**. This loom allowed the weaver to employ his hitherto idle feet to lift and depress the sets of threads.
- ❑ Block-printing (Chhapa) was perhaps unknown in Ancient India. Scholars credit the Muslims with its diffusion in India.

Building Construction

- ❑ **Lime mortar** was brought by the immigrant Muslims during the Delhi Sultanate.
- ❑ One result of lime mortar was the extensive use of bricks, as it made the brick buildings more durable. Another important consequence was that lime mortar paved the way for the construction of a **true arch (Mihrab)**.
- ❑ From mihrab to **Gumbad** (vaulted roofing or dome) was a natural development.

Paper Making and Bookbinding

- ❑ The Indians perhaps knew about the paper in the 7th century, but they never used it as writing material.

During the Delhi Sultanate, paper was used for many purposes, especially for books.

- ❑ The practice of writing a book on paper was accompanied by the craft of book-binding which was an innovation in India.

Military Technology

- ❑ **Iron stirrup** (Rikab) was unknown in India. Its introduction was the contribution of the Muslims.
- ❑ It is now an incontrovertible fact to infer that horseshoe was a foreign importation, brought by the Turks to India.
- ❑ The immigrant Turks brought **gunpowder** to India, perhaps in the late 13th or early 14th century. But it must be pointed out that even by the reign of Sultan Feroz Shah Tughluq, its only use was for pyrotechny or fireworks and not for fire-arms or for propelling cannon-balls. Firearms were used for the first time during the second half of the 15th century in some regions of India like Gujarat, Malwa and the Deccan. The use of firearms on a regular basis was introduced by the Portuguese when they came to Calicut in A.D. 1498 and by Babur in North India in 1526.

Tin Coating

A coating of tin is given to copper and brass vessels frequently, specially inside, to protect them from the chemical action of acid food. This craft came to India along with the Turks. There is no reference to this technique in Ancient India. **Abul Fazl** refers to tincoating in the **Ain-i Akbari**.

Navigation

For navigation, **the magnetic compass** was a great contribution which the Muslims diffused in India.

Medicine

The Unani system is of **Greek origin**, and it was **introduced in India** during the **Delhi Sultanate**.

- ❑ **Alauddin Khilji** gave **royal patronage** to the Unani system.
- ❑ Within Unani medicine, patients are treated through diverse approaches such as diet, pharmacotherapy, exercise, massage, and surgery.
- ❑ Regimental therapy stands out as a particularly popular method of treatment.

CONCLUSION

India's contributions to science and technology have been profound and enduring, shaping global knowledge and innovation across the ages. From ancient mathematical insights to cutting-edge space exploration, India continues to make significant strides in the quest for scientific excellence and technological advancement.

Cultural Institutions in India and Awards

14

INTRODUCTION

In India, cultural institutions and awards form the cornerstone of the nation's artistic landscape, serving as pillars of recognition, preservation, and promotion of its diverse cultural heritage. These institutions and awards play a crucial role in nurturing artistic talent, fostering creativity, and celebrating excellence across various art forms, from literature and music to dance, theatre, and visual arts.

CULTURAL INSTITUTIONS IN INDIA

The Archaeological Survey of India



Fig. 14.1: The Archeological Survey of India

The Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) falls under the **Ministry of Culture** and is the primary institution for preserving and safeguarding physical heritage found in ancient monuments and archaeological sites.

- ❑ It operates under the guidance of two key legislations: **The Ancient Monuments and Archaeological Sites and Remains Act, 1958**, and **the Antiquities and Art Treasure Act, 1972**.
- ❑ ASI also manages **related institutions** like museums, excavation branches, epigraphy branches, and others.

Crafts Council of India

The Crafts Council of India (CCI) is a non-profit organization founded in **1964** by **Kamala Devi Chattopadhyay** to support and promote the Indian handicraft industry. Its **headquarters** is in **Chennai**. They operate '**Kamala**' shops to showcase and promote arts and crafts supported by the council.

- ❑ **Mission of Craft Council of India:**

To help ensure growth for artisans, promote research and documentation to conserve tradition and to bring technology and entrepreneurial skills for self-reliance within changing markets at home and abroad.

Indira Gandhi National Centre for the Arts (IGNCA)

- ❑ IGNCA is an autonomous organization established in **1985** by the late Prime Minister **Rajiv Gandhi**.
- ❑ Indira Gandhi National Centre for the Arts Trust governs the functioning of IGNCA.
- ❑ IGNCA is headed by a Chairman who is assisted by an Executive Committee.
- ❑ It is dedicated to research, conservation, display, and dissemination of various forms of art, including visual and performing arts, as well as fostering critical and creative literature.

All India Radio

- ❑ All India Radio (AIR) is India's leading public-service radio broadcaster.
- ❑ It operates under the **Ministry of Information and Broadcasting**, Government of India.
- ❑ AIR's motto, '**Bahujan Hitaya: Bahujan Sukhaya**', signifies its primary goal of serving, educating, and entertaining the audience.
- ❑ AIR creates programmes in 23 languages and 179 dialects.



Fig. 14.2: All India Radio

Centre For Cultural Resources and Training (CCRT)

The Centre for Cultural Resources and Training (CCRT) is an **autonomous body** under the **Ministry of Culture**, Government of India, to **integrate education with culture**.

- ❑ It was established in 1979 with the efforts of **Dr. Kapila Vatsyayan** and **Smt. Kamala Devi Chattopadhyay**.
- ❑ Its **headquarters** is in **New Delhi**, with four Regional Centres in Udaipur, Hyderabad, Damoh and Guwahati to promote Indian art and culture.
- ❑ The Indian government gives money to CCRT so that they can support artists, teachers, and students in their efforts to connect culture and education through scholarships.
- ❑ Additionally, they conduct the Cultural Heritage Young Leadership Program, which is designed to encourage civic engagement and social values among India's proactive youth.

National Archives of India

- ❑ It was **established by the British** as the Imperial Records Department (IRD) in 1891 in Calcutta.
- ❑ Subsequent to the transfer from Calcutta (Kolkata) to New Delhi in 1911, the Imperial Records Department (IRD) shifted to the present building in 1926.
- ❑ After India's independence, it was **renamed the National Archives of India (NAI)**, with a director heading the organisation.
- ❑ The scope of the Archives was expanded to **include the acquisition of public records**, private papers/collections, research and reference programs, and conservation training.
- ❑ Its regional centres are in **Jaipur, Bhubaneswar, and Puducherry**.

Indian Council for Cultural Relations (ICCR)

- ❑ It was established in **1950 by Maulana Abul Kalam Azad under the Ministry of Culture** with a focus on cultural exchanges.
- ❑ Objectives of the organisation:
 - To actively participate in the formulation and implementation of policies and programmes pertaining to India's external cultural relations.
 - To foster and strengthen cultural relations and mutual understanding between India and other countries.
 - To promote cultural exchanges with other countries and people and to develop relations with nations.

National Film Development Corporation (NFDC)

- ❑ National Film Development Corporation (NFDC) is a Public Sector Undertaking (PSU) working under the **Ministry of Information and Broadcasting**.
- ❑ It was established in 1975 to promote and organise an integrated development of the Indian film industry and to foster excellence in cinema.
- ❑ In 2022, the Government of India announced the **merger** of four film media units, including the Films Division, Directorate of Film Festivals, National Film Archive of India, and Children's Film Society of India, with the **National Film Development Corporation**.

Indian Council of Historical Research

- ❑ The Indian Council of Historical Research (ICHR) is under the **Ministry of Education**.
- ❑ It is an autonomous organisation established in **1972** and funded by the **University Grants Commission (UGC)**.
- ❑ It is dedicated to **promoting and preserving the history of India**.

- ❑ It publishes journals like the **Indian Historical Review** (English) and '**Itihas**' (Hindi), featuring scholarly research articles on history.

National Mission for Manuscripts

NMM's primary objective is to create the '**National Electronic Database**,' documented 5.2 million manuscripts and conserved 90 million folios across the country, making it the world's largest database of its kind. NMM also focused on **conserving manuscripts**, employing a blend of indigenous and modern techniques to preserve the documents while safeguarding their historical significance.

Indian National Trust for Art and Cultural Heritage (INTACH)

- ❑ It is a **non-profit charitable organisation** registered under the Societies Registration Act, 1860.
- ❑ It was **founded in 1984 in New Delhi** with the vision to spearhead heritage awareness and conservation in India.
- ❑ It has pioneered the **conservation and preservation** of our **natural heritage, built heritage** and intangible heritage.
- ❑ In 2007, the United Nations awarded INTACH a special consultative status with the United Nations Economic and Social Council.
- ❑ Notable individuals, including Madhavrao Scindia, M.G.K. Menon, Dr. Kapila Vatsyayan, and former prime minister Rajiv Gandhi were part of the first governing council of the INTACH.

Sahitya Akademi

Sahitya Akademi has been set up for the development of Indian literature and to set high literary standards to foster and co-ordinate literary activities in all the Indian languages.

- ❑ It is an **autonomous body** under the **Ministry of Culture**.
- ❑ It was established by the government of India in **1954** in New Delhi.
- ❑ It has its **headquarters** in **New Delhi** and five regional offices in Kolkata, Mumbai, Bengaluru, Agartala and Chennai.
- ❑ The Akademi has **recognised 24 Indian languages** (22 languages enumerated in the Constitution of India, and **English and Rajasthani**).

Sangeet Natak Akademi

It was **established in 1953** as India's **first national academy** for the arts. Its main focus is on promoting and showcasing **performing arts** in the country.

- ❑ Sangeet Natak Akademi is an **autonomous body** of the **Ministry of Culture**, Government of India.
- ❑ The management of the Akademi vests in its General Council.
- ❑ The **Chairman** of the Akademi is **appointed by the President** of India for a term of five years.
- ❑ The academy also collaborates with **international organizations** like **UNESCO** to save the cultural heritage of India.
- ❑ It oversees various specialised institutions, **like the National School of Drama**, established in 1959.

Lalit Kala Akademi



Fig. 14.3: Logo of Lalit Kala Akademi

- ❑ The government established the **National Academy of Art**, also known as the **Lalit Kala Akademi**, in 1954 with the primary purpose of **promoting fine arts** in India.
- ❑ It is under the **Ministry of Culture** and was given the status of **statutory authority in 1957** under the Societies Registration Act 1860.
- ❑ It is **headquartered in New Delhi**. They have regional Centres situated at Chennai, Lucknow, Kolkata, Bhubaneswar, Garhi (New Delhi) and sub-centres at Shimla, Ahmedabad, Agartala, Patna.

AWARDS & HONOURS

Bharat Ratna



Fig. 14.4: Bharat Ratna

- ❑ Bharat Ratna is India's **highest civilian award**.
- ❑ **First given in 1954**, it is awarded in recognition of exceptional service/performance of the highest order in **any field of human endeavour**.

- The first awardees: **C. Rajagopalachari**, **Dr. C.V Raman**, and **Dr. S. Radhakrishnan**.
- It was awarded to a **naturalized** Indian citizen: **Mother Teresa (1980)**.
- It was awarded to two non-Indians: **Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan (1987)** and **Nelson Mandela (1990)**.

- ❑ Initially, it was for achievements in art, science, literature, and public service, but the criteria expanded in 2011 to include any field of human endeavour.
- ❑ **Recommendations** for Bharat Ratna are made by the **Prime Minister** to the President, who selects a **maximum of three recipients** annually. No formal recommendations for this are necessary.
- ❑ Awardees receive a **peepal-leaf-shaped medal** and a certificate (sanad) **without any monetary reward**.
- ❑ Bharat Ratna recipients are ranked **seventh (7A)** in the Indian **Order of Precedence**.
- ❑ The award **cannot be used as a prefix or suffix** to the recipient's name, as per the Supreme Court under **Article 18(1)** of the Constitution.

Padma Awards

- ❑ The Padma Awards are **one of the highest civilian honours** in India, announced annually on the eve of **Republic Day**.
- ❑ The award seeks to recognise works of distinction and is given for distinguished and exceptional achievements/service in all fields of activities/disciplines.



Fig. 14.5: Padma Vibhushan, Padma Bhushan and Padma Shri

- ❑ The awardees are presented with a Sanad (certificate) signed by the President and a medallion.
- ❑ Padma Awards were **instituted in 1954** and are given in **three categories**:
 - **Padma Vibhushan**: It is the **second-highest civilian award** in India. Those privileged to get the award are given a citation certificate and a medal, which has a **lotus flower** in the middle and the words '**Desh Seva**', embossed on the obverse. It is awarded for 'exceptional and distinguished service'.

- **Padma Bhushan:** It is the **third-highest civilian award** given by the government of India for 'distinguished service of a high order.
 - **Padma Shri:** It is the **fourth highest civilian award** in India and is given for distinguished contributions to various subjects like arts, literature, sports, politics, industry, medicine, social service, etc. The awardee is given **a certificate and a medallion** with a **three-leafed flower** on one side and on the obverse **Padma** (lotus).
- ❑ The Padma Awards have been **given every year except three times** - 1978, 1979 and between the years 1993-1997.

Rules About Padma Awards

- ❑ A higher degree of award can be given **after five or more years** if the recipient has received a **lower degree of Padma award**.
- ❑ Posthumous awards are rare, but exceptions can be made for **highly deserving cases**.
- ❑ The achievements of the person should have an element of public service, not solely based on excellence in a field but on excellence plus.
- ❑ **Government servants** (except doctors and scientists) **working in PSUs are not** eligible for these awards.

National Film Awards

- ❑ These are among the **most prestigious honours** bestowed upon persons who have contributed to the advancement of cinematic art.
- ❑ These prizes have been given out annually **since 1954**.
- ❑ In 1973, the **Directorate of Film Festivals** was made responsible for organising these awards.
- ❑ The winners are chosen by a **national selection committee** appointed by the government. The award is **presented by the Indian President**, and the films that won the award are shown to the public.
- ❑ The National Film Awards also include the very prestigious **Dadasaheb Phalke Lifetime Achievement Award**, which is presented to those who have spent their entire career contributing to Indian Cinema.
 - The award was introduced in 1969, and is India's **highest honour** in **cinema**.
 - It commemorates **Dada Saheb Phalke**, the pioneer who directed India's first full-length feature film, "**Raja Harishchandra**", in 1913.
 - The award is presented by the Directorate of Film Festivals **under the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting**.

- ❑ The awards are given to the best amongst Hindi Film Industry and from the regional categories.
- ❑ The following five major categories receive this award: **Swarna Kamal Or the Golden Lotus Award**; **Rajat Kamal** or **Silver Lotus Award**; **Best Feature film** in the languages **specified in Schedule VIII** of the Constitution; **Best Feature Film** in languages **other than those specified in Schedule VIII** of the Constitution: Five categories including English, Bhojpuri, Kokborok, Monpa and Tulu.

Jnanpith Award

It is awarded for **exceptional literary accomplishment** and was first introduced by the **Bharatiya Jnanpith** in **1961**.

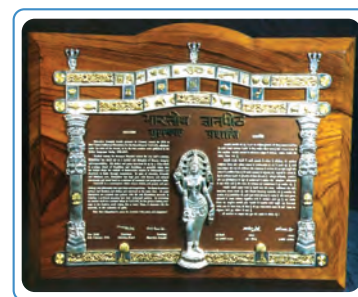


Fig. 14.6: Jnanpith Award

- ❑ It is given to those Indian citizens who compose literature in one of the **22 languages** listed in **Schedule VIII** of the Indian Constitution **and English**.
- ❑ Apart from a plaque and a **cash prize** of 11 lakh rupees, the winner is also given a **bronze statue of Goddess Saraswati**.
- ❑ This award is **not given posthumously**.

Saraswati Samman

- ❑ It is an annual award for outstanding prose or poetry literary works in any of the 22 Indian languages listed in Schedule VIII of the Constitution of India.
- ❑ The award was instituted in 1991 by the **K. K. Birla Foundation**.
- ❑ It consists of a plaque, a citation, and fifteen lakh rupees.
- ❑ A team of scholars and past award winners chooses candidates from among literary works that have been published in the last ten years.

Vyas Samman

- ❑ This literary award was first given in 1991.
- ❑ The K. K. Birla Foundation awards it every year, and the prize money is Rs. 250,000.
- ❑ The literary work must be in Hindi and have been published within the last ten years in order to qualify for the award.

Awards Given by Sahitya Akademi

Award	Purpose
Sahitya Akademi Award	❑ This is an honour given to those who achieve brilliance in literature. ❑ It was established in 1954. ❑ The award consists of a plaque that reads “Sahitya” in Devanagari script and a monetary prize of one lakh rupees. ❑ It is given annually to those who have achieved literary merit and created new trends through their works in any of the 24 major languages recognised by the Akademi.
Sahitya Akademi Fellowship	❑ The highest honour conferred by the Akademi on a writer is by electing him as its Fellow. ❑ This honour is reserved for ‘the immortals of literature’ and is limited to twenty-one only at any given time.
Bhasha Samman	❑ The award is given to writers who have made significant contributions to Indian languages other than the 24 major languages. ❑ It also recognizes the contribution to classical and medieval literature.
Dr. Anand Coomaraswamy Fellowship: Those who have worked in the field of art, especially in Ancient India. Premchand Fellowship: Those who have contributed to Hindi literature.	

Bhasha Samman Award

- ❑ The Sahitya Akademi bestows these honors.
- ❑ Each year, the Akademi selects authors for their outstanding contributions to classical and medieval literature, as well as to Indian languages besides the 24 major languages that are covered by the Sahitya Akademi award.
- ❑ A plaque and a cash award of one lakh twenty thousand rupees are included in the Bhasha Samman.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

Elaborate on the significance of cultural institutions and awards in shaping and disseminating cultural narratives through various art forms.

CONCLUSION

In essence, the cultural institutions and awards in India serve as beacons, guiding the artistic trajectory of the nation. Their influence extends beyond the realms of galleries and auditoriums, reaching into the very heart of communities, schools, and homes, enriching the lives of countless individuals and contributing to the enduring legacy of Indian arts and culture.

UNESCO's List of World Heritage Sites

15

UNESCO

- ❑ United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO) is a specialized agency of the United Nations (UN), it endeavours to foster peace through global collaboration in education, science, and culture.
- ❑ Additionally, it is part of the **United Nations Sustainable Development Group** (UNSDG), working alongside other UN entities to achieve the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).
- ❑ Situated in **Paris**, UNESCO operates over 50 field offices worldwide.
- ❑ With **194 Member States** and **12 Associate Members**, it operates under the oversight of the **General Conference** and the **Executive Board**.

THE WORLD HERITAGE CONVENTION

The Convention recognizes the way in which people interact with nature and the fundamental need to preserve the balance between the two. The convention defines the kind of natural or cultural sites that can be considered for inscription on the World Heritage List. Signatory countries commit to preserving both the global and national heritage within their borders.

Timeline of the World Heritage Convention

- ❑ The Convention concerning the Protection of World Cultural and Natural Heritage was adopted by the **General Conference of UNESCO** on 16 November 1972.
- ❑ In 1975 the convention formally took effect upon **ratification** by the first 20 State Parties. The **World Heritage Fund** was established.
- ❑ The year 1992 marks the 20th Anniversary of the Convention, the creation of the UNESCO World Heritage Centre, and the adoption of the cultural landscapes category by the World Heritage Committee, making the Convention the **first international legal instrument to recognize and protect cultural landscapes**.

- ❑ The General Assembly proclaims 2002 as the **United Nations Year for Cultural Heritage**, with UNESCO as the lead agency.
 - To mark the 30th anniversary of the Convention, UNESCO organizes the International Congress "**World Heritage: Shared Legacy, Common Responsibility**" in Venice (Italy).
- ❑ The year 2022 marks the **50th Anniversary** of the Convention.
- ❑ For the first time, India will host the meeting (46th session) of the World Heritage Committee in 2024.

The Criteria for Selection

To be included on the World Heritage List, sites must be of **outstanding universal value** and **meet at least one out of ten selection criteria**. These are **essential places** of **cultural or natural heritage** as described in the **UNESCO World Heritage Convention** established in **1972**. The protection, management, authenticity and integrity of properties are also important considerations. Since 1992 significant interactions between people and the natural environment have been recognized as **cultural landscapes**.

Until the end of 2004, World Heritage sites were selected on the basis of **six cultural and four natural criteria**. With the adoption of the revised Operational Guidelines for the Implementation of the World Heritage Convention, only one set of ten criteria exists.

Criteria for Selection of World Heritage Sites

- ❑ Represents **human creative** genius.
- ❑ Demonstrates an **exchange of human values** over time or within a cultural area in architecture, technology, arts, town planning, or landscape design.
- ❑ Provides unique testimony to a **living or vanished** cultural tradition or civilisation.
- ❑ Exemplifies a **significant stage** in human history through its architecture, technology, or landscape.
- ❑ Represents a **traditional human settlement**, land use, or sea use, especially when it's threatened by irreversible change.
- ❑ Has **tangible connections to living traditions, beliefs**, and **artistic and literary works** of universal significance.
- ❑ Contains **exceptional natural phenomena** or displays remarkable natural beauty.

- ❑ Represents **crucial stages** in Earth's history, including the record of life and ongoing geological processes.
- ❑ Represents **ongoing ecological and biological processes** in terrestrial, freshwater, coastal, and marine ecosystems.
- ❑ Contains **vital natural habitats** for conserving biological diversity, including threatened species of universal scientific or conservation value.
- ❑ It encompasses the **three most representative examples** of Hoysala-style temple complexes in southern India, dating from the **12th to 13th centuries AD**.
 - The **Chennakesava Temple** at Belur, the **Hoysaleswara Temple** at Halebidu, and the **Keshava Temple** at Somanathapura were collectively inscribed as "Sacred Ensembles of the Hoysalas" on the UNESCO World Heritage List.
- ❑ The Hoysala temples have a basic **Dravidian form** but show strong influences of the Bhumija, Nagara, and Karnataka Dravida styles.
- ❑ The Hoysala temples are known for their **intricate carvings, geometric pillars, and star-shaped ceilings**.
- ❑ The Hoysala used **soft soapstone** for their structures as they were found suitable for intricate carvings.

UNESCO WORLD HERITAGE SITES IN INDIA - (CULTURAL SITES)

Sacred Ensembles of the Hoysalas (Karnataka)

- ❑ It was added to the list in **2023**.

Hoysaleswara Temple (Halebid)

- ❑ Located on the banks of Dwarasamudra tank in **Halebid, Karnataka**.
- ❑ Built In the **12th century**, the temple was built during the **rule of King Vishnuvardhana** of the Hoysala Empire.
- ❑ It is one of the largest temples dedicated to **Lord Shiva** in South India.
- ❑ Another interesting object in the temple complex is the rare **Garuda Stambh**.

The Chennakeshava Temple

- ❑ It is located in the main temple in the complex at **Belur**.
- ❑ It was constructed by **King Vishnuvardhana** in the 12th century to **commemorate his victory over the Cholas**.
- ❑ There are more than 80 Madanika sculptures in the temple, dancing, hunting, and standing under canopies of trees.
- ❑ The **Garbhagriha is stellar in shape**, and its zigzag walls make the figures of 24 forms of Vishnu look different at different times of the day due to light.

The Keshava Temple

- ❑ It is located in **Mysore district**.
- ❑ It was **built in 1268 AD by Somanatha** a Dandanayaka **under the Hoysala king Narashima III**.
- ❑ It has three sanctums on the West, South and North to Keshava, Venugopala and Janardhana, all connected.
- ❑ The temple itself occupies the middle of the rectangular courtyard surrounded by 64 cells, each with pillars in front, forming an appropriate cloistered setting.



Fig. 15.1: Hoysaleswara Temple



Fig. 15.2: Chennakeshava Temple



Fig. 15.3: Keshava Temple

Santiniketan (West Bengal)

- ❑ It was added to the list in **2023**.
- ❑ Santiniketan, which means **"abode of peace"** in Bengali, was originally an ashram built by Debendranath Tagore.
- ❑ Initially established as a school known as Brahmacharya Ashram.



Fig. 15.4: Shantiniketan

- ❑ Nobel laureate **Rabindranath Tagore** later transformed Santiniketan into a university town.
- ❑ It was a residential school and centre for art based on ancient Indian traditions and a vision of the unity of humanity.
- ❑ A 'world university' was established at Santiniketan in 1921, recognising the unity of humanity or "Visva Bharati".

Dholavira (Gujarat)

- ❑ It was added to the list in **2021**.
- ❑ It is an archaeological site in the **Rann of Kachchh** area.
- ❑ It comprises a **fortified city, cemetery** and a sophisticated **water management system**.
- ❑ It is the **only site divided into three parts (citadel, middle town and lower town)**. The rest of the Harappan sites used to be divided into two parts, i.e. citadel and lower town.
- ❑ It was also an important **trading** and **commercial hub**.



Fig. 15.5: Dholavira

Kakatiya Rudreshwara (Ramappa) Temple (Telangana)

- ❑ It was added to the list in **2021**.
- ❑ This Hindu temple in Telangana is devoted to the **god Shiva** and is built in the **Kakatiya style**.
- ❑ Under the direction of his Chief Commander **Rudra Samani**, the Kakatiya emperor Kakati Ganapathi Deva provided support for the construction of the medieval Deccan Ramappa Temple, which was completed in 1213 AD.
- ❑ Because of its principal sculptor Ramappa, the temple was given the name Ramappa. The Ramappa Temple is presumably the only temple in India bearing the architect's name.
- ❑ It was built using **the sandbox technique**.
- ❑ A carving of Lord Krishna can be found on one of the pillars. The **pillar emits melodic tones** when struck lightly.
- ❑ The building features include decorated beams and **pillars of carved granite and dolerite** with a distinctive and **pyramidal Vimana** made of lightweight porous bricks (**'floating bricks'**), which reduced the weight of the roof structures.
- ❑ **Marco Polo** visited this temple.



Fig. 15.6: Ramappa Temple
emperor Kakati Ganapathi Deva provided support for the construction of the medieval Deccan Ramappa Temple, which was completed in 1213 AD.

Sandbox Technique: The pit dug for the foundation is filled up with a mixture of sand-lime, jaggery (for binding) and karakkaya (black myrobalan fruit) before starting construction over it. This sandbox helps provide a cushion against earthquakes.

Jaipur City (Rajasthan)

- ❑ It was added in **2019**.
- ❑ **Sawai Jai Singh II** founded the city in 1727.

- ❑ After **Ahmedabad**, Jaipur is the only city in the country to get this recognition.
- ❑ The city was selected because of its significance as a prime example of late medieval urban planning and architecture, showcasing a significant exchange of ideas and integration.
- ❑ The city is famous for its historical monuments, including palaces, forts, and temples. Some of the notable landmarks in Jaipur include: Hawa Mahal (Palace of Winds), City Palace, Amber Fort, Jantar Mantar, and Nahargarh Fort.

Victorian and Art Deco Ensemble of Mumbai

- ❑ It was added in **2018**.
- ❑ The Ensemble comprises two architectural styles, the 19th-century collection of **Victorian structures** and the 20th-century **Art Deco buildings**.
- ❑ The ensembles exhibit an essential exchange of European and Indian human values over a period of time.



Fig. 15.7: Elphinstone College (Victoria Art)

Historic City of Ahmedabad (Gujarat)

- ❑ It was added in **2017**.
- ❑ **Sultan Ahmad Shah** founded the walled city in the 15th century on the eastern bank of the **Sabarmati River**.
- ❑ It presents a rich architectural heritage from the Sultanate period, notably the **Bhadra citadel**, the walls and gates of the Fort City and numerous mosques and tombs, as well as important Hindu and Jain temples of later periods.

The Architectural Work of Le Corbusier, an Outstanding Contribution to the Modern Movement (Chandigarh)

- ❑ It was added in **2016**.
- ❑ The architectural work of Le Corbusier was chosen from eleven countries across four continents, with sites in seven countries across three continents, including India.
- ❑ **Complexe du Capitole** in Chandigarh is part of this.

Archaeological Site of Nalanda Mahavihara (Nalanda University) (Bihar)

- ❑ It was added in **2016**.
- ❑ It is the most ancient university in India. It comprises the archaeological remains of a monastic and scholastic institution dating from the 3rd century BC to the 13th century AD.

- ❑ It was founded by **Kumaragupta I** (413-455 A.D.) of the Gupta dynasty.
- ❑ **King Harshavardhana** of Kannauj (606-647 A.D.) and the **Pala kings of east India** (8th-12th Century A.D.) continued to extend patronage to this center.
- ❑ The decline of this great institution started in the later Pala period, but the final blow came in around 1200 A.D. by the invasion of **Bakhtiyar Khalji** who destroyed it by fire.

Rani-Ki-Vav (Gujarat)

- ❑ It was included in the list in the year **2014**.
- ❑ It is situated on the bank of the **Saraswati River** and was commissioned by **Queen Udayamati** in the **11th century** in memory of her husband, **King Bhimdev I** of the **Solanki dynasty**.
- ❑ It is designed in the form of an **inverted temple** having various religious, mythological and secular imagery.
- ❑ The **stepwell** served both utilitarian and commemorative purposes. A unique form of water storage and access structure designed with elaborate, multistory platforms descending into the ground.
- ❑ The stepwell has seven levels of stairs, making it one of the deepest and most complex stepwells in India. Each level is adorned with intricate sculptures and carvings.

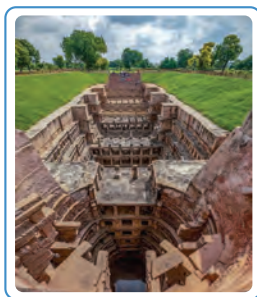


Fig. 15.8: Rani ki Vav

Hill Forts of Rajasthan

These were included in the year **2013**. It includes **six majestic forts** in Chittorgarh; Kumbhalgarh; Sawai Madhopur; Jhalawar; Jaipur and Jaisalmer.

❑ Chittorgarh Fort

- It served as the **capital of Mewar**.
- It is said to have been built by the western branch of Mauryan ruler Chitrangada Mori.
- In 1303, the Sultan of Delhi Sultanate Alauddin Khilji led an army to conquer Chittorgarh, which was ruled by the Guhila king Ratnasimha.



Fig. 15.9: Chittorgarh Fort

❑ Kumbhalgarh Fort

- Kumbhalgarh, also known as the **Great Wall of India**, is a Mewar fortress on the westerly range of the Aravalli Hills.
- Kumbhalgarh, as the fort we see, was built by **Rana Kumbha**, who was the Rana of Mewar from the **Sisodia Rajput clan**.
- **Ahmed Shah I** of Gujarat **attacked the fort** in 1457, but found the effort futile.

❑ Ranthambore Fort

- Ranthambore Fort lies within the Ranthambore National Park, near the city of Sawai Madhopur in the Sawai Madhopur district of Rajasthan, India.
- It is believed to have been built in 944 AD by a Chauhan ruler.

❑ Gagron Fort

- It is situated near Jhalawar, Gagron Fort is unique as it is surrounded by water on three sides.
- The fort has a **blend of Rajput and Sultanate architectural styles** and includes temples, palaces, and mosques.

❑ Amber Fort

- It is located on a hill near Jaipur.
- Amber Fort is known for its **artistic Hindu-style elements**. The fort features a **blend of Rajput and Mughal architectural influences** and includes palaces, courtyards, and a scenic lake.
- It is constructed of **red sandstone and marble**.
- The Amber Fort was originally built by **Raja Man Singh**. Jai Singh I expanded it in the early 1600s. Improvements and additions were made by successive rulers over the next 150 years until the Kachwahs shifted their capital to Jaipur during the time of Sawai Jai Singh II, in 1727.

❑ Jaisalmer Fort

- It is located in the heart of Jaisalmer, this fort is often referred to as the **"Golden Fort"** due to the **yellow sandstone used** in its construction.
- Jaisalmer Fort is known for its intricate architecture, havelis (mansions), and Jain temples.

The Jantar Mantar (Jaipur, Rajasthan)

- ❑ This was added in the year **2010**.
- ❑ It is an **astronomical observation** site built in the early 18th century by **Maharaja Jai Singh II**.
- ❑ Jaipur's Jantar Mantar is a collection of 19 astronomical instruments.
- ❑ The observatory is an **example of Ptolemaic positional astronomy**, which was widely used.
- ❑ There are Jantar-Mantar in other parts of India too, namely Delhi, Jaipur, Ujjain, Varanasi, and Mathura.

Red Fort Complex (Delhi)

- ❑ It was included in the list in **2007**.
- ❑ It was built as the palace fort of Shah Jahan's capital, Shahjahanabad.
- ❑ The planning of the palace is based on Islamic prototypes, but each pavilion reveals architectural elements typical of Mughal buildings, reflecting a **fusion of Persian, Timurid and Hindu traditions**.

- It has important buildings like **Diwan-i-Aam** (Hall of Public Audience), **Diwan-i-Khas** (Hall of Private Audience), **Rang Mahal** (Palace of Colors), and **Moti Masjid** (Pearl Mosque).

Champaner-Pavagadh Archaeological Park (Gujarat)

- It was added in 2004.
- Champaner-Pavagadh Archaeological Park is located in Panchmahal district in Gujarat, India.
- Champaner was an important city during the medieval period, serving as the **capital of the Gujarat Sultanate**. The city was founded by **Sultan Mahmud Begada** in the 15th century.
- Pavagadh hill was a famous Hindu fortress under the Solanki kings of Gujarat, followed by Khichi Chauhans.
- The Pavagadh hill is constructed of **reddish-yellow coloured stone**.
- This formation is one of the oldest rock formations in India.
- Rainwater harvesting** is a notable feature of the Pavagadh hills.
- Pavagadh Hill** is considered a pilgrimage site, attracting devotees to the Kalika Mata Temple and other religious structures

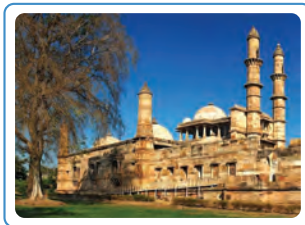


Fig. 15.10: Champaner-Pavagadh Archeological Part

Chhatrapati Shivaji Terminus (Maharashtra)

- It was added to the list in **2004**.
- It represents **Victorian Gothic revival architecture** in India and was built by **British architect F.W.Stevens**.
- Design is based on **late medieval Italian models**.
- It was formerly known as Victoria Terminus (VT).
- It made Bombay as the symbol of the 'Gothic City' and the major international mercantile port of India.
- Its remarkable stone dome, turrets, pointed arches, and eccentric ground plan are close to traditional Indian palace architecture.
- The architectural construction is completed through **white limestone**. The doors and windows are made of Burma teak wood with some steel windows.



Fig. 15.11: Chhatrapati Shivaji Terminus

Rock Shelters of Bhimbetka (Madhya Pradesh)

- It was added to the list in **2003**.
- The Bhimbetka rock shelters (on the foothills of the Vindhyan mountain) are an **archaeological site of the Paleolithic age**.
- Huge linear figures of animals are the trademark of Paleolithic paintings. With the passage of time, paintings became smaller, more precise and delicate.

Mahabodhi Temple Complex at Bodh Gaya (Bihar)

- It was added in **2002**.
- It is one of the four holy sites related to Lord Buddha's life, particularly to the attainment of enlightenment.
- The present Bodhi Tree is believed to be a direct descendant of the original tree under which the Buddha meditated.
- The **first temple was built by Emperor Asoka in the 3rd century BC**, and the present temple dates from the **5th or 6th centuries**.
- The present temple is one of the earliest and most imposing structures **built entirely from brick in the late Gupta period**.



Fig. 15.12: Mahabodhi Temple

Mountain Railways of India (West Bengal; Tamil Nadu; Himachal Pradesh)

- These were added in **1999**.
- This site includes the **Darjeeling Himalayan Railway**, **Nilgiri Mountain Railway**, and the **Kalka Shimla Railway**.
- Darjeeling Himalayan Railway:** It is located in the Indian state of West Bengal, connecting the town of Darjeeling with the plains. It was opened in 1881.
- Nilgiri Mountain Railway:** It is located in the southern Indian state of Tamil Nadu, connecting Mettupalayam with the hill station of Ooty (Udhagamandalam). It was completed in 1908.
- Kalka Shimla Railway:** It is situated in the northern Indian state of Himachal Pradesh, connecting Kalka with Shimla. It was opened in 1903.

Humayun's Tomb (Delhi)

- It was added in **1993**.
- It was built in 1570, the **first garden-tomb** in the Indian subcontinent.
- The architectural style of this tomb is known as **Necropolis of the Mughal Dynasty** for the **double domed elevation**.

- ❑ It was commissioned by **Empress Bega Begum**, the first wife of Mughal Emperor Humayun, in the mid-16th century. The construction began in **1565**, and the tomb was completed in **1572**.
- ❑ It was **designed** by the Persian architect **Mirak Mirza Ghiyas** in a combination of Persian and Indian architectural styles.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

The tag of UNESCO cultural heritage makes universalisation of local art and culture possible. It also aids in the preservation of the art. Comment.

Qutb Minar and its Monuments (Delhi)

- ❑ It was added in **1993**.
- ❑ It was built in the early 13th century by **Qutb-ud-din Aibak** and later completed by **Iltutmish**.
- ❑ The Qutb Minar is a five-storied tower constructed with **red sandstone and marble**.
- ❑ The surrounding archaeological area contains the **Alai-Darwaza** (built in 1311) and two mosques, including the **Quwwat-ul-Islam mosque**.
- ❑ In the courtyard of the mosque stands the famous **Iron Pillar**, a marvel of ancient metallurgy. The pillar, made of pure iron, has not rusted over the centuries and bears inscriptions in Sanskrit.

Buddhist Monuments at Sanchi (Madhya Pradesh)

- ❑ It was added in **1989**.
- ❑ It was originally **commissioned by Emperor Ashoka in the 3rd century BC** and **later expanded during the Sunga period**.
- ❑ The site of Sanchi comprises a group of Buddhist monuments (**monolithic pillars, palaces, temples and monasteries**), all in different states of conservation, most of which date back to the **2nd and 1st centuries BC**.

Elephanta Caves (Maharashtra)

- ❑ It was added in **1987**.
- ❑ These are **seven caves** with the local name **Gharapuri caves**. The '**City of Caves**', on an island close to Mumbai, contains a **collection of rock art** linked to the **cult of Shiva**.
- ❑ The focal point is the colossal three-headed Shiva sculpture, representing the **Trimurti (trinity)** of Lord Shiva as the creator, preserver, and destroyer.
- ❑ Other notable sculptures are the **Gangadhara panel** and **Ardhanarishvara sculpture**.

Great Living Chola Temples (Tamil Nadu)

- ❑ These were added in **1987**.
- ❑ Completed between the early 11th and the 12th century AD, the monuments include:
 - **Brihadisvara Temple at Thanjavur** during the reign of the great **king Rajaraja** (985-1014), the true founder of the Chola Empire, which spread throughout the whole of southern India, part of Ceylon and the Maldives and Laccadive archipelagos.
 - **Brihadisvara Temple at Gangaikonda Cholapuram** was built by Rajendra Chola I.
 - **Airavatesvara Temple** at Darasuram was built by **Rajaraja II**.
- ❑ They represent an outstanding creative achievement in the architectural conception of the **pure form of the Dravida type** of temple (characterized by a pyramidal tower).

Group of Monuments at Pattadakal (Karnataka)

- ❑ It was added in **1987**.
- ❑ Built in the **7th and 8th centuries AD** under the **Chalukya dynasty**.
- ❑ It includes a series of **nine Hindu temples** (including **Virupaksha Temple, Mallikarjuna Temple, Papanatha Temple**), as well as a **Jain sanctuary**.
- ❑ These monuments have architectural features of both **Dravida and Nagara styles**.
- ❑ Virupaksha temple was built to **commemorate the victory of King Vikramaditya II over Pallava King Nandivarman** of Kanchipuram.



Fig. 15.13: Monuments at Pattadakal

Note

- ❑ **Virupaksha temple** at **Pattadakal** belongs to the **Chalukyan dynasty**. It was built by Rani Trilokyamahadevi in the 7th-8th century.
- ❑ **Virupaksha temple** (15th century) at **Hampi** belongs to the **Vijayanagar Empire**.
- ❑ Both these temples are world heritage sites.

Churches and Convents of Goa

- ❑ It was added in **1986**.
- ❑ The **Churches and Convents at Velha (Old) Goa** owe their existence to Portuguese rule in this part of the western coast of India.
- ❑ The most comprehensive group of churches and cathedrals built during the 16th to 17th century AD at Old Goa comprise the following: **Basilica of Bom Jesus** (contains the tomb of St Francis Xavier), **Se' Cathedral, Church and Convent of St. Francis of Assisi, Church of our Lady of Rosary, Church of St. Augustine** and **Chapel of St. Catherine**.

Fatehpur Sikri (Uttar Pradesh)

- ❑ It was added in **1986**.
- ❑ It was commissioned by the Mughal Emperor **Akbar** in 1569 as a tribute to the **Sufi saint Sheikh Salim Chishti**. The construction of the city began in 1571.
- ❑ The **Buland Darwaza**, or the “**Gate of Magnificence**,” is a grand entrance to the city. It is one of the tallest and most impressive gateways in the world, commemorating Akbar’s victory over Gujarat.
- ❑ Other important structures include the **Jama Masjid**, **Diwan-i-Khas**, **Diwan-i-Aam** and **Panch Mahal**.

Group of Monuments at Hampi (Karnataka)

- ❑ It was added in **1986**.
- ❑ Hampi is situated on the **southern bank of the river Tungabhadra**. Once, it was the **seat of the mighty Vijayanagara Empire**.
- ❑ A large number of royal buildings were constructed by **Krishnadeva Raya** (1509-30 AD), the greatest ruler of the dynasty.
- ❑ Most of the structures at Hampi are constructed from local granite, burnt bricks and lime mortar.
- ❑ Vijayanagara architecture is also known for its adoption of elements of Indo-Islamic Architecture (like the **Queen’s Bath** and the **Elephant Stables**).
- ❑ Dravidian architecture survives in the rest of Southern India and spread through the patronage of the Vijayanagara rulers.
- ❑ The Important Monuments include **Virupaksha Temple**, **Vittala Temple Complex**, **Hazara Rama Temple**, **Achyutaraya Temple**, **Lotus Mahal** and **Elephant Stables**.



Fig. 15.14: Vittala Temple

Virupaksha Temple: The oldest and principal temple in Hampi. It has been an important pilgrimage centre for the worshipers of lord Shiva. Krishnadevaraya was a major patron of this temple.

Achyuta Raya’s Temple: This temple is an example of Vijayanagara-style temple architecture in its most advanced form than any other temple in Hampi. The temple is dedicated to Lord Tiruvengalanatha, a form of Vishnu.

Khajuraho Group of Monuments (Madhya Pradesh)

- ❑ This was added in **1986**.
- ❑ It contains **Hindu and Jain temples** built during the reign of **Chandella dynasty** rulers between **950 and 1050 AD**.

- ❑ The **Western Group** of Temples at Khajuraho are the main attraction, featuring some of the most iconic and well-preserved temples. Notable ones include **Kandariya Mahadeva Temple** (built during the reign of Vidyadhara), **Lakshmana Temple**, **Vishvanatha Temple** (has a Panchayatan-style complex), **Matangeshvara Temple**.
- ❑ The **Eastern Group** includes temples like the Parsvanatha Temple, Ghantai Temple, and Adinatha Temple, among others.
- ❑ The **Southern Group** comprises smaller temples with unique features, including the Duladeo Temple and the Chaturbhuj Temple.



Fig. 15.15: Kandariya Mahadev

Bhand Deva temple in Rajasthan is referred to as **Little Khajurao**.

Group of Monuments at Mahabalipuram (Tamil Nadu)

- ❑ It was added in **1984**.
- ❑ The monuments at Mahabalipuram were built during the reign of the **Pallava dynasty in the 7th and 8th centuries AD**, particularly during the rule of **Narasimhavarman I (Mamalla)** in the 7th century and later Pallava rulers.
- ❑ Important Monuments include **Shore Temple**, **Pancha Rathas**, **Arjuna’s Penance** (Descent of the Ganges), **Varaha Cave Temple**, **Krishna’s Butter Ball etc.**
- ❑ Most of the monuments, like the rock-cut rathas, sculptured scenes on open rocks like **Arjuna’s penance**, **the caves of Govardhanadhari and Ahishasuramardini**, and the **Jala-Sayana Perumal temple** (the sleeping Mahavishnu or Chakrin at the rear part of the Shore temple complex) are attributed to the period of Narasimhavarman I Mamalla.



Fig. 15.16: Pancha Rathas

Sun Temple, Konarak (Odisha)

- ❑ It was added in **1984**.
- ❑ It is also known as **Black Pagoda** as it was built in **black granite**.
- ❑ It represents **Kalinga architecture** and was built in the **13th century**, by **King Narasimha Deva I** (Eastern Ganga Dynasty).
- ❑ The entire temple is designed as a chariot for the sun god, drawn by horses, with twelve pairs of wheels representing the months of the year.

- ❑ **Oxidizing weathered ferruginous coloured sandstone** is used for construction.
- ❑ **The Konark Wheel**, also known as the **Sun Dial**, is an iconic feature of the temple. The large stone wheel with intricately carved spokes serves as a sundial and accurately measures time.

Agra Fort (Uttar Pradesh)

- ❑ It was added in **1983**.
- ❑ Agra Fort was initially constructed during the reign of the Mughal Emperor Akbar in the mid-16th century. Subsequent Mughal emperors, including Jahangir, Shah Jahan, and Aurangzeb, made additions and modifications to the fort.
- ❑ The fort is strategically located on the west bank of the **Yamuna River** and served as a military stronghold as well as a royal residence.
- ❑ It is also known as the **Red Fort of Agra**.
- ❑ It comprises palaces, such as the **Jahangir Palace** and the **Khas Mahal**, built by Shah Jahan; the Diwan-i-Khas (audience hall), Jahangir's Chain of Justice (Adl-i-Janjir) etc.

Ajanta Caves (Maharashtra)

- ❑ It was added in **1983**.
- ❑ There are a total of **30 rock-cut caves**. The first **Buddhist cave monuments** at Ajanta date from the **2nd and 1st centuries BC**. During the **Gupta period (5th and 6th centuries AD)**, many more richly decorated caves were added to the original group.
- ❑ The caves include both monasteries (**viharas**) for monks and prayer halls (**chaityas**).
- ❑ Ajanta is renowned for its exquisite **frescoes** depicting scenes from the **life of Buddha**, **Jataka tales**, and various **celestial beings**.
- ❑ Travel accounts of Chinese Buddhist traveller **Fa Hien (visited during the reign of Chandragupta II)** and **Hiuen Tsang (visited during Harshavardhan)** have a reference to this place.
- ❑ The Ajanta Caves are situated near the **Waghora River** in the state of Maharashtra, India.

Ellora Caves (Maharashtra)

- ❑ It was added in **1983**.
- ❑ There are 34 monasteries and temples. The architectural activities were carried out by the followers of **Buddhism**, **Brahmanism**, and **Jainism**.
- ❑ Various dynasties, including the **Rashtrakutas** and **Chalukyas**, were patrons of the Ellora Caves.
- ❑ The **Elaganga River**, also known as the **Ela River** or Elahabad River, flows in close proximity to the Ellora Caves.

Taj Mahal (Uttar Pradesh)

- ❑ It was added in **1983**.
- ❑ It was commissioned by the Mughal Emperor **Shah Jahan** in memory of his beloved wife, Mumtaz Mahal, who died during childbirth in 1631.
- ❑ It stands on the bank of **River Yamuna**. The construction of the Taj Mahal **began in 1632** and was largely **completed in 1648**, with additional embellishments continuing for a few years.

UNESCO WORLD HERITAGE SITES IN INDIA - (NATURAL SITES)

Great Himalayan National Park (Himachal Pradesh)

- ❑ It was added to the list in **2014**.
- ❑ It was **established in 1984** to conserve the unique flora and fauna of the western Himalayas.
- ❑ It is **situated** in the **Kullu region** of Himachal Pradesh, covering parts of the Seraj Forest Division and the **upper Beas River** catchment.
- ❑ The park is home to a diverse range of flora, including alpine meadows, coniferous forests, and medicinal plants. Some of the prominent tree species include oak, deodar, blue pine, and spruce.
- ❑ The park is home to mammals like the **Himalayan tahr**, **Himalayan brown bear**, **Snow leopard**, and **Musk deer**.



Fig. 15.17: Snow Leopard

Western Ghats (Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Goa, and Gujarat)

- ❑ It was added in the year **2012**.
- ❑ It is also known as the **Sahyadri Mountains** and runs parallel to the western coast of India. It spans across several states, including **Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Goa, and Gujarat**.
- ❑ It is recognized as **one of the world's eight biodiversity hotspots**, harbouring a high level of species diversity, including many endemic species.

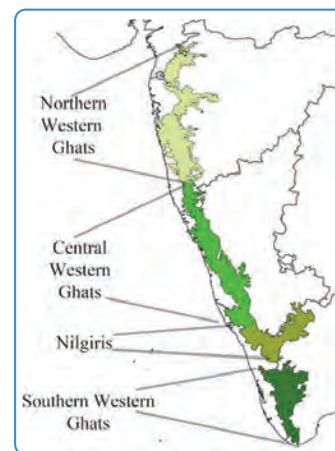


Fig. 15.18: Western Ghats

- ❑ Numerous **rivers originate** from the Western Ghats, including the **Godavari, Krishna, Kaveri, and others**.
- ❑ The region features **tropical rainforests, evergreen forests, and deciduous forests**.
- ❑ Mammals like the **Bengal tiger, Indian elephant, and Nilgiri tahr** are found in the region.
- ❑ The Sub-clusters include **Agasthyamalai, Periyar, Anamalai, Nilgiri, Talakaveri, Kudremukh, and Sahyadri**.

Nanda Devi and Valley of Flowers National Park (Uttarakhand)



Fig. 15.19: Asiatic Black Bear

- ❑ It was added in **1988**.
- ❑ It is situated in the **Garhwal Himalayas** and is named after the Nanda Devi Peak, the second-highest mountain peak in India.
- ❑ The Valley of Flowers National Park is adjacent to Nanda Devi National Park and is known for its alpine meadows and vibrant floral diversity.
- ❑ It is home to rare animals, including the **Asiatic black bear, Snow leopard, Brown bear and Blue sheep**.
- ❑ It encompasses a **unique transition zone** between the **Zaskar mountain range** and the **Great Himalayas**.

Sundarban National Park (West Bengal)



Fig. 15.20: Royal Bengal Tiger

- ❑ It was added in **1987**.
- ❑ It is located at the **mouth** of the **Ganges and Brahmaputra Rivers** between **India and Bangladesh**.
- ❑ It is characterized by the world's largest **mangrove forest**, featuring an intricate network of rivers. It is a delta formed by the confluence of several rivers, including the Ganges, Brahmaputra, and Meghna.

- ❑ It is also designated as a **Biosphere Reserve**.
- ❑ It is **home to the Bengal tiger**, and the national park is a designated tiger reserve. The **Sundarbans Tiger Reserve** is known for its **adaptation of tigers to a saline environment**.

Keoladeo National Park (Rajasthan)



Fig. 15.21: Siberian Crane

- ❑ It was added in **1985**.
- ❑ It was formerly known as **Bharatpur Bird Sanctuary**.
- ❑ Originally created as a hunting ground, the park was later developed into a **man-made wetland** by the **Maharaja of Bharatpur** to attract waterfowl.
- ❑ Keoladeo is **renowned** for being a major wintering ground for **migratory birds**, especially waterfowl, from Central Asia, Siberia, and Europe. These birds arrive in large numbers during the winter months.
- ❑ It was historically known for hosting the critically endangered **Siberian cranes** during their winter migration.

Kaziranga National Park (Assam)



Fig. 15.22: One-horned Rhinoceros

- ❑ It was added in **1985**.
- ❑ It is situated in the Golaghat and Nagaon districts of Assam. It is part of the larger **Kaziranga-Karbi Anglong landscape**.
- ❑ The park is characterized by a riverine landscape intersected by the **Brahmaputra River** and its tributaries. It includes wetlands, grasslands, and dense forests.
- ❑ It is renowned for its population of the Indian **one-horned rhinoceros**.

Manas Wildlife Sanctuary (Assam)

- It was added in **1985**.
- Manas is situated in the **foothills of the Eastern Himalayas**, extending across the international border into Bhutan. It is in the western part of Assam.
- It is a biodiversity hotspot that includes a range of **forested hills, alluvial grasslands and tropical evergreen forests**. The Manas Wildlife Sanctuary is part of the core zone of Manas Tiger Reserve and lies alongside the shifting river channels of the Manas River.



Fig. 15.23: Pygmy Hog
(Found only in Manas WLS)



IGNITE YOUR MIND

What role do local governments and communities play in the management of World Heritage Sites?

UNESCO WORLD HERITAGE SITES IN INDIA - (MIXED SITES)

Khangchendzonga National Park (Sikkim)

- It was added in **2016**.
- It is a **mixed heritage site** (contain **elements of both natural and cultural** significance).
- It is situated in the eastern Himalayas, encompassing parts of North and West Sikkim. It is named after Mount Khangchendzonga, the third-highest peak in the world.
- It is known for harbouring the **endangered red panda**, a charismatic species endemic to the eastern Himalayas.

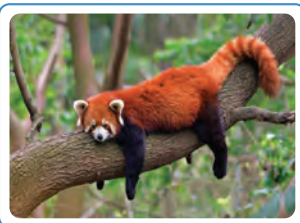


Fig. 15.24: Red Panda

- The park is also home to the **elusive snow leopard**, as well as other Himalayan species such as **Himalayan tahr, Himalayan blue sheep**, and more.
- It includes a **unique diversity** of plains, valleys, lakes, glaciers and spectacular, snow-capped mountains covered with ancient forests.

UNESCO INTANGIBLE CULTURAL HERITAGE

Traditionally, cultural heritage was often associated with monuments, historic sites, and tangible artefacts.

However, UNESCO, through various instruments and conventions, has played a significant role in expanding the scope of cultural heritage to include a broader range of intangible aspects. The understanding now encompasses both tangible and intangible elements that are considered valuable to a community's identity and cultural legacy.

Features of Intangible Cultural Heritage

- Intangible cultural heritage is **dynamic** and exists in both **traditional and contemporary forms**.
- Intangible cultural heritage is **inclusive**, transcending geographical and cultural boundaries. Practices may be shared among diverse cultural groups.
- It reflects a dynamic process of **evolution** (adapting to new circumstances while maintaining a link from the past through the present and into the future) in response to changing environments.
- Intangible cultural heritage contributes significantly to a **sense of identity and continuity**.
- It is not merely valued for its uniqueness or exclusivity but **thrives within communities** that pass the knowledge, traditions, skills, and customs from generation to generation keeping the heritage alive.
- Intangible cultural heritage becomes heritage when it is acknowledged and recognized by the communities, groups, or individuals who create, maintain, and transmit it.

UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage

Sites	Year	Features
Garba of Gujarat	2023	Garba is a ritualistic and devotional dance that is performed on the occasion of the Hindu festival of Navaratri .
Durga Puja in Kolkata	2021	It marks the ten-day worship of the Goddess Durga.
Kumbh Mela (festival of the sacred Pitcher)	2017	It is the largest peaceful congregation of pilgrims on earth , during which participants bathe or take a dip in a sacred river. The festival is held at Allahabad (Triveni Sangam), Haridwar (Ganga), Ujjain (Shipra) and Nasik (Godavari) every four years by rotation.
Yoga	2016	- A practice involving poses, meditation, controlled breathing, chanting, and techniques to achieve self-realisation. - Traditionally, it is transmitted through the Guru-Shishya parampara (teacher-disciple tradition).
Nowruz		It is celebrated as the Parsis New Year .

Traditional Brass and Copper Craft of Utensil Making among the Thatheras of Jandiala Guru in Punjab	2014	An oral tradition passed through generations of the Thathera community. - It involves heating and moulding metals like brass, copper, and Kansa into functional and ritualistic utensils. - Recommended in Ayurveda texts for medicinal purposes. - Patronised by Maharaja Ranjit Singh in the 19th century.
Sankirtana, ritual singing, drumming and dancing of Manipur	2013	- It is a Manipuri ritual art form that combines singing, drumming, and dancing to mark religious occasions and stages in the lives of Manipuri Vaishnavites. - It is performed at temples, narrating the life and deeds of Lord Krishna.
Buddhist chanting of Ladakh	2012	- Buddhist lamas (priests) chant sacred texts representing the spirit, philosophy and teachings of the Buddha. Two forms of Buddhism are practised in Ladakh – Mahayana and Vajrayana – and there are four major sects, namely Nyngma, Kagyud, Shakya and Geluk. Each sect has several forms of chanting, practised during life-cycle rituals and on important days in the Buddhist and agrarian calendars.
Chhau dance	2010	The Tribal martial art dance has three subgenres: Purulia Chhau (West Bengal), Seraikella Chhau (Jharkhand), and Mayurbhanj Chhau (Odisha). - Primarily during the spring festival, lasting 13 days, with community-wide participation. - Performed by male dancers at night, enacting episodes from epics including the Mahabharata and Ramayana and local folklore. - Dancers wear masks, except for Mayurbhanj Chhau.
Kalbelia folk songs and dances of Rajasthan	2010	- It is performed by the Kalbelia tribe in Rajasthan, known for their snake-catching and trading occupations. - Women in flowing black skirts dance and swirl, replicating the movements of a serpent, while men accompany them on the Khanjari percussion instrument and the Poongi, a woodwind instrument traditionally played to capture snakes.
Mudiyettuu		It is traditional ritual theatre, folk dance, and drama in Kerala depicting the battle between Goddess Kali and the demon Darika. - Performed in village temples (Bhagavati Kavus) from February to May, post-harvest. - Performers wear heavy makeup, gorgeous attire, facial painting, and tall headgear, embodying the supernatural.
Ramman	2009	- It is a religious festival, and ritual theatre celebrated in Saloor-Dungra villages, Chamoli district, Uttarakhand, to honour the village deity Bhumiya Devta with offerings in the village temple courtyard. - Key aspects include the singing of Jagar, and narrating local legends.
The Tradition in Vedic Chanting	2008	It is among the oldest unbroken oral traditions, involving several pathas (recitations) or ways of chanting Vedic mantras.
Ramlila		Ramlila, literally “Rama’s play”, is a performance of epic Ramayana in a series of scenes that include song, narration, recital and dialogue. It is performed across northern India during the festival of Dussehra.
Kutiyattam (Sanskrit Theatre)		- It is considered one of the oldest surviving forms of classical theatre, which represents a synthesis of Sanskrit classicism and reflects the local traditions of Kerala. - The plays performed in Kutiyattam are based on classical Sanskrit texts, particularly those attributed to ancient playwrights like Bhasa and Kalidasa. The narratives often include episodes from the Indian epics, the Ramayana and the Mahabharata. - It is traditionally performed in theatres called Kuttampalams, which are located in Hindu temples. - The actor’s art lies in elaborating a situation or episode in all its detail. Therefore, a single act may take days to perform and a complete performance may last up to 40 days.

List of UNESCO world heritage sites in India

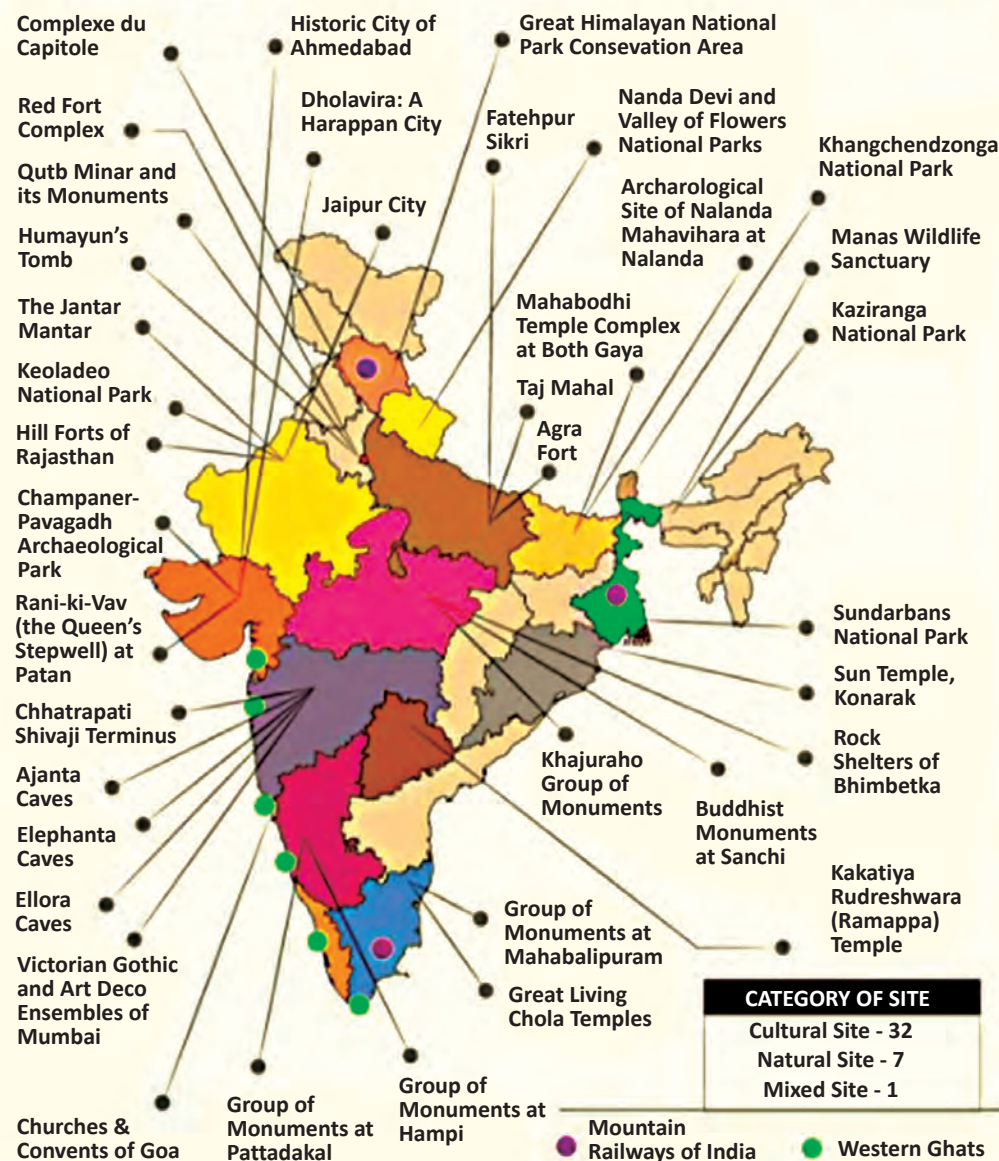


Fig. 15.25: UNESCO World Heritage Sites in India (Till 2022)

CONCLUSION

In summary, UNESCO World Heritage status, whether for tangible or intangible heritage, not only celebrates the unique value of sites and practices but also contributes to their preservation, promotion, and sustainable development on a global scale. The Indian constitution also has the provisions viz. **Article 29** (Protection of Interest of Minorities), **Article 49** (Protection of Monuments and Places and Objects of National Value) and **Article 51A (f)** (To Value and Preserve the Rich Heritage of our Composite Culture) for the protection of Art and culture of India.

INTRODUCTION

India's commercial interactions with the outside world date back to around the middle of the third millennium BC, with travellers journeying extensively and leaving cultural imprints wherever they went. Conversely, they also absorbed ideas, customs, and traditions from distant lands. What's noteworthy about this dissemination is that it didn't occur through conquest or coercion but through the voluntary embrace of India's cultural and spiritual principles.

Spread of Indian Culture

❑ Role of Traders

- In ancient times, Indian traders ventured to distant lands in pursuit of new business prospects.
- Items of trade used to be carnelian, agate, mallow, muslin cloth, glass, pearls, rare stones etc.
- As early as the first century BC, they journeyed to regions like **Indonesia** and **Cambodia** in search of gold, particularly focusing on the islands of **Java, Sumatra, and Malaya**, which earned them the designation "Suvarnavipa."
- The kingdom of Kalinga engaged in trade with **Sri Lanka** during Emperor Ashoka's reign.
- Wherever these traders travelled, they forged cultural connections with the localities, serving as **cultural emissaries** and fostering trade relations with the wider world.

❑ Role of Universities and Teachers

- The universities were the most important centres of cultural interaction. Students and teachers from such universities carried Indian culture abroad along with its knowledge and religion.
 - ❑ **Huien-Tsang** describes his stay at two very important universities—one in the east, **Nalanda** and the other in the west, **Valabhi**.
 - ❑ The Tibetan scholar **Taranatha** has given a description of **Vikramshila University**. Teachers and scholars of this university were so famous that



Fig. 16.1: Huiyen Tsang

the Tibetan king is stated to have sent a mission to invite the head of the university to promote interest in common culture and indigenous wisdom.

- ❑ **Odantapuri** in Bihar grew in stature under the patronage of the Pala kings. A number of Monks migrated from this university and settled in Tibet.
- ❑ **Jnanabhadra** went to Tibet with his two sons to preach Dharma. A monastery was founded in Tibet on the model of Odantapuri University.
- ❑ The head of the Vikramashila University, **Acharya Ateesha**, went to Tibet in the eleventh century and gave a strong **foundation to Buddhism in Tibet**.
- ❑ **Romas** (an ethnic group of Indo-Aryan origin who traditionally lived a nomadic, itinerant lifestyle) **or Gypsies**, groups of Indians, went abroad as wanderers. They spread to many countries of Europe. It took them almost four hundred years to spread to these countries. By that time, though they had forgotten their original home, they did retain their language, customs, ways of living, and their professions.

COUNTRY-WISE INFLUENCE OF INDIAN CULTURE

Central Asia

- ❑ From the **2nd century B.C.** onward, India maintained extensive **commercial connections** with **China, Central Asia, West Asia**, and the **Roman Empire**.
- ❑ Central Asia, bordered by China, Russia, Tibet, India, and Afghanistan, served as a crucial corridor for trade. Despite the challenges, traders travelled regularly between India and China through this region. This route, later known as the **Silk Route**, gained its name from the prominence of silk among China's trade goods.
- ❑ Over time, scholars, monks, and missionaries also utilized this route. It played a pivotal role in the exchange of cultures across the known world, with Indian culture making a significant impact in Central Asia.



Fig. 16.2: Bamiyan Buddha, Afghanistan

- ❑ Among the kingdoms of Central Asia, **Kuchi** was a very important and flourishing centre of Indian culture.
- ❑ Cultural exchanges that took place between India and the countries of Central Asia are visible from the discoveries of **ancient stupas, temples, monasteries, images and paintings** found in all these countries.
- ❑ Silk and jade, horses and valuables changed hands, but the most lasting treasure that travelled along the route was **Buddhism**. Thus, the trade route transmitted religion and philosophy, ideas and beliefs, languages and literature, and art and culture.
- ❑ **Khotan** was one of the most important outposts.
 - Coins found from the first century AD bear engravings in Chinese on the obverse and Prakrit in Kharosthi script on the reverse providing evidence of a composite culture in Khotan.
 - A large number of Sanskrit manuscripts, translations and transcriptions of Buddhist texts in Sanskrit were discovered in the monasteries buried in sand.
- ❑ Indian art styles blended with **Greek and Kushana influences** in **Central Asia** extend India's cultural reach up to Bakh.
 - The **Gandhara school of art** in Afghanistan and Central Asia drew from Indian artistic traditions.

China

- ❑ The contact between India and China began around the 2nd Century BC.
- ❑ Indian culture first entered China with two **monk scholars** - **Kashyapa Martanga** and **Dharmarakshita**.
- ❑ There was a continuous flow of scholars from India to China and from China to India. The Chinese who came in search of wisdom wrote about India and the Indian culture (Eg. **Si-Yu-Ki** by **Hiuen Tsang** and **Fo-Kwo-Ki** by **Fa Hien**) to such an extent that today they are the most important sources of Indian history.
- ❑ **I-Tsing** rendered numerous Pali and Sanskrit Buddhist texts into Chinese, including the Golden Light Sutra and Avadanas.
- ❑ Prominent teachers from the Indian Universities and monasteries became famous in China.
 - A scholar named **Bodhidharma** went to China from Kanchipuram. He carried the **philosophy of Yoga** with him and popularized the practice of '**dhyana**' (**meditation**), which was later known in China as **ch'an**.
- ❑ In the fourth century AD, **Wei Dynasty** came to power in China. Its first emperor declared **Buddhism** as the **state religion**. This gave an impetus to the spread of Buddhism in China.

- With the spread of Buddhism, China began to build cave temples and monastic complexes on a large scale. **Dun-huang, Yun-Kang** and **Lung-men** are among the most famous cave complexes in the world. Indian influences are quite evident in these complexes.

Korea

- ❑ Korea received Indian cultural elements through China. **Sundo** was the first Buddhist Monk who entered Korea, carrying a Buddha image and sutras in AD 352.
- ❑ Sundo was followed by **Acharya Mallananda** who in AD 404 built two temples in the Pyongyang city in Korea.
- ❑ Acharya Mallananda was followed by a number of teachers from India. They brought philosophy, religion, the art of making images, painting, and metallurgy.
- ❑ Out of devotion to wisdom, Buddhist texts (Eg. Tripitaka Koreana) were printed by the Koreans in six thousand volumes. Indian scripts had also reached Korea by then.

Japan

- ❑ The earliest historical evidence of Indian culture going to Japan is from 552 AD.
- ❑ At that time, the Korean Emperor sent a Buddhist statue, sutras, instruments for worship, artists, sculptors, painters and architects as gifts for the Japanese Emperor.
- ❑ Soon, Buddhism was given the status of **State Religion**. Thousands of Japanese became monks and nuns.
- ❑ **Sanskrit** was accepted as the sacred language in Japan. As the language of Buddhist scriptures, it is a cementing force between India and Japan.



Fig. 16.3: The Great Buddha of Kamakura

Tibet

- ❑ The Tibetan **king Naradeva** is believed to have sent his minister **Thonmi Sambhot** accompanied by sixteen outstanding scholars, to Magadha, where they studied under Indian teachers.
- ❑ **Thonmi Sambhot** devised a new script for Tibet in the seventh century on the basis of Indian alphabets of the Brahmi script. Till today, the same script is being used in Tibet.
- ❑ On going back to Tibet, he wrote a new grammar for the Tibetans, which is said to be based on the Sanskrit grammar written by Panini.

- Thonmi Sambhot carried with him a number of books from India. From the seventh to seventeenth century, there was continuous effort on translation. According to this tradition, ninety-six thousand Sanskrit books were translated into Tibetan.

Sri Lanka

- **King Ashoka** made great efforts to propagate Buddhism outside India. He sent his son **Mahendra** and daughter **Sanghamitra** to Sri Lanka to spread the message of the Buddha. A number of other scholars also joined them.
- The teachings of the Buddha were transmitted orally by the people who had gone from India.
- The first monasteries built there were **Mahavihar** and **Abhayagiri**.
- Buddhism played an important role in shaping Sri Lankan culture. The **Dipavansa** and **Mahavamsa** are well-known Sri Lankan Buddhist sources.
- With Buddhism, Indian Art forms also reached Sri Lanka, where the themes, styles and techniques of paintings, dance, folklore and art and architecture were taken from India.
- **Tamil language** is the official language of Sri Lanka and Singapore.

Myanmar

- People and culture of India began to reach Myanmar at the beginning of the Christian era.
- In Burma, Pagan was a great centre of Buddhist culture from the eleventh to the thirteenth century. It is still famous for its magnificent Pagodas.
- **King Aniruddha** was a great builder who built **Shwedagon Pagoda** and about a thousand other temples.
- They also **developed their own Pali language** and translated both Buddhist and Hindu scriptures into their version of Pali.
- Indian traditions were quite strong at the Burmese court. Up to recent times, the court astrologers, soothsayers and professors were known to be brahmins called **ponnas**. Most of them were believed to be from Manipur.



Fig. 16.4: Shwedagon Pagoda

Thailand

- Indian cultural influences began to reach there in the first century AD. It was first carried by Indian traders, followed by teachers and missionaries.
- The Thai kingdoms were given Sanskrit names such as **Dwaravati**, **Shrivijay**, **Sukhodaya** and **Ayutthiya**. The names of their cities also indicate a strong cultural interflow.

- The word **"Songkran"** comes from the Sanskrit word **Samkranti** meaning transformation or change. It is the Thai New Year's national holiday.

- Brahminical images and Buddhist temples began to be constructed in the third and fourth century AD. The earliest images found in Thailand are those of Lord Vishnu.
- A number of temples were built. There are four hundred temples in Bangkok, the present capital of Thailand.
- **Ramakien** is an important part of the Thai literary canon. It is thought to be influenced by the Valmiki's Ramayana and Vishnu Purana.

Cambodia

- The history of the deep-rooted cultural relationship between India and Cambodia goes back to the first and second centuries AD. In Kambuja (Cambodia), **Kaundinya dynasty** of Indian origin ruled from the first century A.D.
- Cambodians constructed huge monuments and embellished them with sculptural representations of Shiva, and Vishnu. Buddha and other divinities from Indian Epics and the Puranas.
- Sanskrit remained their language for administration till the fourteenth century.
- Their kings bore Sanskrit names. Brahmins assumed the highest position.
- The government was run according to the Hindu polity and Brahminical jurisprudence.
- A large number of localities were given Indian names like Tamrapura, Dhruvapura and Vikramapura.

Angkor Vat

Initially a Hindu temple dedicated to **Vishnu**, it evolved into a "Hindu-Buddhist" temple in later period.



Fig. 16.5: Angkor Vat Temple

- Angkor Vat is supposed to be the abode of Vishnu, that is, **Vaikunthadhama**.
- Its five towers are said to be the five peaks of the Sumeru mountain.
- The **king Suryavarman** is portrayed there as an incarnation of Vishnu.
- Scenes from Ramayana and Mahabharata are engraved on the walls of this temple. The largest among all of them is the scene of Samudra Manthan which is churning of the ocean.
- Recently it earned the title of **"8th wonder of the world"**.

Vietnam (Champa)

- Indian culture was carried to the distant land of Vietnam by a number of enterprising traders and princes who migrated and established themselves as pioneers in the field of politics and economics.
- The people of Champa are called Cham. They built a large number of Hindu and Buddhist temples.
- The Cham people worshipped Shiva, Ganesha, Saraswati, Lakshmi, Parvati, Buddha and Lokeswara.

Malaysia

- Malaysia has been known to us since ancient times.
 - There are references in the **Ramayana**, the **Jataka stories**, **Malindapanha**, **Shilapadikaram**, **Raghuvamsha** and many other works.
 - Evidence of **Shaivism** has been discovered in Kedah and in the province of Wellesley.
 - Female figurines with tridents have been unearthed.
- **Brahmi**, in its late form, was the script of ancient Malaysia.
- Tablets of Buddhist texts written in a script that resembles **old Tamil** have been found at Kedah.
- **Sanskrit** was one of the source languages for them. Till today a fairly large number of Sanskrit words can be seen in their language.

Indonesia

- In the field of religious architecture, the largest Shiva temple in Indonesia is situated in the island of Java. It is called Prambanan. It has a Shiva temple flanked by Vishnu and Brahma temples.

Borobudur Temple Compounds

- This is one of the greatest Buddhist monuments in the world, and was built in the 8th and 9th centuries AD during the reign of the **Syailendra Dynasty**.



Fig. 16.6: Borobudur Temple

- The Borobudur Temple Compounds consist of three monuments: namely the Borobudur Temple and two smaller temples situated to the east on a straight axis to Borobudur.
- This is a UNESCO World Heritage Site.
- Over five hundred hymns, stotras dedicated to Shiva, Brahma, Durga, Ganesha, Buddha, and many other deities have been discovered from Bali.
 - Bali is the only country where Hindu culture flourished and survived. Today, while the entire Archipelago has accepted Islam, Bali still follows Hindu culture and religion.

- A large number of scriptural works have been found from Java. They are mostly written on palm leaves in their ancient script called Kawi. **The Kawi script** was devised on the basis of Brahmi.
 - Among the texts on Shaiva religion and philosophy, **Bhuvanakosha** is the earliest and the longest text.

Arab world

- India's links with West Asia, by land as well as sea routes, goes back to very ancient times.
- About the **economic aspects of this relationship**, we have from about mid-ninth century AD a number of accounts by Arab and other travellers, such as **Sulaiman**, the Merchant, **Al-Masudi**, **Ibn Hauqal**, **Al Idrisi**, etc, which attest to a flourishing commercial exchange between these areas.
- Evidence for a very active interaction in the cultural sphere, however, goes back to the eighth century and earlier. The fruitful cultural intercourse between India and West Asia is evident in many areas.
 - In the field of **astronomy**, two important works, namely the **Brahma-Sphuta-Siddhanta**, better known to the Arab world as **Sindhin** and **Khandakhadyaka** (known as Arkand), were brought to Baghdad by embassies from Sindh.
 - **Aryabhatta's** and **Varahamihira's** works on astronomy were also studied and incorporated into the scientific literature of the Arabs.
 - Another important contribution of India to Arab civilization was **mathematics**. Indians in the 500 BC created unique symbols for numbers 1 to 9. Arabs adopted these symbols as numerals. Traders introduced **decimals** to Arabia. Arabs recognised this as '**hindisat**' (Indian math). The Western world later adopted these concepts.
 - A number of Arab sources dating back to the tenth and thirteenth centuries inform us about several Indian works on **medicine** and **therapeutics** that were rendered into Arabic.
 - For instance, the **Sushruta Samhita** was translated by an Indian called **Mankh** in Arabic.
 - The other fields of Indian knowledge they studied included works on snake poison, veterinary art and books on logic, philosophy, ethics, politics and science of war.

Rome

- The first three centuries of the Christian era saw a profitable sea-borne trade with the West, represented mainly by the Roman Empire, which had become India's best customer. This trade happened mostly in South India. Trade became one of the most important drivers of cultural exchange.

- Items like **pepper, betel, spices, scents** and **precious stones** like **beryl, gem, diamond, ruby** and **amethyst, pearls, ivory, silk** and **muslin** were in great demand.
 - This trade with Rome was bound to bring in gold to India which helped establish a stable gold currency for the **Kushana empire** of those days.
 - The volume of trade with Rome was so high that to facilitate its movement, ports like **Sopara** and **Barygaza (Broach)** came to be built on the west coast, while the Coromandel coast in the east carried on trade with “Golden Chersonese (Suvarnabhumi) and Golden Chyrse (Suvarnadvipa)”.
- At a site called **Arikamedu** near Pondicherry, specimens of the famous Italian pottery known as Arretine with the Italian potter’s stamps imprinted on them and fragments of a Roman lamp have also been found.

Europe

- Cultural exchanges with Europe under Manuel I of Portugal influenced architectural styles.
- Christian basilicas in Europe share similarities with Buddhist stupas, particularly in their mosaics.
- Gothic sculptures in European cathedrals, like those in Bayeux, Aachen, and Trier, show Indian motifs.

The Fibonacci sequence

The **Fibonacci numbers** and their sequence first appeared in Indian mathematics, as **Matrameru** mentioned by **Pingala**.

- Long before the Italian mathematician Fibonacci introduced the sequence, the mathematicians Virahanka, Gopala, and Hemacandra developed the methods for forming these numbers.
 - The Fibonacci sequence is a sequence in which each number is the sum of the two preceding ones.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

How has India’s historical role as an exporter of religious and scientific ideas influenced global spiritual and material development?

CONCLUSION

Indian culture abroad reflects the diversity, creativity, and resilience of Indian people and their cultural heritage, contributing to global multiculturalism and enriching the cultural landscape of countries around the world.

MARTIAL ARTS IN INDIA

Introduction

Dhanurveda, a branch of the Vedas written between 1700 and 1100 BC, has references to martial arts. Derived from the words meaning bow (Dhanushya) and knowledge (Veda), Dhanurveda is known as the “science of archery” in Puranic literature. Later on, the term “martial arts” was employed generically.

Historical References

□ Indus Valley Civilization

- Two men are shown spearing each other on a seal from the Indus Valley Civilization, appearing to be focused on a woman.
- At one site in the Indus Valley, a statue depicting a spear thrower was also found.



Fig. 17.1: Spear throwers, IVC

□ **Vedic Era:** In the Vedic era, it was formalized into four forms. Four upaveda (applied Vedas) are mentioned in Shaunak Charanavyuha. They include military sciences (shastrashastra) and archery (Dhanurveda).

□ The Mahabharata and the Malla Yuddha

- The Mahabharata tells of fighters armed only with daggers besting lions, and describes a prolonged battle between Arjuna and Karna using bows, swords, trees, rocks and fists.
- There is also a mention of the first known organized unarmed fighting sport in the Indian subcontinent, i.e. malla-yuddha, or battle-wrestling.

□ **Sangam Literature:** Written documentation of martial arts in Southern India can be found in the Sangam literature, which was composed between the second century BC and the second century AD. The Akananuru and Purananuru tell about the Sangam era’s use of spears, swords, shields, arrows, and Silambam.

Important Martial Arts

Martial Art	State	Features
Pari-Khanda	Bihar	□ Its elements are absorbed into the Chhau dance, which relies on its steps and techniques. □ The Rajputs created it using a shield (Pari) and a Sword (Khanda).
Thoda	Himachal Pradesh	□ The name “Thoda” is derived from the round wooden piece attached to an arrow’s head to minimise its lethal potential. □ It combines martial arts, sports, and culture to invoke the blessings of the Goddesses Mashoo and Durga during Baisakhi. □ Two groups of around 500 people participate, called Pashis and Saathis, believed to be descendants of the Pandavas and Kauravas. □ The game is played on a marked court, and archers aim for the leg below the knee to score points.
Kalaripayattu	Kerala	□ The martial art is practised in the training hall or gymnasium known as Kalari. According to legends, it was introduced by sage Parasurama. It includes unarmed and armed combat with a strong emphasis on footwork. Women and men practise it. □ Important terms • Uzhichil: a Gingli oil massage. • Otta: a stick with an ‘S’ shape used in combat. • Maipayattu: Body exercises. • Puliyanam: Sword fighting. • Verumkai: Bare-handed combat. • Angathari: Utilizing metal weapons and Kolthari sticks.



Fig. 17.2: Kalaripayattu

Mardani Khel	Maharashtra	- It emphasises weaponry skills, especially swords, swift movements, and low stances suitable for hill ranges. - Notable for using the unique Indian Pata (sword) and Vita (corded lance). - It was used effectively by Shivaji against the Mughals.
Thang-ta and Sarit Sarak	Manipur 	- Thang-ta is an armed martial art using a sword (Thang) and a spear (Ta). It involves ritualistic practices and uses practical techniques for combat. - Thang-Ta was popularized in Manipur during the 17th century when the state was ruled by the Meitei kingdom who used it effectively against the British. Thus, it was banned during British rule but resurfaced after independence. - Sarit Sarak is an unarmed combat art known for its offensive and evasive actions. The two components Thang-Ta and Sarit Sarak, are together called Huyen Langlon.
Cheibi Gad-ga	Manipur	It is one of Manipur's ancient martial arts involving sword and shield fighting. Its modified versions use a soft-leaf stick (Cheibi) encased as a sword and a leather shield. The contest occurs in a circle on a flat surface.
Inbuan Wrestling	Mizoram	It is a native martial art which dates back to 1750 AD in Dungtlang village. It has strict rules which include staying within the circle, no kicking, and no knee bending. Victory involves lifting the opponent off their feet and catching the opponent's belt.
Insu Knawr	Mizoram	The players use a round wooden rod within a circle. Each player in this match attempts to force the other player out of the ring by pushing them through the side or back of the circle.
Gatka	Punjab 	- The name "Gatka" is associated with freedom and grace and may have roots in the Sanskrit word "Gadha," meaning mace. - It is a weapon-based martial art practised by the Sikhs in Gatka. - It involves using weapons like stick, Kirpan, Talwar and Kataar.
Silambam	Tamil Nadu 	- References to trading silambam staves, pearls, swords, and armour to foreign traders are found in the Silappadikaram. - It is of divine origin, with Lord Murugan (in Tamil mythology) and sage Agastya having created Silambam. - It evolved from a pure defence art into a combat exercise. - The art also spread to Malaysia, where it's a well-known sport and self-defence method.
Kuttu Varisai	Tamil Nadu	It was first mentioned in Sangam literature. - It is empty-hand Silambam, focussing on athleticism, footwork, stretching, yoga, gymnastics, and breathing exercises. - Techniques include grappling, striking, and locking, with animal-based sets such as snake, eagle, tiger, elephant, and monkey.

Varma Ati	Tamil Nadu	It focuses on attacks aimed at the body's vital spots. Usually, practice is conducted outside or in open spaces covered by palm fronds. Asans are the term for masters.
Musti Yuddha	Uttar Pradesh	Originating in Varanasi, it is an unarmed martial art resembling boxing, including kicks, punches, and knee and elbow strikes. It incorporates physical, mental, and spiritual development.
Kathi Samu	Andhra Pradesh	- It is an ancient skill mastered by royal armies. - Sword fighting is the focus of this martial art. - The term "Kathi" itself means "sword."
Sqay	Jammu and Kashmir	- This art belongs to the region of Kashmir. - It involves the use of swords and shields.
Mallakhamb	Madhya Pradesh	 - The gymnast performs aerial Yoga poses in concert with a vertical, stationary or hanging wooden pole. - In 2013, the Indian state of Madhya Pradesh declared Mallakhambha as the state sport.
Kirip, Saldu	Andaman and Nicobar	Saldu is an indigenous game that is played among the Nicobarese tribe and it is actually a form of wrestling that does not require a court, only vacant land. A competitor is deemed to have lost if his back makes contact with the ground.
Paika Akhadha	Odisha	
Bandesh	Throughout India	It is an ancient unarmed art that uses various lock holds to defeat an armed assailant without killing him. Another traditional Indian Martial art form, Malla Yuddha, has given rise to Bandesh.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

How can the ancient philosophical aspects of Indian martial arts be applied to modern-day challenges and personal development? Explore the connections between traditional Indian martial arts and other mind-body practices like Yoga or Ayurveda, and how do they complement each other?

These Indian martial arts have deep cultural significance and are often practised as a means of self-defence, physical fitness, cultural preservation, and spiritual development.

While some martial arts have declined in popularity over time, efforts are being made to revive and promote them, both within India and internationally.

FESTIVALS AND FAIRS IN INDIA

Introduction

India, a country known for its festivals and variety, holds a number of fairs that highlight the depth of its customs, history, and culture. These Indian fairs, which range in scale and importance, provide an insight into the various facets of Indian civilization, encompassing its commercial, social, cultural, and religious facets.

Major Festivals of India

Festival	State	Significance
Bathukamma	Telangana	It is a festival of flowers and is celebrated as part of Dussehra.
Bonalu		Bonalu is celebrated during the Telugu month of Ashadam (June/July). The festival is dedicated to Goddess Mahakali.
Ugadi	Karnataka	This festival marks the Kannada New Year. It is celebrated on the first day of the Indian month of Chaitra (March–April).
Doongri	Himachal Pradesh	Celebrated in honour of Hidimba Devi (wife of Bhima) at the Hadimba or Dhungiri temple in Manali, located in the Dhungri van Vihar forest.
Sarhul	Jharkhand	It is celebrated during the spring season, offering Saal flowers to Gods.
Vishu	Kerala	It is the 'Malayalam New Year'. It is celebrated on the first day of the Malayalam month of Medam.
Mela Hemis Gompa	Ladakh	It is held at the Hemis monastery to celebrate the birth of Lord Padmasambhava (founder of the Vajrayana sect of Buddhism) on the 10th day of the Tibetan Calendar, which coincides with the end of the winter season in Ladakh.
Hari Jiroti	Madhya Pradesh	It is a month-long festival of greenery during which the Gond and Korku tribes plant saplings of fruit-bearing trees.
Gudi Padwa	Maharashtra	It is widely celebrated as the Marathi New Year.
Rath Yatra	Odisha	The sacred journey of Lord Jagannath with brother Balabhadra and sister Subhadra from the Jagannath Temple to the Gundicha Temple.
Baisakhi	Punjab, Haryana and western UP	It is celebrated on the first day of the Vaisakh month (April–May) when the harvest is gathered. It is also known as the foundation day of Khalsa Panth.
Gangaur	Rajasthan	It is a spring festival celebrated in honour of Goddess Parvati or Gauri, the wife of Lord Shiva.
Desert festival		It is celebrated in Jaisalmer, showcasing the tradition of Rajasthan, including the camel race.
Pushkar Fair		It is also known as Pushkar Camel Fair, where lakhs flock to Pushkar, along with their camels and cattle, for many days for livestock trading and pilgrimage.
Pongal	Tamil Nadu	It is a major harvest festival.
Teppam		It is a 12-day festival also known as float festival.
Puthandu		It is celebrated as Tamil New Year's Day.
Meenakshikalaynam / Chithirai Festival		This festival is celebrated in Madurai to re-enact the celestial wedding of Goddess Meenakshi (Shakti) with Lord Sundareswarar (Shiva).
Nanda Devi Raj Jat Yatra	Uttarakhand	It is a festival of the Gharwali and Kumaoni people. It is a three-week-long pilgrimage organized once in 12 years.
Chaliha Festival	All India	It is a festival celebrated by the Sindhis, wherein they pray to their god, Jhulelal.
Makar Sankranti		It denotes the sun's entry into the zodiac sign of Makara (Capricorn). It is also celebrated as a thanksgiving to Mother Nature for a good crop.
Basant Panchmi		It is dedicated to the worship of Saraswati (Goddess of Learning).
Cheti Chand		Sindhi New Year, celebrated in honour of the birth of Jhulelal.
Buddha Purnima		It was celebrated as the birth anniversary of Lord Buddha, on a full moon day in the month of Vaisakh.
Gurupurab		It is also known as Guru Nanak's Prakash Utsav and Guru Nanak Dev Ji Jayanti, celebrates the birth of the first Sikh guru, Guru Nanak.

Festivals of North-East India		
Solung	Arunachal Pradesh	It is a socio-religious festival of the Adi communities.
Myoko Festival		It is celebrated in March as a festival of friendship and harmony between various Apatani villages.
Mopin		It is a festival of Galo community and is associated with agriculture. An objective of this festival is to drive away evil spirits.
Buddha Mahotsava		It is celebrated in Tawang to preserve the Buddhist cultural heritage and encourage Buddhist Tourism.
Dree Festival		An agriculture rite observed by Apatanis involving the sacrifice of eggs and animals to the Sun and Moon Gods.
Torgya Monastery Festival		It is celebrated by the Monpa community to welcome a healthy and prosperous new year.
Bihu Festival	Assam	It is celebrated thrice a year to mark the three important stages of agricultural operation. ☐ Bohag Bihu (also known as Rongali Bihu) marks the beginning of sowing. ☐ Kati Bihu is observed to pray for the standing crops. ☐ Magh Bihu (also known as Bhogali Bihu) marks the harvesting season.
Dehing Patkai Festival		It is organised at Lekhpani in January every year and is named after the Dehing River and Patkai range in eastern Assam.
Ambubachi Mela		It is associated with the annual purification rites of Goddess Kamakhya held every year in the middle of the month of June at the Kamakhya Temple. It is also referred to as Mahakumbh of the East.
Majuli Festival		It is organized in November on Majuli Island by the State Ministry of Assam, with the invocation of the local patron deity during opening and closing ceremonies.
Kang Chingba	Manipur	It is a 10-day-long festival that is celebrated in July every year celebrated by the Meitei community who follow Vaishnavism.
Sajibu Nongma Pānba or Cheiraoba Festival		It is the Manipuri New Year celebrated during the Manipuri month of Sajibu (March/April).
Nongkrem Dance Festival	Meghalaya	It is celebrated annually to appease the Goddess Ka Blei Synshar for the people's rich bumper harvest and prosperity.
Wangala Festival		It is a harvest festival among the Garos to thank Misi Saljong, the 'Sun God' and Mini-ma Kiri Rokime, the 'Goddess of Grains'.
Chapchar Kut	Mizoram	It is a thanksgiving festival celebrated after clearing the jungles for Jhum cultivation. It is also celebrated as a spring festival with great fervour.
Losoong Festival	Sikkim	It is a festival to celebrate the harvest. The Black Hat dance takes place at this festival commemorating the victory of good over evil, with 'chaams' held in many monasteries two days prior to Losoong.
Saga Dawa		It is celebrated by Buddhist communities of the State.
Kharchi Puja	Tripura	The festival involves the worship of the fourteen gods forming the dynasty deity of the Tripuri people, and is observed on the eighth day of the new moon in July or August every year.

Fairs of India

Fairs	State	Significance
Sonepur Mela	Bihar	☐ It is associated with the Hariharanatha Temple in Sonepur , at the confluence of the Ganga and Gandak rivers . ☐ It occurs in November on Kartik Poornima , for trading elephants, dating back to Chandragupta Maurya . ☐ It is considered the largest cattle fair in Asia .

Surajkund Fair	Crafts	Haryana	It is an international craft fair held annually for a fortnight from 1st February onwards near Faridabad to showcase regional as well as international crafts and cultural heritage.
Chitra Vichitra Fair		Gujarat	It is the largest tribal fair in Gujarat celebrated mainly by the 'Gharasia' and 'Bhil' tribes on 'Amavasya' after Holi.
Shamlaji Fair			It is celebrated by a tribal community to honour Lord Shamlaji , considered an incarnation of Krishna or Vishnu by taking a holy bath in the Meshno river .
Kolayat Fair (Kapil Muni Fair)		Rajasthan	People take a dip in the holy Kolayat Lake Bikaner on the day of Kartik Poornima to get respite from all their sins.

COINS IN ANCIENT AND MEDIEVAL INDIA

Ancient Coinage

Coins were first used in China and Greece around 700 BC and in India around the 6th century BC.

- ❑ The earliest reference found in the **Vedas**, which uses the term "**Nishka**" to refer to metal coins.
- ❑ The study of coins and medallions is known as **Numismatics**.

Punch Marked Coins (500BC-100BC)

Panini's Ashtadhyayi mentions a "**Ratti**". These coins were cast and die struck manually with one to five incused marks.

Classification

- ❑ During the **Mahajanapadas period (500 BC)**, the **first** Indian punch-marked coins called **Puranas, Karshapanas or Pana** were minted.
 - These coins had irregular shapes and standard weight. They were made of silver with different markings.
 - **Saurashtra coins** featured a **humped bull**, **Dakshin Panchala** had a **Swastika**, and **Magadha** had **five symbols**.
 - These are mentioned in the **Manusmriti** and Buddhist **Jataka stories**.
- ❑ During the **Mauryan Period (322–185 BC)**, these coins were referred to as **Karshapanas**.
 - Chanakya mentioned the minting of punch-marked coins such as '**Rupyarupa**' (silver), '**Suvarnarupa**' (gold), '**Tamrarupa**' (copper), and '**Sisarupa**' (lead) in his **Arthashastra treatise**.
 - Symbols of the **sun** and **six-armed wheel** were the most consistent.



Fig. 17.8: Mauryan Punch Marked coins

- ❑ **Iconography:** Figures like **elephants, horses, lions**, or **Chaitya** on one side, and the **Ujjain symbol** – a cross with four circles at the end of the two crossing lines on the other.
- ❑ **Cowrie Shells** served as another major medium of exchange by the common people for small-scale economic transactions.



Fig. 17.9: Satavahana coins

Coins of the Western Satraps (Indo-Scythians)

- ❑ These coins feature the **king's portrait** on **one side** and **Buddhist chaitya** or **stupa motifs** likely borrowed from Satavahanas on the **other side**.
- ❑ They employed **Prakrit** language in various scripts.

Coins of the Gupta Age (300-550AD)

Gupta coins were primarily made of **gold**, although **silver** and **copper** coins were also issued. The exquisite and creative features seen on Gupta coins make them one of the most remarkably detailed coinage from ancient India.

Depictions on Coins

- Fineness of carved images on both faces of the coins signifies remarkable craftsmanship.
- On **one side**, Gupta coins depicted the **king engaged in various activities** like playing the **veena (Samudragupta)**, performing **rituals, hunting** animals etc.
- The **other side** often featured the **goddess Lakshmi** seated on a throne or a **lotus seal**, or the **queen** herself. Other deities featured included **Durga, Ganga, Garuda**, and **Kartikeya**.
- Inscriptions on coins used to give a description of the inscribed image.

Coins of the Satavahanas

- ❑ Satavahana kings (232 BC-227 AD) primarily used **lead** and an **alloy** of **silver** and **copper** known as "**potin**" as materials.

- ❑ For the **first time**, coins were inscribed in **Sanskrit** (Brahmi script).



Fig. 17.10: Gupta Coins

Transition After Gupta Rule

- ❑ Post-Gupta period coins were characterised by **low metallic content** and **less artistic design**.
- ❑ A mix of designs borrowed from the **Kushana–Gupta pattern as well as foreign designs**, were employed by successor dynasties
- ❑ **South India's Gold Standard**: In South India, a different coin paradigm emerged, moving toward **a gold standard influenced by Roman** gold coins.

Coins of Chalukya Kings (6th-7th century AD)

The **Western Chalukyas** had a **temple or a lion** on one side, with the other side being blank. The **Eastern Chalukyas** had a **boar** at the centre, with **each letter of the king's name** in a separate punch. The other side was blank.

Coins of the Vardhanas (7th Century AD)

Vardhana **silver coins** featured the **king's portrait on one side** and a fan-tailed peacock in the centre, facing right, Brahmi legends around. Harshavardhana's coins used a **new era dating system**, beginning most likely in 606 AD.



Fig. 17.11: Coins by Vardhana

Coins of the Rajput Dynasties (11th-12th Century AD)

Coins were primarily made of **gold, copper, or billon** (a silver-copper alloy), with silver being rarely used. There were **two types** of Rajput Coinage:

- ❑ Displaying the **king's name in Sanskrit on one side** and a **goddess on the other side**.
- ❑ Silver coins with a **seated bull** on one side and a **horseman** on the other.

Coins of the Pandyan, Chola and Pallava Dynasty

- ❑ **Pandyan Dynasty**: Early Pandyan coins were **square-shaped** with an image of an **elephant**. Later, **fish** became a significant symbol. **Gold** and **silver coins** had **Sanskrit** inscriptions, while **copper coins** had inscriptions in **Tamil**.
- ❑ **Chola Dynasty**: **Raja Raja-I's** coins featured the **standing king on one side** and a **seated goddess on the other**, typically with inscriptions in Sanskrit. **Rajendra-I's** coins carried legends like '**Sri Rajendra**' or '**Gangaikonda Chola**' along with emblems of a **tiger and fish**.
- ❑ **Pallava dynasty** coins showcased the figure of a **lion**.



Fig. 17.12: Coins of Chola, Chera, Pandyas and Travancore

Medieval Coinage

Delhi Sultanate Coins (1206-1526 AD)

Sultans of Delhi issued **gold, silver, copper, and billon** coins featuring inscriptions with the **king's name, title, mint's name** and **Hijri calendar** date.

- ❑ **No images of issuing monarchs** due to Islamic prohibition of idolatry.
- ❑ **Iltutmish** introduced **Silver Tanka** and **Copper Jital**.
- ❑ **Alauddin Khilji** replaced the Khalif's name with **self-praising titles**.
- ❑ **Muhammad bin Tughlaq** introduced **bronze, copper coins**, and **token paper currency**.
- ❑ **Sher Shah Suri** established weight standards, **rupiya** (silver), and **dam** (copper).

Vijayanagara Empire Coins (14th–17th century)



Fig. 17.13: Coins of Vijayanagara empire

- ❑ **Gold, pure silver, and copper** coins were issued by the Vijayanagara Empire.
- ❑ **Different coins** for various purposes: **Pagodas** (higher denomination), **Gold Fanams** (fractional units), **Silver Taras** (fractional units), and **Copper coins** (daily transactions).
- ❑ Coins had inscriptions in **Kannada or Sanskrit**.

- ❑ The coins were minted in places called **Barkur Gadyanas** and **Bhatkal Gadyanas**.
- ❑ Images on coins included a double-headed eagle, a bull, an elephant, and Hindu deities.
- ❑ **Gold Vardhan** coin by **Krishna Deva Raya** featured a **seated Vishnu** and a **three-line legend** of Shri Pratap Krishna Raya in Sanskrit on the other side.

Mughal Coinage (1526-1707 AD)



Fig. 17.14: Mughal Coins

- ❑ Mughal standard **gold coin** was called **Mohur** (170-175 grains). Abul Fazl, in '**Ain-i-Akbari**', indicated that a Mohur was equivalent to nine rupees.
- ❑ The Mughal **copper coin** was **derived from Sher Shah's dam**, while the **Silver Rupee** was adopted from Sher Shah's currency.
- ❑ **Akbar** issued round and square coins. His "**Ilahi coins**" promoted his religious creed.
 - **Sahansah was the largest gold coin** and featured the names of the Persian solar months.
- ❑ **Jahangir's** coins included **couplets**, his wife **Nur Jahan name**, and Zodiac signs.

Other Coins

- ❑ Chhatrapati Shivaji issued gold huns and copper Shivarais with titles in Nagari script.
- ❑ **Wodeyar** dynasty (Mysore) coins featured the **Narasimha avatar of Vishnu**.
- ❑ **Haidar Ali and Tipu** Sultan **continued coinage with figures of Shiva, Parvati**.

British and Modern Coinage

British Period

- ❑ The coins of **Bengal** were developed along the **Mughal pattern**.
- ❑ The English coins of Western India developed along **Mughal as well as English patterns**.
 - English pattern coins were struck at the **Bombay Mint**.
 - The **gold coins** were termed **Carolina**, the **silver** coins **Anglina**, the **copper** coins **Cupperoon** and **tin** coins **Tinny**.

- ❑ The first **coinage under the crown** was issued in **1862** and in 1877, Queen Victoria assumed the title the Empress of India.

Today, Coins are minted in four mints owned by the **Security Printing and Minting Corporation of India Ltd. (SPMCIL)**. The mints are located in **Mumbai, Hyderabad, Kolkata and Noida**.

- ❑ The coins are issued for circulation only through the Reserve Bank under **Section 38 of the RBI Act**.



IGNITE YOUR MIND

How did changes in coinage systems reflect shifts in political power, and what insight can we gain about social values and priorities from the imagery and symbols depicted on the coins throughout history?

CALENDARS IN INDIA

Several calendars are followed in India, each with its own significance and purpose. The most widely used calendar in India is the **Gregorian calendar**. However, India also has a rich tradition of traditional calendars, each of which is used in various regions and communities for religious, cultural and agricultural purposes.

Systems Used to Frame Calendars Across Various Regions of India

Solar Year	Lunar Year
❑ It is based on the Earth's orbit around the Sun. ❑ It closely aligns with the seasons and has 12 months (based on the names of the twelve zodiac signs). ❑ The entry of the Sun into a zodiac sign is called a Sankraman or Sankranti, which occurs every month. ❑ The solar year is divided into two halves under the Hindu calendar: Uttarayana (first six months from Makara Sankranti to Karka Sakranti) and Dakshinayana (last six months of the year)	❑ It comprises 12 lunations (the period between successive full or new moons). ❑ The months vary from 29.26 to 29.80 days, resulting in a year of 354 days, 11 days shorter than the solar year. ❑ Lunar months are divided into Pakshas (fortnights), weeks, and days. The two Pakshas are: • Shukla Paksha (bright half), starting the day after the new moon. • Krishna Paksha (dark half), commencing the day after the full moon.

The Four Yugas

❑ Satya Yuga/ Krita Yuga

- It is also known as the **Golden Age** and considered the most virtuous and harmonious phase of existence. It is believed to be an era of truth, purity, and spiritual enlightenment.

❑ Treta Yuga

- It is also known as the **Silver Age**. In this era, human virtues gradually decline, and rituals and sacrifices gain prominence. While righteousness still prevails to a certain extent, moral values begin to wane.

❑ Dvapara Yuga

- This phase is characterized by increasing materialism, dualities, and conflicts. People become more driven by personal desires, and spirituality takes a backseat.

❑ Kali Yuga

- This is often referred to as the **Dark Age**. This era is marked by widespread moral and spiritual degradation, ignorance, and the dominance of negative forces.

Classification of Indian Calendar Forms

Vikram Samvat

- ❑ **Origin:** It commenced approximately in **57 BC**, thus **ahead of the solar Gregorian calendar** by 56.7 years.
- ❑ Attributed to either **King Vikramaditya of Ujjain** or **Malawa Ganarajya**.
- ❑ **Structure:** A calendar system combining both **lunar** and **solar aspects**, rooted in the ancient Hindu heritage.
- ❑ **Calendar Year:** **New Year** begins with the **first day after the new moon** in the month of **Chaitra** (usually March-April in the Gregorian calendar).
- ❑ Comprises **12 months**, including Chaitra, Vaisakha, Jyeshtha, Ashadha, Sravana, Bhadrapada, Asvina, Kartika, Margasirsha, Pausha, Magha, and Phalgun.
- ❑ It is divided into two phases: **Shuklapaksha** (bright) and **Krishnapaksha** (dark).
- ❑ It is **followed across India, except in Bengal**.

Saka Samvat

- ❑ It was established by **King Shalivahan** in **78 AD**.
- ❑ **Calendar Structure:** A combination of **solar and lunar elements** with **12 months**, similar to the Vikram era.
- ❑ **New Year** commences on **22nd March** (**21st March** in Gregorian leap years).
- ❑ **Months:** Follows the sequence Chaitra, Vaisakha, Jyeshtha, Ashadha, Shravana, Bhadrapada, Ashwina, Kartika, Margashirsha, Pausha, Magha, and Phalgun.

Hijri Calendar

- ❑ **The Arabic calendar**, formerly **Amulfil**, was renamed Hijri after **Prophet Mohammed's hijrat** (622 AD).
- ❑ **Structure:** **Lunar calendar** with **12 months**, totalling **354 days**.
- ❑ **Daily Cycle:** The day begins with sunset.
- ❑ **Months** includes **Muharram, Safar, Rabi-al-Awwal, Rabi-ath-thani, Jumada-al-ula, Jumada-al-akhirah, Rajab, Shaban, Ramadan, Shawwal, Dhu-al-Qadah, and Dhu-al-Hijjah**.
- ❑ The months **do not align** with the **seasons or the solar year**, creating a year-to-year discrepancy compared to the Gregorian calendar.

Gregorian Calendar

- ❑ It is based on the birth of **Jesus Christ**.
- ❑ **Structure:** A **solar calendar** beginning on **January 1st**, consisting of **365 days, 5 hours, 48 minutes, and 46 seconds**.
- ❑ Every **four years**, an additional day is added to February to **account for extra hours**, in order to maintain **alignment** with the **solar year**.
- ❑ **Year Type:** Referred to as a civil year.

Zoroastrian Calendar Era

- ❑ Started from 632 AD.
- ❑ **Parsi New Year:** Jamshedi Navroz (March 21, equinox) and Kadmi New Year (Pateti, July- August).

The **Indian Government** has adopted the **Saka Calendar** as the **National Calendar of India**.

The national calendar began to be used on March 22, 1957 (Gregorian calendar), which corresponds to March 1, 1879 (Saka Samvat).

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ISBN 978-93-6034-300-2



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